



SSC

THE BAMF BIBLE

Top 25+ Growth Hacks from 2017

Written by **JOSH FECHTER**

Edited by HOUSTON GOLDEN

INTRODUCTION

Over the last year, I - along with others - had the pleasure to document our life experiments to help other marketers and founders.

I hope you use everything you gain from this book to help improve the lives of others as well.

It starts with being authentic about your journey.

Honesty heals all.

— JOSH FECHTER



Josh Fechter
Co-Founder, CEO
BAMF Media



Houston Golden
Co-Founder, COO
BAMF Media

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CONTRIBUTORS



Hailey Friedman
President at BAMF (SF)



Juan Campos
Co-Founder at NomadApp.co



Jenny Gao
Founder at Fernery



Jordan Crawford
Co-Founder at Scout



Jeremy Gillespie
Founder at Built To Scale



Dana Severson
Director of Marketing at Promoter.io



Gilles De Clerck
Growth Strategist at Salesflare



Jakub Gorajek
Co-Founder, CEO at UnStock



Vaibhav Namburi
Director at Five2One



Leo Gamayunov
Co-Founder, President at TTBA Group

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Facebook Marketing Growth Hacks

Credit: [Juan Campos](#), Founder of NomadApp.co

The success of Nomad App's growing community relies on the combination of 1) content that resonates with our community 2) a small budget for Facebook ads.

We have grown our community from zero to over 70,000 followers on Social Media (of which 7,000 are on facebook). We have spent \$700 USD total over the course of the last year learning and optimizing our processes.

Our best performing ad costs us 6 cents per page like. We have since taken this knowledge and implemented it for clients (mostly consumer facing apps and startups) with similar or even better results.

In the following case-study we outline:

- 1) The mindset that make or break your success on Facebook and social media
- 2) The different ads we use to growth-hack Facebook
- 3) Other applications of Facebook Ads (finding your target audience)

Original content is not always the best content.

I know: you want to create high-quality content that fits your style, tone and message. Then you spend a ton of money in creating original content to see it go down the drain because nobody is engaging with it. Instead, re-purpose content that already did well on other platforms and learn what your audience engages with.

Don't create until you curate. Make mistakes with somebody else's content.

Because you want to build a brand, it doesn't mean that every single piece of content you put out in the beginning needs your logo on it. You can always do that later once you have a community and learned what they like using other people's content.

You can build a community based on topics and interest ALONE.



Especially early on, you want to build engagement with “whatever content does well with your audience (even if it’s not your own content).” The moment you get a ton of engagement on your page consistently, start mixing it with your original content.

Yes, your page is called “business page” but it’s not about your business.

Don’t be romantic about whatever YOU THINK should be your message. **You work for your audience.** You don’t build a community by right-hooking them in every single post. There’s nothing more common than seeing early stage startups pleading for downloads or to “check out their new tool” or “spread the love”.

Where’s the value?

Would you share your own content?

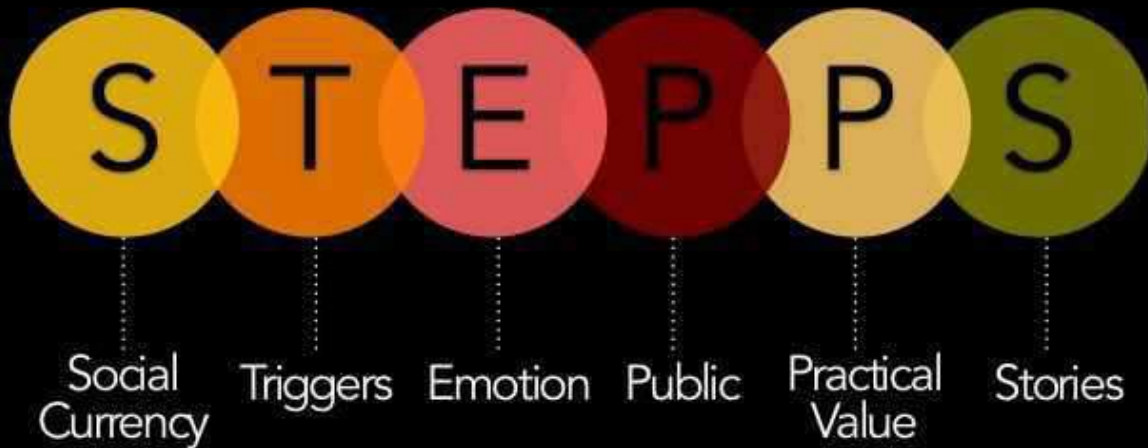
Look at your own Facebook behavior and self-check what you share and engage with: is it pushy: “Buy now;” “Download Now;” “Look at our team playing beer pong” post? Don’t produce that kind of content for your audience.

The moment you have an engaged community and they are actively sharing your content you can right-hook them with “NOW FINALLY DOWNLOAD OUR APP” but don’t do that early on. Nobody will engage. In the beginning (before you average 30-40 qualified likes on every post), produce content that is funny, entertaining, creates emotions and BRINGS REAL VALUE to the community.

Only post things that fall into these categories



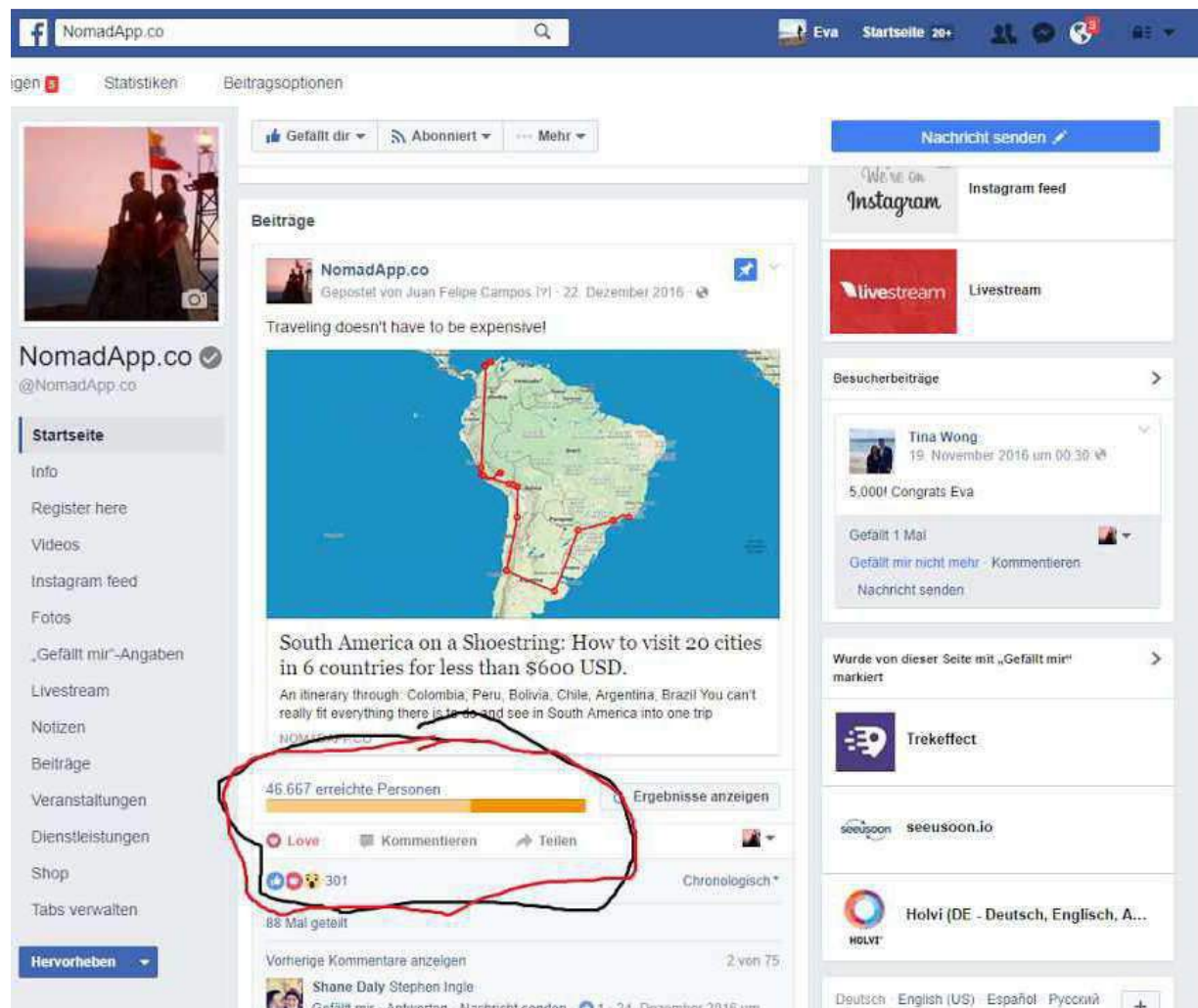
Through a decade of research, Berger found there are six "STEPPS" to creating content that people want to share. They are...



lynda.com

From the book: Contagious by Jonah Berger

Build a community on Facebook. Once you've got people's attention it will be easier to sneak in some sales messages and calls to action like "subscribe to our newsletter."



Here's a screenshot of our first original blog post that got a ton of traction. People loved it! But only because we already had a community and enough experience from recent posts to know EXACTLY what our audience likes and engages with.

Here's an example of what most startups do. This doesn't work:

One more thing on this topic: we constantly see startups struggle with the question of whether they should post "internal startup stuff" or "content for the audience." In our case: "Should we post a photo of the last pitch event that we presented at to keep our audience "up-to-date"?" - The answer is: "No, our audience doesn't care. They are all travelers: all they want to see is travel hacks and inspiring quotes. They aren't entrepreneurs." Post that photo from your pitch event on your personal profile, not on your startup page.

Facebook wants to keep its users on their platform.

If you want to build an engaged community - play by the rules: Facebook doesn't like it whenever you link out to other platforms. Don't link out to YOUTUBE (which is owned by Google, aka Facebook's enemy): Facebook wants to kill YouTube. Facebook also wants to kill Snapchat.

On the contrary, Facebook owns Instagram. Facebook launched its shop function which lets you sell products directly from your page. It also launched Instant Articles which makes it so that big publications' posts open directly within Facebook (and have ads on the bottom of the blog).

Create native content and Facebook will give you more relevance in their algorithm which means more reach and engagement. Today, Facebook is pushing video content. The best type of content you can create is live video. Live video gets the biggest reach. They also implemented that feature on Instagram.

No, it's not (really) about the tool you use or the time you post at. People don't engage with your content because your content sucks.

Don't find excuses and think: *oh it's because I don't know whether to use Hootsuite or Buffer to schedule my posts. Or because I need the new version of photoshop to design content.*

It's not about any of these things. How would any of these 13 year old social media stars become famous if it was about the fancy software and camera they used to produce their content? Crappy phone videos go viral all the time. Focus on your audience and the tools won't matter. People can smell marketers 50 miles against the wind.

It's 80 percent distribution.

Spend 20% of your time creating the content and 80% in distributing it. You can even repurpose old content. A good method for us has also been boosting old, well performing posts again.

"Oh but, how do Likes and Followers even matter"

We keep hearing people hate on us for selling them followers. And we keep telling them: of course, it's not about having 15,000 likes on your facebook page. They need to be relevant and engaged. Yes, sometimes a community of 2,000 engaged followers will be more valuable than



30k empty likes.

We don't sell followers - we sell people's attention. It's on you to figure out with 15,000 people's attention: do you want to sell them t-shirts? An ebook? A course? SaaS? Figure it out. If you don't see the value in having access to tens of thousands of people, then that's on you.

Oh, but isn't Social Media a huge time commitment? I don't have time to post every day.

If your social media person or intern takes too much time, it's because they are doing it wrong. Ideally you would sit down once a month, define the broad pillars of content you'll talk about, produce them (e.g. 3 videos or blog posts) and then chop them up into small pieces of quotes, short gifs, infographics or whatever you want. Schedule these out.

Then, complement with funny or witty content from other people and pages that fit your topic - crowdsource.

Schedule those posts out, too (Facebook's scheduled post tool works fine). Here's your social media on autopilot. Don't wake up every single day thinking about what you should post. You can always improvise over the foundation that you've got scheduled out. So in an ideal world, you'd only check up on your page every other day to boost the most successful posts to reach even more people in your community and manage your ads.

Here's an ideal infographic by Gary Vaynerchuk that shows how he produces content at scale.



A LITTLE BIT OF YOUR TIME < HUGE MONTHLY OUTPUT

30 mins - 1 hour / week of your time required for pillar content capture & review.



Confidential - for internal business use only

20 mins/week needed for approvals of all other content.



vaynerTALENT to derive all these content pieces (articles, images, clips, illustrations, quotes, infographics, texts, audio files, gifs, etc.) from the Pillar Content.



VAYNERMEDIA LLC

Reverse Engineer

Many people drown in their own meetings of strategizing, thinking about how to create a unique voice, etc. Don't! Define your target audience, look at what other people are doing, and reverse engineer. Oh, people like "How to"- blogs and cooking videos. Do that. Your chance of being successful will be better than trying to become original.

Always keep an eye on what other pages are doing and what kind of content does well. We don't say "copy," but keep your eyes open. They are doing the homework FOR YOU.

Know Your Audience

A huge problem for many startups is FOCUS. Especially when you start out, there are hundreds of different things you could do or people that might be a market fit. Whenever you are building your audience, you have to settle for one of them. There's nothing that stalls your growth as much as not knowing who you're producing content for. You can't successfully build a page that targets students, empty nesters, stay-at-home-moms, and event managers at Fortune 500 companies at the same time.

Pick a topic that fits your most profitable target audience and go all in on it. We don't say this to diss you - we all struggle when starting out. The faster you can find your niche and target audience, the better.



Paint-by-the-Dots Facebook Ads Growth-Hacking Strategy

We focus on early stage (consumer facing) startups or individuals who want to build a personal brand and community.

We've realized that most of these startups struggle with two things:

1. How to build a community that engages with my content?
2. How do I remarket to that community and drive traffic to my website/blog/app with this community?

Our Success Strategy

Preparation: Figure out who your audience is. Study your competitors and other pages that produce viral content - make a list of them and collect screenshots of their content.

ATTENTION: If you don't know who you are targeting and producing content for: figure it out. Facebook ads can help you do so.

Growth-Hack your Facebook Page

- 1) Schedule out high-quality content your audience will engage with the most (curate only OR curate and create)
- 2) Build an audience of a few hundred or thousands of people that like your page and engage
- 3) Keep posting high quality content, get a feel for what people like most, post more of that content
- 4) Take the best posts on your page and boost them with \$1 - \$5 of budget to the people who already like your page and their friends.
- 5) Go to the list of people that liked your post and invite them all to like your page
- 6) After a few days or weeks, boost some of the posts again; now to a specific target audience; go back to the list of likers and invite them all

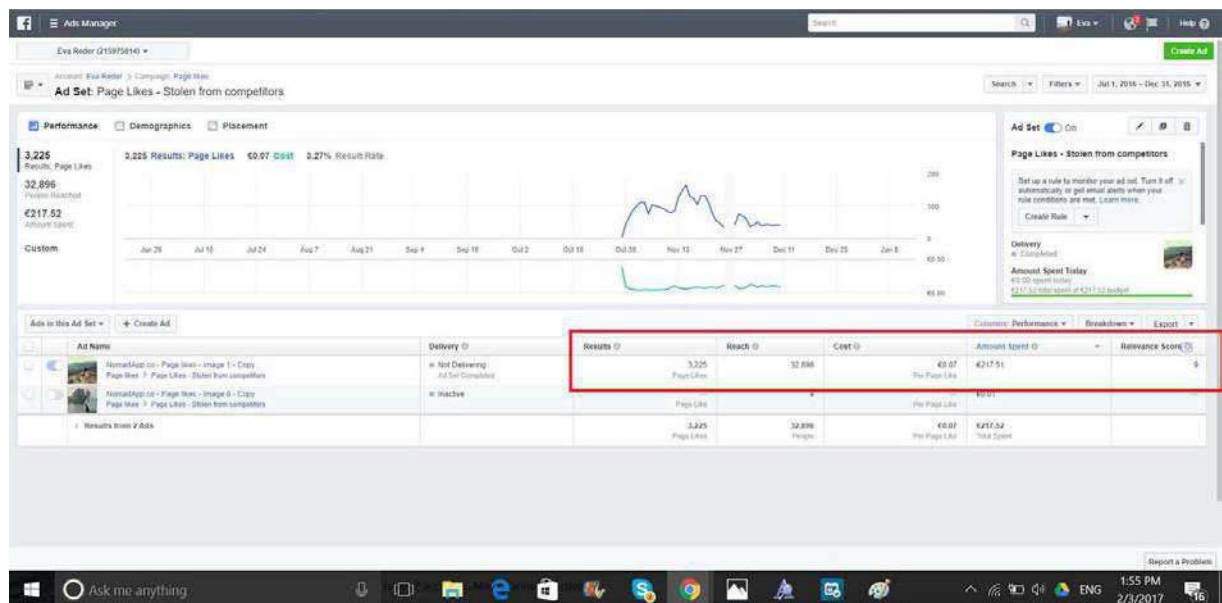
We'll break it down :)



Build a Targeted Community that Likes Your Pages and Engages with Your Content

Today, it's almost impossible to grow your audience purely organically (on Instagram, Twitter or Pinterest it's still easier). First step: set up a hyper targeted Facebook Page Likes campaign.

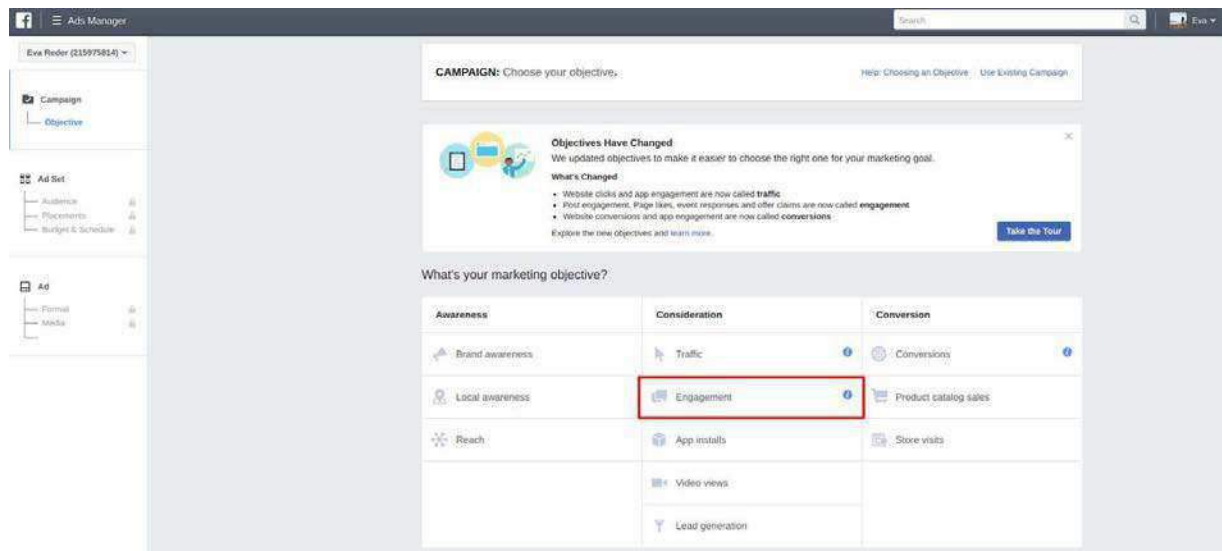
Our best performing ad was the "Stolen from Competitors" (see screenshot below)



As you can see we got 3225 page likes for only 7 cents each and a relevance score of 9 (out of 10). That is the best result of a campaign with targeted followers (not fake likes from a cheap country that don't engage) I have ever seen.

How to create an ad like that up?

You do this by selecting “Engagement” as your objective and then “Page Likes”

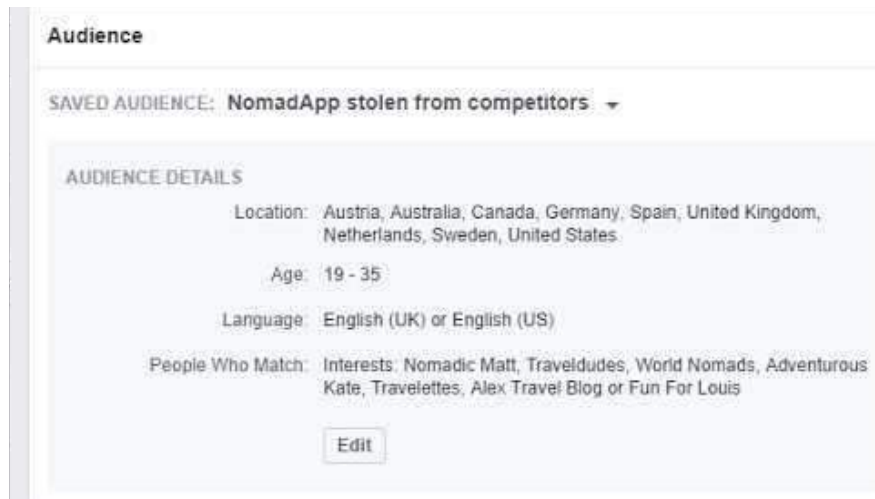


Go ahead and give your campaign a name, and you'll see the setup page. This is where it gets interesting.

The Key to a Successful Ad: The Right Target Audience

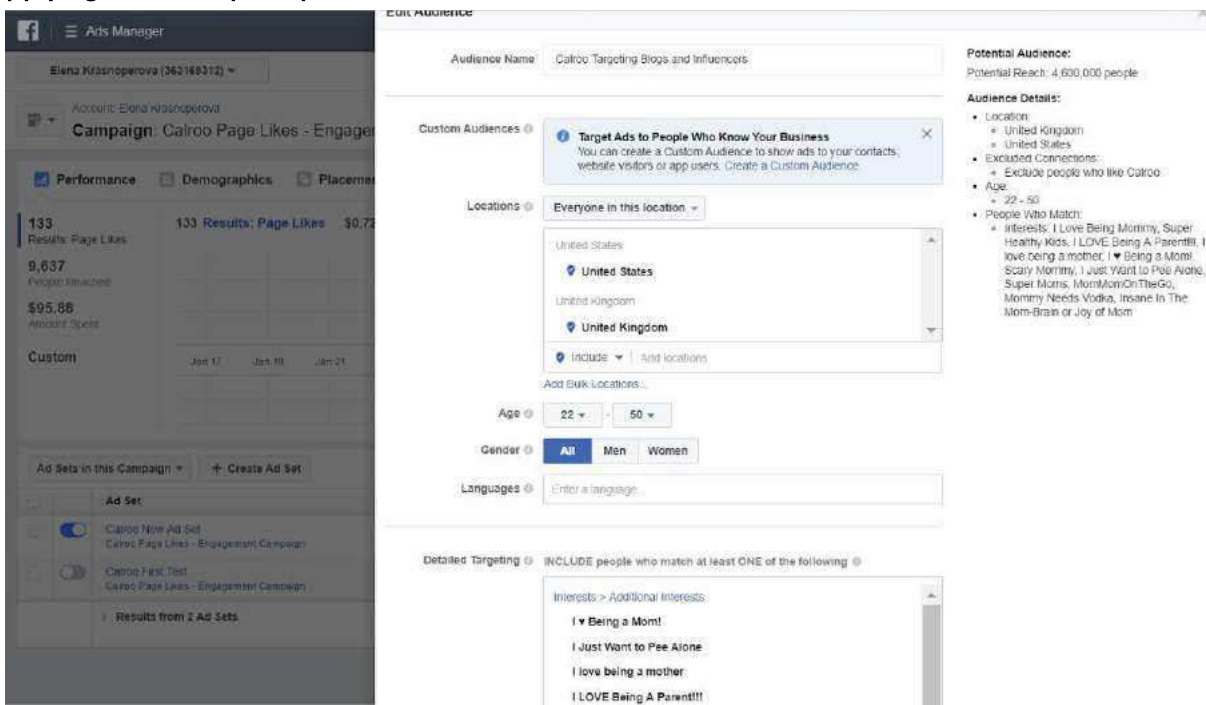
You can get as specific as “target mom’s that live in 64064 Lee’s Summit, Kansas City, that are interested in Bakery Shops and buy a lot of stuff online with a credit card.” Play around with the parameters and get to know the tool.

However, our best performing ads target people who already like Facebook Pages of competitors or other influencers in our space. For travel, it’s mostly other travel bloggers and influencers. We called our audience “stolen from competitors.” See interests: nomadic matt, traveldudes, world nomads etc. NOTE: not any page will work; a page has to have a certain number of followers to qualify as an interest in the targeting tool.



Location: limit the location to countries that don't produce a lot of fake likes (Brazil, India, Pakistan, Turkey etc.)

Another example: Here's the targeting of another ad we ran for a calendar app for families applying the same principles:



Why target other pages?

You'll want to target audiences of pages or communities that already did the work for you. Why? Those leads are more likely to convert and thus cheaper.

Don't target people based on Interests like "Parenting" or similar categories. - these are too broad. You don't know whether these people are likely to engage. Better, target a page in your field that gets a lot of engagement. **Don't go for huge publications or pages. For example, "AirBnB" as a targeted interest when you want to attract backpackers. AirBnB has millions of likes on Facebook but they are not specific enough.**

Your mom might like AirBnB but she will most probably not engage with your backpacker, low-cost, travel hacking startup. You're wasting your marketing dollars advertising to her.

Better, target small and engaged blogs and influencer pages: find the sweet spot with pages that are not so big that they have a ton of irrelevant followers and not so small that they don't qualify as influencers/ interest category on Facebook.

Research a few by yourself by looking for big influencers in your niche on Facebook, check how good engagement is on their page (you don't want to target pages with thousands of followers but zero likes on any posts), add them to your list of target accounts.

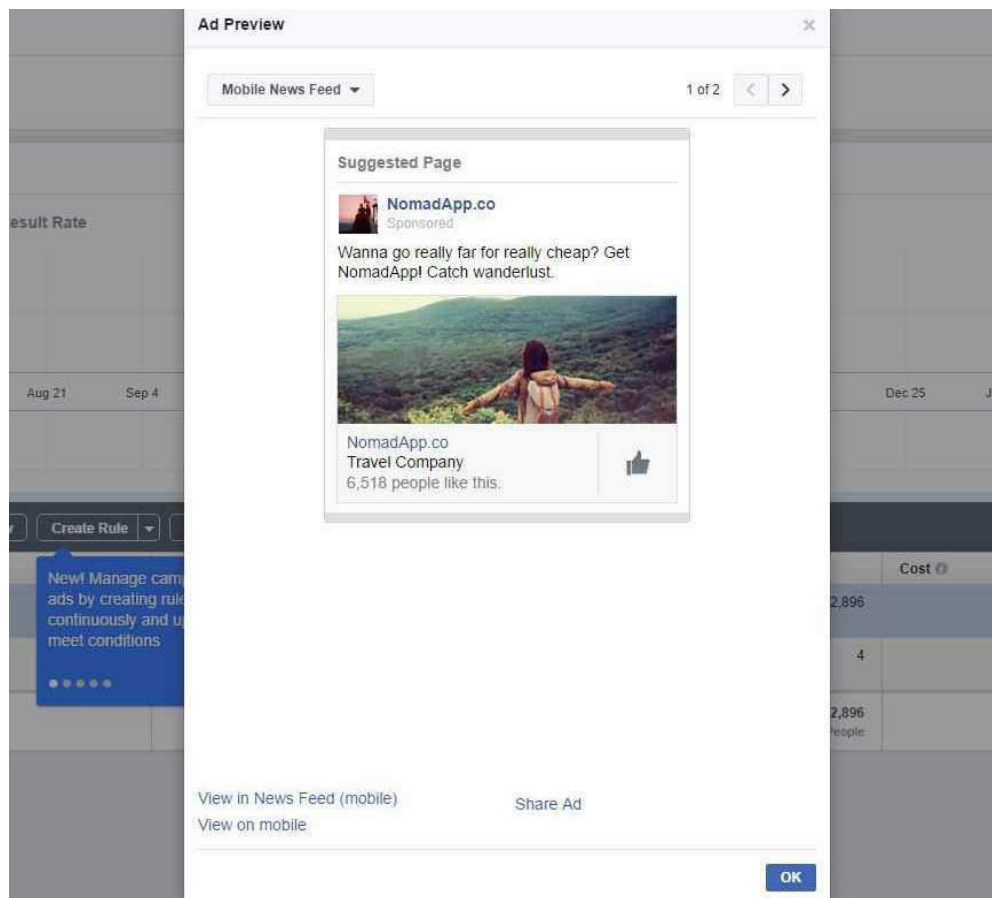
Next, go back to the Facebook Ad audience tool, look up the pages from your list and check whether they qualify as an interest, then click on suggestions and see other pages that Facebook thinks are similar.

If you don't know them, research and make sure they fit your audience and get proper engagement. If yes, add them to the list of target accounts, repeat the process until you have a minimum of five different pages on your list.

Click: Save this audience!

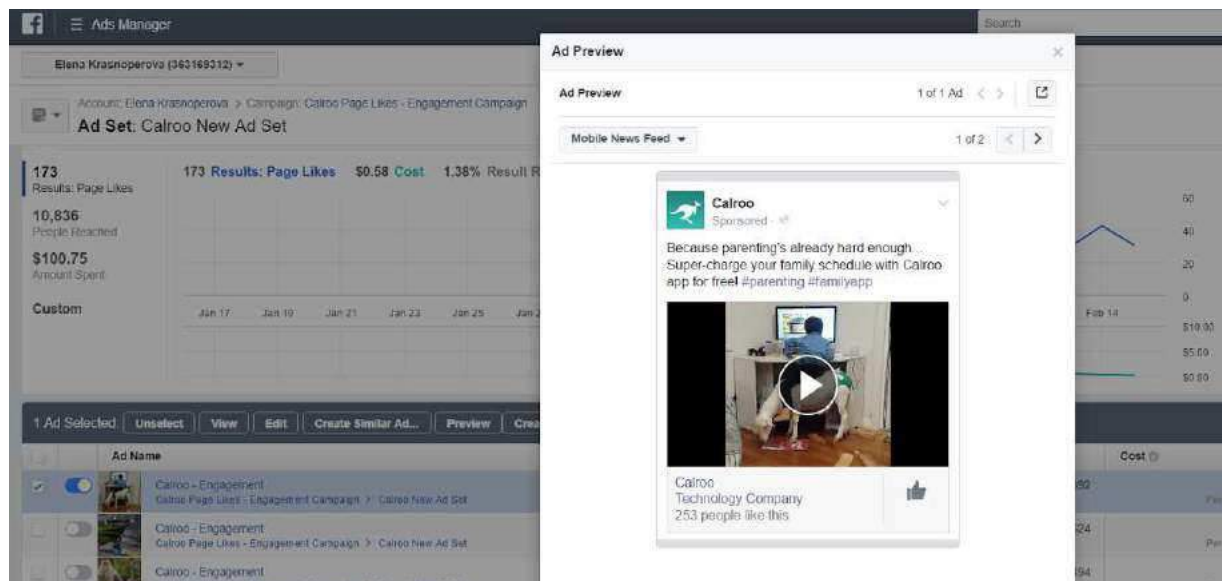
Ad Creative

Facebook now lets you upload up to six different images to test which one do best. Test different images and after a day or a specific amount of ad spend, put the entire budget towards the one that did best.



Preview the ad here: <http://fb.me/1HskoJZnf5DDgl5>

Here's another ad we created for a client: The cost per like right now is at 52 cents with a relevance score of 5. That's good for a page that started from zero two weeks ago. We're up to 200 likes within two weeks.

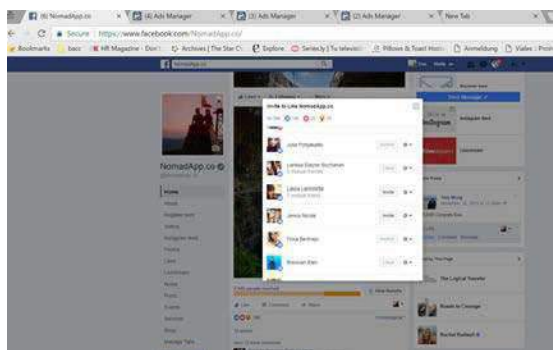


As for the text: we often use this formula: "Question or statement that sparks interest," "Value proposition," and "Call to Action."

2) Drive Engagement on Your Page with Boosted Posts

Why boosting posts to your own audience and their friends? Answer: They already know you. They're more likely to engage than cold audience.

On posts that already do well, click "boost post" and create an ad to reach more people. We often boost our posts to "people that already like your page and their friends" (we use a 1-2USD budget). Once the ad is over, go to the list of people who like it and invite all people that liked that post.



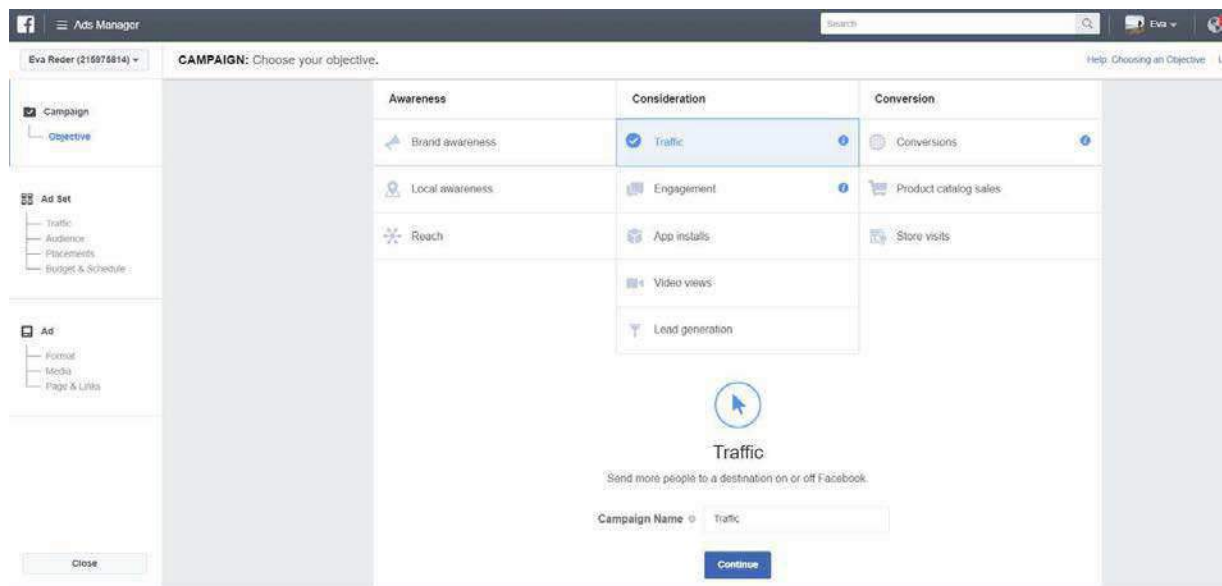
Scott Oldford's Strategy:



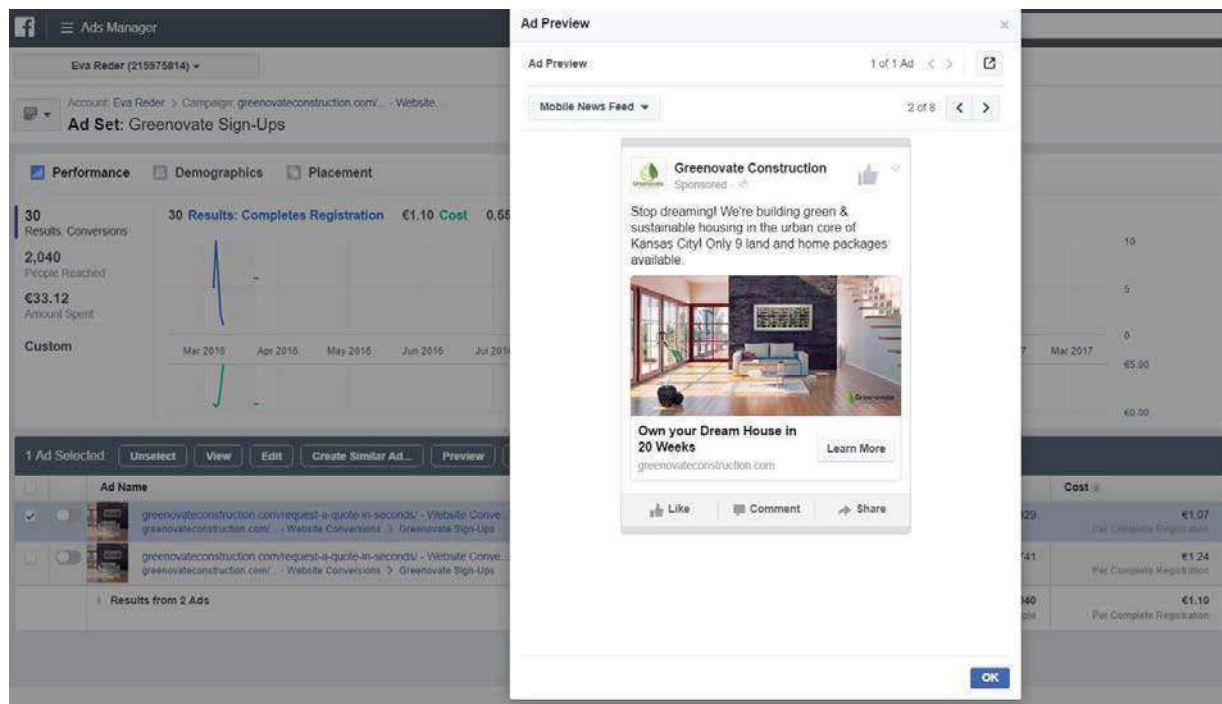
- 1) First day: boost the post to your own audience = “warm audience”
- 2) Second day: boost post to people who like your page and their friends = “warm audience”
- 3) Third day: boost post to people you choose through targeting = “cold audience”

Dark Posts: Drive Traffic to Your Website or Your App

A dark post is a post that doesn't show up as an actual post in your news feed but only as an ad in the news feed of people who you target.



It was through one of these ads that we sold a house for Greenovate Construction!



Back then we still didn't know how to optimize for the conversion pixel. Still we got people to go to the website and request a quote. With a total budget of \$300 in ad spend we got 300 website visitors, 4 leads and 1 sale. We sold a \$300,000 house with \$300 in Facebook ad spend.

How to set up a website traffic ad?

They are straight-forward: be prepared to pay more to direct 'cold leads' to your website than boosting posts to an existing community who already knows you and has liked your page. These are the exact settings of our best performing ad for Greenovate Construction:

Audience

SAVED AUDIENCE: Greenovate specific ▼

Location: United States: Kansas City (+40 km) Missouri

Age: 28 - 40

People Who Match: Interests: Smart Homes & Green Buildings, Environmentally friendly, Sustainable living, Smart Technologies or Sustainable energy, Behaviors: Green living, Relationship Status: In a relationship, Married or Engaged

And Must Also Match: Employers: DST Output, Sprint, H&R Block, Garmin or Cerner Corporation

Edit



Using dark posts for A/B testing

Dark posts are extremely useful to run A/B tests - even better than sending out surveys. For example, if you want to figure out whether people like headline 1 or headline 2 better for your new blog post: run two different Facebook ads with limited budget and see which one does better.

Another use case: test UI/UX mockup

Or: test cover photos for your new blog

Or: test different value propositions for your startup.

E.g.: "make money traveling the world" vs. "become a digital nomad and work from anywhere"

Or: test different target audiences.

E.g.: "Should I target empty nesters, or backpackers?"

Preparation: How to Find Your Target Audience

Many startups don't know who they are targeting. However, for building an engaged community and launching a successful startup, you should know exactly who your customer is. You can only tailor valuable content to them if you know what they are interested in.

What if you don't know who your target audience is? Use Facebook Dark posts.

Not sure if you're targeting honeymooners, students or backpackers?

Run different ads with a small budget and let the results speak for themselves. Which audience is the cheapest to acquire? What kind of content that resonates with them? Which value proposition give the best results?

Set up different ads for every question, spend between \$50 and \$500 depending on how many variables you're trying to test and see which audience is most engaged.

Create A/B test ads

- 1) Ad Category: Engagement or Traffic
- 2) Objective: Page likes or Website Traffic
- 3) Set up 5 different ad versions (different value propositions and targeting) with six images each
- 4) See which one does best

We used this strategy to test whether Greenovate Construction should advertise its ads as

- 1) Investment properties
- 2) Properties in great locations
- 3) Modern homes
- 4) Concrete houses
- 5) Green, energy-efficient homes

The budget for this experiment was low \$25USD. We tweaked the value proposition and audience a few times and figured out which one people prefer.

Ad Sets in this Campaign		+ Create Ad Set		Columns: Performance and Clicks										Breakdown	Export
	Ad Set	Delivery	Results	Reach	Freq.	Cost	Budget	Amount \$	Schedule	Clicks (A.)	CTR	CPA	CPC		
☒	Investment Properties Greenovate Jan. Tests	Completed	View Control	226	1.14	Per View C.	\$5.00	\$5.00 of \$5.00	Jan 7, 2017 - Jan 8, 2017 17 hours	6	2.33%	\$8.33	\$0.83		
☒	Great Location Greenovate Jan. Tests	Completed	View Control	242	1.21	Per View C.	\$5.00	\$5.00 of \$5.00	Jan 7, 2017 - Jan 8, 2017 21 hours	2	0.68%	\$2.50	\$0.50		
☒	Modern Homes Greenovate Jan. Tests	Completed	View Control	222	1.16	Per View C.	\$5.00	\$5.00 of \$5.00	Jan 7, 2017 - Jan 8, 2017 21 hours	3	1.17%	\$1.67	\$0.67		
☒	Concrete houses Greenovate Jan. Tests	Completed	View Control	269	1.31	Per View C.	\$5.00	\$5.00 of \$5.00	Jan 7, 2017 - Jan 8, 2017 21 hours	5	1.53%	\$1.00	\$0.50		
☒	Green Homes Greenovate Jan. Tests	Completed	View Control	219	1.23	Per View C.	\$5.00	\$4.99 of \$5.00	Jan 7, 2017 - Jan 8, 2017 23 hours	2	0.74%	\$2.50	\$0.50		
Results from 5 Ad Sets:				866	1.27	Per View C.		\$24.98	Total Spent	18	1.28%	\$1.39	\$0.59		



**THE FUTURE OF ADVERTISING IS
SOCIALLY INTEGRATED DIGITAL PLATFORMS**

Keep reading...

You're on the path to
growth hacking greatness!



Further Hacks

Get post likes for as cheap as 1 cent

How? Boost posts to “Cheap Countries”

There’s a list of countries that get cheap cost per click. You can get as many as 400 likes on your posts with only \$3 in ad spend. Now, before you rush to wrong conclusions let me tell you two things: 1) many of these accounts are set up by so called “click farms” and won’t engage 2) never do that with page likes as it will make it hard to remarket to that group of people later on. You don’t want any fake accounts in there.

However, if you want to blow up your numbers for social proof purposes go ahead and choose an audience targeting these countries:

Afghanistan, Albania, Algeria, Argentina, Bangladesh, Bosnia, Brazil, Bulgaria, Cameroon, Chile, Egypt, Ghana, India, Indonesia, Liberia, Macedonia, Malaysia, Mexico, Nepal, Nigeria, Pakistan, Philippines, Poland, Romania, Serbia, Slovakia, S. Africa, Thailand, Trinidad, Tunisia, Turkey, Uganda, UAE, Venezuela, Vietnam

The only use case where it’s okay to follow this strategy is to create a few initial likes on a new post. Go ahead and get 30 likes for 1 cent each. Then go back into the settings and change the targeting to your “real” target audience and the previous engagement will make it more likely new people will engage with the post, too.

Audience: **Eng Cheap countries - Alibaba Interest**

Create Ad Create Lookalike

Audience Details

View how this audience is defined

Audience Name: Eng Cheap countries - Alibaba Interest

Location: Bangladesh, Cameroon, Algeria, Egypt, Ghana, India, Kenya, Liberia, Malaysia, Nigeria, Philippines, Pakistan, Poland, Romania, Sierra Leone, Thailand, Turkey, Trinidad and Tobago, Tanzania, Uganda, South Africa, Zimbabwe

Age: 25 - 40

Language: English (UK) or English (US)

People Who Match: Interests: Business opportunity, Passive income, opening my own business, Make Money Fast, Social media marketing, Instagram or All Make Money Online

Edit

Audience History

View all the changes for this audience

Activity	Activity Details	Item Changed	Name	Date and Time
There isn't any activity available for the selected date range. Change the dates to view any activity in these audiences. It can take up to 15 minutes for your changes to show here.				

How to Get Emails from Facebook Groups

Credit: [Josh Fechter](#), Co-Founder of [BAMF.Media](#)

Grabbing emails from Facebook Group members has long been considered the holy grail of marketing.

Here's how you can do it:

Part 1: List the Facebook Groups you want to target

Use your buyer persona to find your customers on Facebook. Find out what groups they are in and list the relevant ones in a Google Sheet.

Go through the group members to find more ideal customers and repeat this process. Send out an invitation to join all of the closed Facebook Groups you come across and make a note in your Google Sheet.

Continue until you have about 40 or 50 Facebook Groups listed that you want to scrape. You can choose to outsource this work to a VA (virtual assistant) as it can get time consuming.

Part 2: Grouply

You now have your list of Facebook Groups - next step is to install Grouply.

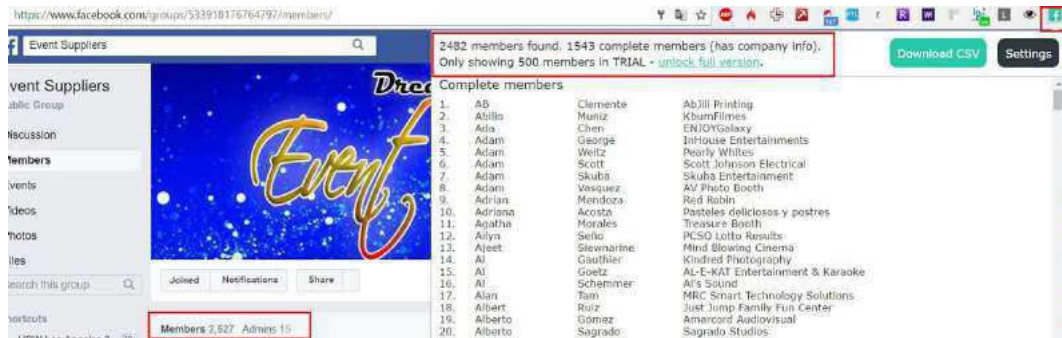
Grouply is a Google Chrome plugin which you can use to extract Facebook group members' first name, last name, company name and profile url into a .csv file. You can download the plugin in the Google Chrome store or on [their website](#). If installed correctly, a lime green Facebook logo will pop-up in your Chrome bar.

Before you continue with extracting data, set your Facebook language settings to English. Don't forget this step as the failure to do so will mess up your results.

If you are on the group page and you are all set to extract, navigate to the member page under `facebook.com/groups/*groupname*/members/` and set the filter on join date. Open the Grouply plugin in your Chrome bar and click on "Start Extracting".



Leave the software running and don't change tabs as you'll then lose your progress. Download the results in a .csv and you'll have a file [like this one](#). Rinse and repeat!



Part 3: Upload the CSV Into Email Hunter

Upload your Grouply CSV into Email Hunter using the Email Finder feature.

 Email Finder

Find the email addresses from a list of names and companies.

 Access

Hunter will return many of the email addresses associated with the contacts.

Facebook Targeting Hacks

Credit: [Dana Severson](#), Director of Marketing at Promoter.io

I've been running a small beef jerky subscription company for the past two years. For the most part, I've used it as a marketing sandbox to play with unique growth tactics.

A few weeks back, I decided to attempt an experiment to see if I could manufacture virality.

While it's still underway, I thought it would be helpful to share my steps and success thus far in case it's helpful for others:

I'm calling this experiment "vegan therapy." It's a reverse marketing campaign.

The idea was to promote the company to the wrong audience, which in my case that's vegans. The premise being that, "It's ok to cheat with meat," suggesting that there is this legion of vegans that secretly want to eat meat, but don't want to be caught doing so.

For the record, I do understand that it's an absurd notion.

I've been using the tagline, "Ashley Madison for Vegans" and built the creative for the ad around their "iconic" image. Replacing the shushing finger with a beef stick.

I didn't think that I'd "convert" vegans into meat eaters, but that wasn't the intention of the campaign. It was to ignite a flame within a passionate community and allow the debate to catch the attention of my true customer.

Here are the steps I've taken:

1. I tested this out with an inexpensive promoted ad on Reddit. Total cost was roughly \$8.00 and I ended up gaining 2 new subscribers (which wasn't even the objective). Here's a screenshot of the ad I ran <https://puu.sh/uV4YD/7da4518533.png>

I would have continued, but Reddit cut me off and would no longer allow me to target the r/vegan subreddit.

2. With the success of that experiment, I moved over to Facebook. I set a budget of \$20/day and targeted both vegan and vegetarian interests. I directed the ad to a content landing page that I built for vegans.

3. Once I had enough likes, negative comments and feedback, I reduced my spend to \$10/day and I began to reach out to media. Here's the actual ad:

<https://www.facebook.com/notdickinab.../posts/1808913495789563>

4. I compiled a list of 15 publications/journalists that I felt were most likely to write about a campaign like this. My two points of criteria were: 1. They had covered obscure trending topics in the past and 2. They liked to eat meat (had to roll the dice with a few of them).



5. I sent them an email (read: "tip") from a phantom account I already had. Positioned myself as their reader and someone who discovered something that was going to pop.

6. Changed the targeting of my FB ad, removed vegans as an interest and moved to "hunting" as an interest.

7. Created a second target of journalists (by job role) and people that work for specific media companies.

Results so far after spending \$158 in total:

Reddit:

263 clicks, 0 PR, 2 Conversions

Facebook:

518 clicks, 1 article, 4 Conversions

PR:

Out of the 15 journalists, one has converted into an article thus far.

<http://www.foodbeast.com/news/beef-jerky-ashley-madison/>

From an ROI perspective based on LTV I'm ahead, but my goal isn't for a few sales here and there, it's to manufacture nationwide buzz.

I'm not sure if it will work or not, but it sure has some people fired up:

<https://twitter.com/LuxAlptraum/status/846029216546263040>



How I Made \$200,000 from One Facebook Group Post Without Selling

Credit: [Josh Fechter](#), Co-Founder of [BAMF.Media](#)

Wish you could make \$200,000 from one Facebook Group post without ad spend?

I did.

To make it happen, I needed to create an engaged Facebook community.

I went through thousands of online communities to find an active one with the most cutting-edge startup material. I wanted to copy what existed to make it easier.

I discovered two things:

1. These communities syndicated material from the best content creators.
2. They posted content with the bare minimum benefit of grabbing a reader's attention.

In turn, even the best communities couldn't keep me engaged.

It's why people starve when searching for tactical startup content, especially case studies.

I decided to solve this problem.

For years, I had produced high-level marketing content about personal case studies. To have material, I ran hundreds of A/B tests every year. And so long as I kept testing, I'd have content to create.

Confident in my ability to engage people with content, I created a Facebook Group called San Diego Digital Marketing Experts.

Two months later, it failed. No new posts.

An abandoned wasteland.

For six months, I forgot about community building until I got another itch.



I tried again with a new Facebook Group, San Francisco Growth Marketers.

One month later, it failed.

"What the heck am I doing wrong?"

I went back to the books and outlined what it would take to make this a reality. I didn't like what I learned. I would need to find a way to produce content every day. And I would have to rely on an intangible skill: creativity.

Once again, the task looked daunting, but I decided to try one more time.

Now, I have an active community of over 15,000 marketers and founders.

Here's how I made it happen:

I had to choose a platform. I thought about using Slack, but nobody spends the majority of their time on Slack. Plus, I've never seen an active Slack channel other than one for work.

On the hand, people spend an [average of 50 minutes](#) every day on Facebook, and it's easy to connect to others. Many top marketers, including Dennis Yu, Mari Smith, and Ryan Deiss consider it the fastest platform to build your know, like, and trust factor.

In other words, it's the fastest platform to sell.

I also noticed how addicted people are to checking their Facebook notifications. If you consistently post engaging content, people develop an addiction to clicking on the notification you create. It works similar to an email inbox. To leverage this power, you need to know the content your audience wants.

I understood the potential, but most importantly, I had hope. I'd seen successful Facebook Groups. In fact, I led growth at a SaaS company, 22Social, which has several active Facebook Groups for their customers. They were masters at using this medium to sell.

Now, it was my time to step up from novice to expert do it for myself with a step-by-step plan:

Design Your Avatar

You can meet thousands of people through community building, but without purpose, you'll make nothing of it. Before I created a Facebook Group, I needed a strong understanding of the people I wanted in it.



I asked myself these nine questions:

1. What job title(s)?

Head of growth, venture capitalist, founder, or a high-level marketer.

2. What income level should they have?

They should make over six figures.

3. What industries should they be working in?

They work in a fast growing startup using advanced marketing software.

4. What habits and routines should they have?

They regularly eat healthily and exercise.

5. What social activities should they take part in?

They enjoy nature, walking, coffee, reading, writing, attending tech conferences, and hustling on weekends.

6. What type of friends should they have?

They should be friends with other founders and marketers.

7. What past accomplishments should they have?

Founded a successful company or have worked in a fast-growing startup.

8. What social platform should they be the most active on?

Facebook.

9. Where do they live?

San Francisco or another major tech city.

By understanding my target network, these are several of the thousands of people I've befriended over six months of community building:



1. Sean Sheppard: Founder of GrowthX and GrowthX Academy, venture capitalist, and top 20 sales influencer of 2016



2. Dennis Yu: Social media influencer, chief technology officer for BlitzMetrics, and writer for Adweek.



3. George Revutsky: Founder of ROIworks, a 16-year-old firm that provides both startups and larger brands growth, including Lyft and Soothe.



Once your networking avatar is locked down, it's time to figure out what value they enjoy consuming on Facebook (i.e. eBooks, podcasts, video).

After a quick Facebook search of the top marketers, I noticed they enjoy:

1. Long-form Facebook statuses
2. Long-form tactical guides
3. Videos which show cool tactics
4. Live stream talks from conferences

The hard part: Practicing over and over again to become great at producing this type of content.

There's no shortcut. It takes time.

My simple trick was to mimic the best. I studied copywriters who wrote long-form blog posts and Facebook posts, and live streamers like Vincent Dignan, owner of Traffic & Copy (Facebook Group of 20,000+ members).

Understand the Fundamentals

To run a great Facebook Group, you need to produce high-value rewards almost every day whether this is in the form of content, video, or another medium. If you don't have much time, find a content expert to keep you on track with your posting schedule.

Sometimes you won't know what content to create. The best way to solve this problem is to ask



the community about their pain points and what type of content they'd like to see.



To see how much effort I should put into a piece of content, I'll gauge my community's reaction to a hype message:



The one big mistake I see with Facebook Groups is they post the same content over and again. People get bored with rewards that don't change. Consistency is important, but a consumer's taste for content on social media will evolve as technology changes. One day you post a tactical guide about Instagram marketing, the next day you may have to shoot a live video.

Optimize Your Profiles

Your audience doesn't stay in your Facebook Group 24/7. What if they're heavy Instagram users or actively consume content on LinkedIn? If you know where your audience enjoys spending their time, then you should optimize your profiles on those platforms.

With a little research, I knew my community spent a significant amount of time consuming content in their Facebook News Feed and prospecting on LinkedIn. The reason is their job as a founder or marketer requires them to be active on those platforms to connect with others and run paid advertising campaigns.

In turn, I optimized my profiles on those social media platforms.

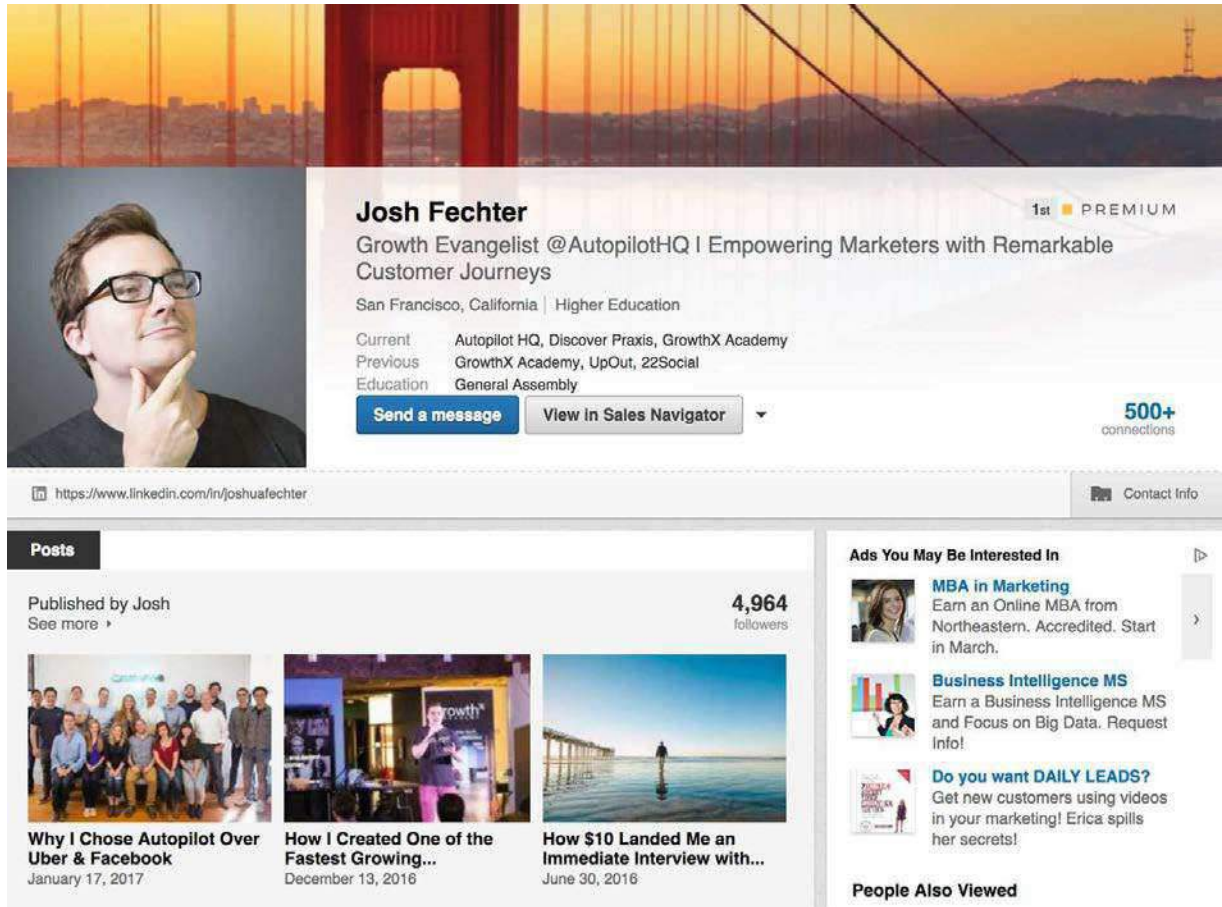
For example, if you're acting as a leader of a community, then you need to portray yourself as a leader through relevant content and an optimized profile to pull the right emotional triggers. You'll receive a higher response and conversion rate when reaching out to people to join your community or asking for a favor.

For starters, I took off any content contradicting my community's mission statement. No old photos of me partying in college. I used new content to design my profiles.

Here's my new LinkedIn profile:

1. Uploaded a picture of San Francisco in the background to develop rapport with people who live in the city
2. Connected with more relevant professionals to increase my follower count
3. Bought a LinkedIn Premium account to show exclusivity
4. Paid for a professional and memorable headshot
5. Published seven high-quality articles





Josh Fechter 1st PREMIUM

Growth Evangelist @AutopilotHQ | Empowering Marketers with Remarkable Customer Journeys

San Francisco, California | Higher Education

Current Autopilot HQ, Discover Praxis, GrowthX Academy
 Previous GrowthX Academy, UpOut, 22Social
 Education General Assembly

Send a message View In Sales Navigator

500+ connections

https://www.linkedin.com/in/joshuafechter

Contact Info

Posts

Published by Josh
See more ▶

4,964 followers

Why I Chose Autopilot Over Uber & Facebook
January 17, 2017

How I Created One of the Fastest Growing...
December 13, 2016

How \$10 Landed Me an Immediate Interview with...
June 30, 2016

Ads You May Be Interested In

MBA in Marketing
Earn an Online MBA from Northeastern. Accredited. Start in March.

Business Intelligence MS
Earn a Business Intelligence MS and Focus on Big Data. Request Info!

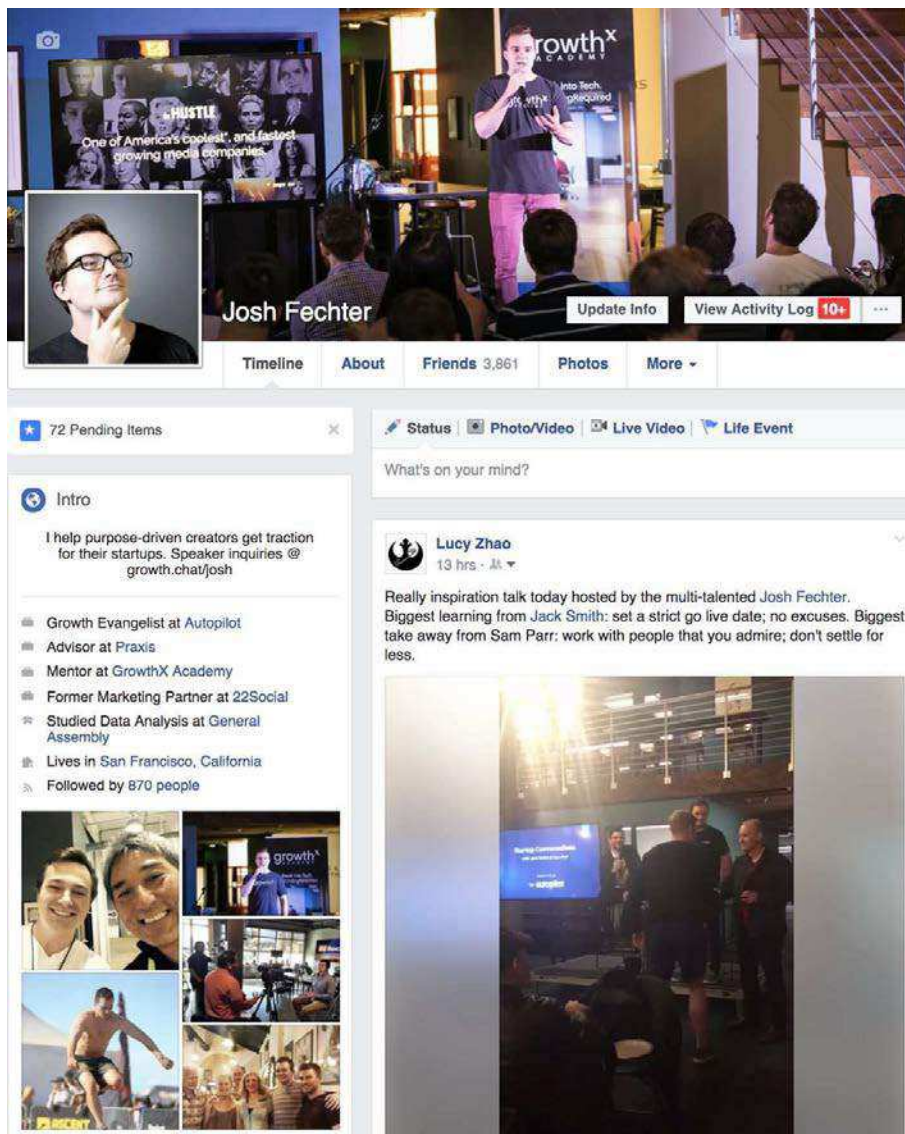
Do you want DAILY LEADS?
Get new customers using videos in your marketing! Erica spills her secrets!

People Also Viewed

Here's my new Facebook profile:

1. Posted shareable content to increase my follower count
2. Used a cover photo to exemplify my speaking skills
3. Used a professional and memorable headshot
4. Advertised myself as a helper in my profile's bio
5. Published high-value statuses 3X a week
6. Took many photos with influencers





Recruit Core Members:

Once you've optimized your social profiles, it's time to recruit your core members. They should fit this criterion:

1. They can produce high-value Facebook content relevant for your target network
2. They're already connected to, at least, one hundred individuals in your target network

Make these people moderators of your Facebook Group and encourage them to invite their network to join. With several moderators inviting their network to join, you should start your Facebook Group with three to four hundred members. And whatever you do, don't give up your



admin access. Period.

ADMINS



Josh Fechter
Growth Evangelist at Autopilot
Created group on April 7, 2016

⚙️

MODERATORS



Taylor Pipes
Content Marketing Specialist at Evernote
Joined
Added by Josh Fechter on January 12

⚙️



Brandon Lipman
Platform & Content at RRE Ventures
Joined
Added by Josh Fechter on June 29, 2016

⚙️



Kieran Goodacre
Growth at Maitreapp
Joined
Added by Charlie Price on September 10, 2016

⚙️



Aj Cartas
Social Media Manager at Bytedance
Joined
Added by Josh Fechter on July 28, 2016

⚙️



Dominick Malzone
Joined
Added by Josh Fechter on July 28, 2016

⚙️



Mehak Vohra
CEO at Jamocha Media
Joined
Added by Josh Fechter on August 29, 2016

⚙️



Juan Felipe Campos
Co-Founder / Partner at Greenovate Construction
Joined
Added by Josh Fechter on January 12

⚙️



Paul Foley
Founder & CEO at Optic
Joined
Added by Justina Nguyen on September 30, 2016

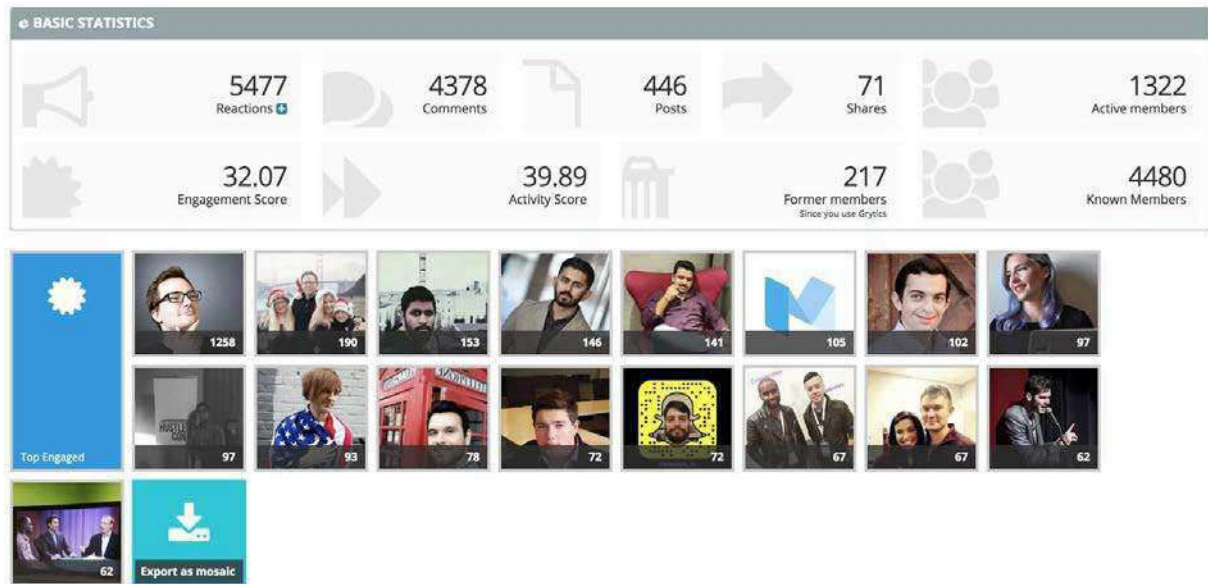
⚙️

Think of your community as an established organization – there’s usually a president, vice president, and a chief marketing officer. Assign your core members job titles and responsibility, and it will spark their motivation to help grow the community.

Using Software to Analyze Engagement

To gain an excellent understanding of your Facebook Group activity, use Facebook Group analytics or the software, [Grytics](#). The software gives you granular engagement metrics and an excellent understanding of your group’s demographics. The software also enables you to export members based on how active they are.

You can look at the overall summary of your group.



If you want to replicate top performing content, look at which individual posts performed exceptionally well. I noticed the best posts include giveaways and growth hacking tactics, so I doubled down on this content.

★ TOP POSTS	★ MOST REACTED POSTS	★ MOST COMMENTED POSTS																																																						
<table> <tr> <th>Score</th><th>Message</th><th>Date</th></tr> <tr> <td>300</td><td>This is how I stole over 860 of my competitors customers in 1 hour. Rinse. And...</td><td>2016-12-20 19:42:47</td></tr> <tr> <td>339</td><td>Here's something a little different... I have this Twitter guide that I used to...</td><td>2016-09-13 20:53:22</td></tr> <tr> <td>338</td><td>I have a BIG GIVEAWAY. There's this new software I'm testing called Pluck. It e...</td><td>2016-11-08 04:45:58</td></tr> <tr> <td>382</td><td>I'm giving away something HUGE. Four step-by-step guides that over fifteen hund...</td><td>2016-11-22 04:08:24</td></tr> <tr> <td>323</td><td>ARE YOU READY FOR THIS? I know there are many lurkers in this Facebook Group. L...</td><td>2016-12-13 20:11:44</td></tr> </table>	Score	Message	Date	300	This is how I stole over 860 of my competitors customers in 1 hour. Rinse. And...	2016-12-20 19:42:47	339	Here's something a little different... I have this Twitter guide that I used to...	2016-09-13 20:53:22	338	I have a BIG GIVEAWAY. There's this new software I'm testing called Pluck. It e...	2016-11-08 04:45:58	382	I'm giving away something HUGE. Four step-by-step guides that over fifteen hund...	2016-11-22 04:08:24	323	ARE YOU READY FOR THIS? I know there are many lurkers in this Facebook Group. L...	2016-12-13 20:11:44	<table> <tr> <th>Score</th><th>Message</th><th>Date</th></tr> <tr> <td>107</td><td>Hey guys! Welcome to this community. Here's the gist of it: This community is a...</td><td>2016-12-19 19:30:07</td></tr> <tr> <td>103</td><td>Here's my personal list of 70+ growth tools. I'm looking to add a few more. Ple...</td><td>2016-12-20 23:40:31</td></tr> <tr> <td>102</td><td>Here is your PHD in Facebook Ads. Complete guide to ad targeting... Found it sup...</td><td>2016-12-08 16:23:05</td></tr> <tr> <td>101</td><td>This past week, I turned \$437.66 into \$100,285.72 on Shopify using only Facebook...</td><td>2016-12-19 03:41:53</td></tr> <tr> <td>97</td><td>4,000 members!!! 🙌🙌🙌🙌 We did it :) Thank you everyone for participating in t...</td><td>2016-11-23 19:59:52</td></tr> </table>	Score	Message	Date	107	Hey guys! Welcome to this community. Here's the gist of it: This community is a...	2016-12-19 19:30:07	103	Here's my personal list of 70+ growth tools. I'm looking to add a few more. Ple...	2016-12-20 23:40:31	102	Here is your PHD in Facebook Ads. Complete guide to ad targeting... Found it sup...	2016-12-08 16:23:05	101	This past week, I turned \$437.66 into \$100,285.72 on Shopify using only Facebook...	2016-12-19 03:41:53	97	4,000 members!!! 🙌🙌🙌🙌 We did it :) Thank you everyone for participating in t...	2016-11-23 19:59:52	<table> <tr> <th>Score</th><th>Message</th><th>Date</th></tr> <tr> <td>199</td><td>Here's something a little different... I have this Twitter guide that I used to...</td><td>2016-09-13 20:53:22</td></tr> <tr> <td>147</td><td>I have a BIG GIVEAWAY. There's this new software I'm testing called Pluck. It e...</td><td>2016-11-08 04:45:58</td></tr> <tr> <td>131</td><td>This is how I stole over 860 of my competitors customers in 1 hour. Rinse. And...</td><td>2016-12-20 19:42:47</td></tr> <tr> <td>113</td><td>I'm giving away something HUGE. Four step-by-step guides that over fifteen hund...</td><td>2016-11-22 04:08:24</td></tr> <tr> <td>101</td><td>ARE YOU READY FOR THIS? I know there are many lurkers in this Facebook Group. L...</td><td>2016-12-13 20:11:44</td></tr> </table>	Score	Message	Date	199	Here's something a little different... I have this Twitter guide that I used to...	2016-09-13 20:53:22	147	I have a BIG GIVEAWAY. There's this new software I'm testing called Pluck. It e...	2016-11-08 04:45:58	131	This is how I stole over 860 of my competitors customers in 1 hour. Rinse. And...	2016-12-20 19:42:47	113	I'm giving away something HUGE. Four step-by-step guides that over fifteen hund...	2016-11-22 04:08:24	101	ARE YOU READY FOR THIS? I know there are many lurkers in this Facebook Group. L...	2016-12-13 20:11:44
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Grow Your Facebook Group with Targeted Members

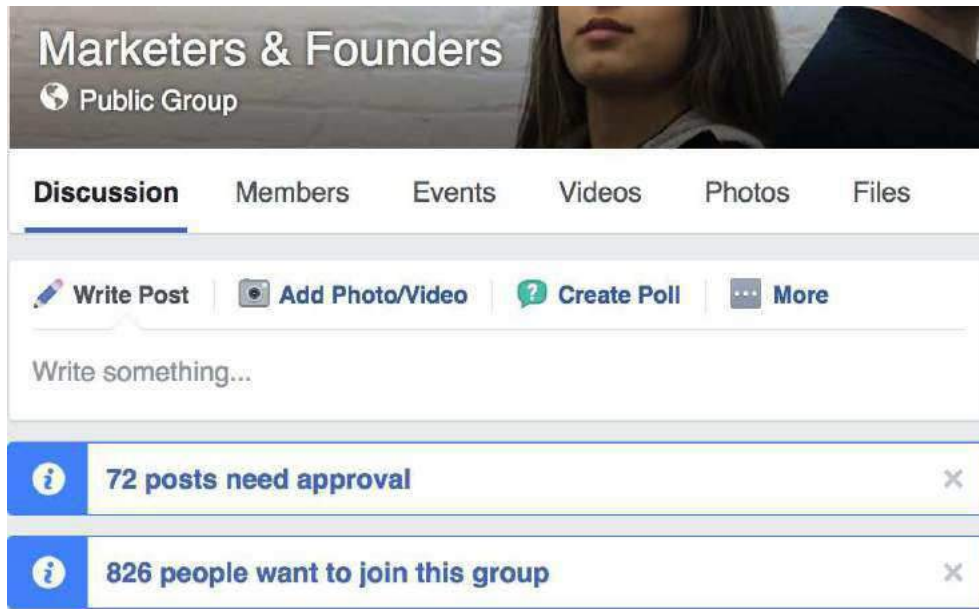
There are many ways to grow your Facebook Group:

1. Giveaways
2. Backlinks in guest posts
3. Backlinks in Quora posts
4. Inviting your existing network



5. Backlinks in your LinkedIn profile
6. Backlinks in your email signature

These tactics work, but they don't always attract the most relevant people. Plus, I don't have time to filter through every incoming request. As of writing this, I have a backlog of over eight hundred people I need to go through. Not fun.



I needed people who were in my exact market. The only way to do this was either have a friend with my exact audience backlink to my Facebook Group in one of their email blasts, or I would have to scrape people and cold email them.

I opt'ed to scrape people because of scalability. If I scraped people, I could send emails to hundreds of thousands of targeted people.

Step 1: Purchase three Mailshake or Mixmax accounts for sending bulk personalized emails.

Step 2: Sign-up for a Findthatlead account, then make a list of search queries and top cities where your members reside.

Step 3: Sign-up for a [Google Apps](#) account and create six different email addresses tied to one or two domains.

What type of cold emails do you send?

Here's my exact copy:



Hey {{First name}}

One of our Los Angeles members referred you to our Marketers & Founders Facebook Group (we have about 300 members in Los Angeles).

I happen to run one of the largest marketing communities in Silicon Valley (1800+ members) and the Facebook Group (4100+ members).

The Marketers & Founders Facebook Group is moderated by a few of the best, so it's invite only.

Our moderators:

1. Will Bunker, founder of Match.com and GrowthX, a 50-mil VC firm
2. Kumar Thangudu, founded three SaaS companies, and a top writer on Quora
3. Me :) Past head of growth for 22Social, UpOut, and now, GrowthX

You can join the Marketers and Founders Facebook Group here:

<https://www.facebook.com/groups/growthmarketers/>

If you want to know more info, feel free to reply.

Cheers

Josh Fechter

Growth Evangelist @Autopilot | Adviser @Praxis"

If they don't open the first email, I have my CRM automatically send a follow-up email two days later that's the same except for this line at the beginning:

"Hey [first name]

Wanted to ensure you saw this email from the other day.

..."

This works well because the chances are they forgot the original value proposition or never saw it.

Here are the responses I received from this cold email:

"Thanks for reaching out! Glad to see you've been building this great community of growth marketers. I just requested to join your FB group and look forward to connecting. If there's anything I could do to help out in any way, please let me know."



"Hi Josh !

Thank you for your email, i joined the FB group ;)"

"Hi Joshua,

Thanks for the invitation!

Looks like an interesting group. I just sent a request to join it.

Looking forward to participating in the community."

That's not to say a few people didn't respond negatively to me. Out of every one hundred people I cold emailed, I got one complaint. The solution: don't email them again ;)

Get People to Say "Yes"

The more people who get used to following instructions from you, the more likely they'll engage with a new call to action (e.x. buying a product).

It starts with the first comment.

Once someone invests in commenting on a Facebook post, they're more likely comment again. To ease the process consider sending them a direct message of encouragement when they become a member.

The easiest way to get people to begin commenting is to promise them an exchange of value whether an extended free trial to a high-demand software or an in-depth guide about a particular tactic. Notice in the screenshot of [this post below](#), I had over 142 members comment to request the free trial.



Josh Fechter 😊 feeling thankful.

October 4, 2016

I have a BIG [GIVEAWAY](#).

There's this new software I'm testing called Pluck. It enables you to find Tweets based on different parameters easily.

Then, it grabs the person's email with a high deliverability rate. As you know most Twitter emails suck. This software fixes that problem.... [See More](#)



Kushaan Shah, Jorge L Soto and 42 others

142 Comments



Like



Comment



Share

The next step is to get people to open up on a more personal level about what they do. To facilitate this, you need to take the first step in opening up to give others the courage to step out of their comfort zone, too.

What does this mean?

You need to write about your personal experiences and tie them into your audience's profession. Here's an [example post](#):



Josh Fechter

February 2 at 8:29am

How to hack your career [10X](#) faster:

A little under a year ago, I arrived in San Francisco with zero network. I started from scratch.

I had skills in PPC, SEO, webinars, web development, and building sales funnels. ...

[Continue Reading](#)



195

29 Comments 2 Shares



Like



Comment



Share

If you don't lead the conversation in your Facebook Group, then no one will.



The next step is to leverage comments. When someone comments on a Facebook post, then reply with a question to get them to expand on their point. The more comments they post, the more invested they'll feel in the group and to you.

How to Produce High-Value Content

Before we go further, know most groups don't die from lack of content. They die because the founders can't produce good content. That's the hardest piece. It's waking up and knowing you'll have to write a 23-page guide like this once or twice a week or your group will die. No one said it was easy.

If you want to learn how to become a great Facebook copywriter, there are two ways to do it:

1. Answer questions on Quora
2. Read a few copywriting books ([here's an excellent list](#))

Answering questions on Quora related to your target audience is the best way to discover content to re-post on Facebook. For example, I answered this question about intelligence which received over 200,000 views.

How do I tell if somebody is intelligent?



Josh Fechter, Growth Evangelist @AutopilotHQ | Advisor @Praxis | Mentor
Updated Jan 9 · Upvoted by Kushaan Shah, Samit Patel, and 13 others you follow

They ask you questions. When you answer, they ask you more. When you start using big words, they ask for clarification. When they can't understand anything you're saying, they ask for you to explain i... [\(more\)](#)

Upvotes 15.8k

Comments 72+





Take a look at the engagement when I re-posted my answer on my Facebook profile:



Josh Fechter

January 12 · 🌐 ▼

How to identify smart people:

They ask you questions.

When you answer, they ask you more.... [See More](#)



Matthew Clementson, Vin Clancy and 330 others

38 Comments 65 Shares



Like



Comment



Share



Embed

The next step is to leverage an influencer's original content. To do this, you need to interview influencers live in the Facebook Group. I wrote an [in-depth guide here](#) about how to do this (includes email templates).

I find influencers in my industry by reading blog posts detailing who the best are. Then, I use [Hunter.io](#) and [Clearbit](#) to find their emails for outreach.

I aim for two interviews a week in my Facebook Group because my other option is to write an in-depth guide like this one which can take around five more work hours.





Josh Fechter was live.

February 8 at 6:15pm

Ask your questions live!

Here with [Dornubari Pope Vizor](#), founder of [LeadQuizzes](#), about to drop some knowledge bombs.

He's been a member of Marketers & Founders since the beginning!



👍❤️😱 Wes Ward, Paul Carleton and 29 others

2 Comments 868 Views

👍 Like 💬 Comment ➦ Share

When it comes to other people posting content, you need to reinforce the selling point of exclusivity.

How do you do this?

Only let original content get posted in your group. This makes the group feel like a secret hub of like-minded individuals. Here's how I did this:

- I only let links from Google Drive or a little-known tool get posted besides native content.
- I stopped giveaways in exchange for inviting members after I reached 1,000 people.
- I remove all content that doesn't perform well (likes, comments, shares) even my own.
- I don't allow members to publish posts without me looking at it beforehand.
- I don't allow members to automatically add members. I must approve them.



Prime Your Group Members

I can hear you thinking: *Where's the part where I learn how to make money?*

We're close. It takes a little more work.

Whenever you have a new member join your Facebook Group, it's important you add them as a Facebook friend and LinkedIn connection. To be clear, it must be right after they join. This is when their acceptance rate is the highest because they want more information about you and your community.

Why do this?

1. As a Facebook friend, you can now send direct messages to them, and they'll see content posted to your personal profile.
2. As a LinkedIn connection, you can now export their personal email and reach them with LinkedIn's publishing platform.

The more high-value touch points you have with group members, the more likely they'll convert into paying customers. If I know I'll be doing a big push for trials and sales, then I'll give myself two or three weeks to send automated personalized messages at scale and use video remarketing for nurturing.

To send these messages at scale to the people in your Facebook Group, use Mass Planner (must get a current customer referral) or outsource a Chrome extension for several hundred dollars like I did. Keep in mind; mostly people you're Facebook friends will see this message unless the other recipients check their "other" inbox.

The message:

"Hey [name]

I wanted to catch up! I was wondering what you thought about my Facebook Group, Marketers & Founders. I'm looking for ways to improve it."

This does two things:

1. Shows you respect their opinion and build rapport.
2. Drives them back to Facebook Group to look over the posts.

Here are the steps to implementing Facebook automated messaging in Mass Planner:



Step 1: Connect your Facebook account to Mass Planner and dive into the Contact section.

1. Plug-in the Facebook Group URL
2. Set the scroll rate between 9,000 - 22,000 seconds to ensure you extract all the members
3. Click **Extract Members**

Finder Joiner UnJoiner Notifications Off Account Actions Accept Invite **Contact** Backup Bump Comment&Like

Unfriend

Facebook Facebook Account (Josh) BROWSE EMBEDDED Account tags: Followers: 3837 Followings:

Extract Members Auto Extract Use Members Friend Requests Send Messages

EXTRACT MEMBERS

* you can add Facebook group URLs (to extract members) or Facebook profile URLs (to extract friends)

Extract users from 'Find Friends' with Highschool

Extract users from 'Find Friends' with College

Extract users from 'Find Friends' with Current City

Scroll the search page for seconds.

☐ Skip Non English names

DATE	LINK			STATUS	#EXTRACTED
1/16/2017 6:38:16 PM	https://www.facebook.com/groups/leadpages/members	COPY	REMOVE	done	8939
1/16/2017 1:43:04 PM	https://www.facebook.com/groups/leadpages/members	COPY	REMOVE	done	8301

You'll have to wait between five minutes and a half hour depending on your scroll rate before all the members get extracted.

Step 2: Click the **Use Members** tab to input your message. Use several different syntax variations. Feel free to copy the settings below.

Finder Joiner UnJoiner Notifications Off Account Actions Accept Invite **Contact** Backup Bump

Facebook Facebook Account (Josh) BROWSE EMBEDDED Account tags: Followers: 3837 Followings:

Extract Members Auto Extract **Use Members** Friend Requests Send Messages

SELECT ALL **SELECT NONE** **SPLIT BETWEEN SAME TAG ACCOUNTS** **SPLIT AND SEND TO FRIEND REQUEST** **SPLIT AND SEND MESSAGE**

A. SEND FRIEND REQUEST
 The selected members will be sent to the "Friend Requests" tab. Friends will be ignored.

☒ Remove selected members from the list after clicking SEND

☒ Ignore members who already received an invite

☒ Ignore Pending or Finalized requests from other accounts in Massplanner (unique friend requests over multiple accounts)

SEND

B. SEND MESSAGES
 The selected members will be sent to the "Send Message" tab.

Message Text (multi-level spin syntax is allowed)

Hey [FIRSTNAME]

I wanted to catch up! I was wondering what you thought about my Facebook Group, Marketers & Founders. I'm looking for ways to improve it.

TEST SPIN AND TOKENS

[FULLNAME] [FIRSTNAME] [LASTNAME] [GROUPNAME]

The text can contain the following tokens: [FULLNAME], [FIRSTNAME], [LASTNAME]. They are replaced with members info.

☐ Send second message

☒ Remove selected members from the list after clicking SEND

☐ Ignore my friends

☒ Ignore members who already received a message

☐ Automatically send messages to new members

SEND

Step 3. Next, click **Send**. This won't send the message to all of the Facebook members at once since Facebook would flag that action. It will send them to **Send Messages** tab.

Step 4: Go to the Send Messages tab. Copy the settings below. Next, click **Start Sending Messages**.

Finder Joiner UnJoiner Notifications Off Account Actions Accept Invite **Contact** Backup Bump Comment&Like Cover Photo Birthday Unfriend

Facebook Facebook Account (Josh) BROWSE EMBEDDED Account tags: Followers: 3837 Followings:

Extract Members Auto Extract Use Members Friend Requests **Send Messages**

STATUS **stopped** **START SENDING MESSAGES**

SETTINGS

Wait between 10 and 11 minutes before each new operation.

Send between 2 and 4 messages for each operation.

Message a maximum of 65 - 70 per day. (0 = no limit) Increase each day with 0 until it reaches 0 max Message per day.

☐ Pick a random member instead of the first one from the list below

☐ Delete pending messages older than X days

☐ Remove the link from the post after Facebook displays the preview

☐ Stop sending messages after captcha

Execute between 12:00 AM and 11:59 PM

Days of the week when to operate

☒ Sunday ☒ Monday ☒ Tuesday ☒ Wednesday ☒ Thursday ☒ Friday ☒ Saturday ☐ Rotate days

Note: If you have around six versions of the message, then bump up the daily number of sent messages from 20 to 80.



You've opened up conversations with over one thousand people in the span of two weeks. It will take a significant amount of effort to reply to everyone. However, the two weeks of pain is worth the \$200,000 in sales. Trust me.

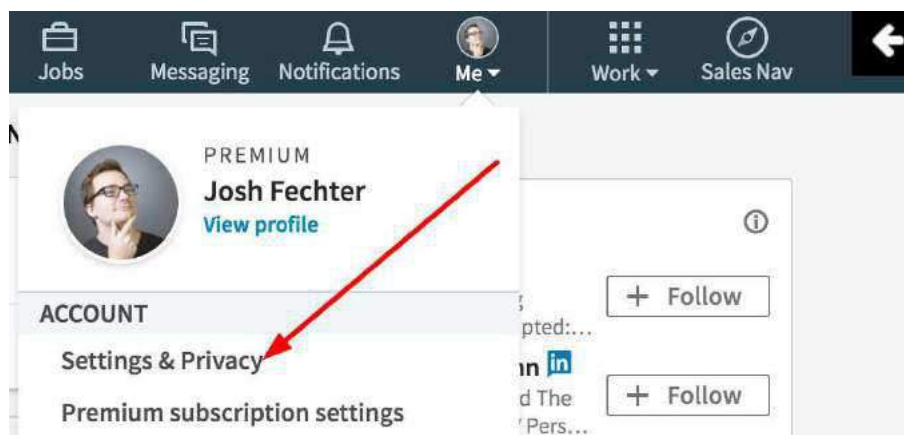
What about LinkedIn?

If you added every group member on LinkedIn, then you should have a huge list of their emails to export. An easy way to connect to people's LinkedIn profiles (if you haven't done it yet) is to ask. In the example below, I have two hundred people I can connect with which takes around twenty minutes.

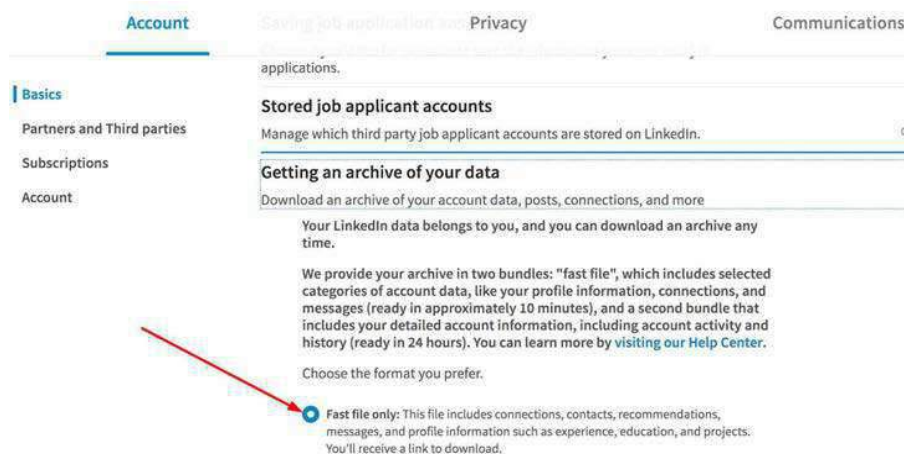


The image shows a Facebook post from Josh Fechter, dated February 13 at 8:29am. The post text reads: "Interested in connecting on LinkedIn to the remarkable entrepreneurs in this Facebook Group? Drop your profile link in the comments: Feel free to use this LinkedIn auto endorse tool: <https://chrome.google.com/.../bipppgfgajlincblmjanphpcogom...>". Below the post is a screenshot of Josh Fechter's LinkedIn profile. The profile includes his name, title "Growth Evangelist @AutopilotHQ | Empowering Marketers with Remarkable Customer Journeys", location "San Francisco, California", and education "Higher Education". It also lists current and previous companies: "Autopilot HQ, Discover Praxis, GrowthX Academy" and "GrowthX Academy, UpOut, 22Social". A red arrow points to the "View profile as" button on the LinkedIn profile. Below the profile, there are interaction buttons for "Like", "Comment", and "Share", and a list of people who liked the post: "Neil MillsHill, Matt Weilbacher and 49 others". At the bottom, it says "View previous comments" and "2 of 210".

To export the emails of your connections, click Settings & Privacy.



Then click on Getting an archive of your data..



When you have your connections' email addresses, then import them into Facebook as a custom audience. **It's time to create a personal video ad to remarket them** ([video ad directions](#)) with a story related to what you're selling.

- The video should be inspirational, entertaining, or informative
- Why video? It's the least expensive way to put content in front of people

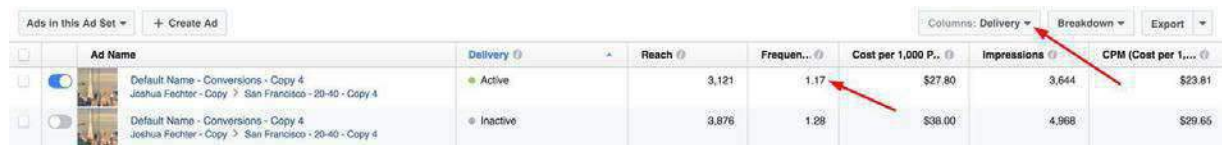
I average 1 - 3 cents per a view when showing a video to a warm audience.

Here's an example of one of my videos:

<https://www.facebook.com/joshuafechter123/videos/731338446990948/>



Let this ad run up a frequency of 3.5. This means on average each person on your uploaded email list saw the ad 3.5 times. You can find this number by clicking on your Ad Set and setting your column title to Delivery.



	Ad Name	Delivery	Reach	Frequency	Cost per 1,000 P.	Impressions	CPM (Cost per 1,000)
☒	Default Name - Conversions - Copy 4 Joshua Fechter - Copy > San Francisco - 20-40 - Copy 4	Active	3,121	1.17	\$27.80	3,644	\$23.81
☐	Default Name - Conversions - Copy 4 Joshua Fechter - Copy > San Francisco - 20-40 - Copy 4	Inactive	3,876	1.28	\$38.00	4,968	\$29.65

Now, when your audience has their peak emotional tie to you, don't sell to them.

You read that correctly. Don't sell.

Offer value in exchange for an action.

This is key.

Your job is to align the perfect audience with the perfect product, then drop a VALUE BOMB like this one ([original post](#)):



Josh Fechter

January 16 at 10:58am

Wish you had my brain?

Now, you can have it sitting in your Google Drive.

I just established a HUGE partnership with Autopilot, a visual marketing software for automating the customer journey. In turn, I'm giving away 99.9% of my growth hacks to those who

1. Already are a customer.
2. Test out the [free trial](#) and send me one piece of well-thought-out feedback.

Over 50 guides added to your Google Drive.

You will have the super powers I used to build one of the largest marketing communities in Silicon Valley since arriving eleven months ago.

You'll know how to hack Facebook, Instagram, Twitter, LinkedIn, Quora, and more.

Plus, I'll regularly add more guides throughout the year.

I'm not joking. This is 99.9% of ALL MY GROWTH HACKS.

I thought about turning half of this material into a \$2000 course, but then I realized I'm not a huge fan of selling information products.

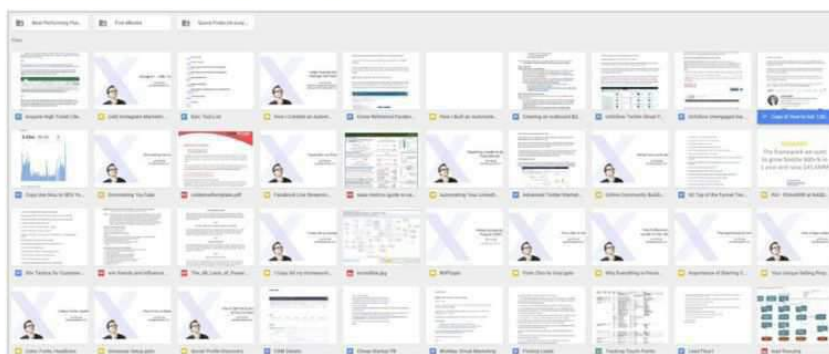
I enjoy building real companies 😊

Specific steps to get the guides:

1. If you're a customer, then email me at josh@autopilothq.com with your request. I'll then send you the link to the guides.
2. If you're not a customer, then sign up for a [free trial](#) and forward a screenshot of a feature with feedback to josh@autopilothq.com. I'll then send you the link to the guides.

It's that easy.

Free trial: <https://autopilothq.com/>



👍❤️🤔 Mike Mcallen, Alex Southern and 187 others

61 Comments

👍 Like

💬 Comment

➦ Share



This is what I posted in my Facebook Group the day before I started working at Autopilot. I received over three hundred responses of people trying out the product with pictures of features and feedback on their onboarding experience.

Because Autopilot has a subscription model priced on the number of email contacts, I asked for the average CLV then multiplied that number by the average order size of the people who purchased.

\$200,000 in sales :)

Expenditures:

Email Hunter: \$1,200

Three CRM accounts: \$200

Google Apps: \$45

Virtual assistant to do scraping: \$500

Total expenditure: \$1,940

ROI: 100X

If I can grow and engage a Facebook Group while working full time, then you can do this, too.

If you're looking to launch a product without spending too much money, then Facebook Groups make the perfect fit. It's not easy, but the community you create makes it all worth it. And there's no better competitive advantage than a rabid fan base following your every post.



10 Ways to Use Custom Audiences to Dominate Facebook Marketing

Credit: [Josh Fechter](#), Co-Founder of [BAMF.Media](#)

Do you use Facebook Custom Audiences?

One of the biggest mistakes Facebook marketers make is not using the many types of Facebook audiences to zero in on their targeting. Many Facebook marketers sync their entire email list to Facebook, then never create a more granular custom audience. Big mistake.

If you're new to implementing custom audiences, then check out AdEspresso's guide to getting [started with them](#). When you're ready for lift off, it's time to get hyper-targeted with the remarkable possibilities of Facebook Custom Audiences.

Here are ten of them:

1. Create a Lookalike of Your Customers with the Highest CLV

Customer lifetime value (CLV) gives you the data to understand how much money you should spend on acquiring customers, how to offer products and services tailored to your best customers, and how much you should invest to retain a customer.

Do you have a list of your customers with the highest lifetime value? If not, here's the foundation for calculating lifetime value:

(Average Value of a Sale) X (Number of Repeat Transactions) X (Average Retention Time in Months or Years for a Typical Customer) farne un grafico

For example, the value of an Autopilot customer who spends \$40 every month for three years would be: $\$40 \times 12 \times 3 = \$1,440$ (or \$480/year)

The first step to creating this custom audience is to apply the Pareto Principle, 20% of the customers create 80% of the revenue. In turn, take your top 20% of customers with the highest CLV and upload their emails into Facebook to create a new custom audience. Now, create a Lookalike Audience from this custom audience.

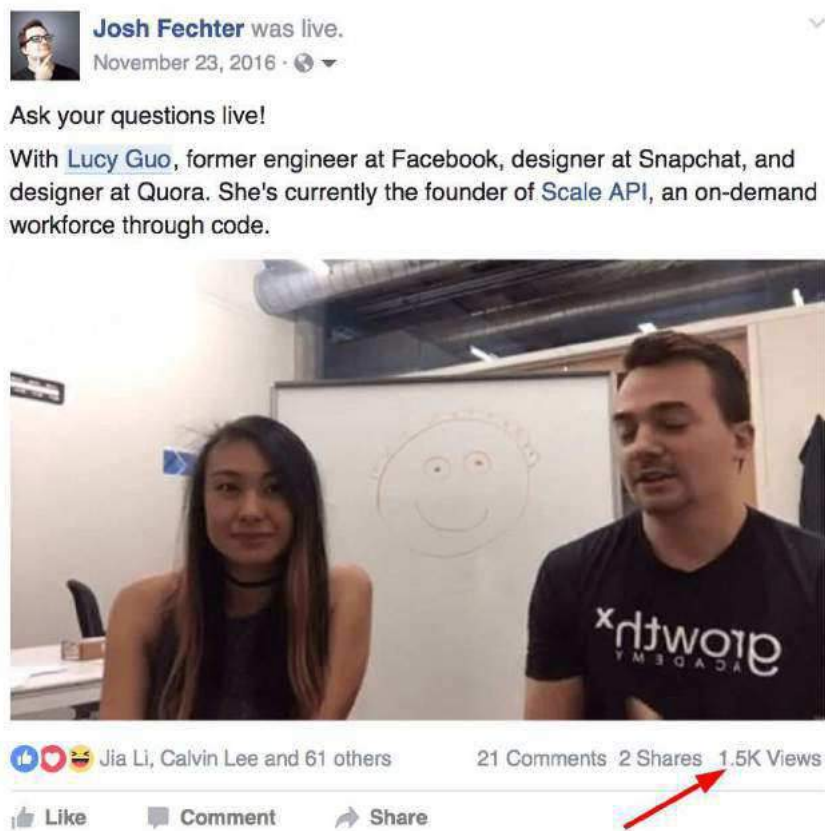


This Lookalike Audience should convert far better than taking the easy route by uploading all your customers emails to create it.

After all, who doesn't want more of their best customers?

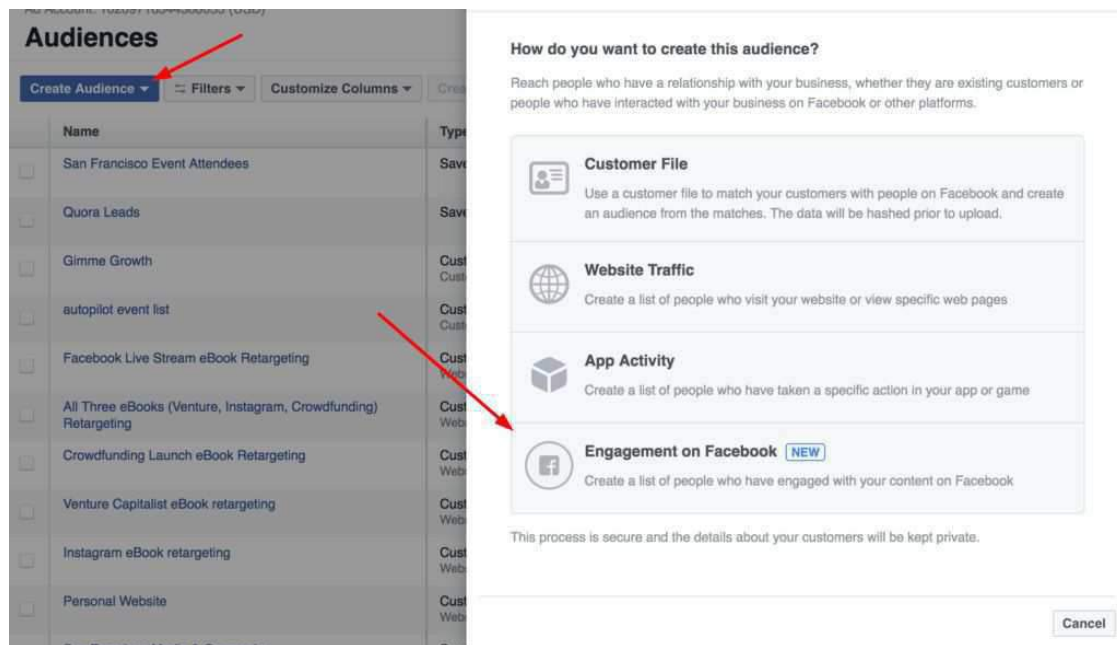
2. Facebook Live Video

Did you know you can create a retargeting audience from people who view your Facebook live video? As someone who makes several live videos a week, I couldn't wait to take advantage of this feature. I don't have a *huge email list*, but Facebook live video gives me a *huge remarketing audience* because people love my videos.

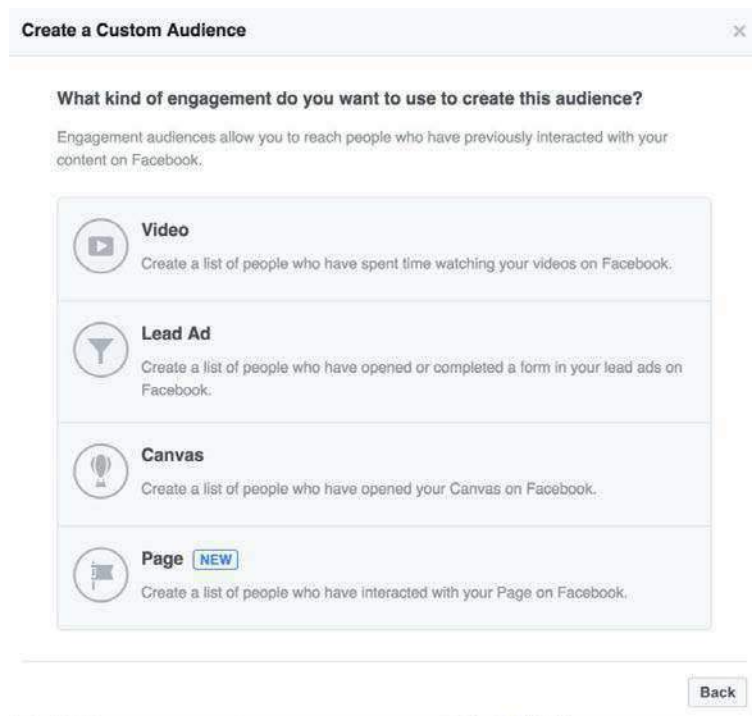


Here's how you do it:

Go into your Ads Manager, then click on the section, Audiences. Next, click on Custom Audience, then select Engagement on Facebook.



Now, select Video.



You'll have an option to select people to target based on how many seconds or percentage of

the video they watched. From here, you'll have a list of videos to choose.

Create a Custom Audience [X]

Engagement ⓘ Choose a content type [Browse](#)

In the past ⓘ

Audience Name

- People who viewed at least 3 seconds of your video
- People who viewed at least 10 seconds of your video
- People who have watched at 25% of your video
- People who have watched at 50% of your video
- People who have watched at 75% of your video
- People who have watched at 95% of your video

[Back](#) [Create Audience](#)

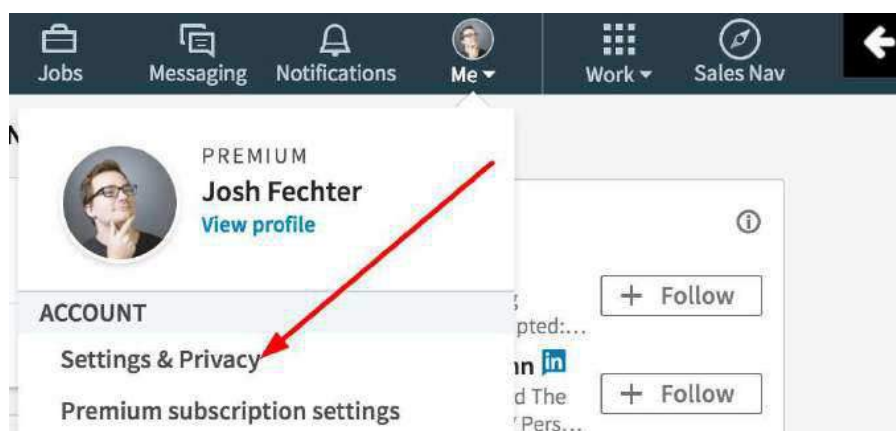
In only a minute, you're targeting people who've engaged with your live content. Talk about a low-hanging fruit.

3. Target Your LinkedIn Connections

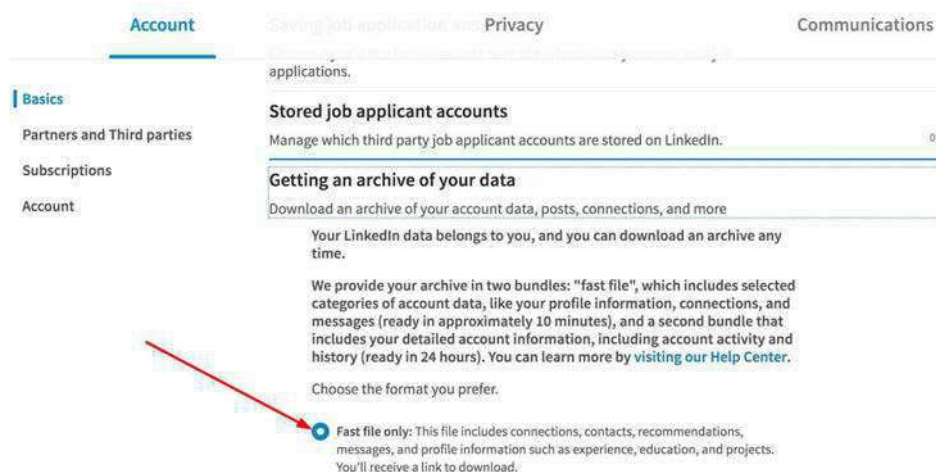
Have a big social media presence, but a small email list? You're in luck.

You can export your LinkedIn connections email addresses and import them into Facebook as a custom audience. Go to your LinkedIn homepage, then click on My Network and select Connections.

To export the emails of your connections, click Settings & Privacy.



Then click on Getting an archive of your data..



Use this tactic if you're active on LinkedIn - engaging with others, publishing status updates, and posts - and have connections comprised of prospects. This tactic will help lower your CPA only if your LinkedIn connections already have several touch points with you whether in-person or online (e.g. seeing you statuses). Their emotional rapport will make them more likely to convert into leads and customers.

4. Warm-Up Outbound Email

If you're sending cold emails with low response rates, then try warming them up first with a custom audience of their emails. I suggest optimizing your ads for impressions and using ads with humor and a sense of awe to develop a more friend-level emotional rapport with them.

Don't be surprised if you see a significant increase in reply rates. You can even get crafty with



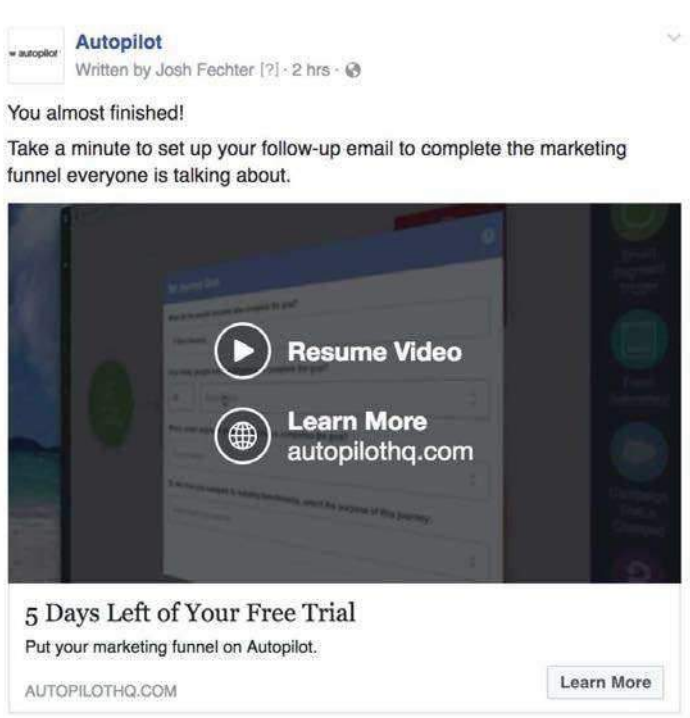
your personalized messaging including a call-to-action to reply to your emails.

5. Target Prospects who Withdrew from Your Onboarding Process

A prospect withdraws from your onboarding process. They made it through the first several steps of investing their time in required tutorials, but then stopped halfway through.

It's time to trigger a Facebook ad. Tools including [Driftrrock](#) and [Autopilot](#) can help you do this using automation. Two types of ads you can target at them include a video containing the last tutorial they left off on or a video hyping up their next onboarding step.

Here's an example:



6. Create Custom Audiences Based on Locality

Did you know using hyper-local copy when targeting hyper-local prospects can double your opt-in rates? It's that effective.

Most people have a strong affinity for the city they live, so if you reference their city in ad, landing

page, or offer page, you'll often see a noticeable upright swing in conversions.

If you can find the top cities where your customers reside, then you can create custom audiences specific to the cities. This hyper-local ad I created targeted at hyper-local prospects went viral and was featured in [Inc. Magazine](#) because of its high engagement levels. Don't underestimate the influence of mentioning someone's city in your copy.



7. Target Customers Who Refer the Most People

How many customers do you have who act as evangelists by referring others? If you use referral links or forms to identify your top referring customers, then you have a resulting list made of gold.

How do you entertain and stay relevant to these customers with Facebook ads?

Here are several ways:

1. Use a Facebook ad focused on engagement to remind them how much you cherish their relationships.
2. Use a Facebook ad showing the epic story how of your company came to be.

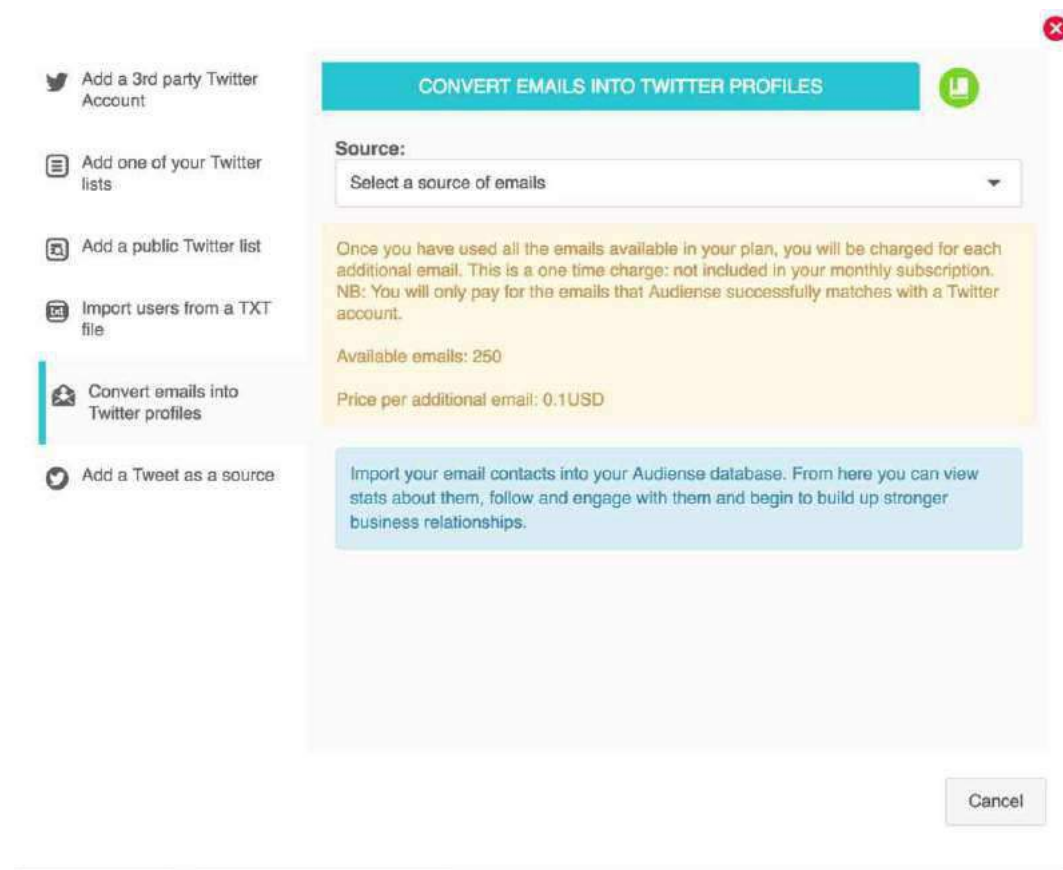


3. Use a Facebook ad focused on highlighting your company's culture.

8. Target Your Leads and Customers with the Most Twitter Followers

Wish you could target customers with personalized messaging based on their Twitter profile bio keywords and the number of followers?

With [Audiense](#), you can by uploading your customer email list to their platform.

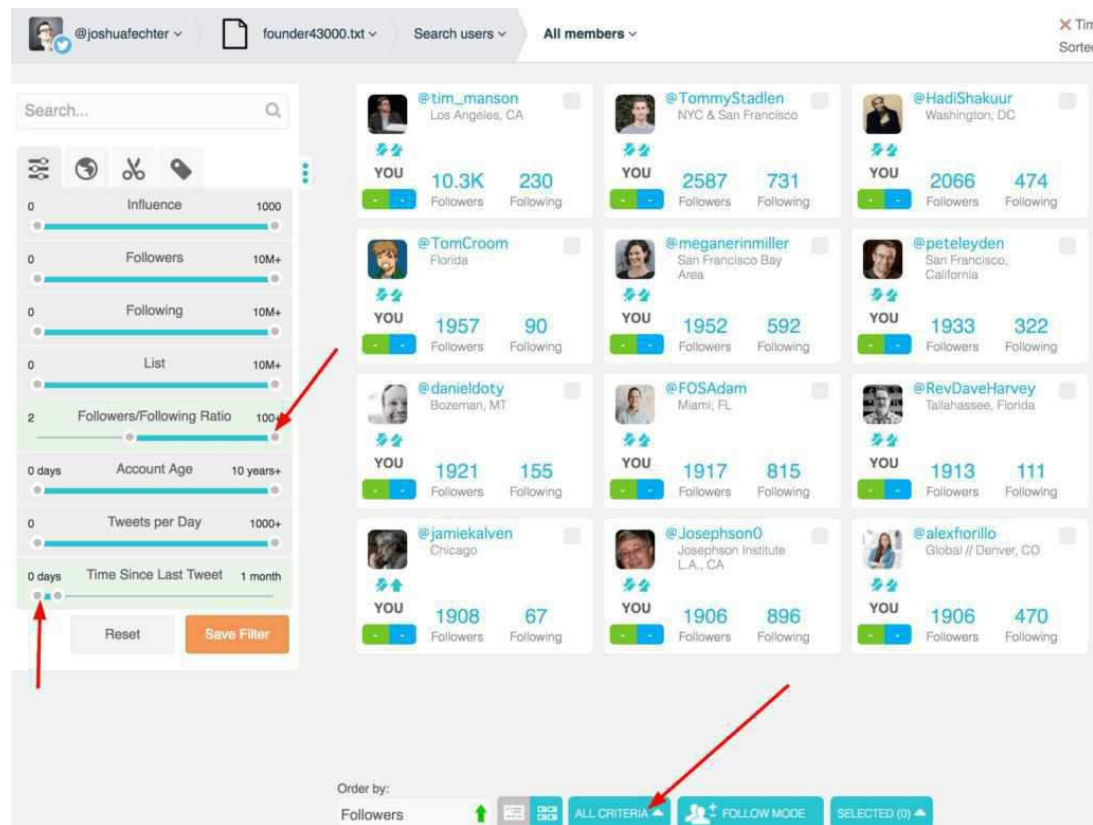


The screenshot shows the Audiense web interface for converting email lists into Twitter profiles. On the left is a sidebar with navigation options: 'Add a 3rd party Twitter Account', 'Add one of your Twitter lists', 'Add a public Twitter list', 'Import users from a TXT file', 'Convert emails into Twitter profiles' (which is highlighted with a blue bar), and 'Add a Tweet as a source'. The main content area is titled 'CONVERT EMAILS INTO TWITTER PROFILES' in a teal header. Below this is a 'Source:' dropdown menu with the placeholder text 'Select a source of emails'. A yellow informational box contains the following text: 'Once you have used all the emails available in your plan, you will be charged for each additional email. This is a one time charge: not included in your monthly subscription. NB: You will only pay for the emails that Audiense successfully matches with a Twitter account. Available emails: 250 Price per additional email: 0.1USD'. Below this is a blue box with the text: 'Import your email contacts into your Audiense database. From here you can view stats about them, follow and engage with them and begin to build up stronger business relationships.' At the bottom right of the main area is a 'Cancel' button. A red 'X' icon is visible in the top right corner of the interface.

The next step is to set your parameters to identify which customers are Twitter influencers. I set Time Since Last Tweet to one month to ensure they're still active on Twitter, then I ensure they have, at least, a 2:1 Followers/Following Ratio.

When I see the resulting Twitter profiles, I click on All Criteria where it gives me the option

to export them.



The next step is to cross-match in Excel these Twitter profile names with the names connected to your email accounts. You'll now have a resulting list of Twitter influencers and customers who you can target with Facebook ads.

9. Target Your Most Active Email List Subscribers

Do you use Facebook ads to activate your top engagers into referrers? If not, you can dive into your email marketing automation platform and segment the people on your email list based on recent opens or click-throughs.

Start with the people who opened your email consistently for the last couple of months. They have a strong positive association of your brand and content. It's time to turn this engagement into a referral. Design Facebook ads to promote a unique ambassador or referral program (think contests and sweepstakes).

This is an easy way to turn your rabid fans into evangelists without annoying your customers not



interested in engaging on social media.

10. Remind Customers of their Wins

Want to trigger a congratulations message with Facebook ads for a lead or customer who completes a particular step?

For example, let's say you have an ambassador program, and one of your ambassadors refers ten people to your email list in exchange for a branded t-shirt. Wouldn't it be nice to fuel their momentum by encouraging them to refer ten more people for the sweatshirt?

Once they get their first win (t-shirt), you target them with a Facebook ad containing acknowledgement of their efforts and encouragement to refer more people.

Closing Thoughts

If you're looking to tie everything together, then use AdEspresso's [Pixel Caffeine WordPress plugin](#). It's the first plugin to allow you to create hyper-segmented customer audiences and conversion tracking without leaving your website.

For people new or advanced with custom audiences, this will save you a significant amount of time implementing all of the above tactics.



Pixel Caffeine - Custom Audiences

Dashboard Custom Audiences **Conversions/Events** General Settings

NEW CUSTOM AUDIENCE

Name

Description

Pre-fill data ☒ Pre-fill data is ON!

Retention days

URL to include

URL to exclude

SPECIAL FILTERS [ADD NEW FILTER](#)

No filters set yet

 **CREATE CUSTOM AUDIENCE**

Based on the ten custom audiences mentioned, there are many avenues to refine your targeting, personalization, and copy.

The problem is many marketers focus entirely on building their email list rather than leveraging the emails they have with granular custom audiences.

Next time you decided to run a Facebook ad campaign, ask yourself whether it's worth reaching a new audience or better leveraging the one you own.

How to Launch a Chatbot with Zero Coding

Credit: [Houston Golden](#), Co-Founder of [BAMF.Media](#)

Process:

- **Step 1:** Writing FB Ad Copy Optimized for Post Engagement
- **Step 2:** Writing Chatbot Messages Optimized for CTA Goal
- **Step 3:** Launching FB Dark Posts As Ads for Chatbot
- **Step 4:** Launching Basic Chatbot Ad with MsgHero
- **Step 5:** Measure Results, Iterate, Optimize, Repeat!

Things You'll Need:

- A Facebook Page and Ads Manager Account
- A Paid Account on www.MsgHero.com

Step 1: Writing FB Ad Copy Optimized for Post Engagement

Strategize

Come up with strategy that makes sense for your client, or audience, in terms of the messaging around optimizing your dark post for comment engagement

Incentivize

Try to use an incentive if you can, such as offering special Promo/Discount codes for people who comment on your post

- Tap into People's Emotions - incentivize tagging friends

Write Your FB Ad Copy:

Best Option: "Tag 2 Friends Below"

- Works best to create a viral effect in the comments section

Second Best Option: "Comment 'THIS' below."

- Works best by tying in your CTA and providing super easy instructions to your audience that requires zero brain power.
- People don't want to think, so tell them exactly what to say below, and you'll get the best results.



Examples of Engaging FB Ad Copy

Client #1:

- “Hungry for a new job? Comment “HIRE ME” below and get on the path to get a killer job at your favorite snack company!”



The ad features a blue background with the text "NOW HIRING" in large, white, serif font. Below the text are three snack items: a bag of KIND Fruit & Nut bars, a jar of Justin's almond butter, and a bottle of POM Wonderful pomegranate juice. To the right of the image is a pink-bordered box containing the text: "Hungry for a new job? Comment 'HIRE ME' below and get on the path to get a killer job at your favorite snack company!". Below this box is the text "Simple 'HIRE ME' CTA Works". The ad shows engagement metrics: 493 likes, 849 comments, and 91 shares. A red arrow points to the "849 Comments" metric. Below the metrics is a section titled "View previous comments" showing 6 of 849 comments. The comments are from Andrew Killen, Michelle Glasco, Consuella Reid, and Gabriela Flores, all of whom have commented "HIRE ME".

Client #2:

- “Freeze Tag, you're it! Tag 2 fro-yo obsessed friends to convert them to Freeze and you'll receive a sweet treat right in your FB inbox!”



The ad features a photo of three cups of Freeze Tag frozen yogurt topped with various fruits. To the right of the image is the text: "Freeze Tag, you're it! Tag 2 fro-yo obsessed friends to convert them to Freeze and you'll receive a sweet treat right in your fb inbox!". Below this text is a section titled "Top Comments" showing 615 comments. The comments are from Billy Brody FroYo, Sahara Chhabra, and Billy Brody, all of whom have commented "Tag 2 friends".

Client #3:



- “This is a game changer 🔥 ✨ “Tag” your friend who needs better sleep and get 25% off in your inbox!”



Step 2: Writing Chatbot Message Optimized for CTA Goal

Once you’ve got the copy of your dark post figured out, you’ll want to optimize your chatbot’s autoresponder text. This is the message that gets sent to everyone who comments on your dark post.

Personalize:

Use people’s First Names and personalize the message to relate to the post they just engaged with so they know why they are getting it and happy to receive the offer.

Trackability:

Use UTM taxonomy, such as “[utm_campaign=fb_chatbot_1](#)” to track the traffic coming from your chatbot messages CTA within Google Analytics. Use Bit.ly to make your trackable links shorter and not messy looking inside the FB message. Bit.ly will also provide some nice analytics for you to cross-reference with GA for accuracy.

FB UX Compliance:

Be sure to be explicit that people who comment on your Ad understand and ***expect they are going to receive a message*** in order to respect Facebook’s UX compliance. This comment to messenger growth hack might not last long...



Emojis, Images, & GIFs

- Increases engagement with FB messages
- Emojis are awesome. Nuf said.
- Images/GIFs can be used to offer more memorable promos and easier to read promo codes that are also more easily read for online checkout, or for use at physical locations.



(example of promo code image via FB Messenger)

Examples of Chatbot Message Copy/Content

Hey [%FIRST_NAME%]!

PAGE is cooling, heating and climate control just for your bed. PAGE is an instant relief for hot sleepers, night sweats, evening hot flashes, cold feet and cold legs.

Better days start with better nights -- bring a PAGE home today and get back to some deep, restful, healthy sleep.

Try it for 60 days - if you don't love it, return it. We pay the return shipping.

Follow this link to get 25% off your PAGE today:
<http://bit.ly/2ql1b4>

Hey [%FIRST_NAME%], thanks for playing Freeze Tag!

As a thank you, here's a \$2 Freeze! Stop by our Hollywood location and show your cashier this code at checkout to get this sweet deal: FBFZ-02

(y) ;)

Hey [%FIRST_NAME%],

You were clearly meant for a HIRE purpose.

Join the Food industry's leading career network today to gain access to exclusive job opportunities that will help you climb up the food chain! ;P

Click here to start your career:
<http://pagep.co/HIREPURPOSE>

Thanks! - Team PAGE (y)

Step 3: Launching FB Dark Posts As Ads for Chatbot

[Unpublished Page posts](#) are often used for creating News Feed ads that do not show up on your Page.

The screenshot shows the 'Create Unpublished Page Post' dialog box. At the top, a blue header bar contains the title. Below it, a yellow box contains a message: 'If you use unpublished Page posts to create ads, you no longer need to. You can now create News Feed eligible ads in the Ads tab of Power Editor.' The 'Post Type:' section has tabs for 'Link', 'Carousel', 'Photo' (which is selected), 'Video', 'Status', and 'Offer'. Below the tabs, there is an 'Image' section with a dashed box containing a 'Select an Image' button and the text 'You can also drag and drop an image file here'. To the left of this is a 'Post Text' label and a text input field. Below the input field, there is a message: 'We made it easier to create and redeem offers, but it's not available in this tool yet. Create your offer in [Ads Manager](#) or [Power Editor](#) under Engagement instead.' At the bottom, there are two radio buttons: 'This post will only be used as an ad' (which is selected) and 'This post will be published on the Page'. Below the second radio button, it says 'This post will not get organic distribution'. At the very bottom, there are two buttons: 'Create Post' and 'Cancel'.

To create an unpublished Page post:

1. Go to [Power Editor](#).
2. Click **Power Editor** at the top of the page and select All Tools from the menu.
3. Under Create and Manage select Page Post.
4. If you manage multiple Pages, select the Page you want to create an unpublished post for from the top left drop down menu.
5. Click the blue Create Post button.
6. In the dialog box, choose the type of post you want to create and enter the info you want to include in your post.
7. Select "This post will only be used as an ad" if you only want to use this post as an ad, or select "This post will be published on the Page" if you want this post to appear on your Page.
8. Click Create Post. Keep in mind this post isn't published yet. It's saved in the list of your

posts. If you publish the post on your Page, you'll have the option to only show the post to specific languages and locations.

9. Once you're ready to use the post, check the box next to it and select one of the options in the Actions dropdown.

Optimization & Delivery **IMPORTANT: Optimize for "Post Engagement"**

Optimization for Ad Delivery ⓘ Post Engagement ▼

Bid Amount ⓘ
☒ **Automatic** - Let Facebook set the bid that helps you get the most post engagements at the best price.
☐ **Manual** - Enter a bid based on what post engagements are worth to you.

When You Get Charged ⓘ Post Engagement
More Options

Get charged on "Post Engagement"

Delivery Type ⓘ **Standard** - Show your ads throughout your selected schedule (recommended)
More Options

- Find "Optimization for Ad Delivery" and select "Post Engagement"
- Below, see "When You Get Charged" and select "Post Engagement"

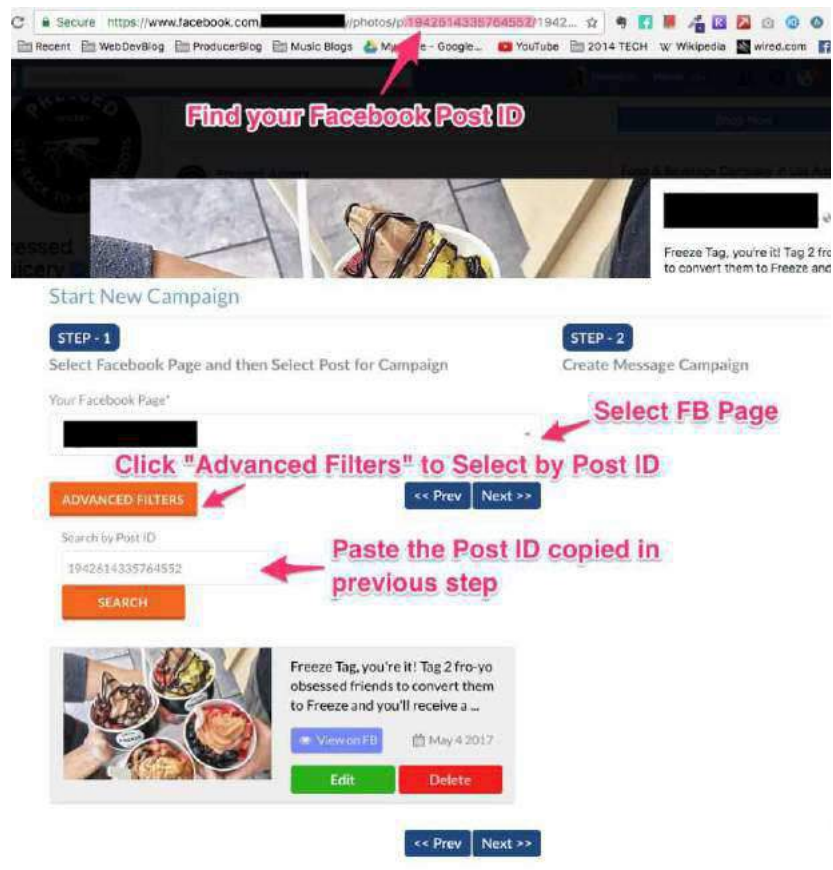
BOOM! Now, you have an **Unpublished Dark Post Ad** that's Optimized for Post Engagement to the fullest!

Step 4: Launching Basic Chatbot Ad With MsgHero

Create an Account on [MSGHero.com](https://www.msghero.com) and Connect Your Facebook Account

For MSGHero to work with a Facebook ad, it needs to be a FB post. This can be an unpublished dark post or a unhidden post. **As long as it's a post, it will work.**

Once you have a MsgHero account, go to the "Setup" page to get started building your new FB Chatbot campaign!



- Under the "Setup" page, (<https://www.msghero.com/login/setup>), select your Facebook page and you'll see a list of your posts show up below automatically.
- If you don't see your post, or want to be more precise, then click on "Advanced Filters" button, and use the "Search by Post ID" field.
- **Go to Preview Your Facebook Post** and find your specific **Post ID** for your Ad in the URL of the Post

Here are the final steps to take your new chatbot live!

- Feel free to ignore optional settings, or configure to your liking:
 - **Add more** - to add longer messages broken into multiple messages
 - **Message Delay** - to add a delay for you message after someone comments
 - **Anti-duplication** - avoid sending the same message to the same person twice

- **Keyword Exclusions & Inclusion** - exclude or include specific keywords for your bot to respond to, i.e. if you exclude "hate" the bot will not respond to people who use that word in their comment and vice-a-versa

- Click "Apply" to take your new chatbot live!

Character Count: 0/600, Maximum Characters Allowed: 600.

[Add more](#)

Message Delay Seconds

Anti-duplication

Add more, delay, anti-duplication, and keywords are all Optional Settings

Exclusion Keywords (Optional)

Inclusion Keywords (Optional)

Click "Apply" to take your new chatbot Live! 

BOOM, YOU'VE DONE IT!

Now, watch the comments roll in and chatbot messages blast out.

Step 5: Measure Results, Iterate, Optimize, Repeat!

Measuring the results of your chatbot will depend on your goals.

Most likely, you'll want to measure a few KPIs:

- Total # Messages Sent by Chatbot
- Total # Post Engagements
 - Comments, Likes (Reactions), Shares
- Cost Per Engagement
- Total # of People Reached
- Cost Per Click-Through
- Cost Per Conversion
 - **E-commerce:**
 - How many people click through your message link and make a purchase?



- Track Messages Click-through rates against E-commerce conversions goals, or Google Analytics custom goal conversions
- Or, how many people redeem the coupon/promo code from your messenger campaign?
- **B2B:**
 - How many people click on the Calendly or booking link to schedule a sales call?
 - How many free trials convert from click-throughs on your link?
 - How many leads use your messenger promo code?

Client Example #1:

Ad Set Name	Delivery ?	Resu... ?	Reach ?	Cost ... ?	Budget ?	Amount ... ?
"Hire Me"	Active 1 Approved	4,896 Post Enga...	78,374	\$0.18 Per Post E...	\$30.00 Daily	\$899.90

- Chatbot campaign running
- 4,896 Post Engagements / 2,674 Messages
- 78,374 People Reached
- \$0.18 per engagement
- 47% Chatbot Click-Through Rate
- 353 Shares
- Total Spent \$899.90
- **Budget:** \$30/day



Google Analytics Metrics: CLIENT_WEBSITE.COM/JOBS/?utm_source=CHATBOTHERE



- Example of using Google Analytics to track Click-through-rates of chatbot campaigns using MsgHero
 - Utm tag → then created Bit.ly link with that so it's not too long in your message
- **Note:** If you use a more advanced platform like [ManyChat](#) (our preferred platform), you will get more accurate data on click-throughs and your subscriber demographics and a lot more without having to use Google Analytics. That being said, it's still crucial to UTM tag all your links properly for tracking.

Client #2:

Ad Name	Delivery	Results	Reach	Cost per Result	Amount Spent
	Not Delivering Campaign is Off	807 Post Engagements	13,678	\$0.82 Per Post Engagement	\$660.53
	Not Delivering Campaign is Off	1,571 Post Engagements	32,804	\$0.41 Per Post Engagement	\$646.96
Results from 2 Ads		2,378 Post Engagements	46,945 People	\$0.55 Per Post Engagement	\$1,307.49 Total Spent

- Ran chatbot campaign for 1 day
- 2,378 Comments / 5,343 FB Messages
- \$0.55 per engagement
- Total Spent \$1,307.49

Client #3:

Ad Set Name	Delivery ⓘ	Resu... ⓘ	Reach ⓘ	Cost ... ⓘ	Budget ⓘ	Amount ... ⓘ
	● Active 2 Approved	22,003 Post Enga...	42,322	\$0.01 Per Post E...	\$10.00 Daily	\$220.84
	● Active 1 Approved	725 Post Enga...	19,798	\$0.24 Per Post E...	\$10.00 Daily	\$172.85
» Results from 2 Ad Sets		22,728 Post Enga...	60,580 People	\$0.02 Per Post E...		\$393.69 Total Spent

- 22,728 Post Engagements
- 60,580 People Reached
- \$0.02 per engagement
- Total Spent \$393.69

Next Steps Going Forward:

With Facebook chatbots still being at an early stage, this is a huge untapped area of opportunity for any business that currently runs Facebook ads or an email newsletter.

There are many great platforms for building chatbots as well as Facebook allowing you to optimize ads for "Send a Message" or build chatbots natively. Here are my favorite tools/platforms right now"

- [MsgHero.com](https://msghero.com) - for easy "comment" triggered chatbots like this guide
- [ManyChat.com](https://manychat.com) & [ChatFuel.com](https://chatfuel.com) - for more complex chatbots with built-in logic and better subscriber management features

One subscriber on Messenger = 5x the value of someone on email.

You can expect 99% open rates, and ~50% click-through-rates, now if you compare those metrics to a typical email campaign, **you'll understand the power of chatbots!**

"Chatbots are the new email."

- Houston Golden



Facebook Ad Script for Liking Your Page

Credit: [Jeremy Gillespie](#), Director of User Growth at Mixmax

// How to automagically invite 15,000 people to like your page every month //

Outside of Groups, using your business Facebook page is a great way to build a following around your brand. And not just for the vanity metrics, but to increase your know, like, and trust factor.

Anyway, there's been numerous times when I've had Facebook ads get a shitload of likes and shares, but no Page love... which sucks because I want to engage and nurture them into repeat buyers.

Yes, you can manually go through all of your likes and invite them to your page, but that takes too much time.

To the point - there's a script you can run to auto-invite (up to 500/day = 15,000/mo) to like your page.

If this is new to you, give it a try and let the community know your results.

If this is old news and you've been doing it for awhile, what type of results have you had?

// Invite All On Post //

1. Click on the number of likes of a post then you scroll all the way down, press 'See more' until the list is completed.

2. Right click on the blank area --> Inspect element --> choose Console tab.

3. Then paste the following script & enter.

```
javascript:var inputs = document.querySelectorAll('a._42ft._4jy0._4jy3._517h');
for(var i=1; i<inputs.length;i++) {
inputs[i].click();
}
```

AFFILIATE & REFERRAL

The Secret Growth Hack to Building an Affiliate Marketing Program	Hailey Friedman	84
The Hustle's Ambassador Program: A Framework for 275K Subscribers	Josh Fechter	95

The Secret Growth Hack to Building an Affiliate Marketing Program

Credit: [Hailey Friedman](#), Growth Marketing Manager & Blogger at [GrowthMarketingPro.com](#)

I had an epiphany about life that led me to the secret growth hack that grew our affiliate marketing program 9X year over year.

First off, what's an affiliate marketing program?

For those who don't know, building an affiliate marketing program means building partnerships with bloggers and influencers in your space that have an online audience and paying them per lead they send to your site.

Often, you both sign an agreement at a set cost per conversion on your site. The partnership is mutually beneficial in that they benefit by monetizing traffic to their site, and you benefit by having an influencer vouch for your product and send qualified traffic to your site.

Affiliate marketing traffic is “friendly” traffic

Bloggers who have a loyal following, have readers who return to their site time and time again. These readers have established trust with the blog and content they find there.

Therefore, when a blogger writes about your company and can recommend it to their readers in a genuine way, that blogger is sending a “warm lead” to your site. This is someone who's already been primed, pre-qualified by learning a bit about your site and is interested enough to click through to learn more.

Why do affiliate marketing relationships matter?

An affiliate marketing lead is comparable in quality to the type of lead you'd get from a referral program - when a current customer refers a friend.

To give you an idea of how strong affiliate leads are, here's a snapshot of my Google Analytics page showing that affiliate leads signup at a conversion rate that is more than 4.4X the average site visitor.



Source / Medium ?		Acquisition	Behavior	Conversions	Goal 17
				Investor Signup Conversion Rate 0.98% Avg for View: 0.98% (0.00%)	
1.	google / cpc			1.59%	
2.	affiliate			4.34%	
3.	(direct) / (none)			0.85%	

When I joined RealtyShares in 2015 as the second marketing hire and 20th employee at the company, among the many things on my plate, I was tasked with building an affiliate program from the ground up.

The first thing I did was research and create a list of all the FinTech/investing bloggers in our space and reach out to them via email to invite them to join our affiliate program...

Hi Joe,

Happy new year!

We're big fans of your blog, [redacted] and I'm reaching out because I think you'd be a great fit for our **affiliate program**. RealtyShares is (by traffic) the biggest real estate crowdfunding platform.

We've on-boarded [redacted] affiliates to date and we pay them [redacted] per completed application on our website. Some of our best affiliates are making [redacted] a month.

Let me know if you'd be interested in moving forward.

Thanks,

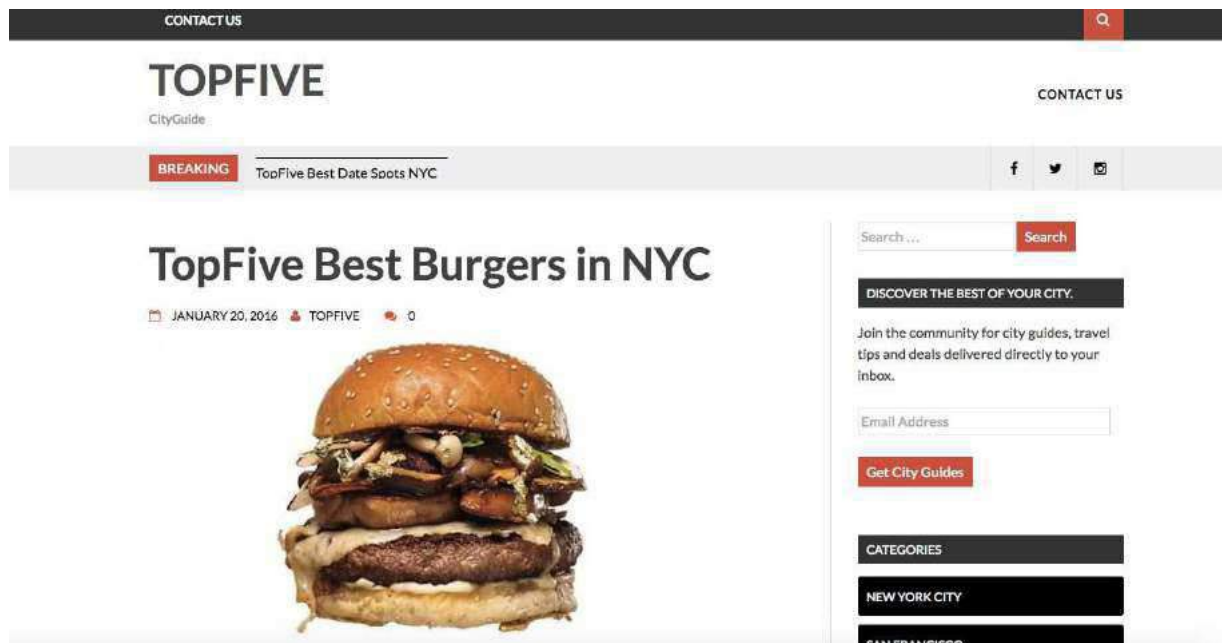
Hailey

I sent out 50 emails and got 12 responses. All of which did not think the partnership would be a fit or were not interested at this time. That effort produced *zero* affiliate partnerships.

It wasn't until I was working on a side project of mine, when I unlocked the secret to building affiliate relationships.

How I discovered the secret to building affiliate relationships

www.topfivecityguide.com is a blog where I aggregated survey responses from hundreds of New Yorkers and San Franciscans about their absolute favorite restaurants in various categories. Each week I'd post a new blog post based off the data I collected "[Top Five Brunch Spots in NYC](#)", "[Top Five Burgers in NYC](#)", "[Top Five Coffee Spots in NYC](#)".



Each time I wrote something I also posted about it on Facebook and Twitter, tagging every restaurant or company that was mentioned in the blog post.

To my surprise, these renowned restaurants and food brands were extremely flattered by the mention and over 50% of them “liked”, “re-posted” and “shared” my tweets...





Carvel Ice Cream @CarvelIceCream · 11 Apr 2016

@TOPFIVE_CG Thanks for including us! PS mark your calendars - April 21st is #FreeConeDay at Carvel! facebook.com/events/2097529...

↩️ ↻️ ❤️ ...



Eataly NYC Flatiron liked your Tweet 10 Apr 2016

10 Apr 2016: IT'S HERE- The NYC 2016 Summer Ice Cream Checklist! How many of these spots have you tried? bit.ly/1oHNYLU pic.twitter.com/ZxTGYoPRmv





16 Handles @16Handles · 8 Apr 2016

Proud to make the top 5 list of best ice cream places in NYC, beating out many places that actually serve ice cream!

TOPFIVE CityGuide @TOPFIVE_CG

IT'S HERE- The NYC 2016 Summer Ice Cream Checklist! How many of these spots have you tried? bit.ly/1oHNYLU



↩️ ↻️ 3 ❤️ 7 ...



Tacombi @tacombi · 7 Apr 2016

Best tacos in #NYC thanks @TOPFIVE_CG: bit.ly/1SCXDvf. #VisitTacombi



The Best Mexican Spots in NYC - TOPFIVE

Here's to the best Mexican in NYC- Because there's nothing like a giant pitcher of margaritas and a pile of chips with guac to kick off your weekend.

topfivecityguide.com

↩️ ↻️ 1 ❤️ 1 ...



Dos Toros Retweeted your Tweet 25 Mar 2016

24 Mar 2016: Hundreds of New Yorkers voted- Here are the TopFive The Best Mexican Spots in NYC topfivecityguide.com/best-mexican-i... pic.twitter.com/rSRHerS6Wv





Dos Toros liked your Tweet 25 Mar 2016

24 Mar 2016: Hundreds of New Yorkers voted- Here are the TopFive The Best Mexican Spots in NYC topfivecityguide.com/best-mexican-i... pic.twitter.com/rSRHerS6Wv





Dos Caminos @DosCaminos · 12 Apr 2016

Voted #BestMexicanFoodinNYC, we'll take it! Thanks @TOPFIVE_CG:

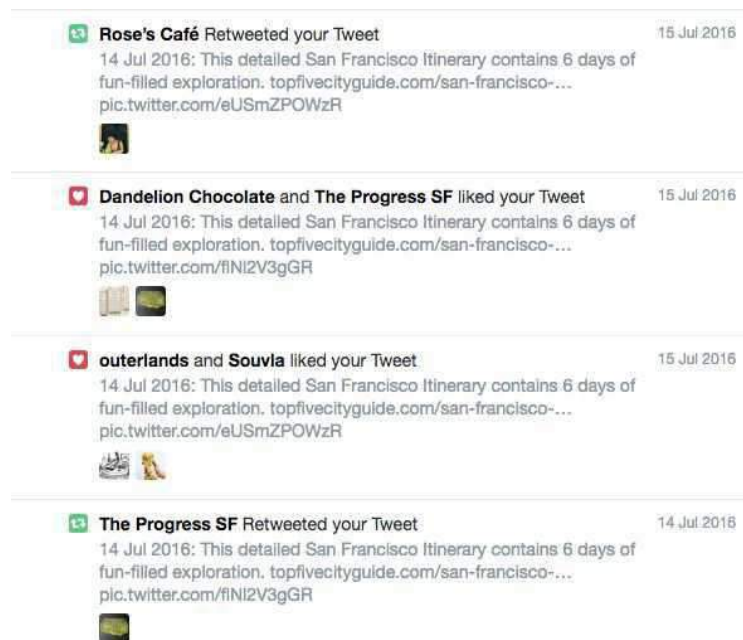


The Best Mexican Spots in NYC - TOPFIVE

Here's to the best Mexican in NYC- Because there's nothing like a giant pitcher of margaritas and a pile of chips with guac to kick off your weekend.

topfivecityguide.com

↩️ 1 ↻️ 1 ❤️ 4 ...



It was at this point that I came to a realization about life that helped to drive my growth marketing career forward.

People love being recognized.

I took this concept and ran with it at RealtyShares. I put together content: [“Top 60 Real Estate Investing Blogs,”](#) [“Top 76 Alternative Investing Blogs,”](#) [“Top 75 Real Estate Blogs,”](#) [“Top 14 Personal Finance Blog”](#) and many more. As many categories as I could possibly think of that related to FinTech or the Real Estate industry. All together we ended up mentioning over 373 different blogs, podcasts, books and influencers within these “Top” lists that we posted to the RealtyShares blog.

Next, I reached out to every single person that was mentioned in one of our blog posts, taking a slightly different approach than the first time I reached out via email- **I didn't mention our affiliate program at all.**

Gave you some love on our blog

Inbox x



Hailey Friedman

to Joe

1/14/16

Hey Joe,

My name is Hailey Friedman and I'm reaching out because we love what you're doing over on your blog

We just created a list of the Top 60 Real Estate Investing Blogs for 2016, and we ranked you at the top of our list! As far as I can tell, it is the most comprehensive one ever created:

<https://www.realtyshares.com/blog/top-real-estate-investing-blogs/>

I was hoping that you might be willing to

1. Consider sharing this with your readers if you think it would be helpful to them
2. If for any reason, you notice that I'm missing any blogs, please let me know and I will add them.

Thanks!

Hailey

Here's the response I got this time around...

Joe

to me, Joe

1/14/16

Holy! I didn't realize there were so many sites out there. Thanks for including me, I'm happy to share.

Here's one you missed -

Best,

Joe

Hailey Friedman

to Joe, Joe

1/14/16

Thanks, Joe! There's a ton of great content out there :)

In case you're interested, I've been working on putting together our **affiliate program** for 2016 and I think you'd be a great fit. RealtyShares is (by traffic) the biggest real estate crowdfunding platform.

We've on-boarded affiliates to date and we pay them per completed application on our website. Some of our best affiliates are making a month.

Let me know if this is something you might be interested in and we can discuss further.

Thanks!

Hailey

Joe

to me

1/14/16

Hi Hailey,

Yes, I'd be very interested and I'm quite familiar with RealtyShares. I've had a few friends do deals with you.

Do you have more details on how to get set up?

Best,

Joe

By first giving recognition to the blogger for their fantastic content, I was able to "warm up" the relationship, and therefore Joe and the rest of the bloggers I spoke to were far more open to learning about our affiliate program.

Not to mention all the shares and backlinks we gained when these 373 influencers shared our post with their followers.



Out of the 373 influencers we emailed, 66 of them ended up signing up for our affiliate program. **That's an 18% conversion rate!**

By utilizing this strategy alone, I was able to grow our affiliate program 9X year over year.

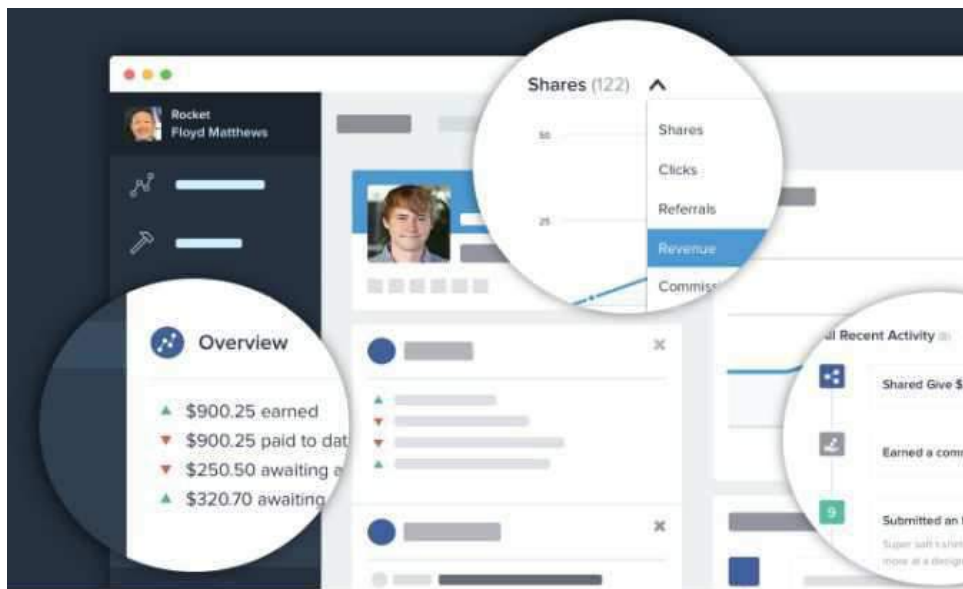
Not only did affiliate traffic grow exponentially- but the quality of the leads proved to be among the strongest relative to other channels like SEM, Native and Paid Social.

Meaning that signups that came from our affiliate program, became investors at a higher rate and invested more dollars on our platform than signups from other channels.

How do I track my affiliate marketing program?

If you're looking for a tool to manage & track your affiliate marketing partners and the commissions that they're each earning, I use Ambassador, which is [referral marketing software](#) and it's awesome. The Ambassador platform makes it easy for affiliates to sign up, access their unique tracking link and monitor their clicks, conversions and commission. You can even pay your affiliates through the platform.

How did I find out about Ambassador? Well, first I used them to build out our referral program at RealtyShares which scaled 10X within 45 days of implementing Ambassador. Enough said. I implemented it on the affiliate marketing side as soon as I saw those results.



However, if you find Ambassador is out of your price range- look into [Omnistar](#). Omnistar's tool will also let you track an affiliate program quickly and easily and it's a fraction of the cost.

[Omnistar](#) costs ~\$40/month rather than \$1,000/month like Ambassador. This is the first platform we used to get the referral program off the ground and it worked wonders; however, there were a couple of feature limitations that led us to our ultimate switch to Ambassador.

So I have affiliate partners- now what?

Once someone agrees to be an affiliate partner, send them a link to sign up for your affiliate program. This link should take them to a sign-up page that explains how your affiliate program works.

For example, "When you sign up as an affiliate, you'll get a unique link that you can use any time you refer to our company. When someone clicks on your link and signs up or makes a purchase, we'll pay you \$X in commission."

Every affiliate marketing partner should have their own unique tracking link. That way, whenever they write about your product, they can link to your site and get credit for every click or sale.

If you use a tracking platform like Ambassador, your affiliates can log in and monitor their performance in terms of clicks, conversions and the commissions that they're earning.

How do you get affiliates to write about your product?

It's one thing to convince someone to sign up as an affiliate.

You: "Hey, do you want to make money for writing about my product on your blog?"

Them: "Uh, yeah."

It's another thing to convince them to sit down, and take the time to create content that will drive affiliate conversions. Your product is likely not the only product that they've signed up to promote.

You: "Hey, so I noticed you signed up to be an affiliate, but I'm not seeing any traffic from your site yet..."

Them: "Oh yeah, I've been meaning to, but I just haven't had the time to get around to writing new content"



How do you encourage your new affiliates to take the time to write about your product? How can you get your new partners to prioritize producing and promoting your content ahead of their other partnerships?

Provide affiliates with the tools they need to be successful

This includes:

1. Pre-written blog posts
2. Best practices around creative (what works for your company when you write about your product?)
3. Examples of high converting headlines
4. Important data points around your company
5. Press pieces that mention your company
6. Examples of blog posts from successful affiliates
7. Set up a kick-off call where you can brainstorm ideas together

Incentivize your affiliate marketing partners

Say it's a month or two later and you're still not seeing them send traffic to your site, how do you motivate them to get started?

I'll tell you how- *you pay them!*

Money talks.

Check it out...

You: "Hey, so you know how I told you earlier that I'd pay you \$40 per conversion? Well, if you send over your first few conversions before the end of the month, you can lock in a special rate \$60 per conversion for good."

Them: "Oh shit, sweet deal. I'm going to get on writing your content ASAP!"

Reward affiliate partners that send strong leads

Before going ahead and offering more money per a conversion, you'll have to make sure that the numbers work in favor for your company's ROI.

That might mean that you start newer affiliates at a lower pricing tier and promote them to higher priced tiers once you determine that they send you quality traffic.



It's okay to pay different affiliates different base commissions per a conversion.

Sucky Affiliate: "Hey, can you bump up my base commission rate?"

You: "Uh, no. None of the leads you are sending me are actually converting. They're low quality and I can hardly afford to pay you what I'm paying you. In fact, I'm considering terminating our partnership if I don't see an improvement in lead quality before the end of the month.

Awesome Affiliate: "Hey, can you bump up my base commission rate?"

You: "Yes- the leads you are sending me are awesome and spending a lot of money our product. I can bump up your commission rate by \$X."

Stay top of mind with your affiliate marketing partners

Once you've gotten your affiliate partners to "activate" or make their first few referrals that convert on your site, stay on top of their mind so that they're motivated to pump out content with your company's name on it.

There are a few ways you can do this.

1. **Email drip campaign:** Enter your affiliate's emails into an automated email drip campaign that sends them an email every week with data and nuggets of information that they can use in their content.
2. **Press:** Send your affiliates any articles or press mentions about your company. They can share this with their audience or integrate the news into their own content.
3. **Build relationships-** Follow your affiliates on Twitter. Connect on LinkedIn. Join Facebook groups and engage in their communities. Integrate yourself into their world and bring value when you can by sharing articles they might be interested in and liking their content.
4. **Host events:** Invite your affiliate partners to company events or offer to host a meetup at your office. If you can provide value to your affiliate marketing partners, they will want to return the favor.

Conclusion

People love to be recognized.

1. Identify influencers you want to partner with.



2. Create a “top list” blog post that recognizes them for high quality content.
3. Email them to let them know you think they’re awesome and they’ve been featured.
4. Pitch your affiliate marketing program.
5. Manage your affiliate program through [Ambassador](#) (\$1,000/month) or [Omnistar](#) (\$40/month)
6. Set your affiliates up for success and motivate them to get started
7. Stay top of mind with your affiliate partners

If you carefully track your affiliate marketing traffic, you’ll soon discover that it can be an incredibly valuable source of leads.

At RealtyShares, affiliate traffic has become a huge part of our funnel and this traffic converts to sign ups at a massive rate compared to other traffic sources.

Affiliate traffic is too valuable to ignore!

The great thing about an affiliate program is that it’s relatively inexpensive. Rather than paying per click or per impression like you do on Google Adwords or Facebook, you only pay for *actual signups* on your site. No money wasted!

If you’re looking for high quality traffic growth, an Affiliate program is an excellent place to start.



The Hustles Ambassador Program A Framework for 275K Subscribers

Credit: [Josh Fechter](#), Co-Founder of [BAMF.Media](#)

What's the best source of a lead?

A referral.

And the best way to get referrals is to use ambassador programs to turn subscribers and customers into advocates.

Startup founders and marketers love ambassador programs because they require little-to-no engineering, have low setup costs and streamlined tracking. They're fast to implement, but they won't help your company grow if you don't track the right metrics and engage with your members.

In parallel, to run a high-level ambassador program, you need to analyze how many ambassadors and signups you receive from different sources using like Google Analytic and Autopilot. And to ensure you can fine-tune your ambassador program's content and landing pages, you need to use referral software that includes A/B testing and event tracking.

Here's your ambassador program tool list to make it happen:

1. [Queue](#), advanced referral marketing software

"The queue system we made drops them in something like 500th place in a queue when they leave their email. The only way to get further up the queue is to like our Facebook page, follow us on Twitter, invite their friends by email, etc. If they finish near the top of the queue, they get bonuses.

In our case, it was free growth hacking consultancy, free webinars, free entrance to a secret growth hacking group on Facebook, etc. In your case it might be early access or free products. People LOVE gamification like this, and we saw well over 100% uplift (i.e. we more than doubled the number of people we invited to the queue. On launch day, we had over 2,200 people from the queue waiting for the book to come out." - Vin Clancy, CEO & Founder of Traffic & Copy

2. [Viral Loops](#), all-in-one referral marketing software

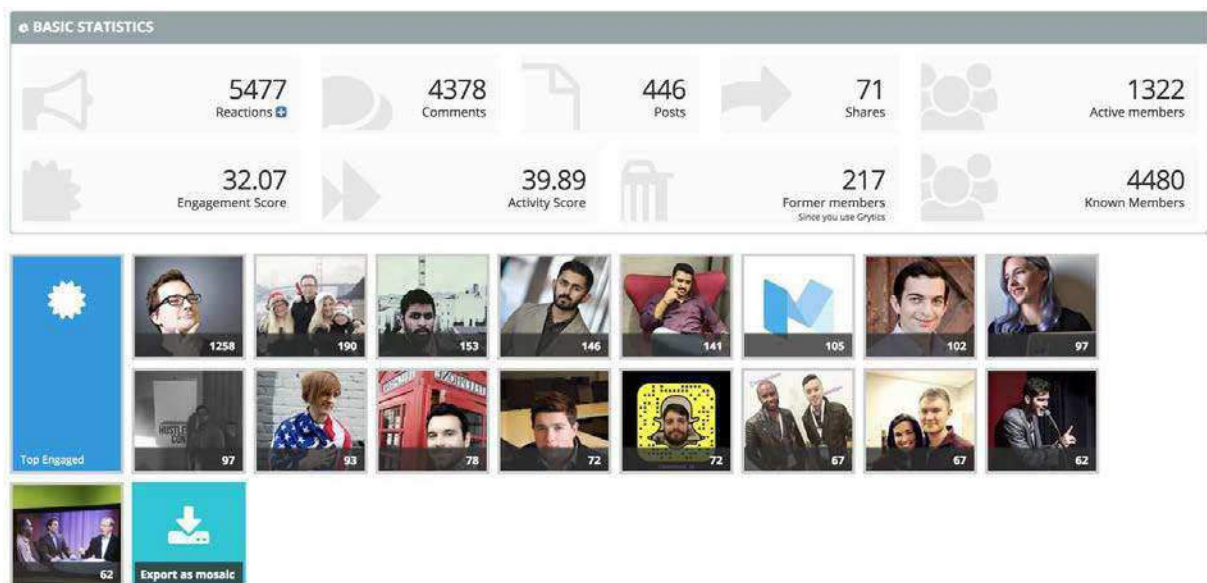


I **prefer this software**. Viral Loops gives you every option for an ambassador program. They have features made to mimic The Hustle's ambassador program because they loved it so much. You can find it under their [Milestone Referral Program](#).

3. [Grytics](#), Facebook Group analytics software

Grytics will help you manage your Facebook Group's analytics regarding members, likes, comments, interactions, and best-performing posts. You can easily export this data, too. It also has a sleek interface and can pinpoint the exact areas where your group needs improvement from content to management.

And Grytics provides you details about your most engaged group members. Here's an insider screenshot of the interface:



What is *The Hustle*?

Because of the many moving pieces, few companies run great ambassador programs. One company that does it exceptionally well is *The Hustle*, a media publication founded by serial entrepreneurs, Sam Parr and John Havel.

The Hustle is a daily email newsletter and publication targeted at millennials. Today, the email has over 275,000 daily email subscribers. Powerful.

Sam Parr founded a unique niche with their daily email's conversational tech-bro voice, and memorable stories and reporting. A couple of more standout stories, include [Microdosing: I](#)

[Spent 14 Days Using LSD to Increase Productivity... Kind Of](#), [Soylent: What Happened When I Went 30 Days Without Food](#), and [How Much Does it Cost to Build an App?](#)

"In the way Vice has filled a voice somewhere between CNN and Fox News, we're doing that with business-undertone news, focused on an affluent young audience, somewhere between CNBC and The Wall Street Journal," said Parr.

To see what makes *The Hustle*'s ambassador program tick, let's go on a deep dive.

It Starts with the Opt-in Form

First, [submit your email](#). Notice the casual copy above the opt-in form and the lack of text on the button. I can only wonder how many times they A/B tested this form.

the **HUSTLE**

Oh - hey there. What's up?

The Hustle is an email newsletter for savvy forward thinkers interested in business news. We find, explore, and uncover original content on stories that inspire.

Looks like you arrived on this page because one of your friends thinks you should sign up. So go on...try it.

Enter your email address	→
--------------------------	---

ALREADY ON THE LIST?

Enter your email to check your score.

You can access this opt-in form through a direct link or other pages on *the Hustle* like this one:





Cheers to bullshit-free news.

Since launching The Hustle's daily email, we've somehow attracted a tribe of fanatical readers.

All you crazy people out there have mailed us massive amounts of free stuff (keep it coming btw), randomly stop by our office, and have sent us photos so we can see how you're living (one day last month [1,500+ of you sent us photos in 12 hours](#)). One of you deviants even had 20 pizzas delivered to our office. Thanks.

However, the best thing you all have done for us is quite simple: you've convinced your friends to join The Hustle. And we're very thankful for that as we now have millions of people every month reading The Hustle.

And so, to thank you all, we've set up a private community where you can chat with one another as well as an Ambassador program so we can reward you for sharing The Hustle.

Hustle Ambassadors help us brainstorm new products/content, test new features, take part in our events, and contribute to discussions with other hustlers.

There's already a couple thousand of Hustle Ambassadors out there...[wanna join?](#)

- The Hustle team

What happens when you opt-in?

You see an unforgettable thank-you page. The man in the mirror is a GIF, so when you land on the page, you'll see him nod his head over and again. Talk about a seductive landing page!





Welcome aboard.

Emails are sent out every weekday at 9am Pacific so keep your eyes peeled.

In the meantime, check out the [stuff we're writing on the blog](#) and the [events we're hosting](#). And, if you're socially minded, [follow along on Facebook](#) for extra entertainment when you're pretending to work.

Talk soon,
The Hustle

You're officially a subscriber. Now, you'll receive the most epic welcome email ever to exist. I know what you're thinking:

"To ever exist? Really?"

Yes.

Many publications featured their welcome email, including [here](#), [here](#), [here](#), and [here](#). Oh, and [here](#), too.

Here's the welcome email word-for-word:



the **HUSTLE**

A letter from the leader of a circus, aka The Hustle:

I assure you, we don't take what just happened lightly.

You just gave us your email and joined our newsletter.

That's a VERY big deal to us.

Don't believe me?

After you pressed the submit button and sent us your email a little buzzer went off in our office. Our entire team can hear it, and when it went off everyone smiled.

Our office manager gave a golf clap and our operations guy did a pushup (I don't know why, but for some reason he does a pushup each time the buzzer goes off).

Greg, our head of marketing, ran outside and hugged some old lady walking by the office. I'm pretty sure he just tried to kiss her. She didn't seem to mind it, thankfully.

I'm also fairly certain I just saw Kera, our director of content, take a shot of tequila. I have no idea why she's drinking at work, but hey, the kid is excited you just signed up. Is she pouring another one? Ah crap, I gotta go and stop her.

Wait, shoot... I'm getting off topic.

Look, I didn't write this to tell you about our team's awful impulse control, but to thank you for signing up. Every pixel and character of copy on our site and in this newsletter is here to make you happy.

We hope every piece of content we create will inspire you to live a more epic life. If it doesn't, just hit reply to any email you receive from The Hustle and tell us how you feel.



Thanks again for joining our tribe. We'll holler at you soon with some awesome stuff.

And by the way...want to share this email with your friends? Click the link below and we'll take care of the rest.



Sam Parr, CEO of The Hustle

PS: Want to join our Ambassador program so you can earn free swag and get access to our private community? Give this bad boy a click: <http://ambassadors.thehustle.co/?ref=3d5edfbd87>

 Share

 Tweet

GIVEAWAYS EPISODES ADVERTISE

[TERMS & PRIVACY POLICY](#)

the HUSTLE

[UNSUBSCRIBE](#)

Notice the call to action to join their ambassador program at the bottom of the email. This link is in many of their daily emails, too. When you click the link, you land back on your personal ambassador homepage where you see the number of people you've referred and the prizes you can win.

Here's the first half of the landing page:



13

friends have joined

SHARE YOUR UNIQUE LINK:

<http://ambassadors.thehustle.co/?ref=e51156fa6c>



Not everyone who enters will become a referrer. Maitre, a viral marketing software, conducted a study of [3.6 million referral emails](#) and found most people don't refer even one person. In turn, by



only referring a small number of friends (2-3), you can push yourself to the top of the leaderboard. In fact, to be in the top 10%, you only need to refer one person. If you refer two people, you're in the top 5%

Before we continue, many people may be asking what's the difference between a sweepstakes, giveaway, contest, and ambassador program. A giveaway is another way to say "contest" or "sweepstakes." Why? The word "giveaway" [receives 27% more conversions](#) than "sweepstakes" when running a sweepstakes. The more you know :)

A sweepstakes is a game of chance. A contest requires skill and exclusion. An ambassador program is a contest that anyone can win - a combination of a contest and community.

Who participates in ambassador programs?

[Forrester's Social Technographics](#) explains the different audiences that will engage with your promotion: Spectators, Joiners, and Creators.

- ***Spectators*** click through to your giveaway, but their interaction doesn't go further. For **spectators**, use **a well-designed landing page and clear messaging, so they leave with a good impression of your brand.**
- ***Joiners*** participate in low-barrier ambassador programs and may engage further through referrals, commenting and sharing.
- ***Creators*** love **user-generated content giveaways and ambassador programs.** Because many of us have iPhones, there are many more content creators than a few years ago. As content has become easier to create, expectations have increased, too.

The Hustle's ambassador program caters to *Joiners* because they require you to hit a certain level of referral tiers to get rewards.

What do you give away?

The Hustle gives away a ton of swag and free tickets to their events. In fact, they've changed their referral tiers as they've received a better understanding of the customer lifetime value of their average referrer.

Ideally, what you give away should have a viral component to it. The most viral gift *The Hustle* gives away are their stickers (think of it as their Apple logo). Most people slap the sticker on their laptop resulting in thousands of free impressions.

To give each gift a viral component, *The Hustle's* team always goes over the top. One of their referrers posted an image of the prizes she received. Notice the extras, including the



handwritten letter and branding on the packaging.

As Sam Parr says, "Everything is content."



Make sure to keep the prizes relevant to your niche and brand. If *The Hustle* gave away an Apple iPhone, then they'd have many people on their email list interested in iPhones, not their daily email and events. At the same time, don't make it too specific or you'll scare people off.

To save money, think of your prize in regards to benefit to the subscriber. For example, I took a poll of my community and they'd rather have a BAMF t-shirt over \$100 Amazon gift card. Lesson: ask your community what they want.

Now, for the second half of the ambassador landing page:



Proven methods to get referrals

- **Social Media:** Share your link on FB, Twitter, Tinder, whatever you're into. Ambassadors say FB groups work best.
- **Office:** Share your link in Slack or in a company wide email. Give the whole company something to discuss daily.
- **Text and email:** Copy and paste your link into a text or email. Easy peasy. Or, simply mass email your link to any of your contacts
- **In college?:** Student orgs and listservs are great places to spread the word
- **Get creative:** Marissa Horwitz, one of our ambassadors, emailed her entire company just so she could get a sticker. She got it. And she referred over 75+ people.



Say hi to Marissa.

Here's the email she sent:

"Expand your knowledge! Learn cool shit! Help me get a free sticker of a drunken pizza holding a 40! You can do this and more by signing up for an awesome daily newsletter called the hustle using this link:
<http://ambassadors.thehustle.co/?ref=5b07e194d0>

It's a daily tech/business/social media newsletter that I rely on to get info every morning. Plus, the welcome email is amazing."



Say hi to Sean.

And here's another one of our ambassadors, Sean Wilcox:

Sean gets an A+ for effort. When he saw a huge line of people, he went up to them one by one and had them sign up using his link and phone. Got 104 people. (thumbs up emoji)

Did you hustle your way to 50+ subscriber referrals? Send your story and any other questions to jackie@thehustle.co

Notice how the second half details the exact steps to getting more email subscribers using testimonials. Few - if any - brand ambassador programs do this. By the time you finish reading the testimonials, you feel confident enough to sign people up for *The Hustle*.

What happens when you refer enough people to receive a prize?

You get another email with excellent copy and a few call to actions. First, they ask you to fill out a form to input your shipping address.



the **HUSTLE**

Yo.

We see you had 4 of your buds sign up for The Hustle, awesome work. You are now an official ambassador! Here's what's next:

1. Free gifts

We want to give you swag, no need to say thanks. Please fill out this [short questionnaire](#) so we can know more about you, don't forget to share your mailing address!

You need 10 friends for a t-shirt, 25 friends to get a hoodie, and 50 friends to receive a free ticket to [Hustle Con](#).

2. Introduce yourself

We invite you to join our [private community](#). Tell us who you are, where you're from, and how you are a hustler. **We will not accept you into our community if you did not fill out our short questionnaire in #1.**

Here's the genius part: Since they know you have a strong incentive to fill out the form, they also ask whether you're a founder, type of content you enjoy reading, desired outcome from the ambassador program, and what websites you follow. By the time you hit "Submit," you've given *The Hustle* a detailed look into your life enabling them to market to you better.

At the end of the form, they also link to a YouTube video of the co-founder, Sam Parr, introducing *The Hustle* on a more personal level:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WxewIXvHO4s>

Now back to the second part of the prize email:



3. FAQs

As you talk more about The Hustle, you'll start to get a lot of attention. You can read everything about this in our [Ambassador Guide](#), but here is how we answer our most popular questions:

- **What is The Hustle about?**

The Hustle is an email newsletter for savvy forward thinkers interested in business, design, and tech. We find, explore, and uncover original content on stories that inspire.

- **How is our content different from everything else on the internet?**

We believe there's a massive gap created by older and stuffy content sites like The New York Times and Wall Street Journal, and newish but boring sites like Inc, Forbes, and Fast Company. The Hustle wants to be the biggest and best creator of content for entrepreneurial millennials.

- **How did this all start?**

We started as Hustle Con, a conference where non-technical founders would come and talk. People absolutely loved hearing their raw and authentic stories. We created a media company to bridge the gap and share those stories all year long. Now, we are delivering these epic stories directly to your inbox.

If you have any questions, they link to their ambassador guide [FAQ](#). This is one my favorite parts of the ambassador program. The FAQ answers every question the prospect might ask.

Moreover, it reminds them of how easy it is to refer people because they include a few testimonials similar to the ambassador homepage.

Here's a short snippet of the testimonials on the FAQ page:

If you have any questions, they link to their ambassador guide [FAQ](#). This is one my favorite parts of the ambassador program. The FAQ answers every question the prospect might ask.

Moreover, it reminds them of how easy it is to refer people because they include a few testimonials similar to the ambassador homepage.

Here's a short snippet of the testimonials on the FAQ page:



What have ambassadors done in the past that worked?

- Alun Hill gave a shout out to The Hustle on an email to his 70,000+ Udemy students! Alun got 2,000 sign ups in 72 hours!
- Paige Ando from Zenefits personally messaged her link to her friends who liked business, tech, or design. She reached 52 sign ups in less than a week.
- David Brookes went to Twitter and used hashtags like #Entrepreneur #Business & #Hustle to attract people. He reached 54 people!
- Greg Frank is a University student and shared his link in different Facebook groups. He targeted ones that were business minded, tech loving, and those who had an entrepreneurial spirit. Greg collected 65 emails overnight.
- Alex Moskov, co-founder of SetMine, collected 41 emails in under five hours! When I asked him how he did it, Alex said, "Just hitting up some friends."

There are many ways to spread the word about The Hustle. Figure out which hustle is best for you and get all the sweet rewards.

The last call to action is to refer more people. Most marketers put this CTA at the top of their email, but *The Hustle* doesn't believe you should ask first. They're objective is to build trust. And it works quite well - 275,000 plus subscribers.



4. Sharing & tracking

Continue to share your unique link because you're only 6 friends away from receiving a free t-shirt. To track how many people signed up, visit our [ambassador home page](#).

5. Welcome

Thank you for being here, seriously. We're grateful to have you on this journey.

Keep up the hustle,



Tam "Tambassador" Pham

GIVEAWAYS EPISODES ADVERTISE
TERMS & PRIVACY POLICY

the **HUSTLE**

UNSUBSCRIBE

What's up with the private community?

This is where the magic happens. An engaged community is priceless, but it takes a significant amount of work to facilitate. You need to post excellent content almost every day, respond to comments, approve members, and introduce new members.

The Hustle founders know this, so they're constantly testing out content from polls to live streaming with influencers.





Sam Parr created a poll.

February 6 at 2:37pm

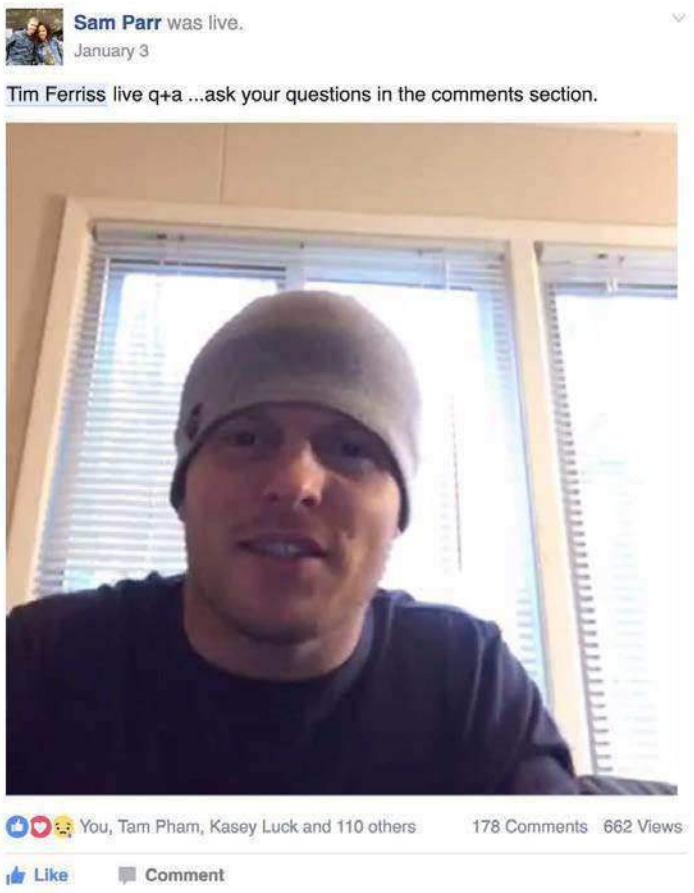
Question: which inbox did The Hustle go into today?

☒	Main		+77
☐	Updates		+9
☐	Promos		+4
☐	I marked it as spam		+1
☐	Work		+2
4 More Options...			

Like Comment

[View 3 more comments](#)

Imagine having the exclusive benefit of a Q&A with Tim Ferriss because you're one of *The Hustle's* ambassadors. Benefits like this live stream encourage thousands of more people to become ambassadors.



To reiterate, they post new content every day. I've seen many people try to create ambassador programs, but give up after a couple of months - they can't continue providing value.

Can you?

Ask yourself:

"How do I provide value to keep my community engaged without burning out?"

There are several ways to do this.

1. Make other active members moderators or admins to encourage them to create great content.
2. Interview influencers, so you don't have to create original content.
3. Document your personal journey of failures and successes with tactics.
4. Congratulate your top members regularly.

Don't stop posting great content. As soon as you stop posting content, the group dies. As the community leader, it's up to you facilitate the relationships.

A startup's dream

Startup founders and marketers love ambassador programs because they require little-to-no engineering, have low setup costs and include streamlined tracking.

If you can pull it off, then you'll hit all the critical components of a startup's marketing dream: viral sharing, community building, word-of-mouth referrals, fan-generated content, and thought leadership.

You'll have an edge over every competitor in your space with an ever-growing, ever-multiplying community.

Think you have what it takes?





EVENTS



The Complete Guide to
Throwing Epic Events

Josh Fechter

114

The Complete Guide to Throwing Epic Events

Credit: [Josh Fechter](#), Co-Founder of [BAMF.Media](#)

Want all the templates I used to host over 150 events in two years?

Here you go:

Meetup Template

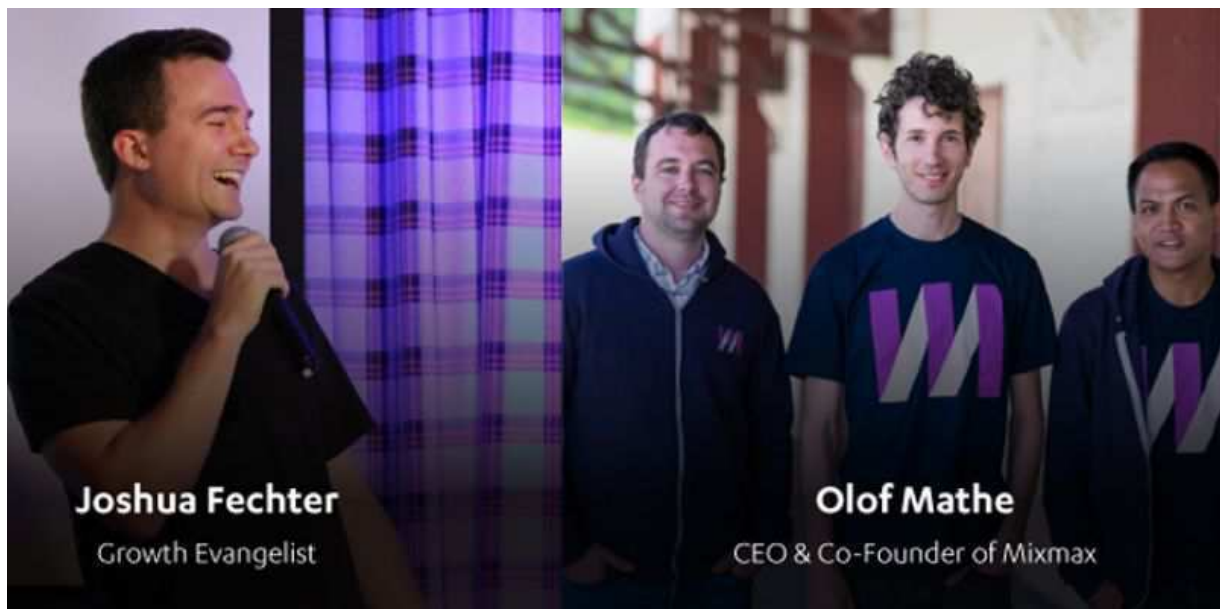
When creating a new Meetup event, please use this [event template](#):

I also copy and pasted it here in a [Google Doc](#).

Notice we how immediately link to the Eventbrite, focus on learning points, use a picture of the speaker and the host (done with the Google Slide in this folder), and promote our partners.

Eventbrite Template

Use a picture of you and the speaker as the header (you can make something like this in Google Slides):



"Join us for a fireside chat with Olof Mathe, CEO & Co-Founder of Mixmax

You'll learn:

1. How to include virality in your product
2. How to implement a growth framework for sustainable traction
3. How to scale a product's user base using engineering for marketing

Olof led the team that built Inkling Habitat, now adopted by the world's largest publishers. Prior, he worked at Skype and McKinsey. He organizes Art Hack Day and is now the CEO & founder of Mixmax.

Mixmax is the platform for all your external communications. Just like you use Slack to talk within your team, you use Mixmax to talk to people outside of your immediate team, in other organizations. sales, recruiting, marketing and ops teams use Mixmax to reach anyone, anywhere and rely on its automation, analytics and instant scheduling features to drive results."

Note: Sometimes you have to add the Google Developer Launchpad Space logo at the bottom or whatever company you're partnering with.

Promotional Email from Email Marketing Software (we use Autopilot)

(IMPORTANT: Send every Monday between 7 a.m. - 9 a.m.)

"Hey there

Who'd you like to see speak?

Just reply to this email, and I'll respond.

I'd love for you to join the fun at our next event at the Nasdaq Entrepreneurial Center:

"How JotForm Increased Revenue 50% Year over Year, for 3 Straight Years" with Leeyen Rogers

You'll learn how to:

- 1. Include virality in your product*
- 2. Implement a growth framework for sustainable traction*



3. Scale a product's user base using engineering for marketing

Leeyen Rogers is the VP of Marketing at JotForm. JotForm is a tool designed to build the most powerful and beautiful online forms with a drag-and-drop interface. It allows you to create forms and analyze their data without writing a single line of code.

You can register here for free: <http://growth.chat/jotformgrowthstory>

In case you can't make it, on May 17th, I'll be speaking at Google:

"How to Growth Hack 0 to 200,000 Followers in One Year"

I'll talk about how to acquire customers with zero marketing budget, tactics to gain over 200K followers in one year, and how to create an engaged online community.

You can register here: <http://growth.chat/growthhack200000>

Thank you in advance for coming :)

There will be refreshments.

See you soon.

Josh"

Promotional Email from Meetup

(IMPORTANT: Send Twice a Week between 7 a.m. - 9 a.m. and focus on one CTA)

Also, keep this email very concise :)

"Hey there

Hope you're having a great week.

We have an exciting startup event coming up with Mixmax at Google Developer Launchpad Space on the 19th:

"How Mixmax Got 5,000 Customers Without Spending a Penny on Marketing" with Olof Mathe
You'll learn:

- *How to include virality in your product*



- How to implement a growth framework for sustainable traction
- How to scale a product's user base using engineering for marketing

Register here for free: <http://growth.chat/mixmax5000>

There will be refreshments.

See you soon.

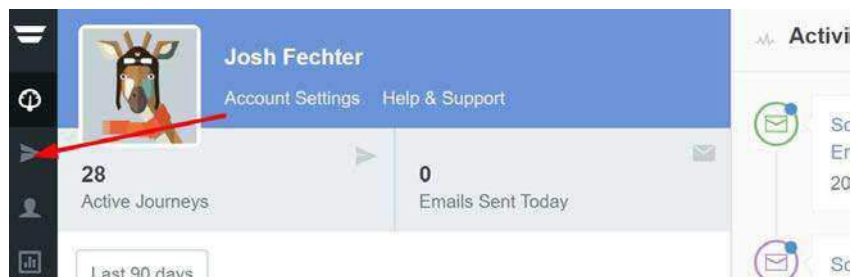
Josh”

Where to get Speaker Images

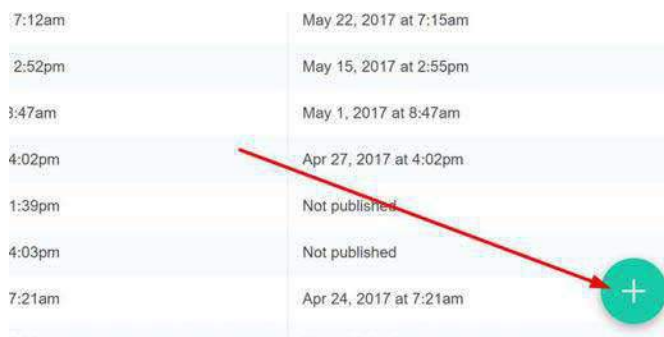
I find speaker images via Google Search, their Facebook profile, or LinkedIn profile. I don't ask for permission because they don't care.

How does [Autopilot](#) Work?

Next, click on Journeys:



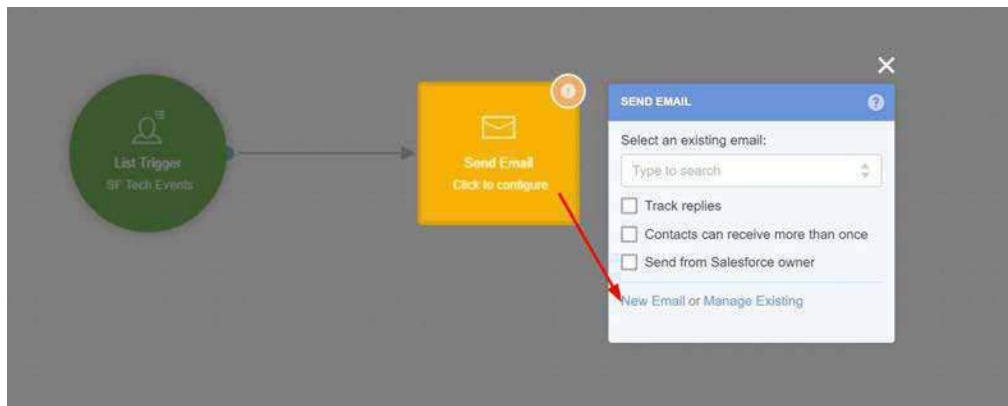
Now click on create New Journey:



Note: Always create a new journey for each email campaign



Drag these shapes onto the canvas. Under the "List Trigger" shape, select "SF Tech Events." Now, drag the arrow from the shape over to the "Send Email" shape. Now click "New Email."

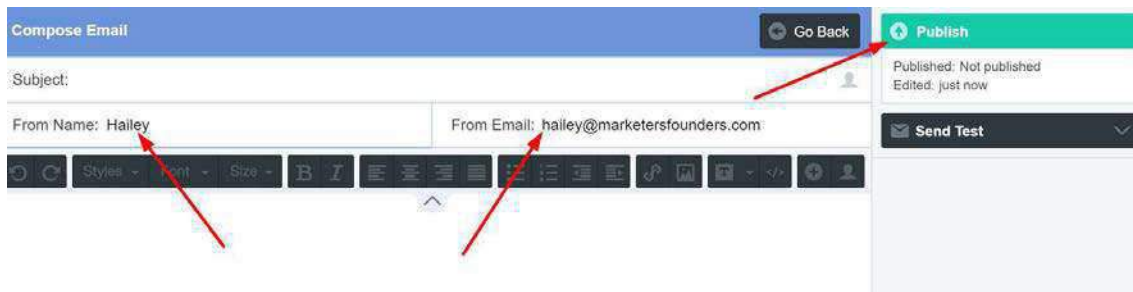


Please insert the title and date of the event into the email name.

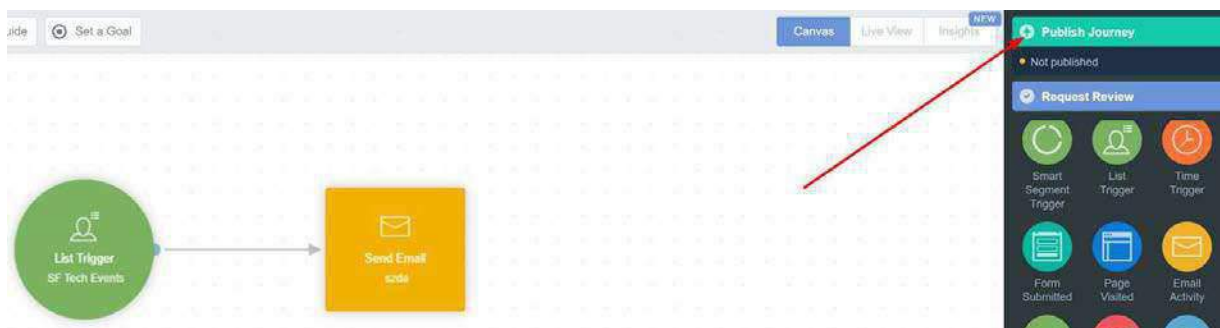
Then, you'll be prompted to design your email.

Note: Stay away from images because they kill your deliverability rate. Follow the email template above.

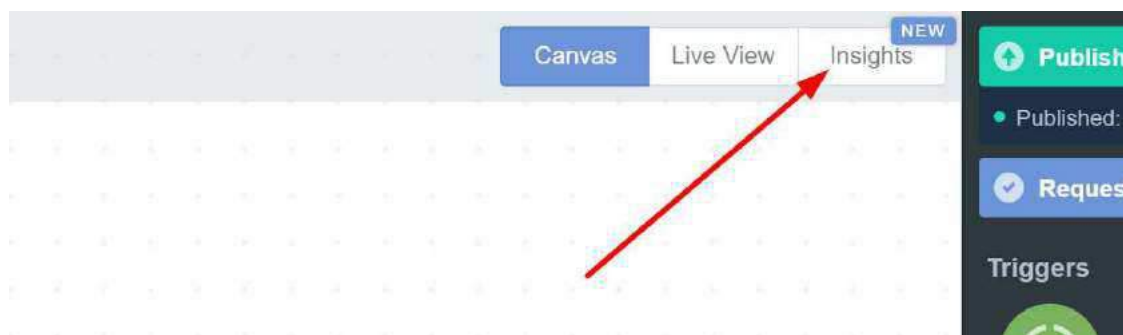
Make sure to put in your details, and when you finish designing the email, send a test email to yourself to check the links and format. Next, hit Publish.



From here, once you hit "Publish Journey," your emails will get sent.



To see data on your email performance, click insights:



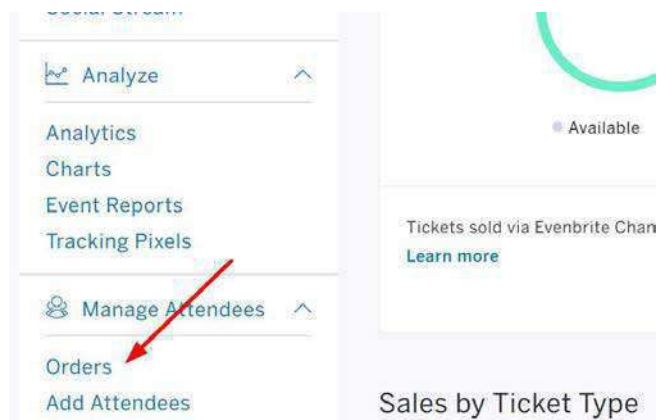
For subsequent campaigns, use new List Triggers and Send Email shapes; otherwise, your campaign will NOT get sent.

Importing Emails into Autopilot

Go to Eventbrite. Click on events, then you'll see a list of past events. Now, click on Manage.

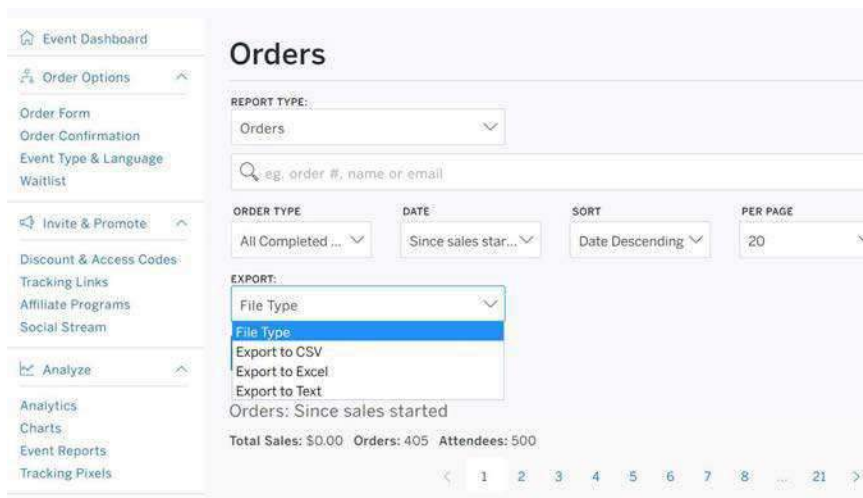


Click on Orders.



Now export the data into a CSV file.

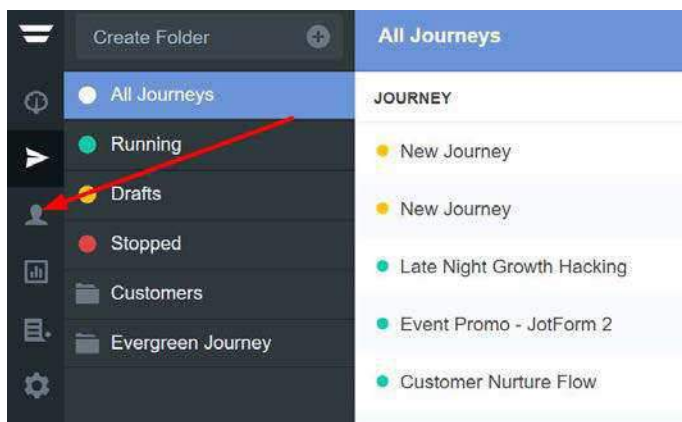




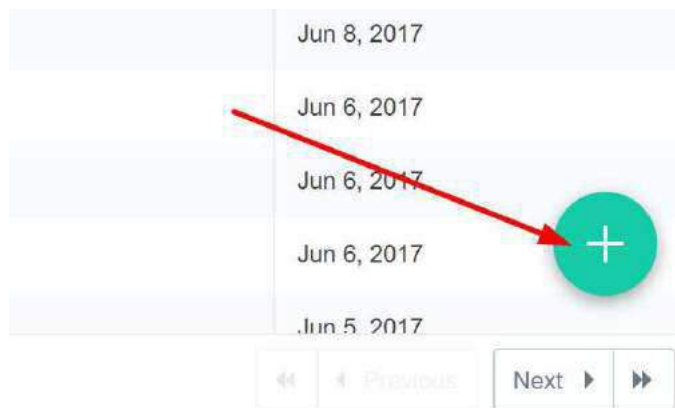
From here, dive into the spreadsheet and delete all the rows except for email and name.

Now, upload this sheet of emails into Autopilot:

Step 1: Click on Contacts

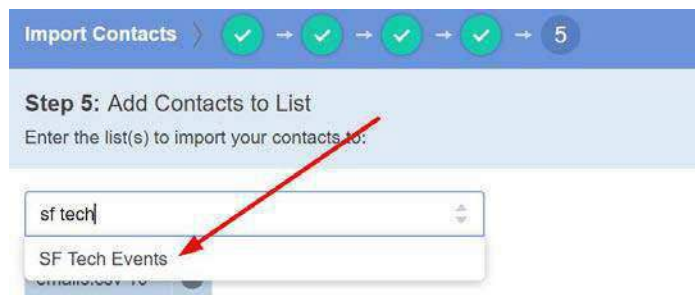


Step 2: Click the import plus button



Step 3: Select the right list you're adding them to - "SF Tech Events"

Step 4: Remove the other list



Tools to Find Emails of Potential Speakers

Chrome extension that works on Gmail: [Clearbit](#)

Chrome extension that works on LinkedIn: [Contactout](#)

Both are very straightforward to use.

Cold Email Templates & Tools for Landing Speakers

I use [Mixmax](#) or [Mailshake](#) for sending cold emails out at scale.



Here's the email sequence I use to land speakers:

Email 1:

Subject: Speaking opportunity

"Hey {{First Name}},

I love the work you've done for {{Company}}.

I happen to run one of the largest marketers and founders communities in Silicon Valley (3000+ members) and an active 13000+ member [Facebook Group](#).

As a growth evangelist who hosts close to seventy events a year ranging in attendance from 100 - 400 people, I'm always looking for knowledgeable speakers and people crushing it in tech such as yourself.

I think you'd make a perfect fit.

Here's an example of one of our previous speaking events:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t4gYdeVpGIU>

Do you have fifteen minutes free in the next week to talk about a speaking opportunity?

Looking forward to hearing back from you.

Cheers,"

Email 2:

No subject: Email reply

Hey {{First Name}},

I just wanted to ensure you saw this email from the other day.

I love the work you've done for {{Company}}.

I happen to run one of the largest marketers and founders communities in Silicon Valley (3000+ members) and an active 13000+ member [Facebook Group](#).



As a growth evangelist who hosts close to seventy events a year ranging in attendance from 200 - 700 people, I'm always looking for knowledgeable speakers. I think you'd make a perfect fit.

Here's an example of one of our previous speaking events:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t4gYdeVpGIU>

Do you have fifteen minutes free in the next week to talk about a speaking opportunity?

Excited to talk about the opportunity.

Cheers,"

Email 3:

No subject: Email reply

"Hey {{First Name}},

Following up on my previous two emails.

I'm wondering if you'd be interested in an interview in front of a couple of hundred people in San Francisco. It will be epic! :)

I run one of the largest marketers and founders communities in Silicon Valley (3000+ members) and an active 13000+ member Facebook Group.

In case you missed it, here's an example of one of our previous speaking events:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t4gYdeVpGIU>

Do you have fifteen minutes free in the next week to talk about a speaking opportunity?

Talk soon.

Cheers,"

Sponsorships (adding attendee emails to your partner's list):

Step 1: Add emails to another company's list without it feeling like spam.



1st email (sent one day after the event from the partnership company):

Subject line: [Video Recording] [name of event; e.g. "How JotForm Increased Revenue 50% YoY"]

"Hey sara!

Thank you for registering to see JotForm's VP of Marketing, Leeyen Rogers, talk about implementing a framework for sustainable growth and increasing revenue for the company 50% year over year, for 3 straight years.

[Here's the video recording](#) in case you missed it or would like to tune into the replay:



*Hope to see you at our next event soon!
Anne"*

2nd email (three days later from the company):

Subject line: Did you miss this one?

"Hey there!

Many people sign up for BAMF's events to learn from the most influential people in tech. But we understand not everyone can make it.

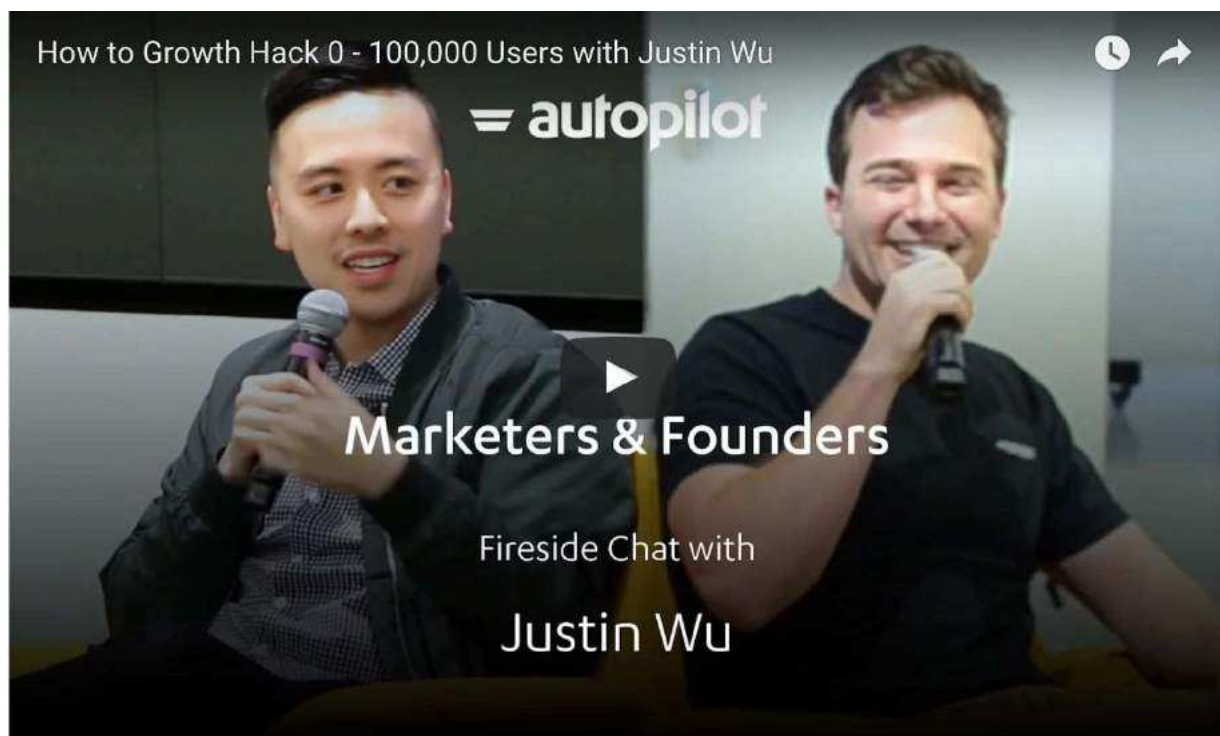


That's why we have an entire video library from our previous talks, hosted in Flight School. [You can watch them here.](#)

If you want to skip to our most well-renowned talk, then here's our interview with Justin Wu, LA growth hacker and founder of Growth.ly.

You'll learn how to growth hack Snapchat, Instagram, and Facebook. And he'll teach you the framework he used to grow companies to \$1m ARR in their first year

Watch here: "[How to Growth Hack 0 – 100,000 Users with Justin Wu](#)"



Let me know which talk you like the best.

And I'd love to get feedback on how we can improve.

See you soon!

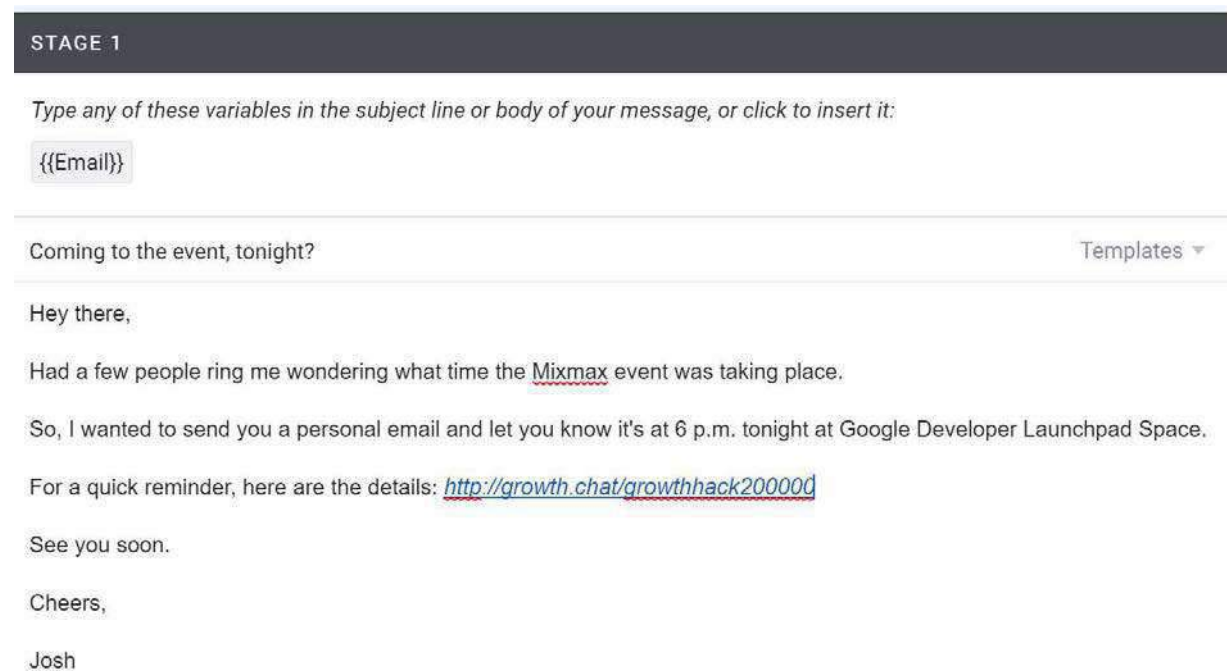
Anne"



After the 2nd email, they receive the partnership company's regular email drip campaign

Increase Your Attendance Rate by 20%+:

On the morning of the event, I send out an email like this one (picture below) from Mixmax to all the registrants to ensure they arrive. Mixmax results in 90%+ of these emails landing in the recipient's primary inbox.



This personal email makes a world of difference.

Don't forget it.

On the morning of the event, I send out an email like this one (picture below) from Mixmax to all the registrants to ensure they arrive. Mixmax results in 90%+ of these emails landing in the recipient's primary inbox.

STAGE 1

Type any of these variables in the subject line or body of your message, or click to insert it:

{{Email}}

Coming to the event, tonight?

Templates ▾

Hey there,

Had a few people ring me wondering what time the Mixmax event was taking place.

So, I wanted to send you a personal email and let you know it's at 6 p.m. tonight at Google Developer Launchpad Space.

For a quick reminder, here are the details: <http://growth.chat/growthhack200000>

See you soon.

Cheers,

Josh

This personal email makes a world of difference.

Don't forget it.

Increase Your Attendance Rate by **Another 20%+**:

"Two weeks ago, I RSVP'd to an interesting event that I saw on my news feed.

After a few hours, I got a personal message from [Michael Kilcoyne](#), the host of the event.

The message was a video of him personally thanking me for RSVP'ing and encouraging me to invite tons of friends.

He filmed it on his iPhone while walking down the street. It took him 15 seconds to film and send it to me.

I've never gotten a message like this before, especially from someone I've never met in person.

But I immediately was psyched that Michael went out of his way to reach out personally.

I was also impressed that he put this much effort and care into his event.

Now I know at least one person who will be at the event and have a personal connection to the host.

Easy conversation starter.



Today I started doing the same thing with people who were engaging with my startup's blog posts.

I messaged them each a 15-second video thanking them for engaging with our content and offering a personal coupon code to check out our product.

90% of the people that I reached out to responded within a few hours, thanked me for the kind offer, and not only joined our newsletter, but also signed up for the free trial.

People love a personal connection to the founders, especially when you can stand out from all of the noise and allow them to get a taste of your personality." -Jake Hurwitz, Founder & CEO at Eyesight Collective

How to Throw Epic Events on a Budget

If you want to throw epic events you need money. Here's the budget outline we work with:

https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/1i3LciCb_7pNXjXXzj6P_YwTFruuhnILvwLrrh76ghss/edit?usp=sharing

A	B	C	D	E
Joshua Fechter	Revenue		Expenses	
Sponsorships	Amount		Item	Amount
1	\$8,000		Venue Cost	20000
2	\$8,000		Performers	20000
3	\$8,000		Time	20000
4	\$8,000			
5	\$8,000			
6	\$8,000			
7	\$8,000			
Total	\$56,000			
Ticket Sales	\$37,594.09			
Total	\$93,594.09			
cogs	64.11%			
Profit	\$33,594.09			

What's Next?

Throwing events is not easy.

It takes time and rapid-fire content production.

Ready?

Let's go.





LINKEDIN

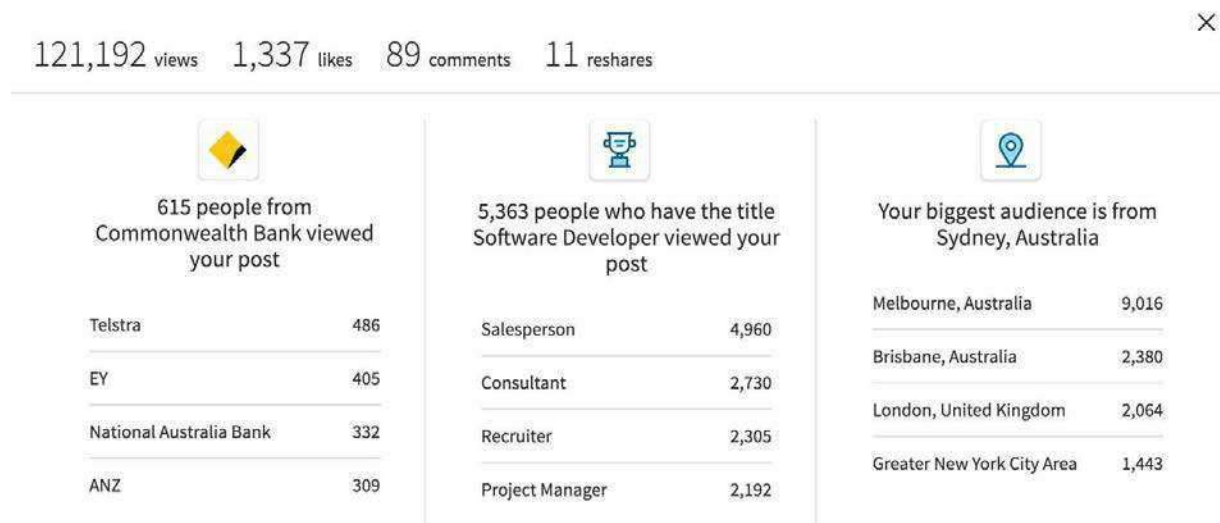


Unlimited "InMails" - LinkedIn "Hack"	Vaibhav Namburi	131
The Growth Hacker's Guide to LinkedIn Content Marketing	Josh Fechter	136
The Anatomy of a Viral LinkedIn Post	Josh Fechter	151

Unlimited “InMails” — LinkedIn “Hack”

Credit: [Vaibhav Namburi](#), Director of Five2One

Little history, I’ve been a huge fan of LinkedIn, and use the platform heavily, recently had a article of mine cross 120,000 views and growing :



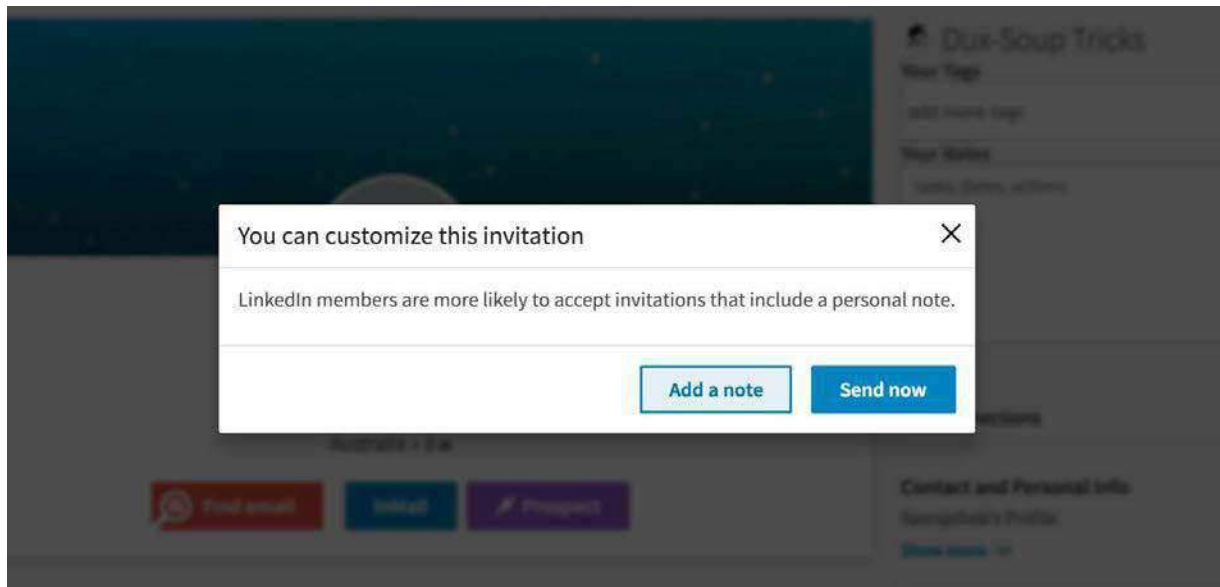
And I feel like i’m slowly getting what it’s all about. Every big influencer says it, stay consistent and it will eventually happen! The above article was my “win” after posting for 2 years straight almost every single day!

What is this “growth hack” — okay, we know inMail, we know that it’s limited — 40 per month if you’re business. What if you need to send more but can’t afford ridiculous LinkedIn prices?

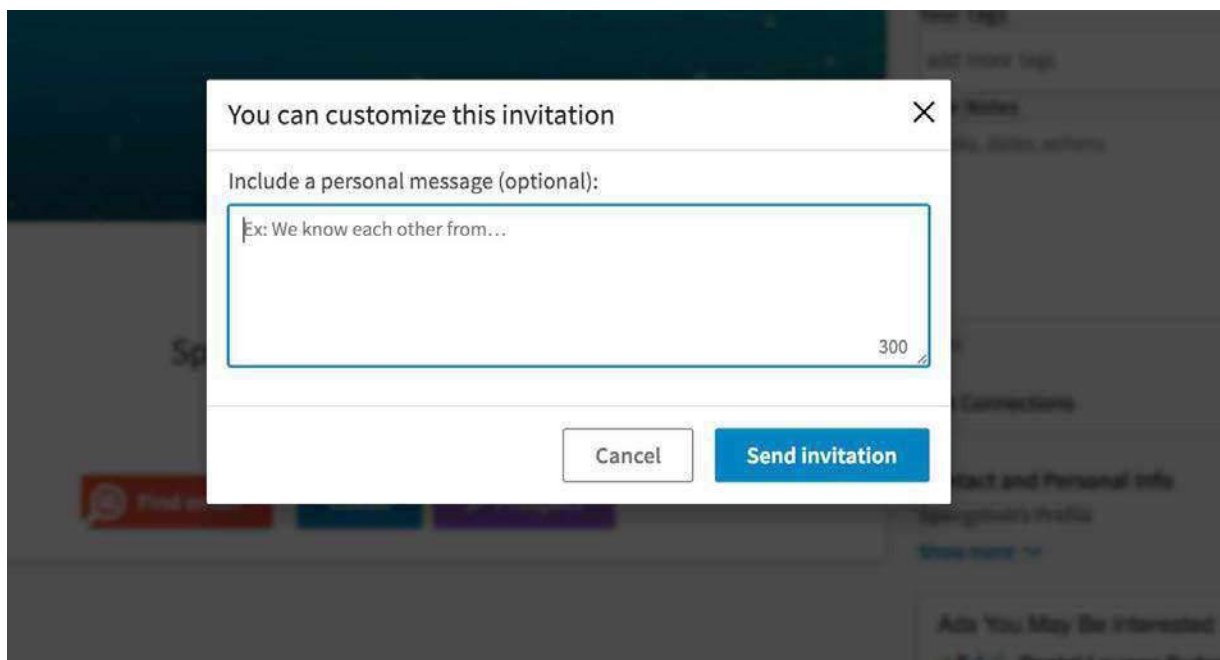
Here’s how:

Go to the person you want to send a message. Click on the “Add a note” button that shows up.



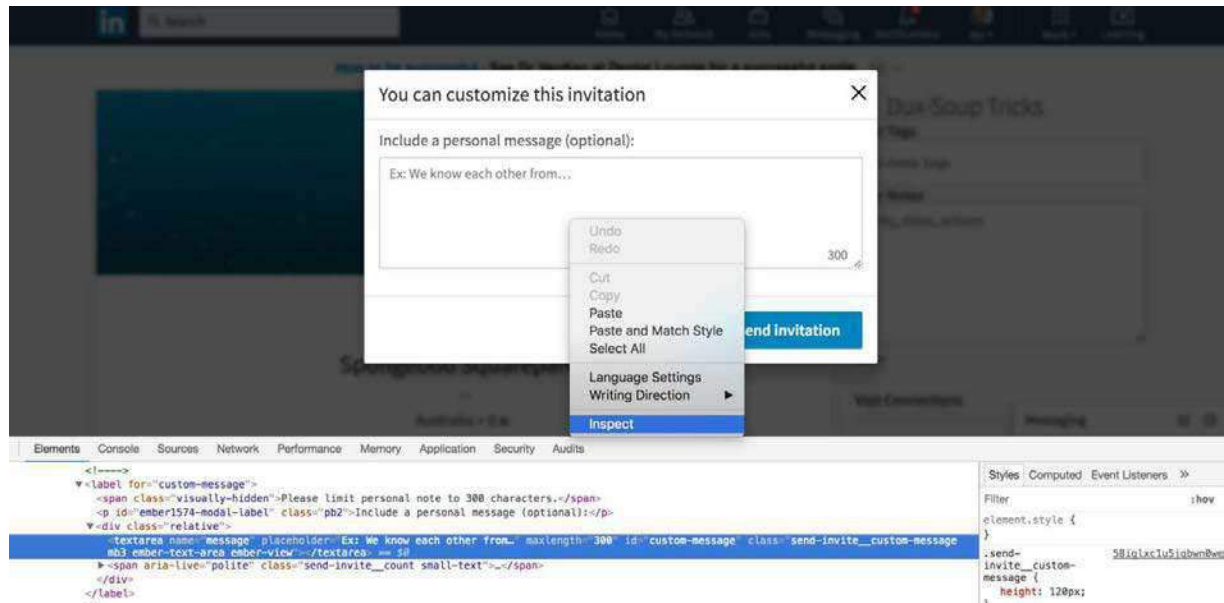


This is where the magic begins:

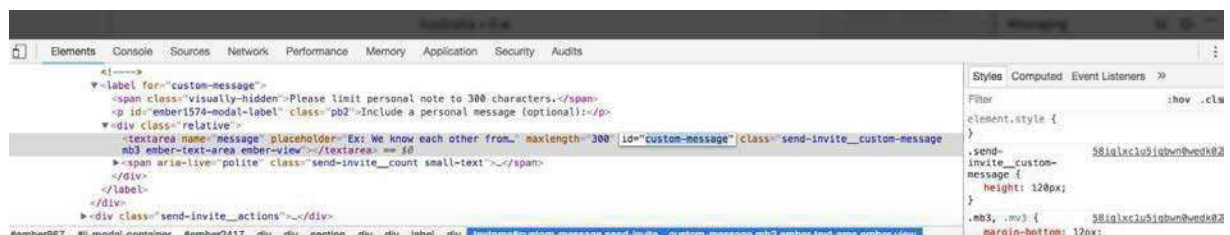


Go ahead and add a note or whatever text you'd like, you quickly realize the 300 characters are not enough.

To bypass, right click on the input box, click inspect element and it opens up the console.

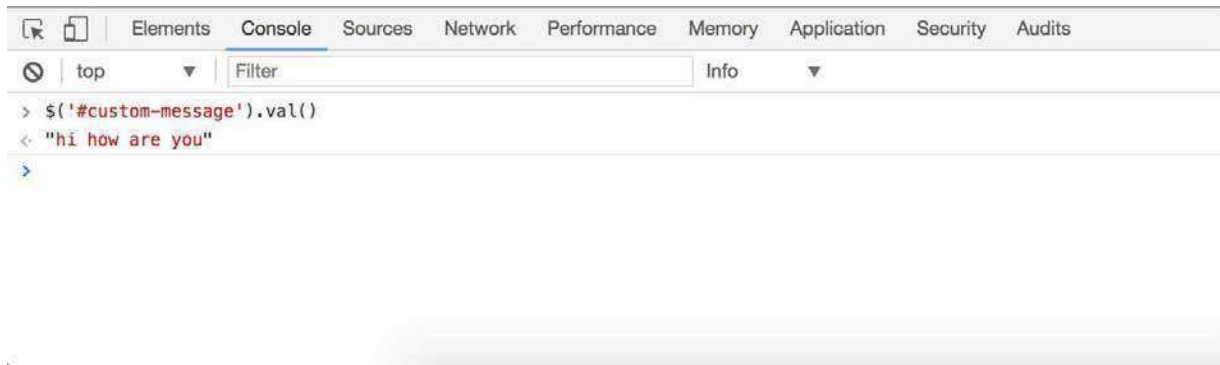


Target the ID of the text field:



In this case it was "custom-message" (they might change this in the future).

LinkedIn's front end uses jQuery, so we can easily work with selectors like IDs and classes.



By using the “#” symbol with the id name and finding the value, you can see what you type in the input box — i typed in “hi how are you”

Now the message if the message is more than 300 characters long how do you include it.

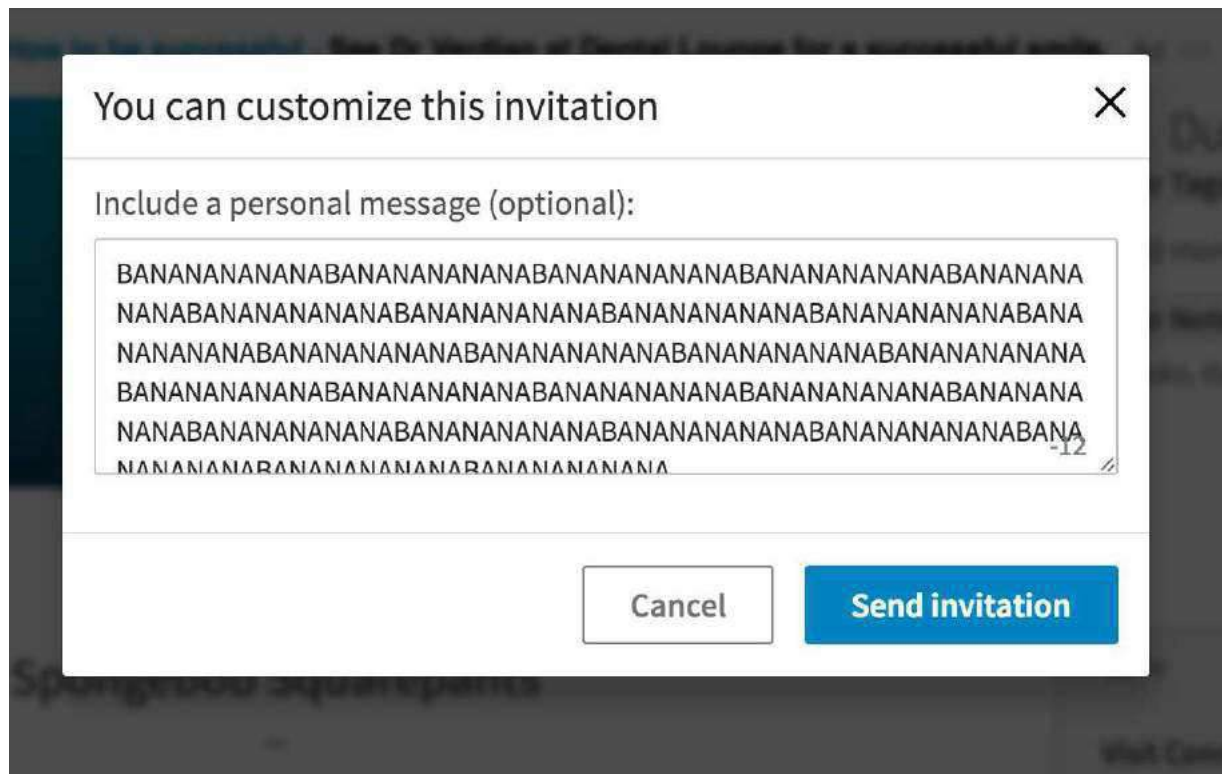
Simple:



Invoke this function:

```
$('custom-message').val('my 1000 character long text')
```

The second you type that in your console and click enter, you'll see the text update in your input box as well most likely see a negative count on your character count



See the -12 here.

Click Send invitation and you have access to send however long messages to whoever you want, and since connections are free, you're bypassing inMail restrictions.

The Growth Hacker's Guide to LinkedIn Content Marketing

Credit: [Josh Fechter](#), Co-Founder of [BAMF.Media](#)

I almost gave up on LinkedIn.

"It's a dying platform."

"Work is getting more social; LinkedIn isn't."

Then, I noticed a few people driving an insane number of leads and opportunities from LinkedIn.

They didn't use LinkedIn like the majority of users.

They were the one percent who understood how to growth hack it with tactics.

So, I studied these top, young thought leaders on LinkedIn: Marketing Manager at Grade A, [Michaela Alexis](#); and Director of Growth for Engagio, [Brandon Redlinger](#).

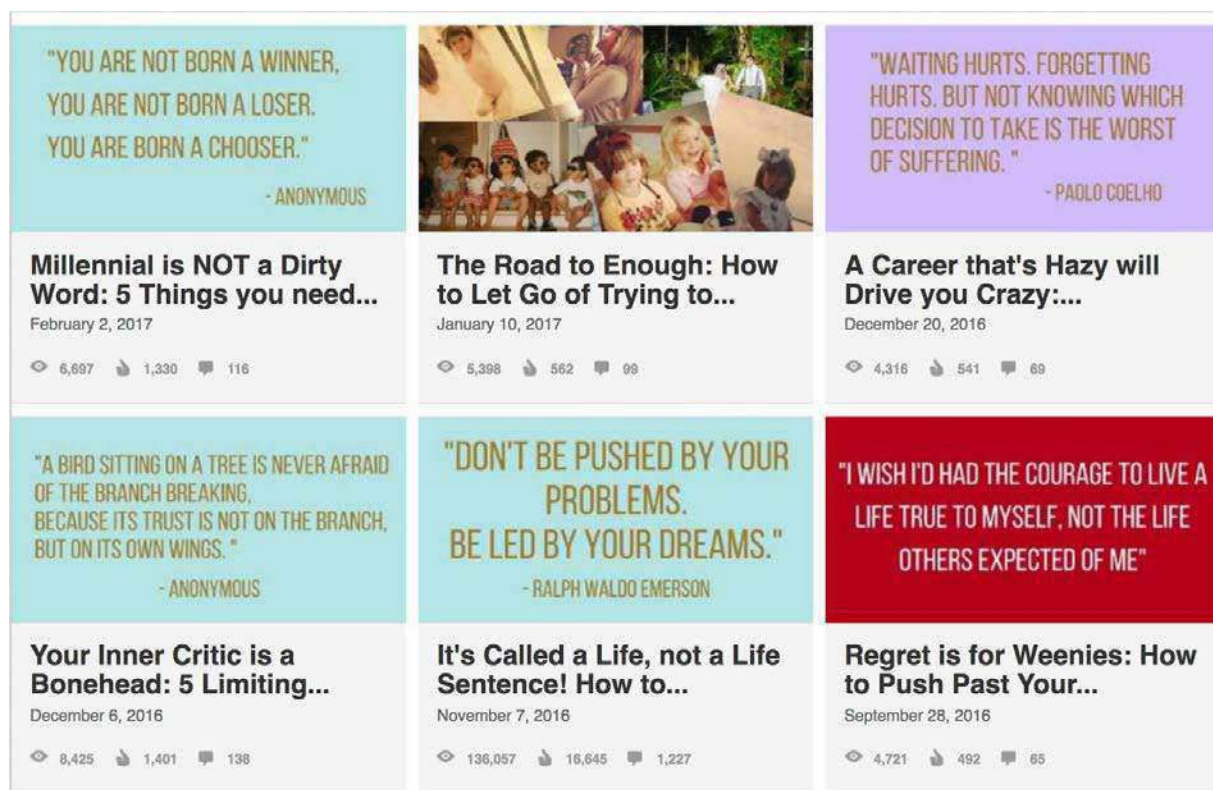
In this guide, I document many of their strategies while adding a few of my growth hacks.

Each person, including myself, has their strengths when it comes to mastering LinkedIn. When combined, you can become an unstoppable powerhouse, especially for B2B marketing.

Let's dive into each person's tactics:

Michaela Alexis writes many of the most engaging articles on LinkedIn. This has led to her receiving many podcast, speaking, and job opportunities. Here's a look at the engagement on her most recent posts:





What makes her LinkedIn articles different?

Michaela Alexis told me,

"LinkedIn is a unique community. You can't just write. Yes, you may end up with some home runs, but you have to spend about 20% of your time writing, and the other 80% engaging and sharing updates. People need to see you actually growing to believe that you know what you're talking about or listen to what you have to say. Trust me, there are far better writers than me, but they aren't spending as much time as me building relationships.

In terms of format, I never write anything that will take longer than 5 mins to read. Always assume people are consuming content on a quick coffee break. I follow the same format, always. First part is a personal story. Second is the result. Third is how that result can be replicated.

I literally respond to as many comments as humanly possible. I answer as many messages as possible, but it's grown so much that I'm bringing on interns to categorize my messages. I know Gary Vee is all about personally replying, and I agree with him. I also share my articles on Medium, and have had a few picked up by publications that way."



Michaela did leave out that she uses images of inspirational quotes for almost all her LinkedIn article cover photos. These perform well, especially when paired with personal photos in the article.

One key takeaway: Michaela engages many of her connections to ensure they interact with her content. She does this by liking their photos, commenting, and endorsing others.

This sounds time-consuming. However, if you use LinkedIn automation tools, including Dux Soup, GPZ LinkedIn Tools, or Linked Helper, you can interact with many of your LinkedIn connections at scale in an automated way without them knowing.

You can use [Dux Soup](#) (\$15/month) to begin auto-viewing profiles. The paid version has support for Sales Navigator and Recruiter, enables you to download visited profile-data as a CSV, re-visit based on previously downloaded CSV, have unlimited visits/day and tagging.

When you download Dux Soup, click on options to configure your settings as seen below:



Automation Rules

- ☐ Automatically endorse skill(s) of a profile when visiting (Pro only).
- ☐ Automatically expand the 'Contact' tab when visiting a profile
- ☐ Autotag profiles as "" when auto-visiting.

Skipping Rules

- Number of days before revisiting. (0 to 31)
- ☒ Skip visit when the photo is blank.

Display Options

- Show Notifications: ☒ Info | ☒ Action | ☒ Warning
- Display in Dux-Soup Badge.

Download Options

- ☐ Include Excel CSV hint (tells MS Excel we're using a ',' as column separator)
- Character Encoding : (use ANSI for MS Excel, otherwise use UTF-8)

Visiting Speed (Pro only)

- Random : between 50 and 150 per hour
- Pause for minutes (0 to 60) after every visits (1 to 100)

Limit Daily Visits (Pro only)

WARNING! Changing this setting to a higher level than your LinkedIn subscription could lead to LinkedIn blocking your account due to excessive profile visiting. Handle with care!

Check to confirm you understand the risk! ☐

Detect :

When you have your desired settings in place, then use your LinkedIn Sales Navigator or Recruiter to conduct a search query to begin auto viewing profiles.



people and companies...

T MANAGEMENT
INBOX

1.1M Total results	44.2K Changed jobs in past 90 days	995 Mentioned in past 30 days
------------------------------	--	---

Selected filters (1): Marketing Manager

Stella wu · 1st | **Wish - Shopping Made Fun!**

Growth **Marketing Manager**

7 months in role | 1 year 7 months at company

San Francisco Bay Area

[Shared Connections \(20\)](#) | [Related Leads](#)

Steve Gough · 1st | **NerdWallet**

Digital **Marketing Sr. Manager**

2 years in role and company

San Francisco Bay Area

[Shared Connections \(19\)](#) | [Related Leads](#)

Matthew Sadofsky · 1st | **Tilting Point**

Senior **Manager, Growth Marketing**

6 months in role and company

Greater New York City Area

[Shared Connections \(4\)](#) | [Related Leads](#)

0 captured profiles

0 visits today

VISIT PROFILES	Visit profiles in the current result page, records their details too (*).
SCAN PROFILES	Record profiles without visiting.
STOP ROBOT	Stop the ongoing automated action.
DOWNLOAD DATA	Download the captured profiles.
REVISIT DATA	Upload a file for revisiting.
SEARCH BY TAG	Find previously tagged profiles.
CLEAR DATA	Reset the recorder. <i>(does not affect visit history)</i>

*: only available when the Dux icon colours green, indicating that the browser is displaying a People-search result. Hit Stop Robot to stop the automated action.

[options](#) | [about](#) | v5.3.26

0 visits today

T MANAGEMENT **INBOX**

1.1M Total results	44.2K Changed jobs in past 90 days	995 Mentioned in past 30 days
------------------------------	--	---

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Shared Connections (20) Related Leads



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Digital Marketing Sr. Manager
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Shared Connections (19) Related Leads



Matthew Sadofsky · 1st | Tilting Point

Senior Manager, Growth Marketing
6 months in role and company
Greater New York City Area

Shared Connections (4) Related Leads

VISIT PROFILES

Visit profiles in the current result page, records their details too (*).

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Record profiles without visiting.

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Stop the ongoing automated action.

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Download the captured profiles.

REVISIT DATA

Upload a file for revisiting.

SEARCH BY TAG

Find previously tagged profiles.

CLEAR DATA

Reset the recorder.
(does not affect visit history)

**: only available when the Dux icon colours green, indicating that the browser is displaying a People-search result. Hit Stop Robot to stop the automated action.*

If you want to capitalize on more of your existing network with messaging while expanding your network in a highly targeted way, then you'll get better results with [GPZ LinkedIn Tools](#). GPZ LinkedIn Tools is for automated message sending, auto connecting, and auto viewing. The interface is intuitive enabling you to set up a campaign within minutes. In this example, we use the Auto Message Sender campaign.

Campaign Builder

Auto Message Sender (1st connections)

Campaign

LinkedIn People Search (1st Connection)

[Open people search page](#)

https://www.linkedin.com/sales/search?titleScope=CURRENT&jobTitleEntiti

Message

AddEditDelete

Messages sent per day

0

Save Campaign

From here, we configure the New Connection Messenger feature to send messages to specific people based on the URL corresponding to an Advanced People Search.

Campaign Builder

Search URL

Message

Create Message

Invite to community

Are you in my community?

Hey [First_Name]

I was wondering if you're in my Facebook Group of 7,000+ marketers and founders? We have over 2K+ members from San Francisco. If you're not, I can send you an invite. Let me know. Cheers!

Cut and paste this tag: [FIRST_NAME] above & SocialSidekick will place each persons first name into your script.

Cancel Add/Update

Now, you can send hundreds of messages every day to people in your network. This is a great way to give value to your LinkedIn connections at scale.

Here's an example message you could send out to build rapport with your connections:

"[first name],

I want to reach out because we're connected, and I noticed you work in [i.e. growth marketing] in [i.e. San Francisco]. I wrote this LinkedIn article on how [X people in X industry] can use LinkedIn to expand their network and get leads.

Let me know if this is something you're interested in and I'll send you a few secrets I left out of the post :)

Thank you for reading.

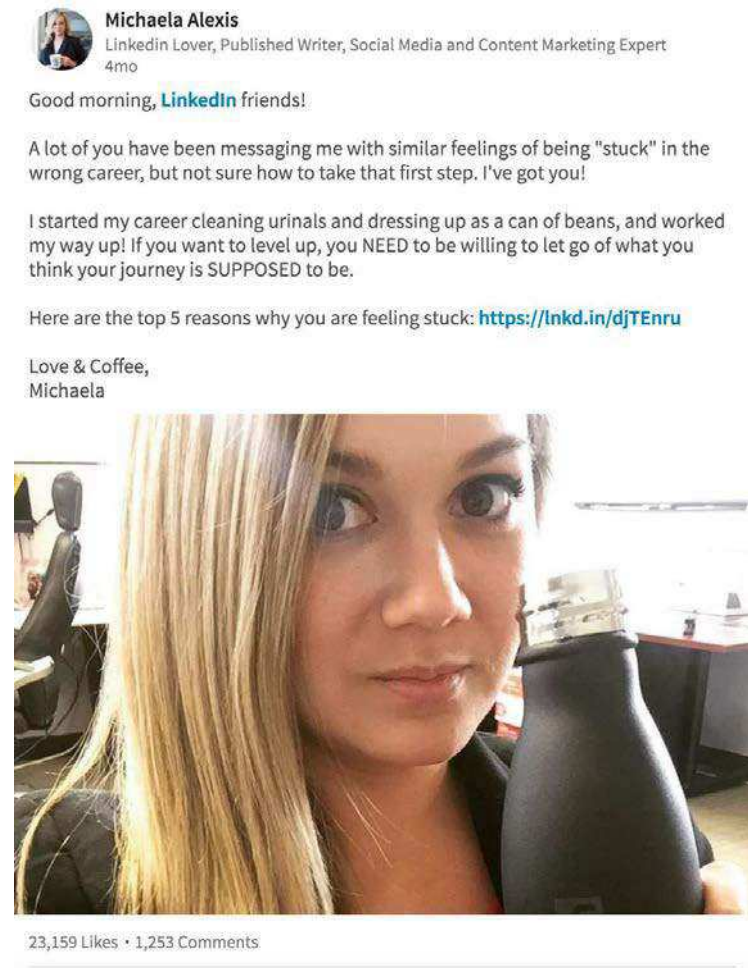
-Josh"

Once you're auto engaging with your audience at scale, start deploying published articles and status updates.

How do you perfect a status update?



Michaela focuses on turning her “work wins” into content. She adds a little flavor to each status by adding a short personal story and a picture of her to build more rapport and capture attention. Notice how in this status update she links to a LinkedIn article she’s written and signs off in a professional way. She also keeps her paragraphs to one or two sentences, so people can easily read them on mobile.



Below is another work win she posted. If you examine closely, you’ll see she writes with the hero’s journey in mind. In her first post, it’s about how she leveled-up from cleaning urinals. In her second post, it’s about how she conquered her fear of public speaking.



Michaela Alexis

LinkedIn Lover, Published Writer, Social Media and Content Marketing Expert
3w

Good morning, [LinkedIn](#) friends!

I felt SO confident last night. I had my notes all prepared and I put on my favourite black suit. And then, I walked into the room and started freezing up.

I suddenly realized that there were hundreds of people in the room. I remembered that I had never used a mic before. I seriously considered sneaking out behind that velour curtain and racing back to my car.

This photo is the moment I told hundreds of strangers about being laid off around this time last year, and how I overcame it. I'm anything but fearless, but I keep pushing forward anyway. THIS, in one photo, is the secret to true happiness.

Love & coffee,
Michaela



1,128 Likes • 106 Comments

Five key takeaways:

1. Use personal pictures
2. Make it mobile friendly
3. Tell a hero's story
4. Focus on a work win
5. Use a professional sign off



You don't always have to focus on work wins. A few entrepreneurs focus more on controversy and intelligent discussion to get big hitters in their industry involved.

Brandon Redlinger does this exceptionally well. He'll start every status update with a hard-hitting line to generate controversy. In the picture below, he uses "Dear sales-spammers." Now that's a good one. He'll then tag the relevant thought leaders in the industry, so they respond and generate more buzz around his article.

Before he tags a thought leader, he first messages them on LinkedIn about their opinion on the subject matter. This way they don't feel like Brandon's tagging them for self-promotion.

Notice Brandon's use of caps when writing statuses to get his audience's attention. A post status like this one will stay at the top of my news feed for an entire week, and if I already engaged with it via a Like or Comment, then I'll be alerted every time someone else comments on it.

Brandon Redlinger replied to Daniel Barnett's comment on this



Brandon Redlinger
Director of Growth at Engagio
1w · Edited

Dear sales-spammers – I can see your automated "personal email" from a mile away. Just because you use my name and company, doesn't mean it's personalized or, more importantly, RELEVANT. Customization is NOT personalization. And don't just say you did some research on me – SHOW me that you did.
Anyone else getting tired of the sales spam? What does it take to get your attention in a cold email?

Thoughts [Steli Efti](#), [John Barrows](#), [Kevin Gaither](#), [Gerhard Gschwandtner](#), [Andrea Austin](#), [Jake Dunlap](#), [Ben Daters](#), [Lena Shaw](#), [Ray Carroll](#)?

369 Likes · 63 Comments

 Like  Comment  Share

Show previous comments



Daniel Barnett This is also a tactic that is pushed by vendors that we know and love well. Its a numbers game and it breaks me everytime s ...see more
Like Reply | 1 Like · 1 Reply



Brandon Redlinger Yes, 100%!!!
Like Reply



Add a comment...

Here's another example of how Brandon uses this tactic. He starts off with a strong emotional statement, then proceeds to back it up with evidence. Next, he tags relevant thought leaders to get their opinion. And again, he gets a huge amount of engagement.

Brandon Redlinger replied to Gareth Rice-Adams 's comment on this ...

**Brandon Redlinger**
Director of Growth at Engagio
2w · Edited

Cold calling is not dead – in fact, it's alive and well. Everyone is always within 6 feet of their phones. More people have access to phones in the world than indoor plumbing. The people who write articles on how cold calling is dead are the ones who are afraid of cold calling. What do you do to pump yourself up for a power hour on the phones?

Thoughts [Aaron Ross](#), [Art Sobczak](#), [Jeb Blount](#), [Chris Orlob](#), [Jill Konrath](#), [Keith Rosen](#), [Sam Richter](#), [Kendra Lee](#)?

237 Likes · 31 Comments

 Like  Comment  Share

Show previous comments

**Gareth Rice-Adams** I have to say its refreshing to see others with this point of view! every post I see on LinkedIn is either a recruitment post ...see more
1w ...
Like Reply | 6 Likes · 1 Reply

**Brandon Redlinger** There is indeed a lot of noise, and it's great to see that people are having genuine conversation. Somet ...see more
3d ...
Like Reply | 1 Like

 Add a comment...

Similar to Michaela, Brandon engages with every comment on his posts. This helps him build rapport with his most engaged audience.

To further build rapport with industry leaders and awareness for his company, Engagio, Brandon does write-ups that tag them in appreciation.

Smart move.

While Michaela has found a way to hit a wide audience over and over again, Brandon has streamlined the process for dominating a niche industry with LinkedIn content.

Now to answer the most common question when it comes to LinkedIn marketing: *How many times should you be posting?*

Post every day on LinkedIn if you're looking to get your audience's attention. More specifically, I'd aim for a status every day and one published article every week. If you have the bandwidth, then level up to two published articles every week. Make sure to apply content creation and distribution tactics Michaela and Brandon use. These will help ensure you get traction for your content.

What happens when you add in a few growth hacks?

If you want to take full advantage of your LinkedIn profile, then you'll need to combine it with the power of Facebook Ads.

Here's how to do this:

1) Go to Settings & Privacy to download your LinkedIn Contacts into a CSV.



Getting an archive of your data

Close

Download an archive of your account data, posts, connections, and more

Your LinkedIn data belongs to you, and you can download an archive any time.

We provide your archive in two bundles: "fast file", which includes selected categories of account data, like your profile information, connections, and messages (ready in approximately 10 minutes), and a second bundle that includes your detailed account information, including account activity and history (ready in 24 hours). You can learn more by [visiting our Help Center](#).

Choose the format you prefer.

- ☒ **Fast file only:** This file includes connections, contacts, recommendations, messages, and profile information such as experience, education, and projects. You'll receive a link to download.
- ☐ **Fast file plus other data:** You'll receive the data in two bundles over approximately 24 hours.

[Request archive](#)

2) Upload your LinkedIn Contacts' emails as a Custom Audience into Facebook Ads Manager.

The screenshot shows the Facebook Ads Manager interface. On the left, there is a table of existing audiences. On the right, a modal window titled 'Create a Custom Audience' is open. The modal asks 'How do you want to add customers to this audience?' and provides two options: 'Choose a file or copy and paste data' and 'Import from MailChimp'. A red arrow points to the 'Choose a file or copy and paste data' option.

Name	Type
People who Opted-In For Tech Events	Custom Audience
Autopilot Email List (1)	Custom Audience
Vincent Dignan, Jack Smith & Sam Parr Eventbrite	Custom Audience
San Francisco Event Attendees	Saved Audience
Quora Leads	Saved Audience
Gimme Growth	Custom Audience
autopilot event list	Custom Audience
Facebook Live Stream eBook Retargeting	Custom Audience
All Three eBooks (Venture, Instagram, Crowdfunding)	Custom Audience

Create a Custom Audience

How do you want to add customers to this audience?

You can use your own file to upload one or more kinds of customer information, or import email addresses directly from MailChimp.

Choose a file or copy and paste data
Use your customers' information to match them with people on Facebook.

Import from MailChimp
Import email addresses directly from this third-party connection by providing your login credentials.

[Back](#)

3) Stay in front of your LinkedIn connections 24/7 with Facebook advertising

If you want more engagement on your content, then run educational, inspirational, and entertaining video ads to this audience. By running video ads, your target market will have a stronger, emotional touch point with you.

As a result, when you publish LinkedIn articles you'll receive more engagement because people will have established a *better know, like, and trust factor* with your personal brand.

 **Autopilot**
Sponsored · 

Watch [Josh Fechter](#), growth evangelist for Autopilot, interview [Jake Kuczeruk](#), VP of business development at West Agile Labs about product/market fit and getting traction for startups.



Interview with Jake Kuczeruk | Marketers & Founders

AUTOPILOTHQ.COM [Learn More](#)

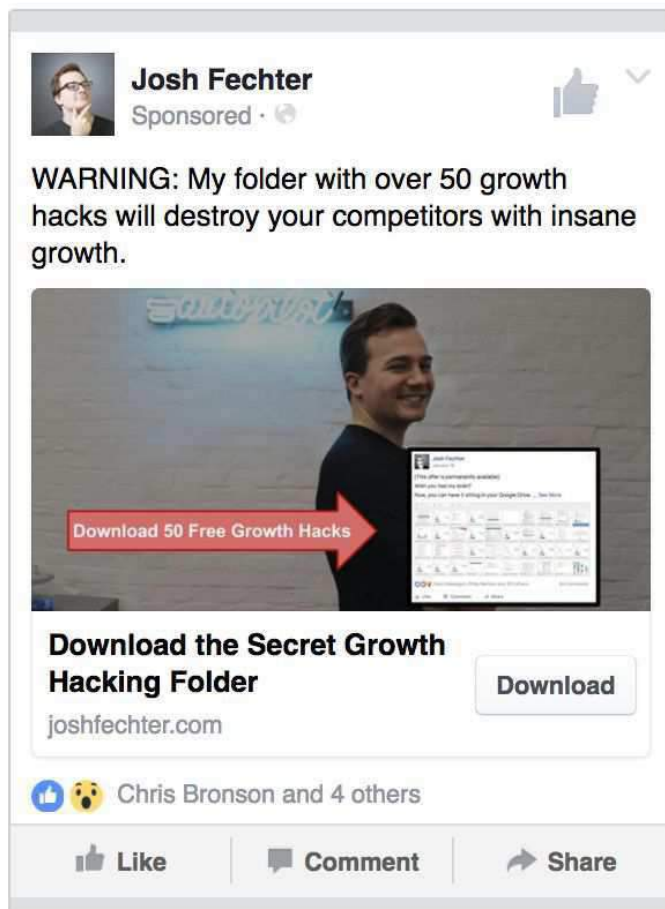
21 Likes 2 Comments 3 Shares

 Like  Comment  Share

4. Run ads to a landing page

Once you've given your audience a lot of value with Facebook video content and excellent LinkedIn articles and statuses, run a Facebook Ad to a landing page. If you've defined your network (e.g. only connect with growth marketers), then it's relatively easy to offer them something worth opting into. Here's an example ad I ran to my LinkedIn connections resulting in less than \$1/lead (with zero A/B testing):





Don't waste another second.

Now you can crush it with LinkedIn Publishing and use it to drive leads. Write your first LinkedIn post or status today with the recommended content and design principles to drive engagement.

With enough effort, you may just become a LinkedIn influencer.

Are you ready?

Bonus LinkedIn Hacks:

Growth Hack #1:

While experimenting with LinkedIn, I've noticed one of the best ways to drive traffic to a blog post is by using an interesting status of around 800 - 1200 characters, then dropping the link at the end.

For shorter statuses, I drop the link in the first comment. It turns out, [Guy Kawasaki](#) was thinking the same thing and more.



"Take what you're about to read with some caveats: this isn't exactly scientific because it's impossible to control all the variables, and what's true for me might not be true for you.

- Picture with post vs no picture. 3-5 x more views when there isn't a picture. Yes, you read that right.

- I'm convinced that there should be no picture. There are two ways to not have a picture:

- 1) Remove the picture from the draft post (clicking on the "x" in the top right corner) but leave the link. The advantage of this method is that the link is in the post, so it's easier for people to click.

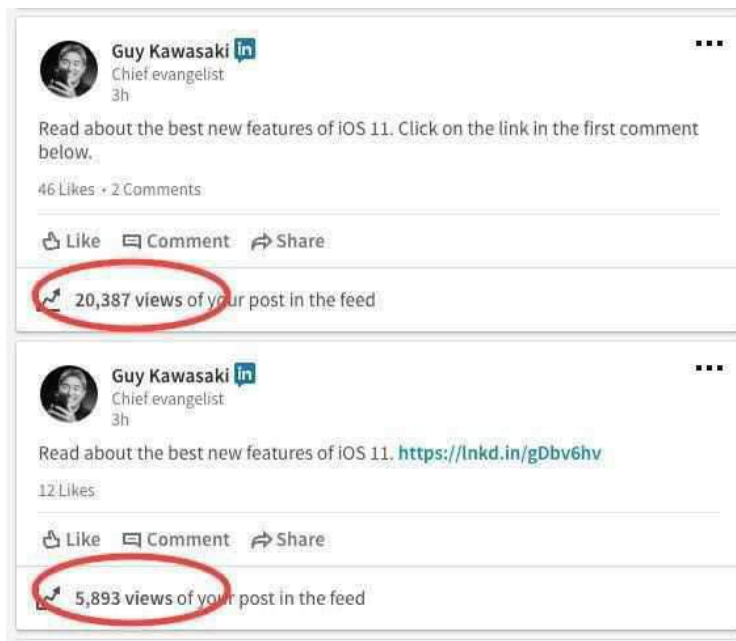
- 2) Remove the link from the post and put it in the first comment. This is a pain in the ass for me and for everyone who wants to click on the link especially if this requires clicking on "previous comments" multiple times to get to the first comment.

But when the link is in the first comment and not the post itself, I get 3 x more views of the post. You read that right too.

My friends at LinkedIn tell me that this can't be/shouldn't be happening, and LinkedIn is just looking for good content and doesn't care about these nuances.

What can I say?"

To conclude, no picture (unless it's a work selfie) + link at the end of a 800 - 1200 character post works best to drive traffic to a blog post.



Growth Hack #2:

Want to SEO growth hack your LinkedIn profile?

Find 100 - 300 of your 1st level connections who get lots of traffic to their profile. Now, give all of them a recommendation.

Congrats! You have upwards to three hundred backlinks from their profile to yours.



The Anatomy of a Viral LinkedIn Post

Credit: [Josh Fechter](#), Co-Founder of [BAMF.Media](#)

[Original post](#)

"I quit my job.

Ran out of savings.

Then took a low-paying job as a copywriter.

I bootstrapped down and moved into my Dad's tiny apartment.

Without much space, we slept in the same room. During this time, I learned something beautiful.

Success and happiness parallel how much value we create for others.

Not how many books we read, podcasts we listen to, or YouTube videos we watch.

The problem: I had no skills. I had no money.

With few options, I began writing for many hours every day.

To focus, I stopped...

-Talking to friends who didn't help me create value.

-Opening my Facebook News Feed.

-Paying attention to politics.

-Watching T.V. and Netflix.

-Going out to eat.

First, I wrote on my blog.



As I became a better writer, I contributed to publications.

People began to recognize and respect my ability to create value.

I left my low-pay copywriting job to work for a Facebook software company and moved out of my Dad's apartment.

I then took a job as the VP of marketing for an events company spread across five cities, then eventually, I became the head of growth for a VC firm.

Now, I'm a founder of two companies and a 15,000-person community.

If your life is not on a successful track, then ask yourself:

Am I a consumer or a creator?"

Learnings:

Almost the entire piece is written in one line sections. This make it easier to read.

If you came across this post and every sentence had similar length and was on one line, then it'd look awful. Instead, I use the sentence length and bullet points to help style the piece. Notice how from a bird's eye view, the piece when put on its side looks like a wave length. This is an excellent sign of a well-written piece of copy.

Outline:

1. Start the piece by drilling down into the problem and "knife twisting" in a total of eight words:

"I quit my job."

"I ran out of savings."

2. Explain the negative outcomes and release vulnerability within the next two lines. Powerful.

"I bootstrapped down and moved into my Dad's tiny apartment.

Without much space, we slept in the same room."

3. Dive into the aha moment:



"During this time, I learning something beautiful:

Success and happiness parallel how much value we create for others."

4. Reiterate a clearer picture of the problem with more confidence.

"Not how many books we read, podcasts we listen to, or YouTube videos we watch.

The problem. I had no skills. I had no money."

5. Dive into the sacrifices you needed to make to solve the problem.

"With few options, I began writing for many hours every day.

To focus, I stopped...

-Talking to friends who didn't help me create value

-Opening my Facebook News Feed

-Paying attention to politics

-Watching T.V. and Netflix

-Going out to eat"

6. The result of the sacrifices (first step of the hero's journey)

"First, I wrote on my blog."

7. Escalate the first step to the second step fast.

"As I became a better writer, I contributed to publications."

8. Beneficial outcome.

"People began to recognize and respect my ability to create value."

9. Problem solved.

"I left my low-pay copywriting job to work for a Facebook software company and moved out of my Dad's apartment."



10. Escalate the benefit to give more credibility to the learning.

"I then took a job as the VP of marketing for an events company spread across five cities, then eventually, I became the head of growth for a VC firm."

11. Say directly or imply how you give back from your learning (15,000-person community)

"Now, I'm a founder of two companies and a 15,000-person community."

12. What you can do if you have similar problems.

"If your life is not on a successful track, then ask yourself:

Am I a consumer or a creator?"





How to Get Thousands of Leads
from Quora in Five Months

Josh Fechter

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How to Get Thousands of Leads from Quora in Five Months

Credit: [Josh Fechter](#), Co-Founder of [BAMF.Media](#)

Can't find a solid channel to get leads?

Here's how to dominate a social platform to generate thousands of leads and build a huge online community in only a few months.

The secret: Quora.

If you don't know, [Quora](#) is a question-and-answer site and community for intellectuals to voice their opinions -- think Yahoo Answers but with actual good advice.

But think about this: even though there are over 3 million questions on Quora (with dozens of answers), most Quora writers don't break a thousand views.

But a few seem to strike gold every day and rake in thousands of leads.

What's the difference?

I wrote my first big hit on August 8th, 2016. I answered, "[At what point should founders take a salary from their startup?](#)"



At what point should founders take a salary from their startup?

It seems the current conventional wisdom is that founders should act like modern ascetics and shun all thoughts of remuneration and to take even a penny (or cent) from the company is a major red flag. But what about the rent/mortgage and things like food?



Josh Fechter, Growth Evangelist @AutopilotHQ | Advisor @Praxis | Mentor

Updated 24m ago · Upvoted by Ravi Vadrevu, Derric Haynie, and 2 others you follow



This answer received over **one hundred thousand views**.

Why?

Controversy.

By stepping on toes, you get noticed. Top writers regularly use controversy to get traction.

What other Quora strategies do they use?

After extensive research, I discovered their closely guarded strategies (then implemented them). The results after five months:



- Over 2,000 quality members (around 6,000 requests) added to my Facebook Group, [Marketers & Founders](#)
- Over 3,000 leads added to my email list from an eBook I promoted on Quora strategies in my bio

Weight	Visitors	Views	Conversions	Conversion Rate
100%	7230	9026	3010	41.63%

or

Leads (3010)

Now, I have over twenty-two thousand followers and 8 million views on my work. To give you a reference, I have one of the fastest growing [Quora profiles](#).

Josh Fechter
Growth Evangelist @AutopilotHQ | Advisor @Praxis | Mentor

I'm the growth evangelist for a visual marketing software for automating customer journeys, [Autopilot](#).

I'm also an author, startup advisor, and serial entrepreneur.

Grab my free eBook: [How to get 7,000+ Quora Followers in 4 months](#)

Follow me on social:

[Facebook](#)

[LinkedIn](#)

You may have seen my writing here:

[Entrepreneur](#) [social media explorer](#) [THE HUFFINGTON POST](#) [SocialMediaToday](#) [Inc.](#)

My favorite Quora answers:... (more)

Followers 22k [Facebook](#) [Twitter](#) [LinkedIn](#)

Credentials & Highlights Edit

- Growth Evangelist at AutopilotHQ 2017-present
- Studied at General Assembly
- Lives in San Francisco, CA
- 8.9m answer views 899.4k this month
- Top Writer 2017
- Published Writer Inc and The Ladders

Knows About Edit

- Life Advice 71 answers
- Self-Improvement

Views are great, but I know what you're thinking: " *Why should I focus on Quora?*"

- You build your email list fast.
- You establish thought leadership.
- Your posts get many organic views.
- Your traffic compounds as you gain followers.
- You can drive thousands of more members to your online community.
- Excellent posts get syndicated to major publications, including *Time* and *Inc. Magazine*.

But all that happens if you get your answers seen, read, and upvoted like a top writer.

To do that, you need the secret Quora sauce for traction.

To get traction, implement these ten strategies top writers use to identify questions, drive traffic, build community, and creating a huge, loyal following fast.

1. Focus on the Metrics That Move the Needle

If you want to be the best, then act like the best.

The best marketers on Quora find and answer the most relevant questions to their brand.

They niche down to portray themselves as thought leaders and dominate Google search for the topics related to their business.

You'll see many writers on Quora focus on broad lifestyle questions because they're the most likely to get upvotes and comments. However, if they're not related to your business offering or lead magnet, then you're chasing fool's gold.

Avoid vanity metrics by optimizing your profile attributes and tagline according to your niche, then answer questions in that niche.

For starters:

- Add a detailed About Me section
- Add your areas of expertise
- Add your interests
- Your cities
- Schools & colleges you've attended
- Previous companies
- Connect your other social media accounts

The tagline from your bio shows at the top of every answer:



12 Answers



Josh Fechter, Growth Evangelist @Autopilot | Advisor @Praxis | Mentor

Written Mar 30 · Upvoted by Stephen Doherty, Stan Hanks, and 4 others you follow



HOW WE RECKLESSLY BLEW \$500,000 IN FIVE MONTHS

This tagline is customizable for the different topics you write about and includes fifty characters. To customize it, click the several dots at the bottom right of your answer, then click Edit Credential.

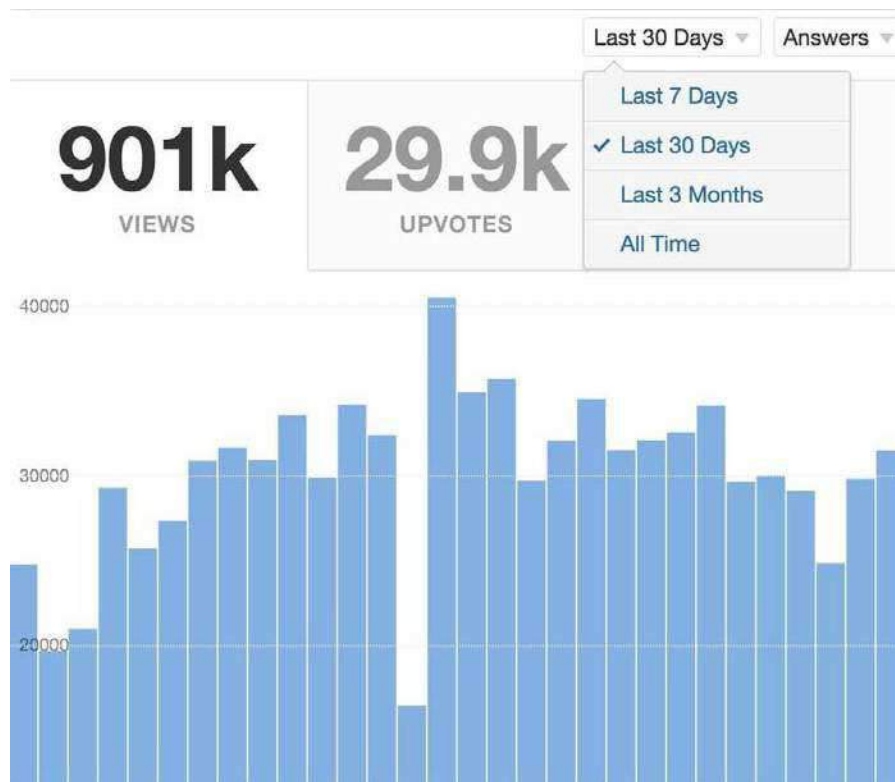
You'll now have an option to select pre-existing taglines or edit them to create a new one.

Stick to one tagline to create strong brand recognition across the many questions you answer. Make sure this tagline is relevant to the lead magnet in your bio to increase conversions.

If you're interested in several niches and not sure which one to start answering questions in, then A/B test it. You can write for two weeks in one niche and use a relevant offer in your bio, then do the same for another niche the second two weeks.

To compare traffic week-by-week, go to the stats section of your profile. Here you can change the date according to the timeframe you want to analyze:





These stats will give you a strong overview of your performance, but they're not the end-all be-all. The most important metric is the number of leads you're driving. With that said, more views and upvotes have a high correlation to the number of leads you receive.

2. Make Your Bio Work Harder (And Smarter)

You could answer 1000 questions on Quora, but if you don't generate leads, your hard work will go to waste.

That's why you need to optimize your bio.

Top writers design their bio like a website homepage.

They use elements like:

1. A relevant offer
2. Social validation
3. A memorable picture



4. Links to your other content

As you can see from my bio, I ensure to link to Autopilot organically, then I promote an eBook (which generated me over 3,000 signups). Below the offer, I include [social proof](#) to increase conversion votes.

Then, I promote a few of my favorite Quora pieces:



Josh Fechter

Growth Evangelist @AutopilotHQ | Advisor @Praxis | Mentor

B *I* ☰ ☷

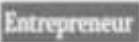
  ...

I'm the growth evangelist for a visual marketing software for automating customer journeys, **Autopilot**.

I'm also an author, startup advisor, and serial entrepreneur.

Grab my eBook - How to get 7,000+ Quora Followers in 4 months:
<http://joshfechter.com/quora/ebook/>

You may have seen my writing here:

     **Inc.**

My favorite Quora answers:

1. How can I be more charismatic?
2. What is the most frustrating thing about being a high school student?
3. Why do most high school students hate reading?
4. Why do many students hate school?
5. What tweak has made all the difference in your life?
6. What's the best mistake you've ever made?
7. What's the riskiest thing you have ever done which did not pay off?
8. What's the most interesting startup right now that barely anyone is talking about?
9. What's the most creative way to get noticed when applying for a job?

Another great bio example is of Nicolas Cole. He uses a mix of brand names, features, imagery, and relevant offers to drive leads.

Nicolas Cole

Author & Entrepreneur. Inc Columnist. Published in TIME, Forbes, Fortune, etc.

Want to become a successful writer online?

Take the online course: [How To Get Your Writing Featured In Major Publications.](#) ↗



Named by Forbes: [One of the Top 25 Marketing Influencers to watch in 2017](#) ↗.

Sign up for my [FREE 7 Day Personal Branding e-mail course](#) ↗.

When I was 17 years old, I was one of the highest ranked World of Warcraft players in North America (and I wrote a book about it): [Confessions of a Teenage Gamer.](#) ↗

Columnist for [Inc Magazine.](#) ↗

Published in: TIME, Entrepreneur, Huffington Post, Inc Magazine, Business Insider, Forbes, Fortune, Entrepreneur, Chicago Tribune, and more.

Fitness: [“Skinny to Shredded” eBook Series, sold in 30+ countries worldwide](#) ↗

Again, don't rethink the wheel. Copy how top writers design their bios to drive traffic and leads. It will save you time you can use for answering questions.



3. Find and Answer the Right Questions 10X Faster

Knowing how to writing quality Quora answers is important, but if you spend thirty minutes looking for every quality question, then you'll never get traction. You need to understand what questions you should answer and how to find them faster.

To find lead-generating questions, start reading as many answers as possible in relevant topics to your business. When reading, identify a few of your favorite Quora writers in these niches.

Once you've found your favorites, **bookmark the topics they follow**. I read everything by [Jason M. Lemkin](#), so I bookmark all the topics he focuses on by clicking on who he's following, then selecting the Topics tab.

The screenshot shows the Quora profile of Jason M. Lemkin. The profile includes a circular profile picture, a header with his name and bio, a video player, and a bio paragraph. Below the bio are social media links and a 'Topics' tab. The 'Topics' tab is selected, showing a list of topics he follows, including 'Venture Capital' and 'Startup Founders and Entrepreneurs'. Red arrows point from the 'Topics' tab and the 'Following' list to the 'Topics' tab.

Jason M. Lemkin
SaaS & SaaS Fund; ceo/co-founder @ EchoSign (acq'd by Adobe).

Jason M. Lemkin is a hyper-founder centric VC and has sourced or been the first or very early investor in many leading enterprise/SaaS start-ups, including Algolia, Automile, Talkdesk, Parklet, Guidespark, ... (more)

Unfollow | 28.9k | Turn On Notifications | Facebook | Twitter | LinkedIn | WordPress

Feeds | 191 People | **Topics** | Blogs

Answers 2,145
Questions 65
Posts 870
All Activity
Followers 28.9k
Following 191

Venture Capital
707 Answers
Unfollow | 896.4k

Startup Founders and Entrepreneurs
691 Answers
Unfollow | 849.5k

Startup Advice and Strategy
Entrepreneurship

Credentials & Highlights More

- 68 Followers You Know
- Works at SaaS
- Studied at Harvard University
- Lives in Palo Alto, CA
- 28.4m answer views
- Top Writer
- Sessions
- Published Writer
- Most Viewed Writer

Knows About

- Venture Capital
- Startup Founders and Entrepreneurs

Before you begin jumping into these topics and bookmarking every question that pulls your attention, know the attributes that make a question ripe for traction:

1. 7:1 ratio of followers to the number of answers provided.
2. A lot of followers, but many bad answers.
3. A question that you can provide a personal image to complement.

4. An emotional pull. This pull makes it easier to write more genuine answers with thought-provoking stories.
5. Relevant to your bio offer.
6. A question with poor-written answers making yours more likely to stand out.

The fastest way to identify a poorly-written answer is to look at whether the writer focuses on self-promotion rather than providing value.

For example, in the question below, the top answer has a promotional link in the first sentence and provides little value to the reader. Moreover, there's a 7:1 ratio of followers to answers.

Storytelling How-to Become Question Communication +6

How can one become a better story teller?

On either Quora or interpersonal communication.

Request Follow 143 Comment Share Downvote

You've written an answer
You can edit or delete it at any time.

20 Answers

Mike Schoultz, A storyteller for most of my life.
Written Jan 14, 2016

Facts are meaningless without a contextual story. Don't tell facts to influence, tell stories. The more you improve storytelling, the more your influence ... it is as simple as that.

Jackpot!

NOTE: If you write many answers, you'll eventually struggle to find questions with a 7:1 ratio of followers to answer. Just be sure to employ the other strategies in this guide, and you'll get traction.

To start searching for questions, dive into the individual topics you chosen, then save the juiciest questions for later. This allows you to browse through thousands of top-performing questions faster because the immediate questions presented under every topic tend to have the highest follower-to-answer ratio.

When you find a high-quality question, click on the three dots next to it, then select “Answer Later.” I’ll spend 15 - 30 minutes finding 5 or 6 questions I want to answer. As I’m writing this, I currently have over 300 questions saved.

Google Alerts Entrepreneurs Google Products and Services Motivation +1

What motivates entrepreneurs?

[Answer](#) [Request](#) Follow 50 [Comment](#) [Share](#) [Downvote](#) ...

Promoted by Hired.com

Developers are finding new jobs using Hired.
Hired reverses the job search. Make companies apply to you v front.

[Sign Up at Hired.com/signup](#)

16 Answers

Peter Baskerville, Developed a Australian TAFE national qualification in Entrepreneurship
Updated Oct 1, 2010

Go Anonymous
☒ Answer Later
Notify About Edits
[Edit Question & Details](#)
[Edit Topics](#)
[Create Answer Wiki](#)
[Merge Questions](#)
[Report](#)

When you want to access these bookmarked questions, click on Answer at the top right of your screen, then click “Answer Later” on the left side. You’ll then see a list of all the questions you’ve saved.

Protip: Outsource the question search process by contracting a virtual assistant. Ask them to go through a list of 100 to 200 topics to find the best questions according to the 7:1 ratio of followers to answers. Tell them to create a spreadsheet where they have columns for hyperlinked Quora questions to their original source, follower ratio, topic name, and a 1-5 rating of how good the other answers are to the question (1 being the best).

Questions to Answer				
File Edit View Insert Format Data Tools Add-ons Help Accessibility All changes saved				
fx				
	A	B	C	D
1	Quora Questions Hyperlinked	Follower Ratio	Topic Name	Competition (1 - 5)
2	https://www.quora.com/What-should-I-learn-about-	6:1	Startups	3
3	https://www.quora.com/How-can-people-continue-	5:1	Startups	2
4	https://www.quora.com/What-are-examples-of-goo	10:1	Venture Capital	5
5	https://www.quora.com/How-is-the-importance-of-c	2:1	Venture Capital	5
6	https://www.quora.com/What-are-the-common-mis	3:1	B2B Marketing	1
7	https://www.quora.com/What-are-some-lies-startup	7:1	B2B Marketing	4

I have my virtual assistant provide me thirty questions every Monday, so I'm ready to start the week knocking out Quora answers.

4. Showcase Your Work with Beautiful Images

The first piece of every lead-generating Quora answer is the image.

The biggest Quora influencers (like [James Altucher](#) and Nicolas Cole), use images in almost every answer.

If you don't have a personal photo or one of a celebrity relevant to your answer, then use [Allthefreestock.com](#), a site that aggregates many of the best free stock photo sites.

A study by Skyword found a [94 percent increase](#) in viewership if a published article contained a relevant photograph or infographic when compared to articles without an image in the same category.

Diving into the science, images help [release oxytocin in our brain](#) increasing trust in products or brands. In a [PLoS ONE case study](#), participants under the effects of oxytocin gave more money to charity than those who weren't.

I just dropped science on you. What more could you want?



Usually, I'll drop a celeb image to get people's attention, especially if they've recently been in the news:

How do you gain people skills?



Josh Fechter, Growth Evangelist @AutopilotHQ | Advisor @Praxis | Mentor

Written Jan 10 · Upvoted by Ace Eddleman, Emmanuel Aremu, and 9 others you follow

I sat in the back of every high school classroom. I wouldn't make a peep. I thought too much about what I would say. I remember this cute, dark-haired girl who'd always try to talk with me. "Hey! You'... [\(more\)](#)



Upvotes 4k

Comments 37+



Warning: Only use an image of a celebrity if it's relevant to your post; otherwise, the Quora community will throw a fit in your comments. They'll think you're using the image purely for click bait.

Your image doesn't have to be at the top of your answer. Quora takes the first picture in your post to use as the preview even if it's ten paragraphs down. Top writers use images of themselves or celebrities to generate a higher click-through rate on their answers.

In the picture below, James Altucher uses a personal picture with well-known Shark Tank investor, Daymond John:



What's the single most important advice to give someone starting their own company?



James Altucher, Author, entrepreneur, podcaster, wall street investor

Updated Mar 8 · Upvoted by Dawn Gregory and Pek Pongpaet

READY. FIRE. AIM A funny thing happened on the way to a billion dollars. [Sara Blakely](#) had no office, nobody ready to do manufacturing, spent dozens or hundreds of hours trying to meet the main person... [\(more\)](#)



Upvote 472

Downvote Comments 9



The best Quora answers use before-and-after images because they imply a good story and draw emotion from the reader. Nicolas Cole is especially good at using this strategy. Here's an example picture he's used many times over for his Quora answers:



These pictures generate more upvotes because Quora readers love personal and genuine posts. You'll notice almost every top Quora writer detail their personal experiences in their posts using images.

5. Write Your Drafts Like You're Writing In A Journal

The top performing posts on Quora include personal stories, excellent advice, or humor. Everyone, including you, has thousands of stories to draw ideas from.

You can even turn a simple part of your everyday life into memorable content. Maybe it's where you grab your morning coffee or something funny your friend said to you the other day. The material is *everywhere*.

[Dushka Zapata](#) is the most well-known writer on Quora. She takes the angle of turning everyday stories into emotion-evoking content that gets traction. If you're looking for inspiration on how to turn simple stories into remarkable stories, then she's your go-to.

[Sean Kernan](#), owner of one of the fastest-growing Quora profiles, writes from an angle of excellent advice or controversial humor. Sean grew his following to over twenty-five thousand while answering only 158 questions. He's a great example of how traction on Quora has everything to do with quality answers.

How do you pull out the little heart-rending moments from this material?

You examine every tiny physical and emotional change, then write about these changes using metaphors, similes, and emotional adjectives.

Here's a great example from my answer to "What's the most frustrating thing about being a high school student?":

*"You stare at your teacher not listening to a word they're saying.
You try to take notes, but they turn into doodles.
Your knees won't stop shaking.
'Am I nervous?'
'Why can't I pay attention like the kid in the front row?'
You start fiddling with your pencil.
"Crack!"*

On the flip side, here's a bad (read: normal) example from one of the pieces:



Great work needs you to become obsessive, not to focus on many unrelated fields.

If you want to perform like a hero, you need to get a good night's sleep, eat healthy, and learn from the elite in your field (not your school peers and rarely your teachers).

School is a barrier to greatness.

Once you pull the emotional moments out of the tiniest details, it's time to spark the reader's imagination with certain phrases to get them hooked. Here are several phrases Quora readers respond to well:

1. "Imagine this"
2. "Let me explain"
3. "Then everything changed"

Here's an example excerpt from [one of my pieces](#) where I use the word "imagine" a couple of times. The first time is to get the reader involved in the story; the second time is to show contrast:

Imagine you're a young, talented pianist.

The only time you practice is during your hour-long music class, then two hours when you come back home from school.

If you devote these three hours to playing piano, then you miss out on physical exercise, making friends, and dating.

What about the weekend?

You want to become the best. Practicing a skill for fifteen hours a week won't cut it. You need to devote your weekends to playing piano, too.

Now imagine this scenario:

You don't go to school.

Now that you've struck their imagination, **write dialogue to re-enact events.**

Writing dialogue requires a high level of empathy. If you can excel with this skill, then you'll immediately stand out as one of the better Quora writers. Here's an example excerpt from one of my Quora answers that received over 200K views:

I interviewed an entrepreneur who sold his company for fifty million dollars to Walmart.

Here's what happened:

Me: "When you found out Walmart didn't want to acquire you, what did you do next?"

Fraser: "We continued working on the company, and eventually Amazon approached us."

Me: "Oh wow. Amazon."

Fraser: "As soon as Walmart found out about Amazon, they offered to acquire us."

By immersing the reader in the scene using dialogue, they develop a strong emotional connection to my story resulting in more upvotes.

5. Answer...With Style

Content is not king if design prevents people from reading it.

Before you write the most epic Quora answer, style your content for more engagement:

1. Be human (i.e. use metaphors and similes to describe your emotions)
2. Optimize for mobile (make your paragraphs one or two sentences)
3. Bold your first sentence, important statements, and transitions
4. Remove all extra words, including "very," "really," and "that."
5. Use heavy contrast (i.e. "little did I know it would turn for the worst")
6. Reflect on pain (i.e. "I could barely crawl out of bed")
7. Inspire (always end on a positive call to action)
8. Use bullet points and numbering
9. Italicize most questions

Here's an example of how you take a question worth a great story and make it boring by not optimizing for mobile, using dialogue, reflecting on pain, inspiring, or bolding sentences:



Do you need to have a registered company to get funding for your idea?



You should.

Incorporating your business sends the message that you are “put together” which investors appreciate. Some investors may hear you out while others will not even consider meeting with you if you haven’t incorporated. Why risk missing out on a great investor? It certainly won’t hurt to incorporate your business, but failure to do so could really cause some unnecessary challenges.

Here’s how I used my style principles to make my writing stand out. [This piece](#) received over 340K views:

Dropped out of college to start a company.

The photo above is of our founders one week before our startup “officially” failed (I’m on the far right).

We were barely-able-to-pay-rent broke.

We worked close to one-hundred hours a week for an entire year.

All we ate was oatmeal, spaghetti, and peanut butter.

Oh, and there was a lot of shitty coffee to fuel us.

We recruited 150 writers, published hundreds of articles, but never figured out how to make enough money.

Our startup failed.

I learned a lot from this failure:

- How to hustle when everyone depends on you
- How to have the confidence to cold call hundreds of people every day
- How to get in touch with people who can mentor you
- And most importantly, how to appreciate failure

If you have a [background in copywriting](#), you’ll have a head start in understanding how to format your content. And whatever you do, don’t stop practicing. No one became a top Quora writer after their first few answers.

6. Keep the Momentum When You Strike Gold

If you see an answer going viral, then write a follow-up answer with a plug because you’ll have a huge spike of people looking at other answers you’ve written.

But here’s the key: You have to make it look organic.

For example, if you drop a link at the end of an article asking people interested in learning more to visit a resource with no opt-in, then you’re in the clear.



Think about it: You read something clearly promotional, then by the end of article you're dying.

If you're trying to promote your company, then dive into the startup categories to answer questions where you can link to your company without it overtly looking like a plug.

This means avoiding hard asks and click bait to get people to visit your website.

Hard ask: *"Learn more about what we do here:"*

Hard ask: *"Start your free trial here:"*

Click bait: *"For tips 11 - 20, go here:"*

Instead, tell them where they can learn more without a hard ask.

Example: *If this is a subject you're interested in, we've written many articles about it. You can read them here: [insert link]*

I hope they help you with [X pain point]."

Another strategy is to include a backlink in a list post, so you can blend it in with links to other companies. In turn, it won't appear as if you're overtly promoting one.

Do this right after one of your answers goes viral.

For example, I answered the question "What are the most promising Silicon Valley startups to watch for in 2017?" soon after I noticed my answer to "What is the one worst decision you took in your life that changed your life?" start to get huge traction.

This enabled me to plug my company, Autopilot, without it looking spammy:

What are the most promising Silicon Valley startups to watch for in 2017?



Josh Fechter, Growth Evangelist @AutopilotHQ | Advisor @Praxis | Mentor
Written Mar 4 · Upvoted by Brooke Taylor, Brooke Schwartz, and Mario Chamorro

Here are the top Silicon Valley companies to watch in 2017: 1. [Autopilot](#), a visual marketing software for automating customer journeys. We've grown 4X in revenue and employee count in the last year. ... [\(more\)](#)

Upvotes 60

Comments 2



What is the one worst decision you took in your life that changed your life?



Josh Fechter, Growth Evangelist @AutopilotHQ | Advisor @Praxis | Mentor
Written Mar 4 · Upvoted by Isis Rodriguez, Emmanuel Aremu, and 3 others you follow

I sent an email to him. I'd be graduating college soon. After several years of studying, my network comprised of college students who had no connections to companies. I needed to land a great internship or job. ... [\(more\)](#)



Upvotes 824

Comments 15+



Talk about a fantastic opportunity.

This strategy works even better if you have a low-barrier offer such as joining a Facebook Group or Slack community because it's perceived as less promotional than a direct link to your website.

Keep in mind Quora's readers have no-tolerance for self-promotion.

To not get on your reader's bad side, make sure to backlink, at least, 2/3 of the way down your answer.

Don't break this rule! Over the top promotion will get you banned from Quora.

To be safe, don't use links that go straight to a landing page, [a page with a pop-up that appears right away](#), or an above the fold opt-in.



Lastly, make sure you place your call to action on a relevant answer; otherwise, you'll receive low-quality traffic which will mess with your metrics. Use a line (created by typing many hyphens in a row) to separate your call to action from your answer.

For example, here's how I promote my Facebook Group for founders in a topic about venture capital, then use a line to separate the call to action. The offer is relevant to the topic making it a perfect fit.

A well-placed link like this one can **drive several hundred relevant people** to my Facebook Group in a single day:

I'm still a big believer in doing whatever it takes if the founders believe and care enough about their vision.

The chances are that if they're concerned with salary when starting a company, then they're not cut out for startup life.

Purpose-driven individuals will continue pursuing change long after all the money-driven individuals have given up.

Interested in growth and venture capital? Join my Facebook Group of 5,500+ startup founders, VCs, and marketers: [Marketers & Founders](#) 

119.9k Views · View Upvotes

Upvotes 166

Comment 1



Quora is a huge membership driver of my Facebook group. It's one of the primary reasons I could grow the community from 0 - 7,500 people in less than six months.

7. Know What Keywords You Want To Dominate...Then Target Them

If you're trying to drive relevant traffic and leads, [Moz](#) can help rank your Quora posts for keywords related to your niche because they have a free trial for all their features.

To search engine optimize your posts, take advantage of Moz's Keyword Explorer to understand what keywords to go after first.



Because I'm an evangelist for [Autopilot](#), I use the keyword phrase "onboarding SaaS" to find corresponding queries. As a result, I have hundreds of related keywords I can choose from. To help segment these related keywords, I can choose only to display certain matches.

In this example, I chose to "only include keywords with all the query terms."

From there, I save the resulting eighteen keywords as a list under the title, "SaaS Onboarding." To access this list, click "Keyword Lists," and it will appear.

Keyword Lists

29 of 30 keyword lists available

SaaS Onboarding

0 Expired SERPs

Total Keywords	18
Total Volume	--
Average Volume	--
Average Difficulty	35
Average Opportunity	97
Average Potential	29
Average Importance	3

Last Updated: 12/27/2016

When I click on the title "SaaS Onboarding," I get redirected to a page with an in-depth analysis of each keyword by Rank, Volume, Difficulty, Opportunity, and Potential.

18 Keywords 482 of 500 keywords available

I want to **new** Move to Copy to Delete Refresh Add Keywords Export CSV

Check rankings for: Check Rankings

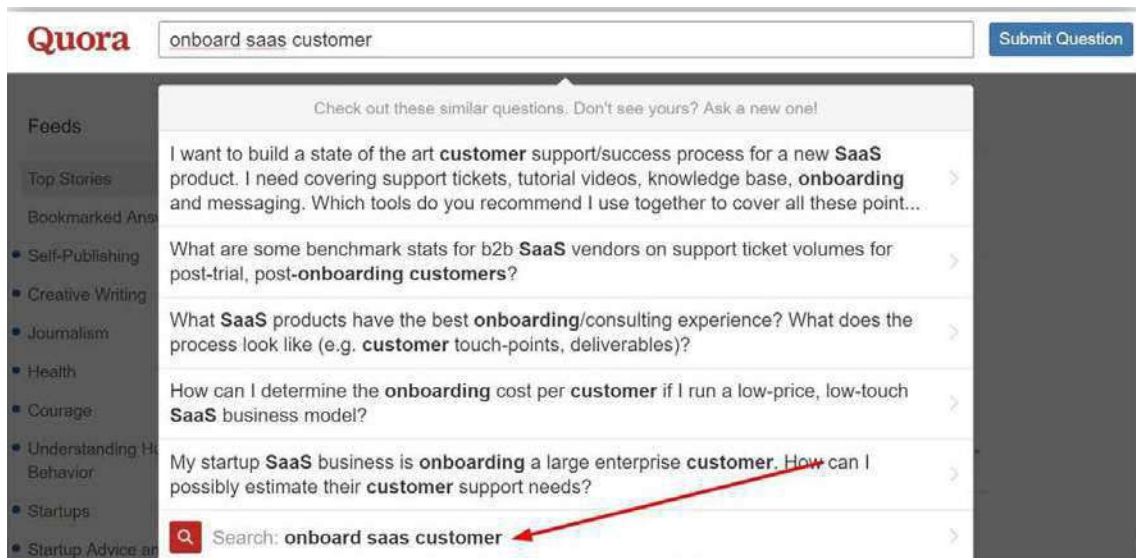
☐	Keyword ↑	Rank ↑ ↓	Volume ↑ ↓	Difficulty ↑ ↓	Opportunity ↑ ↓	Importance ↑ ↓	Potential ↑ ↓	Analyze/Search
☐	client onboarding saas United States - en-US	no URL	no data	32	100	3 Neutral	30	Analyzed 12/27/2016
☐	employee onboarding saas United States - en-US	no URL	no data	30	100	3 Neutral	30	Analyzed 12/27/2016
☐	onboarding saas United States - en-US	no URL	no data	35	100	3 Neutral	30	Analyzed 12/27/2016

- **Difficulty** uses a click-through rate curve model to exemplify when weaker pages rank higher. If the difficulty is low, then it's easier to rank for that particular keyword.
- **Opportunity** provides an estimate of how likely someone is to click on an organic web result. For example, if the Opportunity Score is a 37/100, then it means only 37% of the clicks will go to organic results. What happens to the other 63%? These clicks go to Google AdWords ads.
- **Potential** combines all the metrics to help give you an understanding of what keywords you should optimize for first. I wouldn't rely solely on Potential for ranking the keywords to take action on. This number is highly subjective based on the time it takes you to create the content to rank for these keywords among many other variables.

Using these metrics, you make a list of many keywords to take into consideration when writing Quora answers. From there, you're almost ready to write (FINALLY).

8. Take Your Keywords and Questions On A Date

Once you know the keywords you want to rank for, then search for pre-existing questions including the keywords you're considering.



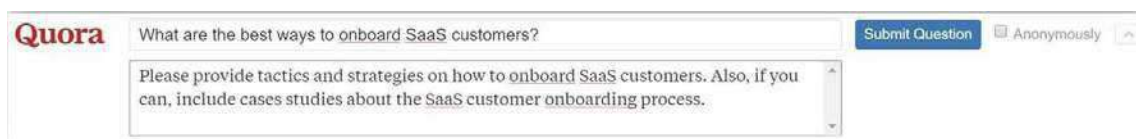
I know what you're thinking:

How well do these questions rank?

When you Google "best onboarding software for saas," the first two results are on Quora. If you had a SaaS company, this is prime Google real estate to capitalize on.

What if there are no questions that use the keywords you want to optimize for?

If there aren't questions that use your keyword, then **you can have a friend ask keyword-optimized questions**. You want to make sure to include the keywords in the description of the question, too. Here's what that looks like:



This take balance.

If Quora thinks you have someone dedicated to asking you keyword-optimized questions, then they'll ban you. To play safe, split your answers fifty-fifty among keyword-optimized questions and ones that aren't.

9. Get the Attention of Big Players

I use Quora to get the attention of big industry players to partner with my company. I find questions they've answered on Quora, then answer them. Sometimes I'll tag them, too.

After getting the attention of these industry influencers, use it as an opportunity to take the conversation further whether over coffee or a phone call.

Using this tactic, I've gained a new fan of my writing. He's one of the top voices in B2B marketing. I've tagged him multiple times, answered many of the same questions, and suggested edits to his answers.

Here's a [snippet from his bio](#):

"Jason has co-founded two successful start-ups selling to the enterprise. Most recently, he served as CEO and co-founder of EchoSign, the web's most popular electronic signature service, from inception through its acquisition by Adobe Systems Inc."

I also got the attention of Dennis Yu, the CTO of [BlitzMetrics](#) and writer for Adweek, by thanking him in an answer for excellent public speaking advice he gave me.





Dennis Yu

December 21, 2016 · Quora · 🌐 ▼

If you want to be a powerful public speaker, learn from [Josh Fechter](#) !



How can I speak with more clarity and confidence?

Josh Fechter's answer: Before I began speaking in front of hundreds of people, I started here: There are around twenty people in the room. Two years later, my speaking engagements look like this: Here's my top tip for speaking whether to one...

QUORA.COM

👍 Like

💬 Comment

➦ Share

👍❤️ You, Brandon Lipman, Hitesh Parashar and 28 others

In return, many of these big players will tag you on Quora resulting in an influx of traffic to your bio which will generate more leads and followers.

10. Get Featured in Inc., Time, and Business Insider

Ok. This one seems a little far-fetched. But I promise you can actually achieve it.



If you write an excellent answer, the Quora staff may pick it up to publish it on major media outlets. You can increase your odds by writing better content faster in niches frequently syndicated to publications and carefully watched by Quora's media team.



To know what topics to contribute in, find someone with the phrase, "Quora Media and Publishing Team," in their bio. From there, you can select the topics they follow to get an idea of where they're looking for answers and whose work they enjoy to read:

Julie Anne Exter FOLLOWS YOU

Quora Media and Publishing Team

- Therapist
- Work-from-home publishing liaison
- Mom to a whole mess of little boys...

(more)

Unfollow 1.5k Turn On Notifications Messages Facebook Twitter ...

Feeds 519 People Topics Blogs

Answers 215
Questions 1,591
Posts 350
All Activity
Followers 1,675
Following 519
Edits 5,359

Following English / Français

Elizabeth Muller
Executive Director of Berkeley Earth
Followed by Julie Anne Exter, Terrence Yang, and Shival Gupta
Follow 2.9k

Steven Schlenker
co-founder of DN Capital venture ...
Followed by Marc Bodnick, Julie Anne Exter, and 2 others you follow
Follow 638

Shrey Banga
Followed by Daniella Maydan, Adrián Lamo, and 8 others you follow
Follow 6.5k

Janie Keddie
Compulsively curious.
Followed by Julie Anne Exter and Diane Shatto
Follow 1.6k

The fastest way to find these writers is to dive into the answers of questions to do with Quora Publishing.

The Quora Publishing team looks for well-designed content for publications. I suggest using lists and staying away from complex words. Furthermore, break your piece down into actionable steps by focusing on how-to content mixed with personal storytelling.

Here's a snippet of my Quora [answer re-published in Inc.](#) They start the answer with a couple of links to my Quora bio which sends traffic to my lead magnet.

And if you haven't figured it out yet, answer questions popular on Quora. The more people who follow an answer, the more likely it will get seen by the right pair of eyes.

Lies and Lying: What is the easiest way to catch a liar? originally appeared on Quora - the knowledge sharing network where compelling questions are answered by people with unique insights.

Answer by Josh Fechter, Growth Evangelist @AutopilotHQ | Advisor @Praxis, on Quora:

A re-published Quora post like this one can result in hundreds of more leads depending on how well Inc.'s audience enjoys the content.

Lock Down the Basics, then Put Your Foot on the Pedal

Quora is far more than a platform to write on; it's a platform to build a huge community of people around your work while developing thought leadership.

And if you use the outlayed strategies in this guide to establish your presence on Quora, it may become one of your top traction channels giving your business a huge competitive edge.



BACKLINKS

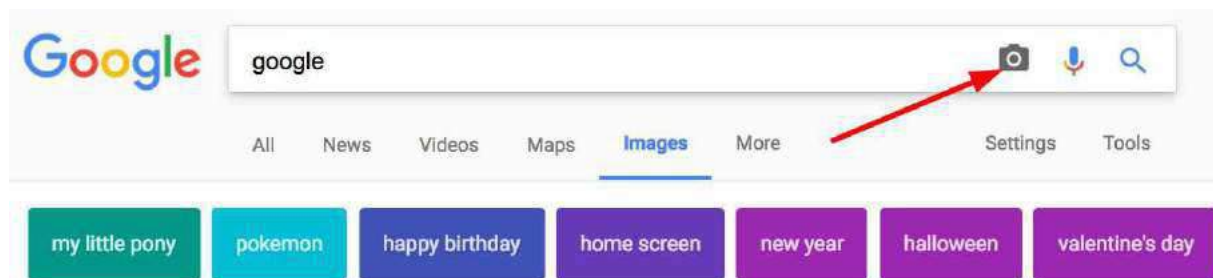


Reverse Image Search for Getting Backlinks	Jakub Gorajek	192
How to Find Your Competitor's Guest Posts	Unknown	194

Reverse Image Search for Getting Backlinks

Credit: [Jakub Gorajek](#), Co-Founder & CEO of Unstock

1. Go to Google Image Search and click on the little camera icon.



Enter a URL of one of the images of your website and click search.

As you can see, there are other websites using this image.

2. Contact the webmaster of the website that are using your image and ask them to link back to you.

It works because it's your image and they are using it without giving you any link (credit).

Here is a reach out template that might help you:

"Hey [Name]

I found out that you are using my image on [article name].

The image link is: [Image Link]

Thank you for using my image as a resource to your blog readers. But I found that you haven't given a credit link for the image.

I would love if you give a link back to my website for the image credits.

Thank You

[Your Name]

Happy hunting!"

Bonus hack:

Create your profile and start uploading quality pictures on [UnSplash.Com](https://unsplash.com)



Check every day your statistics and do the image reverse search on Google for your most popular picture.

Shoot email to the blogger who used your picture and ask him politely to add credits to your picture with your website link.

I get around 30% response rate and usually, they add the link afterward.



How to Find Your Competitor's Guest Posts

Credit: Unknown

Want to one up your competition. Steal their guest posts!

Method 1: Use Google search queries

Your starting point for finding competitor guest posts should be Google search. There are several queries you can try, but this is the one I find most effective:

"Author name" + "guest post" –site:competitordomain.com –site:<https://twitter.com>

Method 2: Look for author pages

Technically this is another search query, but I'll list it here separately as it can often surface additional results.

"Author name" + inurl:author

Method 3: Use reverse image search

You can use Google's reverse image search (right click an image while using Chrome) to find posts containing the author's headshot.

Method 4: Use Ahrefs Content Explorer

You can also use Ahrefs Content Explorer to find content written by a particular author. Just enter the following query:

author:"Author name"





DIRECT MAIL



How to Use Direct Mail like a
Boss

Jordan Crawford

196

Send Personalized Direct
Mail at Scale to Land High-
Ticket Clients

Leo Gamayunov

207

How to Use Direct Mail like a Boss

Credit: [Jordan Crawford](#), Direct Mail Marketer

The reason direct mail works is because so many marketers think it's dead.

When and where to use it:

Direct mail is a good idea for businesses that have \$, have optimized their free channels, know their customers super well, and are past product/market fit, or where LTV is high. Think e-commerce or real estate. It is also a good way to reach people in a specific area, folks who are offline, or inundated with digital advertising. Direct mail is harder to do outside the US (privacy laws for lists, technology, ~2x more expensive, etc).

Conversion #s:

Expect a 1-3% conversion rate on a campaign executed flawlessly with my tips. Best I've ever seen is 10% after >\$1M in spend and over 10+ designs, optimized as they learned. Per-postcard personalization helps a lot.

The best postcard campaigns are sent to targeted audiences, people that already know your brand. After that, targeted purchased lists are good. Generally, avoid sending EDDM (Every Door Direct Mail) to entire carrier routes... which is a good deal cheaper, but not as targeted. Time spent on your list is well spent.

Ready for all my postcard knowledge, distilled into 1 page?

Head into a room. Leave your phone behind. Read for 25 minutes. I have chosen every word and link carefully. Ready? If so... go...



First, Design a Great Card.

1. Get inspired: [here's every postcard we've ever seen](#) (74 cards, Google Drive)
 - a. From companies like Amazon, Chase, Sprig, Jet.com, State Farm, DoorDash, Gap, Verizon, etc.
2. Here are the best design tips
 - a. For postcard sizes, send 6x9 cards or 6x11, 4x6 don't convert as well. Go big OR [weird](#) (G Drive img)
 - b. Use images from [unsplash.com](#) if you don't have a great image. Use [nounproject.com](#) for your icons.
 - c. Your headline should be 3-5 words only, no more. EDIT IT! Again! My [favorite headline](#) (G Drive img)
 - d. Have a crazy good offer (30-40%+), make it expire. After the headline, make the offer most visible.
 - e. If you can, personalize it. First names, maps unique to each card with nearby customers, related products, etc. We send via [lob.com](#) to programmatically do personalization. scott@lob.com will help.
3. Add in tracking
 - a. We use the [message360.com](#) API to provide unique forwarding phone numbers for each campaign to use caller-ID attribution, cheaper + better than Twilio. A free Google Voice number will do, too.
 - b. Use a URL forwarder. Even just bit.ly or [goo.gl](#). If you want, get fancy and get a unique URL for every card to track top of funnel, then follow up with emails (see #2). Unique QR codes, work too.
 - c. Lob.com also offers delivery API calls. Use them, check organic traffic when cards are delivered. You can do QR codes or even in-person redemptions if you have a brick and mortar.

Second, Build a Targeted List.

1. You can target by many criteria
 - a. Target Consumers, Businesses, or Homes/Other (in-doc links).
 - b. Target folks on the web, e.g. LinkedIn with an outsourcer.
 - c. You only buy a list AFTER you design a card. Lists go stale, so send fast!
2. Combine direct mail with email
 - d. If you want to add emails to your addresses or get addresses from your emails addresses.
3. Validate and clean your list
 - e. Lob.com has a free address validator API
 - f. [Smartystreets.com](#) is a way to auto-clean lists
4. Finally, Send and Measure it



1. Pick a printer
 - a. If you aren't doing personalization or per-postcard tracking, don't use Lob.com. [Here's a WIP pricing comparison spreadsheet we're building](#) (Google Sheet), 100% free to all BAMF members, forever.
 - b. If you're Sending >100k, use an offset printer. You can't do much personalization at that volume without spending a lot. Try smaller campaigns first to optimize your message.
 - c. If your LTV is high, you can have letters handwritten: [maillift.com](#) or cheaper, [thankster.com](#).
2. Measure your results
 - a. Generally results will come in 1-4 days after cards are in boxes.
 - b. Based on conversions, do retargeting. Same neighborhood. Same demographics. You can also do browser -> address attribution (yea, right!!) [barometric.com](#).

APPENDIX: CONSUMER TARGETING OPTIONS:

CONSUMER DATA

INCLUDED SELECTS*

Age	Households w/ Children	Home Value
Income	Age Range of Children	Homeowner / Renter
Gender	Gender of Children	Year Home Built
Marital Status	Address Type Indicator	Length of Residence

QUALITY RATIOS

Avg. Deliverability.....	95%
Delivery Guarantee*.....	94%
9-Digit Zipped.....	100%
DPV Qualified.....	100%
Highest DPV Score.....	99.7%
Updated.....	Monthly

When to use Excelsior

If you need the highest quality selects and the most deliverable data available on the market, we suggest using the Excelsior Premium Consumer file. The list is cleaned twice as often as its competitors & it has the highest quality selects included with the base record.

When to use Acxiom

If breadth of targeting options is what's most important to you, we suggest using the Acxiom Consumer file. With over 4,000 data points, ranging from life stages to buying activities and propensities, there's no wider range of targeting choices.

*Excelsior Consumer Data guarantee is 94%. The Acxiom guarantee is 92%.

Scout would like to thank MailersHaven.com for this list of targeting options.



PREMIUM SELECTS

Individual	Financial
Year of Birth	Credit Card Indicator
Month of Birth	Credit Card Users
Education Level	New Bank Card Issued
Occupation	Economic Stability Indicator
Number of Children	Discretionary Income Index
Exact Child Age	Net Worth
Investors	Wealth Personality
Ethnicity	Investment Types
Ethnic Country	Modeled Credit
Religion	
Voter Party Preference	Life Stages
Veteran	Recently Married
	Recently Divorced
	Expectant Parent
	New Parent
	Recent College Grad
	Empty Nester
	Single Parent
	Recent Mortgage Borrower
	Recent Home Buyer
	and many more...



APPENDIX: BUSINESS TARGETING OPTIONS.

BUSINESS DATA

BASIC BUSINESS INCLUDED SELECTS

Geography SIC

PLATINUM BUSINESS + INCLUDED SELECTS ♦ Best Value!

Geography Sales Volume Minority Owned

SIC Year Started

Employee Size HQ / Branch Indicator

Platinum Business+ also includes Multi-Use, Contacts & Phone Numbers

QUALITY RATIOS

Avg. Deliverability 90%

Delivery Guarantee 85%

9-Digit Zipped 100%

DPV Qualified 100%

Highest DPV Score 88%

Updated Monthly

AUTO DATA

INCLUDED SELECTS

Geography

Auto Make

Auto Model

Auto Year

Last Seen Date

Individual Age/Gender

Income

Marital Status

Presence of Children

PREMIUM SELECTS

VIN

Phone

Motorcycles

Email Append

Black Book Append

Blue Book Append

Engine Block

Engine Size

Engine Cylinders

QUALITY RATIOS

Avg. Deliverability 95%

Delivery Guarantee 92%

9-Digit Zipped 100%

DPV Qualified 100%

Highest DPV Score 99.7%

Updated Monthly



PREMIUM SELECTS

Business Detail

Exact Employee Size

Exact Sales Volume

Franchise Indicator

Cottage Industry

Import / Export Indicator

Owner's Ethnicity

Women Owned Indicator

Small Business Indicator

Gender of Contact

Legal Status

Owns / Rents Code

Public / Private Indicator

Square Footage

Subsidiary Indicator

Specialty

Franchise Name

UCC Filing Indicator

UCC Filing Date

UCC Secured Party

Commercial Credit Score

Financial Stress Score

Non-Profit Indication

Veteran Owned

Phones & Contacts

Phones

Fax Numbers

Contacts

Job Titles

Scout would like to thank MailersHaven.com for this list of targeting options.



APPENDIX: PROPERTY, NEW MOVER, SPECIALTY DATA.

REAL PROPERTY DATA

PREMIUM SELECTS

Individual
Age - Gender
Marital Status
Household Income
Presence & Age of Children
Loan
Loan to Value Range
2nd, 3rd Mortgage Indicator
Loan Date & Loan Amount
Interest Rate & Lender Type

Home
Owner Type
Housing Type
Home Purchase Date
Home Purchase Month
Home Purchase Amount
Available Home Equity
Home Market Value
Delinquent Tax Indicator
Delinquent Tax Year

Property Details
Square Footage
Number of Bedrooms
Number of Units
Year Built
Length of Residence
Fireplace or Garage
Pool
Heating & Cooling System
...and more!

QUALITY RATIOS

Avg. Deliverability95%
Delivery Guarantee92%
9-Digit Zipped100%
DPV Qualified100%
Highest DPV Score...99.7%
Updated.....Monthly

NEW MOVER/HOMEOWNER DATA

NEW MOVERS

Monthly New Mover Hotline
Weekly New Mover Hotline

NEW BORROWERS

Monthly New Borrower Hotline

NEW HOMEOWNERS

Monthly New Homeowner Hotline
Weekly New Homeowner Hotline

SPECIALTY MOVERS

Pre-Movers
New Home Constructions

Scout would like to thank
MailersHaven.com
for this list of targeting o
ptions.



SPECIALTY DATA

Medical - Physical & Mental

Ailment & Illness Sufferers
AMA Physicians
Chiropractors
Dentists
Doctors
Health Service Facilities
Hospital Personnel
Medical Office Managers
Nurses
Optometrists
Pharmacists
Physical Therapists
Podiatrists
Psychologists
Radiological Technologists
Veterinarians

Organizations & Agencies

Banks & Financial Institutions
Churches & Religious Orgs
Clubs & Organizations
Colleges and Universities
Fire Departments
Government Agencies

Professions

Accountants & CPAs
Home Occupation
Architectural Firms & Execs
Business Executives
Social Workers
Corporate Meeting Planners
Financial Analysts
Insurance Agents
Investment Advisors
Judges
Lawyers
Occupational Therapists
Pilots
Real Estate Brokers
Venture Capital Execs

Other

Aircraft & Boat Owners
Credit Scores
Pay Advances
Political Donors
Tax Liens
Truck Owners
And More...

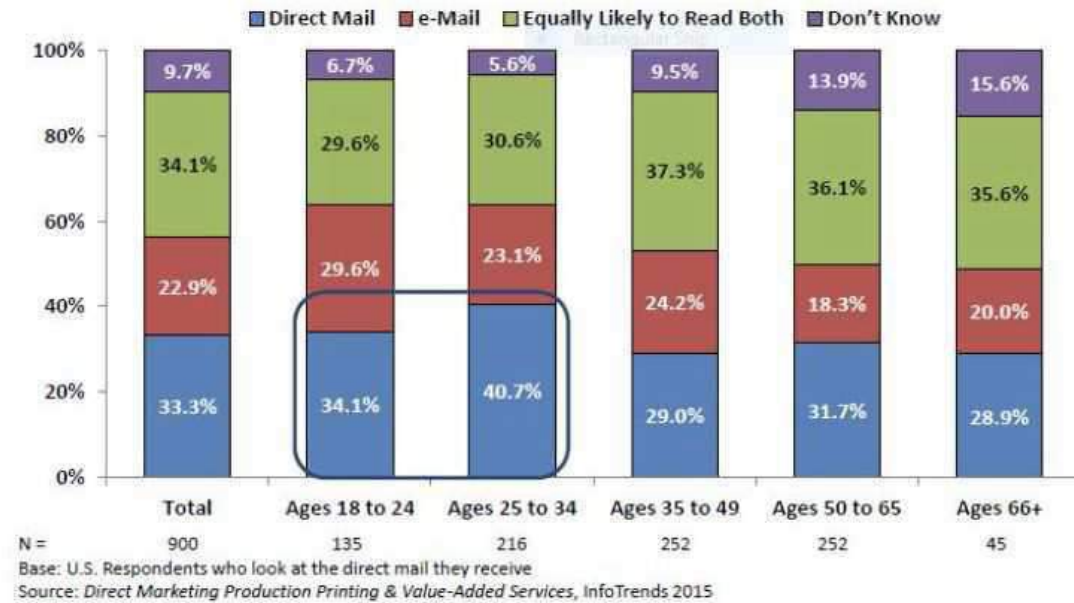
[APPENDIX: 74 POSTCARD EXAMPLES \(Google Drive\)](#)

APPENDIX: Postcard Statistics



And Consumers Still Like Direct Mail!

Are you more likely to read an e-mail with a sales/promotional offer OR look at a piece of direct mail?



Consumers Like Mail!

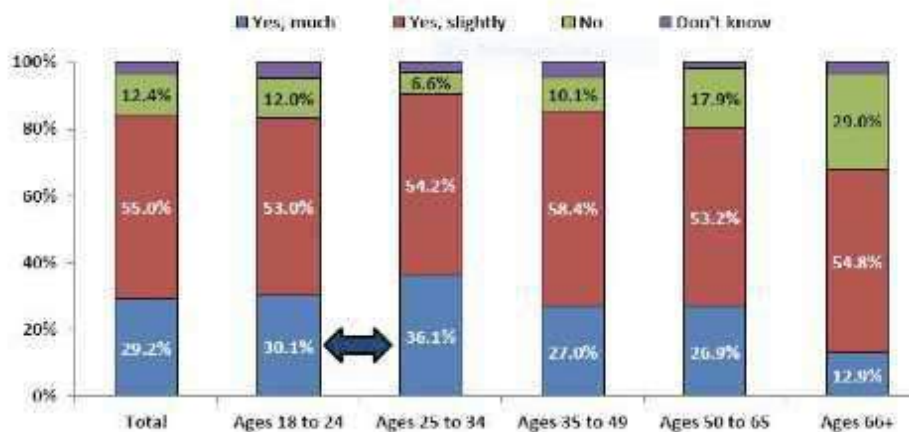


- Mean number of direct mail pieces received in past week:
 - 3.5 letters in envelopes
 - 2.4 flyers/pamphlets
 - 1.9 brochures
 - 1.3 postcards
- 66% of direct mail is opened
- 82% of direct mail is read for a minute or more

Source: Direct Marketing Production Printing & Value-Added Services, InfoTrends 2015

It Needs to Be Personalized

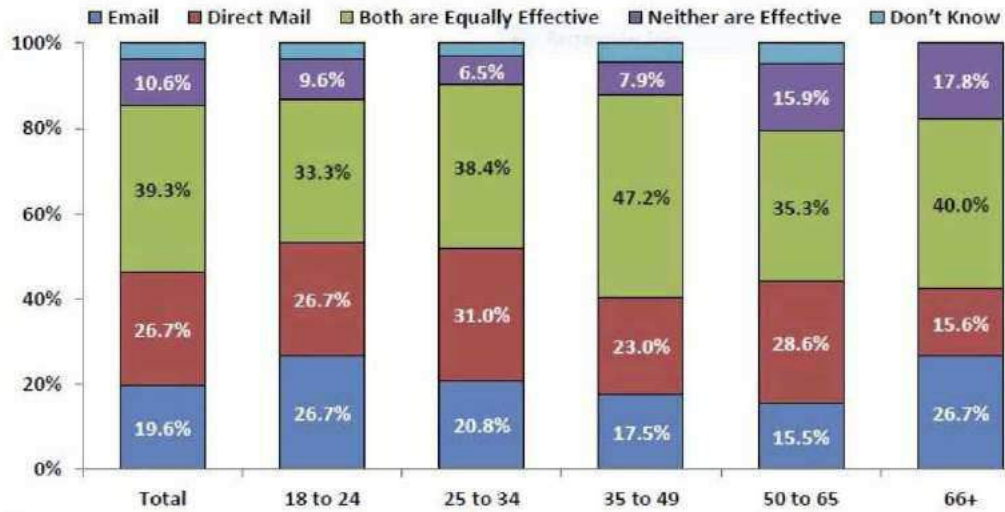
Does the customization of a direct mail piece make you more likely to open/read it?



N = 614
 Base: U.S. Respondents who receive direct mail that reflects a high level of customization
 Source: Direct Marketing Production Printing & Value-Added Services, InfoTrends 2015

Direct Mail Drives Action

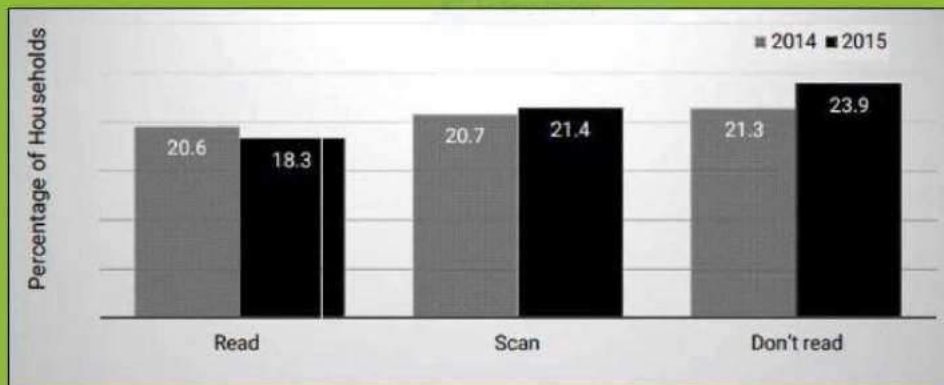
In your opinion, which is more effective at getting you to take action, e-mail or direct mail?



N = 900 135 216 252 252 45
 Base: U.S. Respondents who look at the direct mail they receive
 Source: Direct Marketing Production Printing & Value-Added Services, InfoTrends 2015

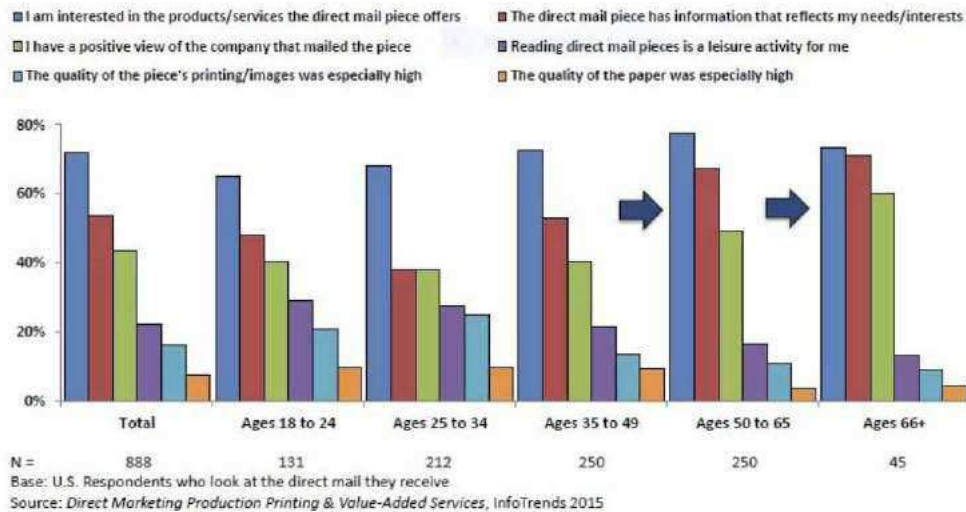
DMA | Educate

Shifts in Direct Mail Engagement



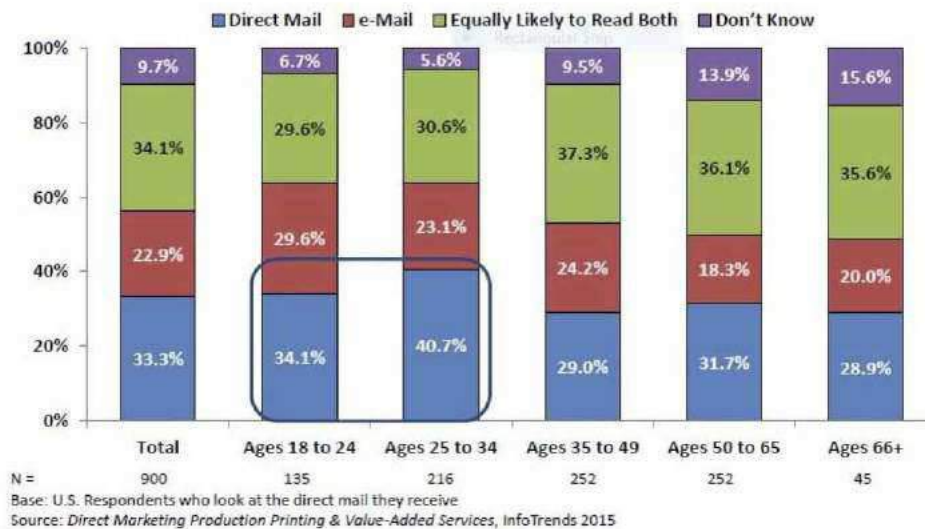
It Needs to Be Relevant

For which of the following reasons have you chosen to open direct mail?



And Consumers Still Like Direct Mail!

Are you more likely to read an e-mail with a sales/promotional offer OR look at a piece of direct mail?



Shifts in Direct Mail Formats

Source: Direct Mail Business, 2015

Shape	1987	2014	2015
Letter-size envelope	1.8	3.5	3.5
Larger envelope	1.3	0.3	0.2
Total Envelope	3.1	3.8	3.7
Detached label card	0.6	0.1	0.1
Postcard	0.2	0.2	0.2
Catalog (not in envelope)	1.5	1.3	1.2
Flyers/circulars	2.1	3.5	3.4
Magazines/newsletters	0.2	0.3	0.3
Other/don't know/no answer	0.1	0.1	0.0
Total Pieces Received per Household	7.8	9.2	8.9

The Best Drive Omni-Channel Value



TREATMENT OF STANDARD MAIL (A) PIECE BY SHAPE
AS PERCENTAGE OF MAIL PIECES RECEIVED BY HOUSEHOLDS

Treatment	Letter-Sized Envelope		Larger than Letter Envelope		Detached Label Postcard		Postcard	
	2012	2013	2012	2013	2012	2013	2012	2013
Read by member of household	33.2	32.7	39.9	41.1	30.8	24.7	55.9	50.5
Read by more than one member of household	4.2	4.0	8.2	7.3	3.0	4.7	10.3	7.2

Treatment	Catalog not enclosed in Envelope		Flyers		Newspapers/ Magazines		Total*	
	2012	2013	2012	2013	2012	2013	2012	2013
Read	33.0	34.1	34.3	36.4	35.8	32.4	35.3	34.7
Read by more than one member of household	11.0	9.9	16.7	8.5	13.7	16.0	7.6	7.1

Source: USPS Household Diary Study, 2014.

*Total includes pieces for which no response was given as to shape.

STANDARD MAIL (A) BY SHAPE

Postal Years 1987, 2012 and 2013 (Number of Pieces)

Shape	1987	2012	2013
Letter-Size Envelope	1.8	3.5	3.5
Larger Envelope	1.3	0.2	0.2
Total Envelope	3.1	3.7	3.7
Detached Label Card	0.6	0.1	0.1
Postcard	0.2	0.2	0.2
Catalog (Not in Envelope)	1.5	1.4	1.3
Flyers/Circulars	2.1	3.2	3.3
Magazines/Newsletters	0.2	0.3	0.2
Other/Don't know/No answer	0.1	0.1	0.1
Total Pieces Received per Household	7.8	8.9	8.9

Source: USPS Household Diary Study, 2014.

Send Personalized Direct Mail at Scale to Land High-Ticket Clients

Credit: [Leo Gamayunov](#), President and Co-Founder at TTBA Group

Looking to increase your direct sales conversion?

Looking for creative ways to stand out from the competition and warm the prospects?

I'm Leo - co-founder of TTBA Group (ttbagroup.com) digital marketing agency based in Montreal, Canada. We recently launched a warming campaign to help our direct sales efforts. It worked like a charm, hopefully, you could take advantage of it, too.

Most of the people here disregard direct mail initiatives, due to its cost inefficiency and low open rates. However, if you spin it right, you can trigger personal emotions of particular targeted individuals in the firm.

Personalized direct letter with a humorous touch.

1. Collect the list of potential companies in your neighborhood (now we are going with segmented niches) that you'd like to work with.
2. Using LinkedIn, find the names and the positions of two of the main decision makers in the company (ex: CEO and a Marketing director).
3. Buy slick eye-catching envelopes
4. Buy preferably expensive chocolate that is packaged in small pieces (we used "Swiss")
5. Buy packs of painkillers (Advil, Tylenol, etc) preferably, so pills are sealed and packaged separately
6. Write up a personalized letter template to each decision maker of the company (you can use our copy):

"Dear John,

we understand how big of a headache Marketing can be for a business. In this envelope, you will find an Advil to ease the pain in the short term.

We sent the same letter to your marketing manager - Steve.

We enclosed a chocolate in your letters so you can take a coffee break together and discuss a marketing approach that makes both your jobs easier in the long-run.

Meanwhile, we wanted to say hello to our neighbors. You might have seen us working late in the "aquarium-like" corner office on St. Patrick. :)



If you need assistance in understanding how to turn positive ROI from Marketing this year, we are already brewing some coffee.

Leo

Co-founder & COO"

7. Put the letter in the envelope along with a chocolate and a painkiller

8. Send it out

The nice part about this approach is that you are sending two letters to two people in the same company. They will talk about it - you sparked a conversation.

Wait 1-2 weeks to receive inbound calls or emails.

Follow up with decision makers to introduce yourself officially, mention your letter in a humorous way. You will be surprised how many people will appreciate the creative outreach and agree to give you some of their precious time, at least to hear what you have to say.

Results:

100% of people who received the letter remembered it and talked about it internally.

90% of people who received this letter were really impressed with the approach.

About 5% of the people found the pill part offensive, but probably that's because we saved on costs and bought the pills that were not separately packaged - looks a bit sketchy :)

10% of the companies scheduled a meeting with us in the same month.

10% of those meetings were closed.

If you are looking for creative ways to stand out and impress a strong account, this tactic should help.





VIRTUAL ASSISTANTS



The Growth Hacker's Guide to
Using Virtual Assistants with
MixMax

Josh Fechter 210

The Growth Hacker's Guide to Using Virtual Assistants with Mixmax

Credit: [Josh Fechter](#), Co-Founder of [BAMF.Media](#)

Imagine if every week you spoke at a conference, hosted an event in front of hundreds of entrepreneurs, and had someone interview you at their conference.

You'd be a lead generating machine.

Most of us don't do this.

Why?

Few of us have the time to research opportunities and send many personalized emails to land them. In turn, most growth hackers don't consider this a realistic traction channel.

What if you could have these opportunities fill up your schedule without putting in time?

You'd remove a huge amount of stress and save yourself countless hours every month to growth hack.

To make it happen, you need virtual assistants.

Working with virtual assistants requires a strong, detailed-oriented personality with an understanding of how to create process frameworks for others to copy.

Rather than have you start from scratch, here's the virtual assistant framework I use to speak at conferences, host interviews, get podcast opportunities, and help build one of the largest communities of [marketers and founders](#):

Find Anyone's Email

If you want your virtual assistant to contact people, then you need their emails. It used to be a complex process to find someone's email, but with growth-hacking email tools it's easier than ever.

Here are the four email finder tools your virtual assistant needs to use:



Clearbit:

Pros: Clearbit provides the most accurate emails, syncs with your Gmail, and is free for up to one hundred email credits/month.

Elucify:

Pros: A free and crowdsourced database for business contact information. Find unlimited emails.

FindThatLead:

Pros: High deliverability rate, efficient at-scale scraping, saves time.

Contactout:

Pros: Free Chrome extension that can find Gmail emails and even phone numbers from LinkedIn profiles.

Start Scraping

To get your VA to start scraping profiles, provide them your defined customer avatar. For example, I target people who live in San Francisco with the job title of CMO, head of growth, or VP of marketing. Findthatlead is rather simple, so they can plug-in the attributes you want and retrieve thousands of email addresses within minutes.

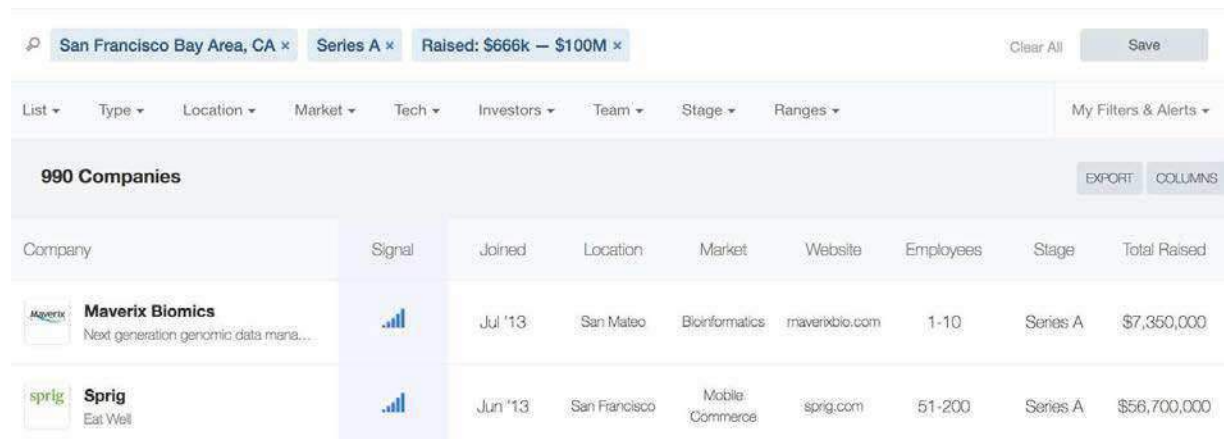
What if we're looking for attributes FindThatLead doesn't have?

These metrics might include the company's funding round and raised capital amount. In this case, you want your virtual assistant to use Angellist and LinkedIn Sales Navigator search.

I explain to my VA that these people should be in a growing company preferably about to receive their A or B round.

When you have your customer details laid out, there are two ways to approach getting their email via Contactout. As an example, let's say you want to reach people from companies in San

Francisco in a Series A and have raised significant money.



San Francisco Bay Area, CA × Series A × Raised: \$666k — \$100M ×									Clear All	Save
List ▾	Type ▾	Location ▾	Market ▾	Tech ▾	Investors ▾	Team ▾	Stage ▾	Ranges ▾	My Filters & Alerts ▾	
990 Companies									EXPORT	COLUMNS
Company	Signal	Joined	Location	Market	Website	Employees	Stage	Total Raised		
 Maverix Biomics Next generation genomic data mana...		Jul '13	San Mateo	Bioinformatics	maverixbio.com	1-10	Series A	\$7,350,000		
 Sprig Eat Well		Jun '13	San Francisco	Mobile Commerce	sprig.com	51-200	Series A	\$56,700,000		

After you know your target companies, then you can find them on LinkedIn to identify the key employees you want to contact. I highly suggest this approach if you're looking for a curated list industry influencers to message.

Here's an Upwork job post example I've used successfully to get the contact information of one thousand highly targeted individuals combining AngelList and LinkedIn data mining.

Data Entry

Posted 13 hours ago


Fixed Price


\$150
 Budget

\$\$ Intermediate Level
 I am looking for a mix of
 experience and value

Details

Hi,

I need you to go through this Angellist URL and create a Spreadsheet of all the founders with their LinkedIn URLs, company domain, company name, job title, first name, and last name. I also need use to do this for CMO and VP of marketing for the company (you'll find these people searching on LinkedIn):

[https://angel.co/companies?locations\[\]=151282-San+Francisco+Bay+Area&stage\[\]=Series+B&stage\[\]=Series+A&company_types\[\]=Early+Stage&company_types\[\]=VC+Firm&company_types\[\]=Startup](https://angel.co/companies?locations[]=151282-San+Francisco+Bay+Area&stage[]=Series+B&stage[]=Series+A&company_types[]=Early+Stage&company_types[]=VC+Firm&company_types[]=Startup)

Here's an example output: <https://docs.google.com/spreadsheets/d/13UJ1-DiIUwmhGfl-30YNTaRik92kLXFbipvhjrSpURc/edit?usp=sharing>

I'm expecting around 1000 people in total.

I'm hoping to get this done in three days.

Project Type: One-time project

Now have your VA pulls prospects' emails through using the Contactout. If the people who you're trying to contact come up with undeliverable emails, then try Elucify to find their correct email. Once you log-in to Elucify, finding an email is as simple as plugging in their company name, then seeing if your target prospect shows up as an employee.



UBER

Uber
uber.com

5001-10,000 employees

\$100M+ funding

California West Coast, USA

Web Technologies used at Uber

pagerduty

Filter leads by title keywords...

Top Leadership

Carolina Randazzo	VP Recruiter		carolina@uber.com	87%
Robert Dunnette	Vice President		rdunnette@uber.com	88%

What if you still can't find your prospect's email address?

Download the [Clearbit Chrome extension](#). The Chrome extension provides up to one hundred email validation searches every month. Once you download it, click on the Clearbit icon on the bottom of your email drafts. If you're using Mixmax, then you'll have to turn off the extension to see this icon.

New Message

To

Subject

Josh Fechter
Growth Evangelist, Autopilot

Autopilot. 589 Howard Street, Second Floor, San Francisco, CA, 94105. +1(800)714-9546

Join my Facebook Group of over 7000+ marketers and founders

Send

Plugin the desired company, then start searching for the desired employee.



digitalmarketer

	DigitalMarketer	digitalmarketer.com
	DigitalMarketer	trafficandconversionsummit.c...
	DigitalMarketer	blackfridaybootcamp.com
	DigitalMarketer.id	digitalmarketer.id
	Digital Marketer	digitalmarketer.co.za

As soon as you click on an employee or founder, you've used one email credit.





Email Ryan



Ryan Deiss

CEO, digitalmarketer.COM // founder,
nativecommerce.COM

Email

ryan@digitalmarketer.com

Location

Austin, TX, US

Site

digitalmarketer.com

Social


What if you want the best of both worlds - bulk processing and deliverable emails for a highly targeted list of contacts in your Google Sheets?

Once your VA fills out the necessary columns for extracting an email (First Name, Last Name, Company Domain), you can pull thousands of individual emails at once using the [FindThatLead](#) Google Sheet Add-on. Match the right columns, click "Find emails," and you're ready to go.

More

FindThatLead Email Finder

Guess Email

Prospection tool

First Name Column

A

Last Name Column

B

Domain Name Column

C

☒ My table has headers

Your API KEY

Get api key

Find emails

Need Help?

Each row processed cost 1 credit, you can see our pricing and credits per plan [here](#)

F	G
Job Title	source :
Co-Founder	
VP of Marketing	
Founder	
Founder & CEO	
CTO and Cofounder	
Co-Founder	
Co-Founder, Head of Engineering	
Co-Founder, VP of Engineering	
Founder & CEO	
Co Founder	
Co-Founder	
Co-founder & CEO	
Co-Founder/CTO	
Founder, Chairman, and CEO	
Founder	
Founder	

Now that your VA knows how to contact prospects using email, teach them how to contact industry influencers using LinkedIn. There are two ways to do this:

1. Connect with them on LinkedIn as a friend with a personalized message

Connect Invitation

Personalize your invitation to Coco

Coco Lee

3rd

Head of Growth at Fiedgg

San Mateo, California | E-Learning

Hey Coco,

I noticed your background in growth and consulting. You seem to have a strong understand of startups and business frameworks. Would you be interested in a live interview in front of my community of 10,000+ marketers & founders?

—Josh

Send Invitation

Cancel

BADASS MARKETERS
AND FOUNDERS
BAMF

218

If they accept your connection request, there's a high chance they didn't see the personalized message because of LinkedIn's interface. It's almost impossible to notice. Take a look:



2. Follow-up with a message as soon as they accept to ensure they see it.



If you still can't get their attention, then it's time to send follow-up LinkedIn messages and emails to get a reply. Sometimes it takes eight or nine messages for top industry influencers to respond to you.

Never Check Your Email Again

You're finding emails like a pro. You're almost ready to get your VA to start scheduling meetings. First, you must lay down the laws. If you never want to have a meeting before 11 a.m. or after a certain time on Wednesday or Friday, then make it known to them.

I book two types of meetings:

1. 15-minutes long

This meeting is for quick briefings to avoid exchanging five or six emails.

2. 45-minutes long

This meeting is for podcasts and hosting interviews.

I never (not even one time) book in-person meetings where someone requests to take me to coffee or pick my brain. None of these meetings have proved fruitful for me.

When you email the recipient an open date for a 45-minute meeting, ensure you can book an open room for that date. To understand how to set up rooms in Gmail, here's an [excellent how-to blog post](#).

Then, click the room to add it. Also, make sure to add the guest's email and - if needed - an assistant or videographer's email, so they get notified about the event.



←

SAVE

Discard

Jan <> Josh

2/3/2017

1:00pm

to

2:00pm

2/3/2017

Time zone

☐ All day
☐ Repeat...

Event details

Find a time

Where

589 Howard St, Second Floor, San Francisco, CA 94105

Video call

Join meeting: josh

Change name | Remove

Calendar

Josh Fechter

Description

Jan: 619.476.9444

Josh: 619.944.0697

-Interview via live stream.

-Talk about growth hacking.

Attachment

Add attachment

Guests

Rooms

Search rooms

☒ Show available rooms only

Suggested rooms

Nancy Bird Walton (SF)

SF Phone Booth 1

Alan Shepard (SF)

Nancy Bird Walton (SF)

Sally Ride (Sydney)

SF Office Town Hall

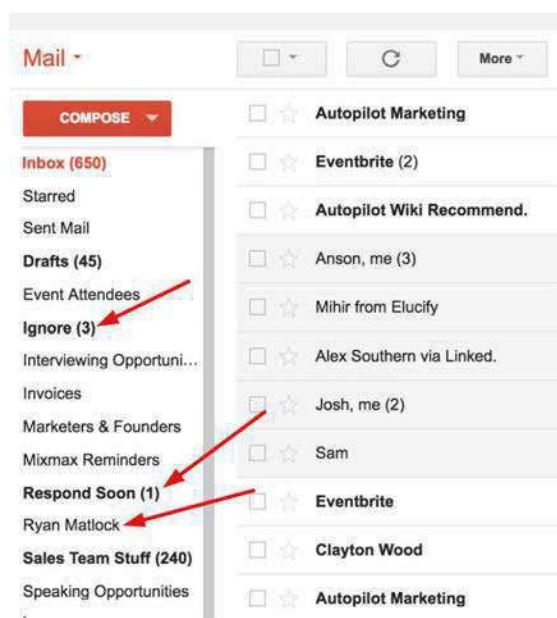
SF Phone Booth 1

SF Phone Booth 2

Try to book back-to-back meetings. This way you can set a harsh deadline for yourself to get things done faster and it reduces the context switching from having a five or fifteen-minute break between phone calls. When filling out the description, make sure to include both parties' contact details and a few notes detailing the conversation to take place.

Once your VA understands how to book rooms, they need to set up and use labels as a way to organize your inbox. My favorite label is "ignore". These emails include anything that doesn't provide value to me. I never check it.

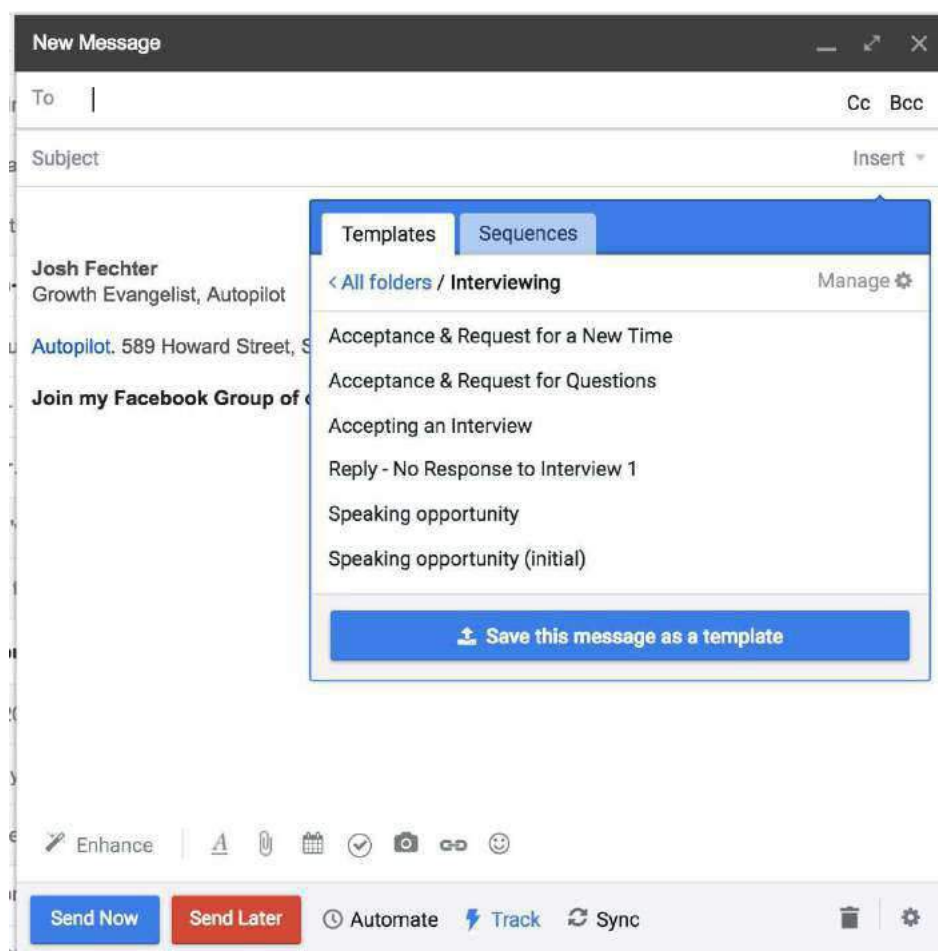
With that said, I balance this label out with the one "Respond Soon".



I also keep a tab for my videographer because I shoot around twenty videos every month. This way I can stay in constant communication with him.

If you're looking to book speaking, guest posting, or podcast opportunities, then create a label for each. For company inquiries, I have a dedicated label "Marketers & Founders."

I use Mixmax for more complex tasks, including sending, tracking, scheduling, and using follow-ups. If I'm sending a one-time template, then I'll use the Mixmax templates feature which buckets them in folders.



With one click, I can insert a template. For most emails you send, you want to schedule a reminder if they don't reply or open. Use Mixmax's "Set Reminder" feature to ensure you stay in contact with someone even if they don't respond.

You were referred to Marketers & Founders

benexample123@gmail.com

You were referred to Marketers & Founders

Insert

Set Reminder

Schedule Follow-up

Customize

ADD NOTE

Enter an optional note

SET TIME AND TRIGGER

Presets

In 2 hours

In 4 hours

Tomorrow morning

Tomorrow evening

In 2 days

In 1 week

March 2017

Su	Mo	Tu	We	Th	Fr	Sa
26	27	28	1	2	3	4
5	6	7	8	9	10	11
12	13	14	15	16	17	18
19	20	21	22	23	24	25
26	27	28	29	30	31	1
2	3	4	5	6	7	8

If no reply

by

In 2 days

Remove X

Remove this reminder

Send Now

Send Later

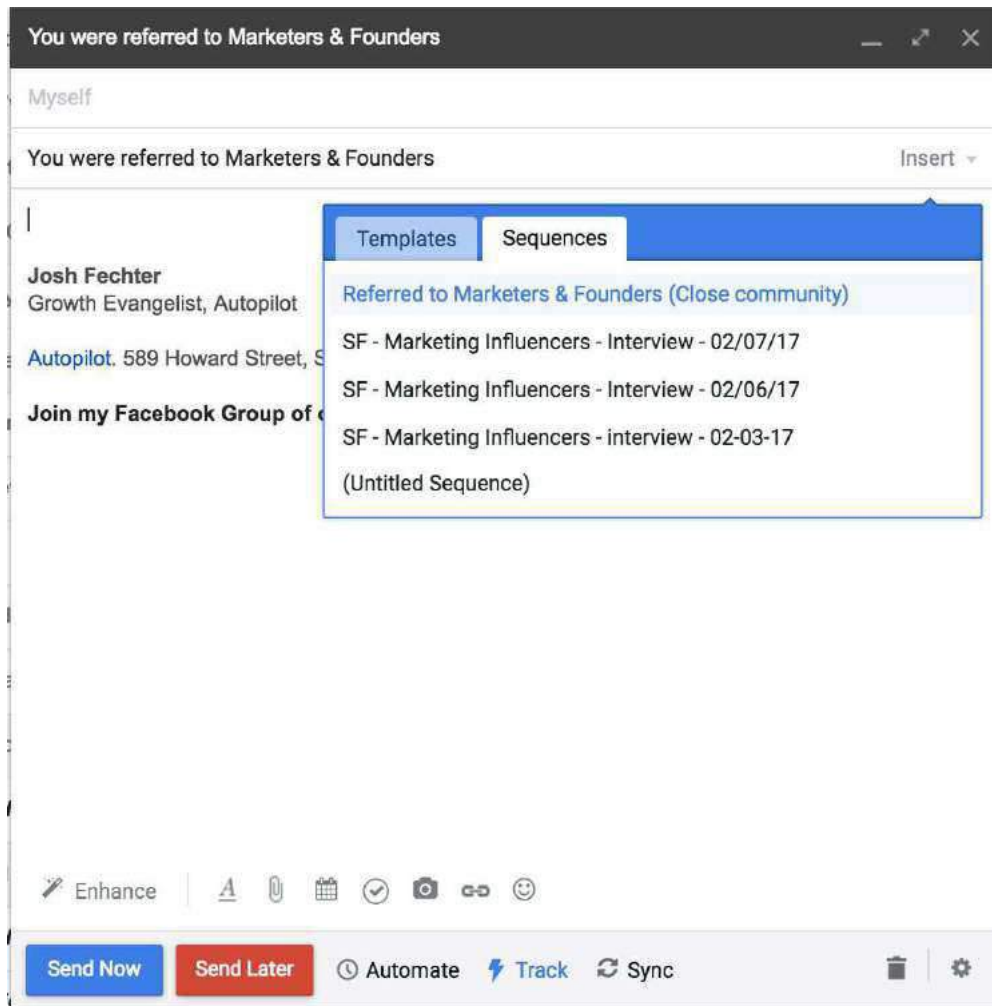
Automate

Track

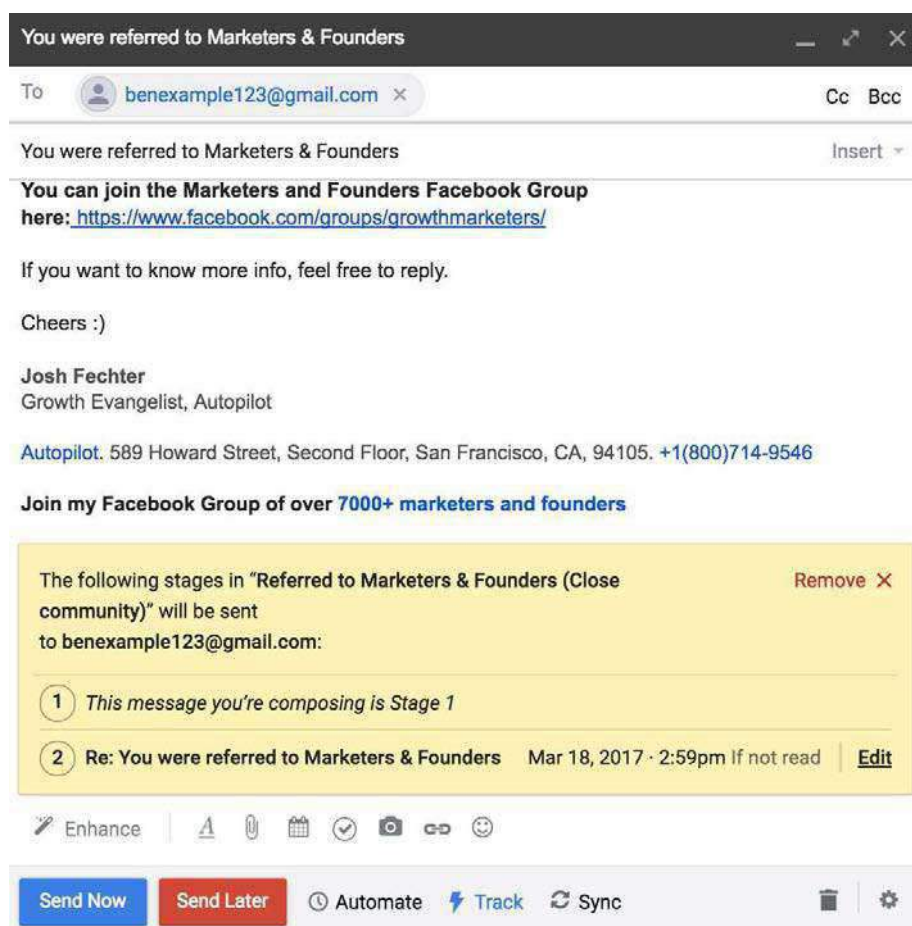
Sync

Sending one email is not ideal if you're reaching out to influencers where you'd need to send several follow-ups to get their attention. For this case, I use Mixmax's sequence feature.

If you've set up a sequence of emails, you can easily add someone to it. Just click sequence and select the one you want to use.



After you create your sequence, you'll see it pop up in your email. If you don't remember how it's designed, Mixmax provides you the exact details of your sequence at the bottom of your email.

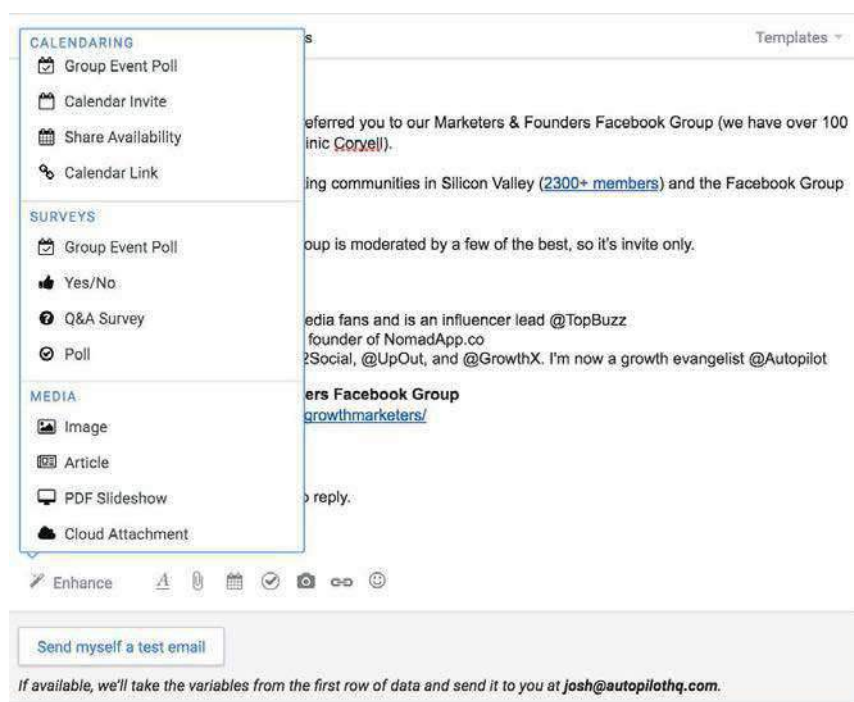


If you know the copy you want to use, creating sequences and templates in Mixmax takes seconds.



My favorite part of Mixmax templates and sequences is the option to enrich your emails with numerous media touch points (i.e. GIFs, link previews, and more), calendar invites, and even surveys.





Before you jump ahead and begin shooting off sequences, ensure to take advantage of Mixmax's in-email scheduling feature. Mixmax gives you the ability to send a personalized link to someone so they can schedule a time on your calendar with a few clicks.

Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri
20	21	22	23	24
11:00am–11:15am PDT 15min	10:00am–10:15am PDT 15min	10:00am–10:15am PDT 15min	10:00am–10:15am PDT 15min	10:00am–10:15am PDT 15min
11:15am–11:30am PDT 15min	10:15am–10:30am PDT 15min	10:15am–10:30am PDT 15min	10:15am–10:30am PDT 15min	10:15am–10:30am PDT 15min
11:30am–11:45am PDT 15min	10:30am–10:45am PDT 15min	10:30am–10:45am PDT 15min	10:30am–10:45am PDT 15min	10:30am–10:45am PDT 15min

Never again use your precious time to book a meeting. Send the recipient your link, and you're good to go.

When setting up your calendar, you can block times and have immediate inputs. For example, I have the inputs "Reason?" and "Your Phone #:". I use these inputs to get my email recipients to fill in their reason of connection. It saves me a ton of time trying to remember why I set up the meeting.



A screenshot of a calendar event creation form. The form has the following fields: 'Name' (empty), 'Email' (empty), 'When' (set to 'March 23, 10:00am-10:15am PDT PDT'), 'Title' (set to 'Reason?'), and 'Location' (set to 'Your Phone #:'). At the bottom left is a blue button labeled 'Pick this time', and at the bottom right is a button labeled 'Cancel'. Below the form, a blue bar shows the current time as '10:45am-11:00am PDT'.

Mastering Cold Outreach with a 40% Reply Rate

Mixmax and email finding tools are only as powerful as your email copy. You can have the emails of everyone in the world, but without copy that pulls your prospect's attention, you'll lose. I don't expect you to master cold email copy overnight, so here are the templates I use for outreach.

Here's the email sequence I use to land speakers:

Email 1:

Subject: Speaking opportunity

"Hey {{First Name}},

I love the work you've done for {{Company}}.

I happen to run one of the largest marketers and founders communities in Silicon Valley ([2300+ members](#)) and an active [7500+ member](#) Facebook Group.

As a growth evangelist who hosts close to seventy events a year ranging in attendance from 200 - 700 people, I'm always looking for knowledgeable speakers and people crushing it in tech such as yourself.

I think you'd make a perfect fit.



Here's an example of one of our previous speaking events:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t4gYdeVpGLU>

Do you have fifteen minutes free in the next week to talk about a speaking opportunity?

***Please select a time on my calendar here:** <https://cal.mixmax.com/joshfechter>*

Looking forward to hearing back from you.

Cheers,"

Email 2:

No subject: Email reply

Hey {{First Name}},

I just wanted to ensure you saw this email from the other day.

I love the work you've done for {{Company}}.

I happen to run one of the largest marketers and founders communities in Silicon Valley ([2300+ members](#)) and an active [7500+ member](#) Facebook Group.

As a growth evangelist who hosts close to seventy events a year ranging in attendance from 200 - 700 people, I'm always looking for knowledgeable speakers. I think you'd make a perfect fit.

Here's an example of one of our previous speaking events:

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t4gYdeVpGLU>

Do you have fifteen minutes free in the next week to talk about a speaking opportunity?

***Please select a time on my calendar here:** <https://cal.mixmax.com/joshfechter>*

Excited to talk about the opportunity.

Cheers,"

Email 3:



No subject: Email reply

"Hey {{First Name}},

Following up on my previous two emails.

I'm wondering if you'd be interested in an interview in front of a couple of hundred people in San Francisco. It will be epic! :)

I run one of the largest marketers and founders communities in Silicon Valley ([2300+ members](#)) and an active [7500+ member](#) Facebook Group.

In case you missed it, here's an example of one of our previous speaking events:
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t4gYdeVpGIU>

Do you have fifteen minutes free in the next week to talk about a speaking opportunity?

Feel free to select a time on my calendar here: <https://cal.mixmax.com/joshfechter>

Talk soon.

Cheers,"

Email 4:

No subject: Email reply

"Hey {{First Name}},

I'm persistent, so here I am in your inbox again asking you to speak in front of a couple of hundred entrepreneurs in San Francisco.

I run one of the largest marketers and founders communities in Silicon Valley ([2300+ members](#)) and an active [7500+ member](#) Facebook Group.

I want you to speak at the event because you're crushing it in tech. More importantly, I think my audience could benefit from your advice and stories :)

Here's an example of one of our previous speaking events (if you haven't watched it yet):
<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=t4gYdeVpGIU>



Do you have fifteen minutes free in the next week to talk about a speaking opportunity?

Feel free to select a time on my calendar here: <https://cal.mixmax.com/joshfechter>

Cheers,

When someone responds to my email asking for interview questions, I respond with this template:

Acceptance and Request for Questions (time works):

No subject: Email reply

"[First name]

Perfect. I attached the questions. Feel free to change them up to your liking.

What's the best number to reach you?

[Questions attached as a Google Drive file]"

Land Your Speaking Opportunity:

Email 1:

Subject: Speaking opportunity

"Hey {{first}}

I love the work you've done as [job title] for [name of event]. Congrats on [recent publicity or milestone].

I'm reaching out to save you the effort of looking for speakers.

As a conference that focuses on [X] and [Y], I think I could benefit your event with my expertise. Moreover, I'd help promote it to my audience.



I happen to run one of the largest marketers and founders communities in Silicon Valley (2300+ members) and an active 7500+ member Facebook Group. I was named top growth hacker for 2016 and have given speeches [here], [here], and [here].

Moreover, I was the head of growth for the first company to live stream on Facebook, 22Social; an events subscription company, UpOut; and a 50-million-dollar venture capital firm, GrowthX.

I'm currently the growth evangelist for Autopilot (one of the youngest tech evangelist at twenty-five years old) and an adviser to a few profitable startups.

Do you have fifteen minutes free in the next week to talk about a speaking opportunity?

How about [date & time]?

Looking forward to hearing back from you.

Cheers,"

Jump on a Podcast:

Subject: Speaking opportunity

"Hey {{first}}

I love the work you've done as the [job title] for [name of podcast]. Congrats on [recent publicity or milestone].

I'm reaching out to save you the effort of looking for people to interview.

I happen to run one of the largest marketers and founders communities in Silicon Valley (2300+ members) and an active 7500+ member Facebook Group. I was named top growth hacker for 2016 and have been featured on these podcasts:

- 1.
- 2.
- 3.



Moreover, I was the head of growth for the first company to live stream on Facebook, 22Social; an events subscription company, UpOut; and a 50-million-dollar venture capital firm, GrowthX.

Do you have fifteen minutes free in the next week to talk about a podcast interview opportunity?

How about [date & time]?

Looking forward to hearing back from you.

Cheers,"

Get Those Backlinks from Guest Posting

For guest posting, I never reach out to the editor. I reach out to many high-level friends to see where they have connections. I've found this tactic to triple my response rate from high-level publications.

Subject: What do you think about this?

"Hey {{first}}

As someone who reads and appreciates my work, I wanted to give you a heads up on this article I want to use for a guest post:

Here it is: [Link to guest post]

Please don't share this with anyone. Let's keep these [benefits] a secret for now.

I was wondering if you know a great publication to guest post this piece on?

I'm looking for a perfect fit because - as you know - I put in a ton of time into my content to help people. If you have any suggestions for or connections to cool publishers that'd be super helpful.

Let me know if you need anything.

Cheers,

Josh"

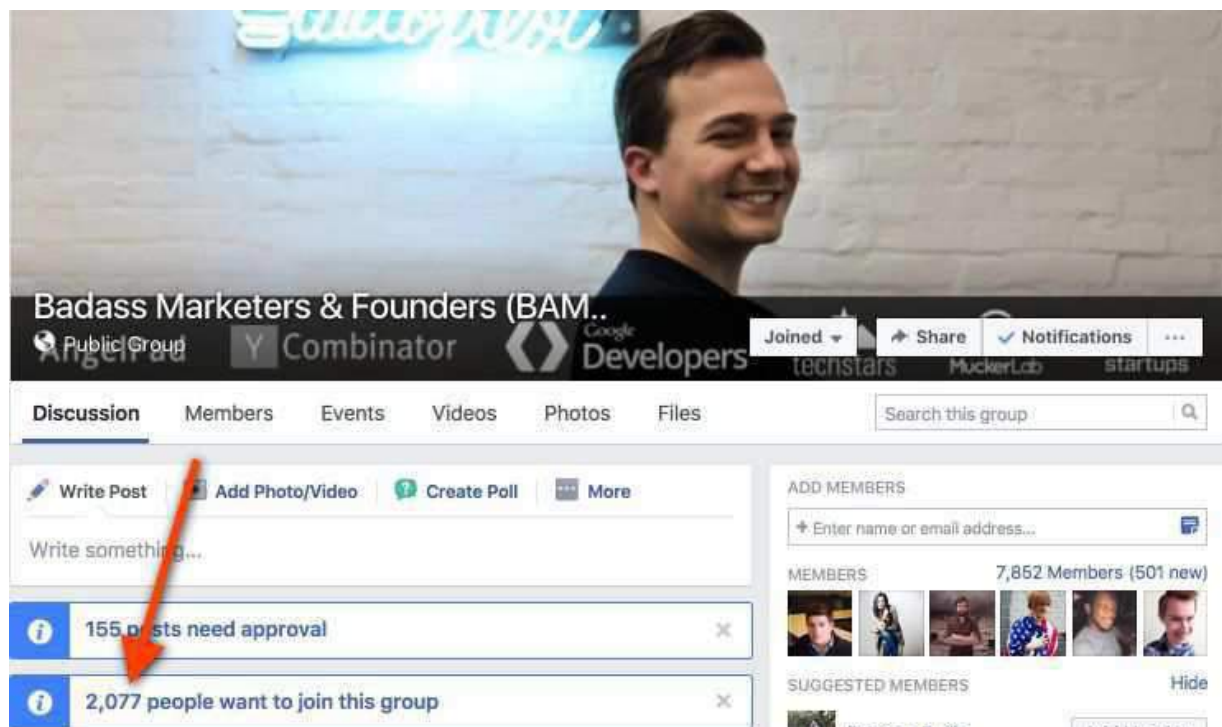


Facebook Group Outsourcing:

One of the most annoying tasks I began outsourcing is approving people into my Facebook Group. It takes a significant amount of my time because I look at each person's LinkedIn profile to ensure they'd add value to my community.

I ask a virtual assistant to do it. I give them a set criteria of people to accept based on these attributes:

1. Job title
2. City they're from
3. Years of experience
4. School(s) they attended
5. Accelerators mentioned
6. Publications featured in
7. Whether they work for a software company



No more Facebook Group member checking.



It feels great.

Grow Your Tribe Faster With Email

To increase my Facebook Group membership, I use Mixmax to reach out to people based on their membership in another tight-knit, startup community. For example, if they're in an accelerator, then I'll send them a cold email mentioning their accelerator.

All Companies

DONE DEALS

RETURNS

BROWSE ALL

Y Combinator x

Clear All

Save

List ▾

Type ▾

Location ▾

Market ▾

Tech ▾

Investors ▾

Team ▾

Stage ▾

Ranges ▾

My Filters & Alerts ▾

602 Companies

EXPORT

COLUMNS

Company	Signal	Joined	Location	Market	Website	Employees	Stage	Total Raised
 Fivetran Data pipeline as a service		Mar '15	San Francisco	Data Integration	fivetran.com	1-10	-	-
 Trackin Software for food delivery (YC W15) ...		Mar '15	San Francisco	Local Businesses	gotrackin.com	1-10	-	-

To get their emails at scale with little work, I get a VA to use both Angellist and LinkedIn to extract their contact details into a Google Sheet, then ask them to use Google Sheet Add-ons like those of FindThatLead and Clearbit to extract their emails.

The next step is to ask a member from one of these communities to vouch for your Facebook Group. I use their vouch as a testimonial in my email copy. Here's a direct message I'll send to someone in my Facebook Group to get this testimonial:

"Hey John,

I wanted to reach out because I've been talking to many people from Y Combinator. Is it cool if I mentioned there are other Y Combinator members in my group such as yourself?"

Once they say, "Yes," I start sending cold emails to my list of Y Combinator people asking them to join my Facebook Group. All I do is download the CSV file of contact info with emails, then upload it into a new Mixmax Sequence.

Here's the cold email template I use:

Subject: You were referred to Marketers & Founders

"Hey Francis,

One of our members from Y Combinator referred you to our Marketers & Founders Facebook Group (we have over 100 alumni from Y Combinator, including [insert testimonial name]).

I happen to run one of the largest marketing communities in Silicon Valley ([2300+ members](#)) and the Facebook Group ([7500+ members](#)).

The Marketers & Founders Facebook Group is moderated by a few of the best, so it's invite only.

Our moderators:

- 1. Aj Cartas, has 1.2 million social media fans and is an influencer lead @TopBuzz*
- 2. Juan Campos, growth hacker and founder of NomadApp.co*
- 3. Me :) Past head of growth for @22Social, @UpOut, and @GrowthX. I'm now a growth evangelist @Autopilot*

You can join the Marketers and Founders Facebook Group here:

<https://www.facebook.com/groups/growthmarketers/>

If you want to know more info, feel free to reply.

Cheers,"

This template works wonders. The join rate from a cold email when using a Mixmax Sequence to send this email and a follow-up is 20%. If I send enough emails, I can get several hundred founders and entrepreneurs from Y Combinator into my Facebook Group in one day. That's powerful.

Just imagine doing this for the many other accelerator programs, too!

Run Through the Finish Line

The hardest part of using a virtual assistant for Mixmax outreach is starting. It's another way to re-invest in your career from the perspective of time; however, it's difficult if you're not used to creating processes for others to copy.



What do you assign to a virtual assistant?

If you think you'll do a task more than several times, the chances are you should outsource it, especially if includes these variables:

1. You don't enjoy it
2. Your project requires data entry and research
3. You can create a process to make it replicable
4. You can hire someone for less than what you get paid

When you take these variables into consideration, think of the many projects you can start outsourcing.

Now ask yourself:

How much time could I save having a virtual assistant using my Mixmax account?



INSTAGRAM MARKETING



Comprehensive Insider's Guide
to Instagram Growth Hacking

Jenny Gao 239

Comprehensive Insider's Guide to Instagram Growth Hacking

Credit: [Jenny Gao](#) (@otherworld.ly + @theroamess, New Zealand travel influencer and photographer).

Many guides out there serve last year's (and even last last year's) knowledge on how to growth hack Instagram accounts. They're still telling you to furiously hashtag and that the only way to grow organically is by manually commenting and engaging with influencers in your niche.

This guide aims to equip you with current, detailed, comprehensive insider's knowledge on every strategy influencers with multi-million follower networks are using to grow accounts (sometimes from scratch) rapidly.

1. Determining how Instagram can serve you

To get the most out of this platform, you must know what you ultimately want out of Instagram. Here are some questions to ask yourself:

Do I want to sell a product/service? If so, in what niche and at what price-point? A \$7 USD trendy fiddle-gadget or \$12 holographic lip gloss will require a different strategy to a \$497 e-course or \$3000 website branding packages.

Am I growing a page for an already established business, or am I growing a new business fresh? If said business is already established, what industry is it in and what kind of content will be genuinely compelling to what audience? If business is from scratch, what content will be used to generate interest and engagement?

Am I growing a personal page for myself, aiming to make a name myself as a thought leader/influencer in [x] niche?

What is the account's ultimate end-goal? Is it to sell a product/service and have Instagram be a source of income, or is it to increase personal impact and reach?

2. Instagram's secret account health rating

Unknown to the public eye, Instagram has a health score for every single account on its database in its back end. When a new account is made, its health is at its fullest. From then onwards, there are several ways your account's health can be compromised. Why is your account's health important, you ask?

Have you ever wondered why some huge accounts (over 100k+) have a comparatively poor amount of likes/comments per post? Say on average they don't even break 1000 likes/10 comments. It is because the account's health is poor and has been red flagged by Instagram's



algorithm enough in the past for it to be penalized to the point where its content is barely reaching its huge audience.

Every action that decreases your Instagram account's health lowers your engagement and the amount of followers/potential for new followers that Instagram pushes the posts out to.

These actions decrease account health:

- People reporting your account/content as spam or inappropriate
- People unfollowing you
- Soft bans (occurs when you've done too many actions too quickly)
- Posting inconsistently
- Changing your display picture
- Changing your username
- Using any kind of automation software/third party tool/scheduling tool

If you're thinking "Man that's a LOT!" I agree with you. Compromising your account's engagement for changing a display picture is a little extreme, but know that Instagram penalizes you with your followers' best interest in mind. All of the above are inconsistent behaviors, and inconsistency confuses followers. Do your best to avoid these.

3. Summarizing prerequisites

Skip this if you're already seasoned with Instagram basics. This is to cover all bases for those who aren't familiar with the below, or would like a refresher.

Hashtags

Use hashtags that have between 500,000 - 1 million posts so your posts have some time to circulate within them before getting drowned out by sheer volume. Not sure what hashtags to begin with? Go into the top influencers of your niche, and dig around in their posts for hashtags they're using and make a compilation of them. Only use the ones that have a healthy amount of posts in them (not under 100,000 and not over 900,000 preferably). You get a max of 30 hashtags under each post, so use them effectively!

Authentically engaging with others

Instagram's community is incredible for its magnitude of human interaction. Ensure you're always being yourself and posting captions and content that is a true reflection of your values, messages and lifestyle. Find influencers of similar sizes to you in your niche and make friends! This really isn't a growth strategy as much as it just fun - this is the true beauty of Instagram, and what keeps it thriving as the biggest and most engaged social media platform above others.

4. Understanding algorithms

On the contrary, Instagram rewards consistently like no tomorrow. It's not uncommon for big accounts (over 100k+) to post up to three times a day to maximize growth. If you don't post for a few days, you're compromising your account's potential for organic growth. Sometimes not



posting for a few days can even stop organic growth permanently, so if there's anything to ensure you do to guarantee success with Instagram, it's to be as consistent as possible.

Post once a day at least.

An Instagram post's lifespan is the most paramount in its first 10 minutes of going live. The more engagement it receives within this time, the more it'll reach the rest of your followers and the likelier it'll reach the Explore page, which is where you are exposed to new eyeballs (and hopefully new followers).

The timing of your posts is just as important. Almost universally, people are most active on Instagram at 9am, 12pm and 3pm EST.

5. Content is (and will always be) king

Instagram's golden rule: Quality should always be your first priority. All other growth strategies come second to incredible content. If you apply all these strategies upon sub-par content no one is interested in, you'll receive less than favorable results. Set yourself up for success by researching what constitutes as high quality content in your niche. It'll vary greatly. For travel/luxury, beautiful vibrant photography is king. For comedy/humour, it might mean applying current meme trends on top of your own niche.

Vibrant photography

Cooler shades (like blue)

High-quality graphics/photos

Engaging captions with a question or a call to action

6. Automation method

Targetted F/UF

F/UF is a controversial growth strategy, but a hugely touted one. Find large influencers who already occupy your niche, go into their followers list and follow all the recent followers. Follow no more than 100 at a time to avoid being picked up as spammy behavior by Instagram. A follow is a way of saying "Hey! Look at me, I exist," and it will usually prompt a large amount of traffic back into your page. The idea is that if they've already followed large influencer A (who has similar content to you) they'll be interested in yours too, and follow you back.

You can repeat this process up to five to seven times a day. Instagram allows you to follow up to 7500 people, so once you've hit this number, do a mass unfollow and repeat the process if you wish.

Auto liking/commenting

You can use services to auto-like and leave auto-comments to accounts that are within your niche. This, like F/UF, serves as a "Hey! Come look at my account!" and will bring traffic over to your account. Be wary with these services as Instagram doesn't like them and if your account is



new (fresh) you'll be subject to being banned quicker. Test and always err on the side of caution with automation services.

Your goals

Your goals with any automated growth for Instagram should be to accelerate your account to a point where your new community/influence is credible, self-sustainable and grows on its own organically. Automation is much cheaper than growing with powerlikes, but it does potentially come at a cost to your account's health. I'd personally not use it at all.

7. Powerliking method

What are powerlikes and why do they work?

Powerlikes are likes/comments from a network of large accounts (100k+ accounts are considered large) as soon as your post goes live. The intent is to play into Instagram's algorithm where a post's first ten minutes are most crucial for gaining traction and determining how it'll do in reaching beyond your current following.

It works two-fold: By flooding traffic from the large accounts over to yours from the 'Following' tab, as well as triggering the algorithm to recognise that large accounts are enjoying that piece of content.

This will not only increase the post's reach to more of your current followers but increases its chances significantly in hitting the Explore page, where you're reaching beyond your current audience and grow organically and quickly.

Telegram groups/rounds

Telegram is a messenger app that has become solely used for Instagram engagement groups. It's hugely popular as you can code bots that take over the entire process for you, making everything automatic.

Below are screenshots of arguably the best and most exclusive engagement group, XPLORE Rounds.

Prerequisites: 80k+ followers, 2k+ likes per post avg

Niche: General/all

At precisely :50 each hour, the bot asks all wanting to participate in that round to drop their accounts. This just means you type in the username of the account you'd like engagement on, i.e.; @theroamess

2. At :00 (on the hour), the bot automatically spits out a list of everyone who dropped their account. During peak times like 9am EST, this list is super long. The longer the list, the more engagement you'll be getting, therefore the better.

3. Everyone goes and engages with every account on the list, and reports back when they're done with 'D @username' so the bot can check. In some groups, you're only required to like the



most recent post. In XPLORE you like the last three posts. This only works if everyone participates, so Telegram round hosts don't hesitate to ban leechers.

General vs niche rounds

There is a divide in opinion on whether it's better to use general rounds (where everyone is of different niches) or niche rounds (where everyone is in your niche, i.e., fashion.)

I'm of the opinion that doing engagement rounds with those in your niche always trumps rounds across many niches, but you might find that there aren't enough people in your niche alone to have any real impact. Rounds are only effective if there are at least 50 participants, and if you're, say, a mommy + vegan + travel influencer, you might be too "niched in". Stick to general rounds with more participants.

Your goals

Your goal with powerlikes is simple: hit the Explore page, where millions of new eyeballs and potential followers await your content. Hitting Explore as frequently as possible is how huge influencers and networks grow hundreds; up to thousands of followers a day.

How do you know if you've hit Explore?

Your likes/comments on that post will be significantly higher than average, followed by a steady stream of new followers. You can further check by randomly going into the profiles of those liking the suspected post and seeing if they follow you. If they don't, they most likely found that post via Explore. Congratulations, you've succeeded in expanding your reach! Now try and repeat this success as much as you can.

8. Last notes

Determine what you ultimately want your account for. If your goal is to use it to sell a product/service, you may need to consider what demographic you'll eventually sell to and grow an account with primarily followers in a certain age group or country.

Determine how fast you'd like your growth - whether it be slow and steady long-term, or as quickly as possible.

Determine how "healthy" you'd prefer your account. If you want your account as healthy as possible, it's probably better to invest in powerlikes/organic growing strategies. Automation software and services will penalize your health slightly but is a potentially cheaper alternative.

Determine how much money you're willing to invest in growing an Instagram following.

Post at 9am, 12pm or 3pm EST daily. Ensure your content is the highest quality you can make it, and keep aiming to improve. Genuinely engage with your audience: ask them questions, get to know the frequent commenters, and leave them call to actions (like tagging friends). Care about what they'd like to see from your account, and what your account does to serve them.





COLD EMAIL



Epic Cold Email Marketing
Tactics

Unknown 245

Epic Cold Email Marketing Tactics

Credit: Unknown

EMAIL 1 / A - The appropriate person technique:

This is a great trick that works well - Send 4 emails to 4 different people in a company, mentioning the 3 other colleagues you emailed. This increases the chances of them talking about you dramatically. The rate of positive replies increases especially if you target people in multiple layers of an organisation. An employee, their boss and the boss of their boss. If it is interesting someone will delegate down. This technique was invented by a guy named Bryan Kreuzberger.

"Hey {{firstname}},

I am writing in hopes of finding the appropriate person who directs customer experience? I also wrote to {{colleague1}}, {{colleague2}} and {{colleague3}} in that pursuit. If it makes sense to talk, let me know how your calendar looks?

{{our company}} helps airlines improve customer experience. We do this by extracting insights out of any customer feedback. We analyse feedback using language processing techniques. Then enrich the data with a hi-end human quality check. The benefit for our airline clients is getting insights to improve every area of their service like onboarding, check-in and flight experience. You can measure and view the results online. Some of our clients include KLM and Transavia.

If you are the appropriate person to discuss this with, when would you be available for a quick introduction call? If not, who would you recommend me to talk to?

All the best from Amsterdam,

Name

Company name

Phone number"

Focus on the benefits your service or tool has for the user, not the features (no long signature, definitely no logo's or picture, they all decrease the chance of our email getting delivered). ONLY use plain text.



EMAIL 2:

"Hey {{firstname}},

Did you read my note from last week about {{our company}} and our tool that translates consumer feedback into actionable insights?

Airlines have a lot of touchpoints with customers, more than almost any other industry. Passengers interact with an airline online, wait for flights and are on board for many hours. In our experience, this opportunity is used very little to gather valuable insights from customers. With {{our company}}, our clients are able to extract insights out of consumer feedback. For example, we were able to determine the exact seats in the back of the plane that were too noisy to be sold at a premium price.

If you are the appropriate person to discuss this with, when would you be available for a quick introduction call? If not, who would you recommend me to talk to?

All the best,

Name

Company name

Phone number"

EMAIL 3:

"Hey {{firstname}},

One last try for the sake of professional persistence. I am wondering if you can help me find the appropriate person who is responsible for Customer Experience?

Thanks you!

Name

Company name

Phone number"

This breakup email increases responses because it creates a sense of urgency.





TWITTER



Advanced Twitter Marketing
Automation

Josh Fechter 248

Advanced Twitter Marketing Automation

Credit: [Josh Fechter](#), Co-Founder of [BAMF.Media](#)

Tired of traction channels that require your time?

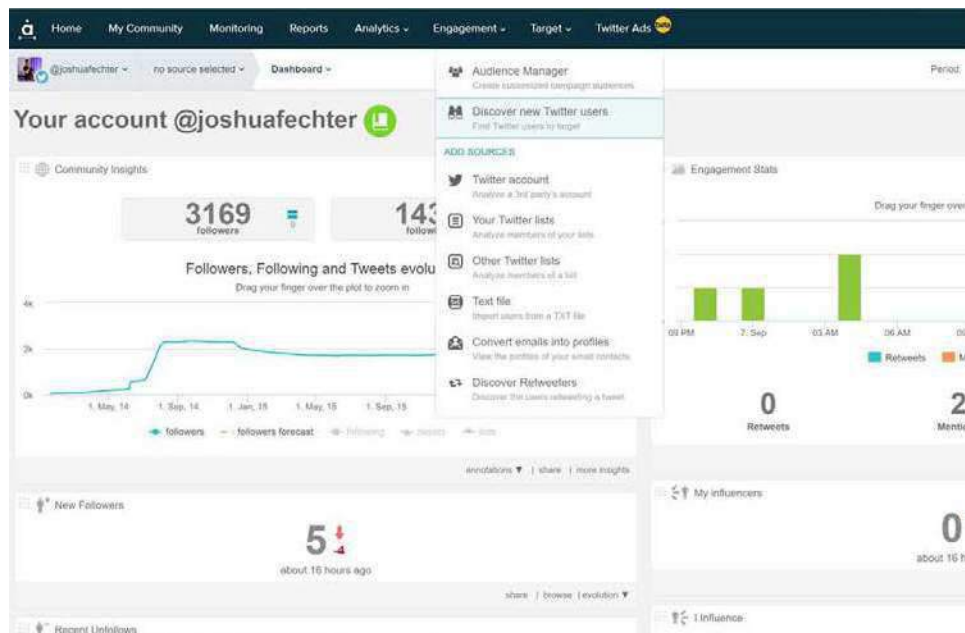
When looking for new customers, there's no reason to search for them when you can go to existing sources like your competitor's fan base.

Now imagine if you could start conversations with your competitor's fans on Twitter without lifting a finger. You could sit back and relax while receiving more leads, conversions, and generating brand awareness. Does it get any better?

Through automating my Twitter account, I created a hyper-local marketing machine. It helped me build the fastest growing Meetup in San Francisco (1,500 members in 5 months!). This machine also helped me get thousands of people to my events, grew my Twitter following by over one thousand people, and generated hundreds of new leads.

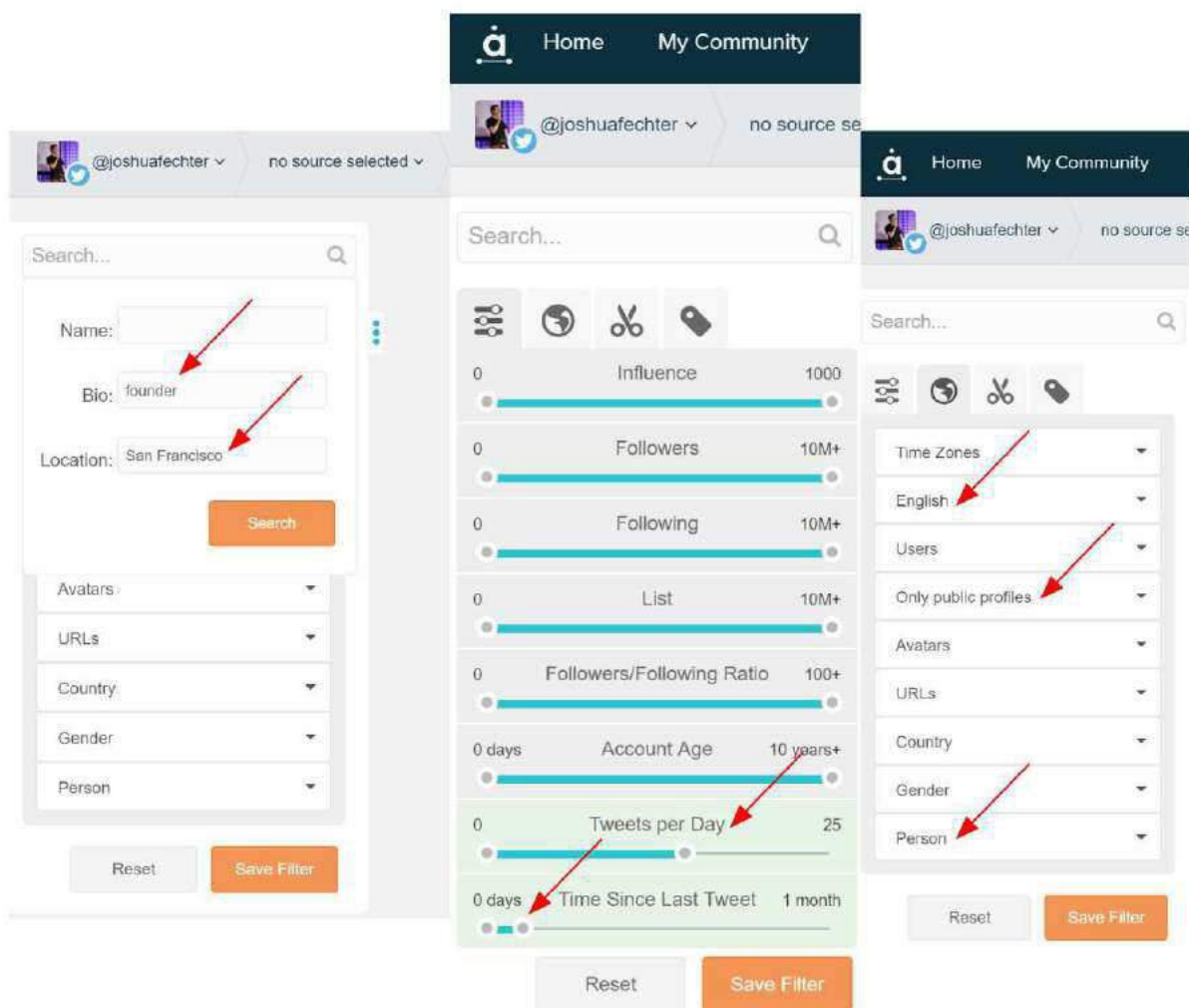
Find & Engage Influencers

To get high-level results, you have to know the top people in your industry on Twitter. You can search for industry influencers using the social discovery and interaction tool, [Audiense](#) (you can get a [free trial here](#)). To start the search process, click Target then Discover new Twitter Users:



Using Audiense's discovery tool, you want to plug-in the relevant location and bio keyword(s) of your target prospect. Next, you want to ensure they are active on Twitter. To do this, you set the Time Since Last Tweet to 1 month. And to weed out spammers, set the Tweets per Day to 25 or less.

Finally, select Person, Only public profiles, and the language English (far right of the screenshot). These settings will ensure you find active influencers in your niche:



From here, you want to find the usernames of those who you think have a valuable audience you'd like to interact with. Once you have that list, download Mass Planner. The software is compatible with PC, but you need a VPS for Mac. Also, the only way to get ahold of this software is to have an existing customer refer you.

In the software, connect your Twitter account.

If your Twitter account is semi-active, then copy the Settings below in the Follow section:

Follow

Follow Back

Unfollow

Favorite

Retweet

Contact

Mention

Twitter

Personal Twitter

BROWSE EMBEDDED

Account tags:

Settings

Follow Sources

Results

SETTINGS

Wait between

25

and

27

minutes before each new operation.

☐

Add random sleep time

Follow between

7

and

15

people per operation.

Follow a maximum of

280

per day. (0 = no limit)

326

Stop the tool for

30

minutes after

70

follows

Scroll the search page for

45

seconds.

Follow between

12:00 AM

and

11:59 PM

☐

Enable automatic follow/unfollow

☒

User has profile image

☒

User has a minimum number of tweets

50

☐

User bio has a minimum number of characters

☐

User bio/username/name must not contain any invalid words (separate words by a comma)

☒

User has a follow ratio (followers/following) greater than

1.15

☒

User tweeted within the last X days

30

☒

User has only English characters in Bio,Username

☒

User is not following this account (skip followers)

☒

Do not follow private users

Days of the week when to operate

Next, click Follow Sources. From here, you want plug-in the usernames you gathered from Audiense. You can choose to interact with those username's followings:

Follow
Follow Back
Unfollow
Favorite
Retweet
Contact
Mention

Twitter
Personal Twitter
BROWSE EMBEDDED
Account tags:

STATUS
ACTIVE
Next run: 6/22/2016 12:49:36 PM

SETTINGS

Unfollow items after a minimum of 3 days after the application followed them.

Wait between 35 and 40 minutes before each new operation.

☐ Add random sleep time

Unfollow between 5 and 10 items per operation

Unfollow a maximum of 800 - 1000 per day, (0 = no limit)

Unfollow between 12:00 AM and 11:59 PM

☐ Enable automatic follow/unfollow

☐ Unfollow all users(leave unchecked to only unfollow those that did not follow back)

Days of the week when to operate

Sunday
Monday
Tuesday
Wednesday
Thursday
Friday
Saturday

☐ Use whitelist

COPY SETTINGS

The tool unfollowed a total of 4112 users.

To take it a step further, you can favorite people who Tweet about your competitor by selecting specific keywords in the Sources section. Feel free to copy the settings below for favoriting:

Personal Twitter

Synchronizing Number of Followers for the 'Personal Twitter' account

RETURN TO TOOLS LIST

Follow Follow Back Unfollow Favorite Retweet Contact Mention

Personal Twitter

BROWSE EMBEDDED

Account tags:

Settings Sources Results

STATUS **ACTIVE** Next run: 6/22/2016 12:20:36 PM

SETTINGS

Wait between 10 and 13 minutes before each new operation.

☐ Add random sleep time

Like between 5 and 7 posts per operation.

Like a maximum of 100 - 300 per day. (0 = no limit)

☒ Use realtime results

Pick tweets less than 5 days old

Pick tweets that have between 0 and 15 retweets.

Pick tweets that have between 0 and 15 favorites

Keep a maximum of 900 likes. When exceeded, old posts are unliked. (0 = no limit) Unlike between 5 and 10 posts per operation.

☐ Skip tweets containing (separate words by a comma)

Execute between 12:00 AM and 11:59 PM

COPY SETTINGS

In the Retweet section, you can set up a reply to tweets based on keywords. So, if one of your competitor's customers complain, then you can be the first to Tweet them. Just picture what they would think your customer service is like compared to your competitor.

Josh

Finalized Number of Followers synchronization for the 'Josh' account.

RETURN TO TOOLS LIST

Follow Follow Back Unfollow Favorite Retweet Contact Mention

Twitter Josh BROWSE EMBEDDED Account tags: Followers: 7249 Followings: 1759

Settings Retweet Sources Results

☒ Reply to tweets based on keywords

Keywords:

Reply text

{hello josh | hi josh }

Check spin syntax

ADD

#	KEYWORD	REPLY	ACTIONS
---	---------	-------	---------

Now you have several ways to interact with your competitors' fans almost entirely automated. Keep in mind that you must follow-up with most people who respond to your replies, follows, and favorites. This is part of nurturing your relationships with people, so they'll turn into customers.

TIME TO DOMINATE

I just explained a few advanced tactics of Twitter automation, but it's time to take it up several levels. So, let's say you don't want to interact with all of a specific influencer's followers, you just want to interact with their followers with specific keywords in their bio, from specific countries, and have a certain follower ratio. Now you can do that and a whole lot more.

From the first part of the tutorial, plug-in your competitor's Twitter URLs into the Mass Planner Contact section (you can also use Twitter List URLs). Then, set the scroll rate to 600 - 10,000 seconds depending on the size of the audience you're exporting.

Josh
 You have 5 accounts. Mass Planner is active.

[RETURN TO TOOLS LIST](#)

Follow Follow Back Unfollow Favorite Retweet **Contact** Mention

Twitter Josh BROWSE EMBEDDED Account tags: Followers: 7246 Followings: 1810

Extract Members Auto Extract Use Members Send message to new followers Send Messages

EXTRACT MEMBERS

* you can extract members from Twitter Accounts (followers) or Twitter Lists
 * extract members will be sent to Use Members (it can take minutes for the extraction to finalize one link)

Scroll the search page for seconds.

Twitter Account URLs or Twitter List URLs or Twitter Hashtag Accounts URLs - one per line
 https://twitter.com/bareckobama
 https://twitter.com/infoGraphic_ave/lists/social-media-gurus/
 https://twitter.com/hashtag/supercars?src=hash&vertical=default&f=users
 Accounts from live tweets (news, photos, videos...)
 https://twitter.com/search?l=tweets&vertical=news&src=typed

[EXTRACT MEMBERS](#) [STOP ONGOING EXTRACTIONS](#)

DATE	LINK	COPY	REMOVE	STATUS	#EXTRACTED
12/25/2016 9:16:29 PM	https://twitter.com/joshuafechter/followers	COPY	REMOVE	done	3195
8/29/2016 1:23:04 PM	https://twitter.com/kowadrienne/followers	COPY	REMOVE	done	36
8/29/2016 1:23:04 PM	https://twitter.com/WillMansfield/followers	COPY	REMOVE	done	622
8/29/2016 1:23:04 PM	https://twitter.com/mtomasello1/followers	COPY	REMOVE	done	549

In this example, I import my own following into Mass Planner. Under Use Members I can see all the imported members. Now, click on "Export Selected" to put all these people into an Excel file to clean up.

Josh
 Synchronizing Number of Followers for the 'Josh' account

[RETURN TO TOOLS LIST](#)

Follow Follow Back Unfollow Favorite Retweet **Contact** Mention

Twitter Josh BROWSE EMBEDDED Account tags: Followers: 7246 Followings: 1810

Extract Members Auto Extract **Use Members** Send message to new followers Send Messages

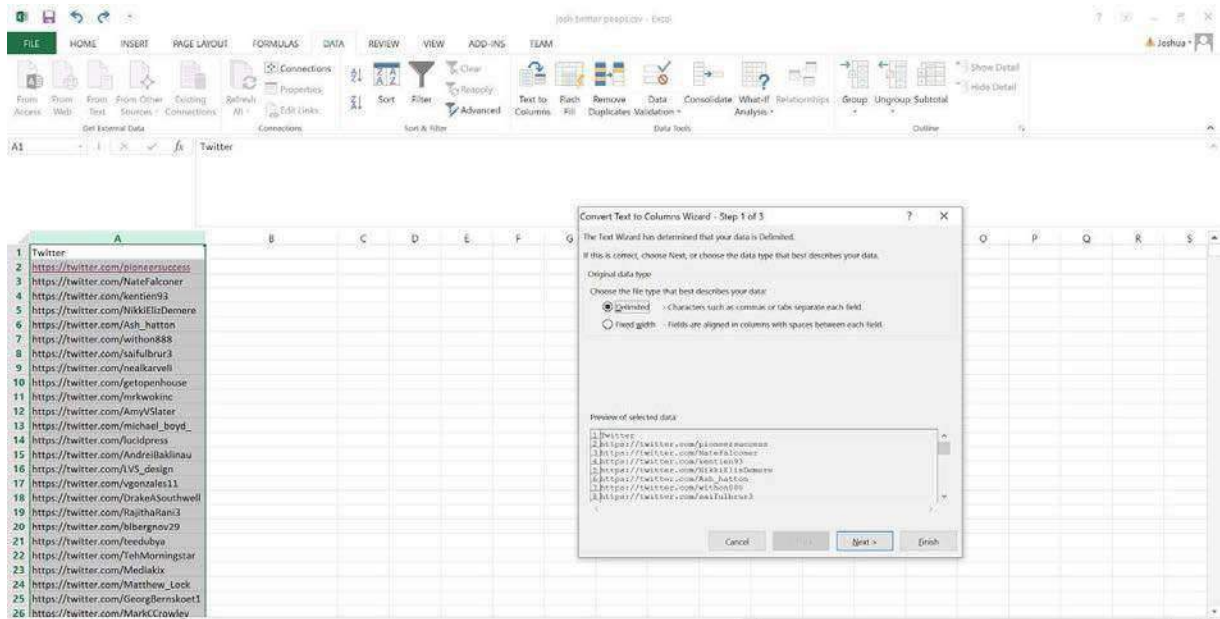
MEMBERS LIST

Selected: 3192 / 3192 [REMOVE SELECTED](#) [EXPORT SELECTED](#) [IMPORT MEMBERS](#)

SELECTED	NAME	USERNAME	ACTIONS
☒	1	Ryan Shaw	DELETE BROWSE BROWSE EMBEDDED COPY F
☒	2	Nate Falconer	DELETE BROWSE BROWSE EMBEDDED COPY F
☒	3	Ken Tien	DELETE BROWSE BROWSE EMBEDDED COPY F
☒	4	Nichole Elizabeth	DELETE BROWSE BROWSE EMBEDDED COPY F
☒	5	Ashley Hatton	DELETE BROWSE BROWSE EMBEDDED COPY F
☒	6	WithOn	DELETE BROWSE BROWSE EMBEDDED COPY F
☒	7	saifulislam	DELETE BROWSE BROWSE EMBEDDED COPY F
☒	8	Neal Karveli	DELETE BROWSE BROWSE EMBEDDED COPY F
☒	9	OpenHouse	DELETE BROWSE BROWSE EMBEDDED COPY F
☒	10	MR.KWOK INC.	DELETE BROWSE BROWSE EMBEDDED COPY F
☒	11	Amy Slater	DELETE BROWSE BROWSE EMBEDDED COPY F
☒	12	Michael Boyd	DELETE BROWSE BROWSE EMBEDDED COPY F
☒	13	Lucidpress	DELETE BROWSE BROWSE EMBEDDED COPY F
☒	14	Andrei Baklinau	DELETE BROWSE BROWSE EMBEDDED COPY F
☒	15	Ben Shepardson	DELETE BROWSE BROWSE EMBEDDED COPY F
☒	16	Vanessa Gonzales	DELETE BROWSE BROWSE EMBEDDED COPY F
☒	17	Drake Southwell	DELETE BROWSE BROWSE EMBEDDED COPY F

[SELECT ALL](#) [SELECT NONE](#) [SPLIT SELECTED BETWEEN SAME TAG ACCOUNTS](#) [SPLIT AND SEND MESSAGE](#)

In the Excel file, delete all the columns except the one with the Twitter URL. From here, click “Text to Columns” under Excel’s Data tab. You want to separate the column by the slashes “/” to clean the data.



You'll now have an entire column of just usernames. Delete all the others columns.

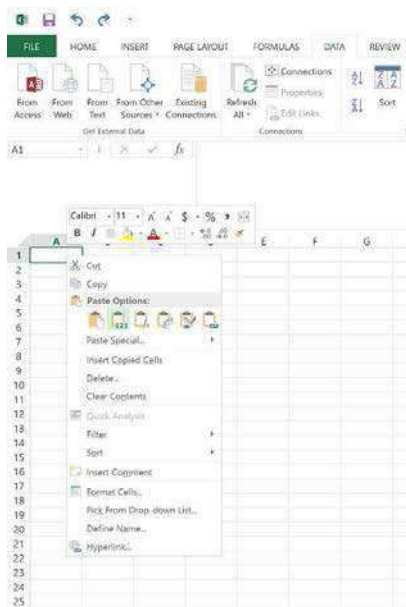
	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I
1	Twitter								
2	https:			twitter.con/pioneersuccess					
3	https:			twitter.con/NateFalconer					
4	https:			twitter.con/kentien93					
5	https:			twitter.con/NikkiElizDemere					
6	https:			twitter.con/Ash_hatton					
7	https:			twitter.con/withon888					
8	https:			twitter.con/saifulbrur3					
9	https:			twitter.con/nealkarveli					
10	https:			twitter.con/getopenhouse					
11	https:			twitter.con/mrkwokinc					
12	https:			twitter.con/AmyVSlater					
13	https:			twitter.con/michael_boyd_					
14	https:			twitter.con/lucidpress					
15	https:			twitter.con/AndreilBaklinau					
16	https:			twitter.con/LVS_design					
17	https:			twitter.con/vgonzales11					
18	https:			twitter.con/DrakeASouthwell					
19	https:			twitter.con/RajithaRani3					
20	https:			twitter.con/blbergnov29					
21	https:			twitter.con/teedubya					
22	https:			twitter.con/TehMorningstar					
23	https:			twitter.con/Mediakix					
24	https:			twitter.con/Matthew_Lock					
25	https:			twitter.con/GeorgBernskoet1					
26	https:			twitter.con/MarkCCrowlev					

Once you delete the other columns, add an “@” symbol to the front of every username. You can do this using the Concatenate formula as seen below:

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Excel interface with the **DATA** tab selected. The ribbon includes options for **Connections**, **Properties**, **Edit Links**, **Sort**, and **Filter**. The formula bar shows the formula `=CONCATENATE(A1,B1)` for cell C1. The spreadsheet below shows a list of usernames in columns A and B, with the concatenated result in column C.

	A	B	C	D	E	F
1	@	pioneersuccess	@pioneersuccess			
2	@	NateFalconer	@NateFalconer			
3	@	kentien93	@kentien93			
4	@	NikkiElizDemere	@NikkiElizDemere			
5	@	Ash_hatton	@Ash_hatton			
6	@	withon888	@withon888			
7	@	saifulbrur3	@saifulbrur3			
8	@	nealkarveli	@nealkarveli			
9	@	getopenhouse	@getopenhouse			
10	@	mrkwokinc	@mrkwokinc			
11	@	AmyVSlater	@AmyVSlater			
12	@	michael_boyd_	@michael_boyd_			
13	@	lucidpress	@lucidpress			
14	@	AndreiBaklinau	@AndreiBaklinau			
15	@	LVS_design	@LVS_design			
16	@	vgonzales11	@vgonzales11			
17	@	DrakeASouthwell	@DrakeASouthwell			
18	@	RajithaRani3	@RajithaRani3			
19	@	blbergnov29	@blbergnov29			
20	@	teedubya	@teedubya			
21	@	TahMorningstar	@TahMorningstar			

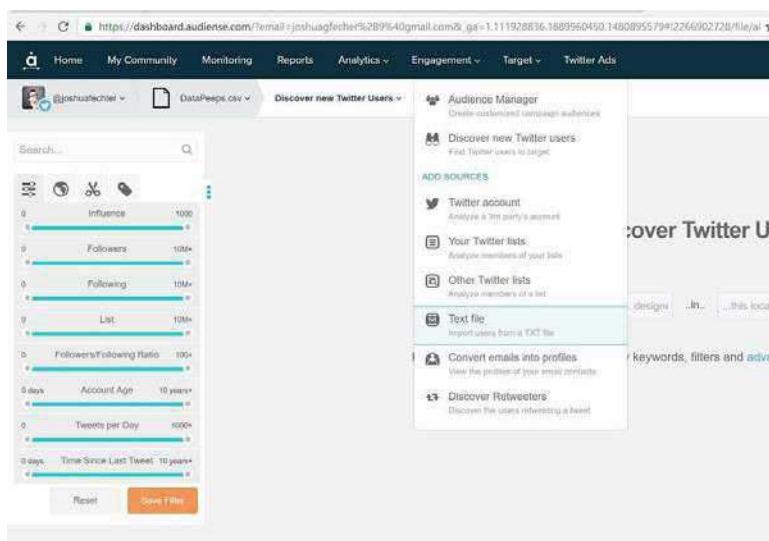
Now, copy the usernames with the @ signs and paste them into a new Excel file using “paste values.”



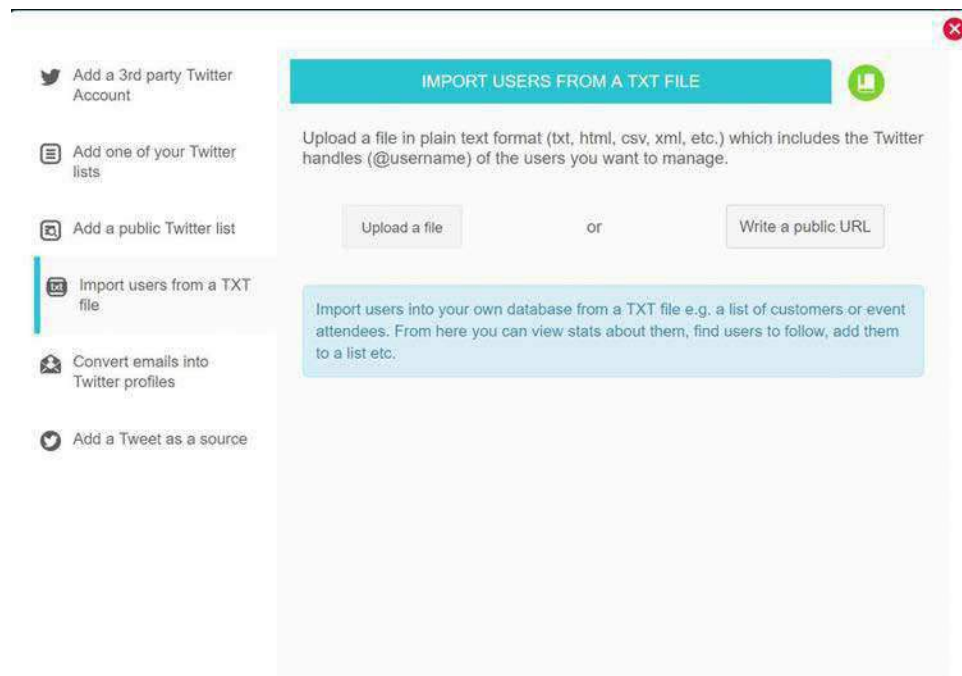
From here, save your new list of usernames as a CSV file.

Here comes the magic:

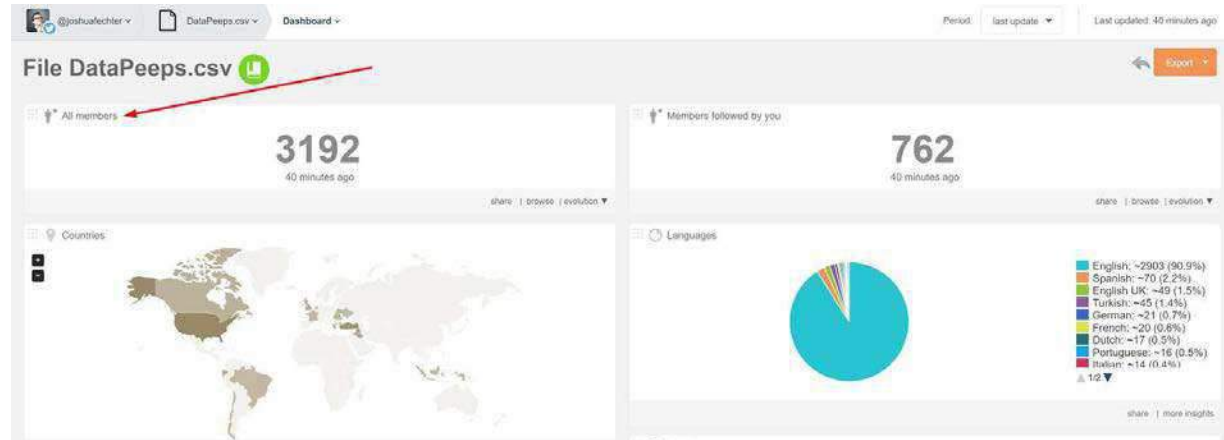
In Audience, click on Target in the menu bar, then Text file.



Now, click on Upload a file and select your CSV file.

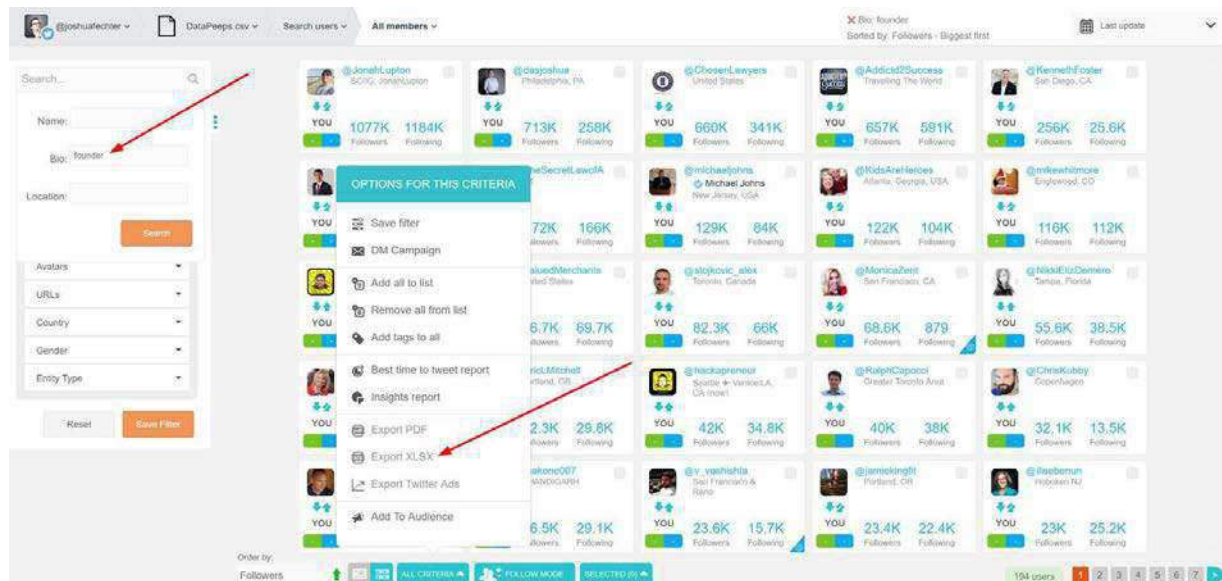


You'll now see a comprehensive overview of the users.



Click All members in the top left-hand corner.

Now, I can see all the exported members in Audiense's discovery tool. Here, I can reduce the audience to a specific group of people based on many different demographics. In this example, I include the word "founder" in the bio. As a result, I see I only have 194 followers who have the word "founder" in their bio. Now, I can click **All Criteria** → **Export XLSX** to get a file of these Twitter users.



You want to upload the XLSX file into a Google Sheet.

Create two new columns titled **Link** and **Twitter**. For Twitter, plug-in the regular Twitter URL. Under Link, you want to combine the username and Twitter URL. Use the formula **"=concat"** to combine the columns. To easily fill out the entire column, double click on the bottom left-hand corner of the cell.

=concat(c2,d2)

A		https://twitter.com/catleecatlee x	D	E
id	B2		username	name
14378846	=concat(c2,d2)	https://twitter.com/	catleecatlee	Cat Lee
273809228		https://twitter.com/	briancornwell	Brian Cornwell
36476755		https://twitter.com/	jonathanhinshaw	Jonathan Hinshaw
10491172		https://twitter.com/	AnandThaker	Anand Thaker
19326200		https://twitter.com/	ShannonLavenia	Shannon Lavenia
24647963		https://twitter.com/	hankleber	Hank Leber
262386138		https://twitter.com/	dappermarketer	Chris Gadek



=concat(C2,D2)

A	B	C	D	E	F
id	Link	Twitter	username	name	location
14378846	https://twitter.com/ca	https://twitter.com/	catleecatlee	Cat Lee	San Francisco, CA
273809228		https://twitter.com/	briancornwell	Brian Cornwell	Cincinnati, OH
36476755		https://twitter.com/	jonathanhinshaw	Jonathan Hinshaw	Fort Collins, Colorac
10491172		https://twitter.com/	AnandThaker	Anand Thaker	Atlanta, GA
19326200		https://twitter.com/	ShannonLavenia	Shannon Lavenia	Salt Lake City, UT
24647963		https://twitter.com/	hankleber	Hank Leber	Venice, Ca
262386138		https://twitter.com/	dappermarketer	Chris Gadek	San Francisco, CA
24263930		https://twitter.com/	trish_thomas	Trish Thomas	Boulder, CO

Next, you want to copy three of the columns into a new spreadsheet (name, Link, username). They must have these column titles. The last column is called **source**. You can put anything here. It's important to do this; otherwise, you can't upload the data into **Mass Planner**. Finally, export the new spreadsheet into a CSV file.

A	B	C	D	E
id	Link	Twitter	username	name
14378846	https://twitter.com/catleecatlee	https://twitter.com/catleecatlee	catleecatlee	Cat Lee
273809228	https://twitter.com/briancornwell	https://twitter.com/briancornwell	briancornwell	Brian Cornwell
36476755	https://twitter.com/jonathanhinshaw	https://twitter.com/jonathanhinshaw	jonathanhinshaw	Jonathan Hinshaw
10491172	https://twitter.com/AnandThaker	https://twitter.com/AnandThaker	AnandThaker	Anand Thaker
19326200	https://twitter.com/ShannonLavenia	https://twitter.com/ShannonLavenia	ShannonLavenia	Shannon Lavenia
24647963	https://twitter.com/hankleber	https://twitter.com/hankleber	hankleber	Hank Leber
262386138	https://twitter.com/dappermarketer	https://twitter.com/dappermarketer	dappermarketer	Chris Gadek
24263930	https://twitter.com/trish_thomas	https://twitter.com/trish_thomas	trish_thomas	Trish Thomas



A	B	C	D
name	Link	username	source
Diana Dorobek	https://twitter.com/plinevelocity	plinevelocity	Audiense
robert j. rapp	https://twitter.com/soldbyrapp	soldbyrapp	Audiense
Seth Klein	https://twitter.com/syklein13	syklein13	Audiense
Sean Danzeiser	https://twitter.com/sdanzeiser	sdanzeiser	Audiense
Estey Real Estate	https://twitter.com/EsteyRealEstate	EsteyRealEstate	Audiense
Kristopher B. Riley	https://twitter.com/kristophercozi	kristophercozi	Audiense
Tania Sheppard	https://twitter.com/brtania	brtania	Audiense
Tasha	https://twitter.com/tmoney123	tmoney123	Audiense
Robby Allen	https://twitter.com/_RobbyAllen	_RobbyAllen	Audiense

Now, you can follow these people using Mass Planner by selecting “Follow people from a provided list.” Next, click “Import” located below this section to select your brand new CSV file of your competitor’s followers with the keyword “founder” in their profile.

Josh

Finalized Number of Followers synchronization for the 'Josh' account.

RETURN TO TOOLS LIST

Follow Follow Back Unfollow Favorite Retweet Contact Mention

Twitter Josh BROWSE EMBEDDED Account tags: Followers: 7250 Followings: 1810

Settings Follow Sources Results

Follow people by keyword search Selection Rank 10

Follow friends of target accounts Selection Rank 10

Follow friends of existing friends Selection Rank 10

Follow people from a provided list Selection Rank 10

ADD ACCOUNTS TO FOLLOW

INDEX	LINK	CIRCLE	ACTIONS
SPLIT ITEMS WITH THE OTHER ACCOUNTS SPLIT ITEMS WITH SPECIFIC ACCOUNTS EXPORT IMPORT CLEAR			

Note: If you want to auto mention these select people at scale, then check out this guide starting at slide eight:

<https://docs.google.com/presentation/d/1ST--kK3KfNd7HXPYlc0Mqf0mYIDqHKzvEnCZOtxPxig/edit?usp=sharing>

With the steps I outlined, you can automate interaction with the most specific users on Twitter. Just to give you an idea, I can take HubSpot's Twitter list of 2015 Inbound Attendees (<https://twitter.com/HubSpot/lists/inbound15-tweeters>), then segment it down to those still active on Twitter. I can further dial it down to those who have the phrase "growth marketer" in their bio, are not a company, live in the U.S., and have a good Twitter ratio. From here, I can automate following and favoriting them.

The power is in your hands.

Use it wisely ;)



YOUTUBE



Rank Your Videos with YouTube
Advertising

Josh Fechter 266

Rank Your Videos with YouTube Advertising

Credit: [Josh Fechter](#), Co-Founder of [BAMF.Media](#)

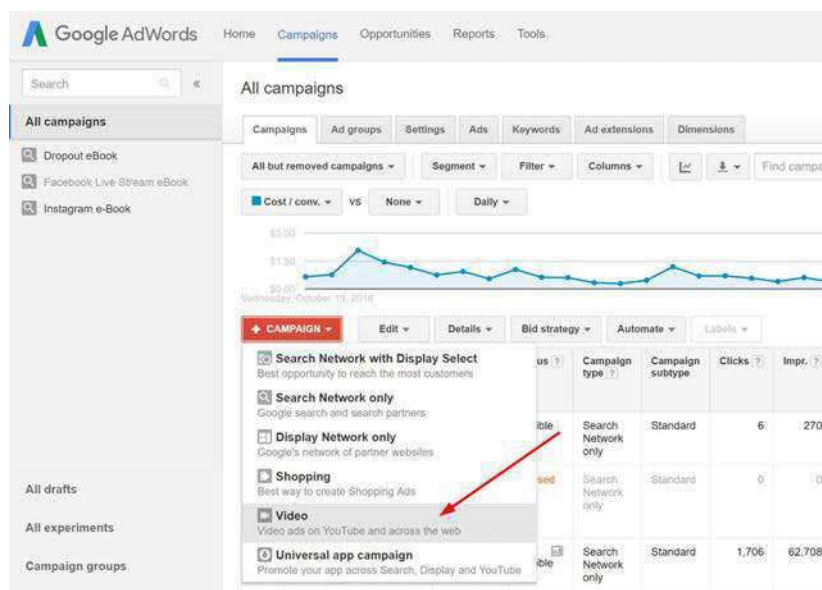
Do you use paid traffic to rank your content on Google?

If not, you're missing one of the best benefits of creating content, especially YouTube videos. YouTube videos rank based on their number of likes, shares, views, and duration viewed.

If you don't have many followers, paid traffic gives you an opportunity to analyze your video's data to optimize keywords for organic search. It's not the best data because you're using paid ads over organic; however, it's important to start.

So, where do you start?

In Google AdWords. When creating a new Campaign, you want to click Video.



Before we go further, know the tips to create a great YouTube ad whether video or text.

1. Your Thumbnail should be eye-catching because it's the first thing people will notice and has the potential to make people stop and read your headline. Excellent thumbnails include action to intrigue viewers.
2. Your headline and description are the most important parts of the In-Display ad. Write a

headline and description that will make people click using action verbs and words relevant to the places you're advertising.

3. You have the option in YouTube to put call-to-action button on video ads. This will get the person off YouTube and onto your website. If you do send them to your channel, then link your channel to your site. You are creating a path for people to follow to become a customer.
4. **Choose to place your videos in search results.** People pay more attention to videos when they pop up in search because they are not pre-occupied watching another video.
5. Do not have In-Display ads and In-Stream in the same campaign. Separate them into two campaigns. They are two different media types. This will make it easier to analyze your Google AdWords campaigns.

Once you understand the type of media for YouTube ads, it's time to dial-in on your targeting and optimization.

Start by optimizing your ad for views. Limit how often a person can see your ad (around 3-5 times a week). You want viewers to become customers; they won't do that if they are annoyed by your ads.

A little trick: First target low-cost countries for many views. This will provide social validation for your videos resulting in cheaper engagement for quality views when you go after more expensive countries.

Now you want to decrease your mobile bid by 50% - 100%. Mobile doesn't convert nearly as well as desktop because the ads (except for cards) aren't clickable. You end up paying for views, but you need likes, shares, and an extended length of duration watched.

Devices [?](#) Your ads will show on all eligible devices by default (computers, mobile, and tablet).

[Advanced mobile and tablet options](#)

- All available operating systems
- All available mobile devices
- All available carriers and Wi-Fi

[Edit](#)

Set device bid adjustments [?](#)

Mobile bid adj. %
Enter a number above to see an example.

Tablet bid adj. %
Enter a number above to see an example.

Computer bid adj. %
Enter a number above to see an example.

Advanced settings

[Schedule: start date, end date, ad scheduling](#)

[Ad delivery](#)

Ad rotation [?](#) ☒ Optimize for views: Show ads expected to provide more views
☐ Optimize for conversions: Show ads expected to provide more conversions
☐ Rotate evenly: Show ads more evenly for each enabled video ad format (in-stream and video discovery)

Frequency capping [?](#) Set a limit to how many times your ads appear to the same user
☐ impressions per day for this campaign
☐ views per day for this campaign

Content exclusions [?](#) Standard (default) [Edit](#)

[Save and continue](#) [Cancel new campaign](#)

To dial-in on the audience that converts best, you want to find out what search keywords are referring you traffic and subscribers, then optimize for those topics. To get more granular, you can find out what videos are referring you the most subscribers, then optimize for the keywords in the video title and channel. You should also select to have your ads play out evenly over time. If your ads are all playing at the same time of day, that's money wasted.

By default your ads will show to all viewers. Optionally you can refine your audience.

Demographics [?](#) Any gender, Any age, Any parental status, Any household income [Edit](#)

Interests [?](#) Any interest [Edit](#)

Placements [?](#) Any placement [Edit](#) [Remove](#)

Topics [?](#)

Search by related term, phrase or URL [Search](#) Selected: 0

Topic

- ▶ Arts & Entertainment [x](#)
- ▶ Autos & Vehicles [x](#)
- ▶ Beauty & Fitness [x](#)
- ▶ Books & Literature [x](#)
- ▶ Business & Industrial [x](#)
- ▶ Computers & Electronics [x](#)
- ▶ Finance [x](#)
- ▶ Food & Drink [x](#)
- ▶ Games [x](#)
- ▶ Health [x](#)
- ▶ Hobbies & Leisure [x](#)
- ▶ Home & Garden [x](#)
- ▶ Internet & Telecom [x](#)

[Done](#) [Cancel](#)

For the most relevant targeting, choose specific videos and channels. It enables you to use hyper-relevant messaging in your advertising. Imagine advertising on a Tom Brady highlights video with an advertisement selling his jersey.

Google AdWords Home **Campaigns** Opportunities Reports Tools

✓ Create campaign 2 Create an ad group and ad

Video ad

Your YouTube video

Search for a video or paste the URL from YouTube

Bidding

Maximum CPV \$

Maximum CPV is the highest price you are willing to pay for someone to view your video when it is run as an ad.

Popular videos bid adjustment %

Enter a number above to see an example.

Targeting

By default your ads will show to all viewers. Optionally you can refine your audience.

Demographics Any gender, Any age, Any parental status, Any household income

Interests Any interest

Placements

Enter placement URLs line by line, or paste in a list.

Selected

- ▼ YouTube channels and videos
 - Any channel or video
- ▼ Websites and apps
 - Any website or app

✓ Create campaign 2 Create an ad group and ad

By optimizing your YouTube videos for paid advertising, you're more likely to rank your videos for keywords. In turn, you no longer have to pay for traffic. You'll receive organic leads through search.

Few use YouTube ads to rank which gives you a huge advantage to compete over many different keywords. The barrier-to-entry to create video and advertise is high, but the first-mover advantage is well worth it. If you're looking for a scalable way to grow your business through content, then add YouTube advertising to your growth list.



PRODUCT HUNT



The Ultimate Product Hunt
Playbook

Gilles De Clerck

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The Ultimate Product Hunt Playbook

Credit: [Gilles De Clerck](#), Growth Strategist at Salesflare

This playbook will hand you actionable tactics, tips, tricks and hacks to get you on top of Product Hunt — Silicon Valley's favorite playground.

Side effects may include ⚠️

- severe traffic spikes on your websites 📈
- a sh!tload of new followers on social media 👥
- getting featured in tech media like TechCrunch or TheNextWeb 📰
- fresh product ideas 💡
- new business relationships 🤝
- a meowntain of new customers 🐱
- money raining down on you from nowhere 🌧️

This won't work if you have a shitty product.

Good thing Product Hunt will tell you why your product is shitty, so you can make it into a good one.

This won't work if you're not willing to put in the work.

This guide is long for a reason. Launching your product on Product Hunt is a one-time opportunity that can turn out pivotal for your business. You'll only get one shot at this and I will tell you exactly what you need to do to make the most out of it. This is me giving you a head start. It's up to you to hit it out of the park.

I've included TL;DRs (Too Long; Didn't Read) at the end of every section so you can get a quick recap before you move on.

WTF is Product Hunt? 🤪



Product Hunt is the little baby of [Ryan Hoover](#). Ryan is one of those guys that friggin' loves everything that's new and cool. For Ryan, new products are an opportunity to learn and, most of all, a way of connecting with like-minded people.

Back in 2013, Ryan was looking for a one-stop-shop to discover the hottest new tech products. As he didn't find anything, he did the entrepreneurial thing and started it himself. In its cute early days as an MVP, Product Hunt was a [mailing list](#), build on this one question:

What cool products are you using?

It's a question we all ask and it turned out to be one hell of a community builder. Within two weeks, Ryan's little mailing list had 170 subscribers devouring discoveries from 30 hand-picked contributors, consisting of startup founders, VCs, and prominent bloggers. Ryan was onto something.

Today, Product Hunt is a tight-knit community of like-minded geeks who bond over anything hot 🔥 and the new ✨. Not just tech, but also books, podcasts and games — you name it. The site works like reddit, with users posting products and the community making or breaking them with comments and upvotes.

More upvotes will get your product higher on Product Hunt's frontpage, getting you some solid street cred with a community packed with early adopters, curious investors and avid entrepreneurs. It is the ultimate startup launchpad 🚀.

TL;DR

- *Product Hunt was founded by Ryan Hoover*
 - *as a one-stop-shop to discover the coolest new products*
 - *it's a tight-knit community of early adopters, investors and entrepreneurs*
 - *making it the ultimate startup launchpad*
-

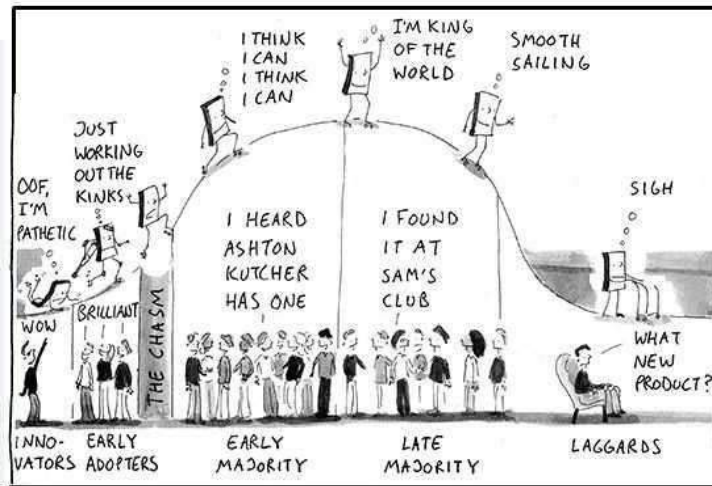
OK... And why should I care again? 🤔

Ever heard of the Product Adoption Curve?

It's one of those gazillion frameworks they show you in marketing class you then instantly forget about.

I did anyway.





The reason you should care is that you want people to start using your product.

You want this because, well, everyone building a product wants this.

To get there, you need to understand how a new product finds its way in the market and makes its way to new users.

The Product Adoption Curve is something all new kids on the block have to go through. Facebook, Slack, Uber and DVDs (still ring a bell?). Some go faster, some go slower. Others die along the way because they fail to understand how it works.

The people you need to get on board first are innovators.

Why?

Because these are the ones willing to take your product for a spin when it's still a baby. They're okay with it still shitting the bed from time to time 🤢. They look beyond the bugs and spartan features to see if your product deserves to exist. They'll share their findings with the world and, if they like what they see, may even end up promoting your product.



Innovators will get you across the [chasm](#), which is the big wide gap sitting between you and your target masses. Or push you in. Whatever happens, you'll be smarter than you were yesterday. It's make or break. **Sink or swim.**

This is how Facebook, Uber and Slack became big fellas. Think about it. All three started out targeting a small group of users and ended up leading their markets. Facebook grew from popular-hungry Harvard, Uber from open-minded San Francisco, and Slack from tech-savvy companies wanting to beta-test.

Innovators are like the first pin on a bowling alley. Knock it down and the other pins will fall along.

Now for the good part.

👉 Product Hunt is one big club of innovators and early adopters.
It's a rocketship waiting to take your product to the stars ✨.

If you want to launch a tech product or service, launch it on Product Hunt.
Oh, did I mention [Product Hunt was acquired by AngelList](#) back in december? You know, the world's biggest network of angel investors 🇺🇸. Doesn't hurt to get into their attention space.

TL;DR

- *Product Hunt is packed with innovators and early adopters*
 - *these are the people you want to take a look at your product*
 - *they'll give you invaluable feedback*
 - *and are likely to use and promote your product if they like it*
 - *oh, PH is also owned by the world's largest network of angel investors*
-

YOLO: You Only Launch Once

Your product can be posted once. Once. You get one shot at getting this right. Make it count.

Look. If you had one shot. One opportunity.

To seize everything you ever wanted. In one moment.

Would you capture it? Or just let it slip?

(Eminem — Lose Yourself)

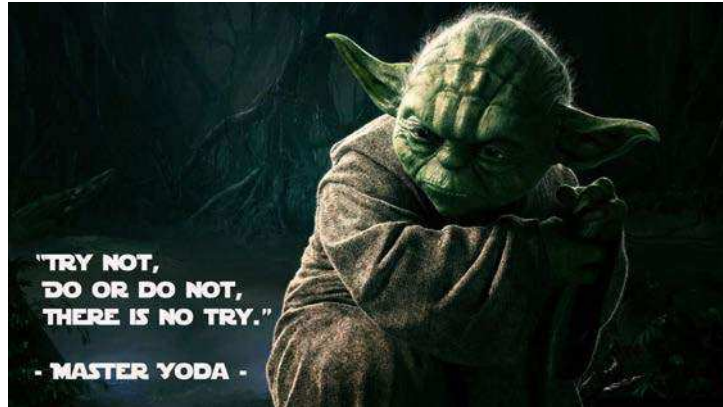
I'm your man on the inside. I've been to the Product Hunt. I've seen things. I survived and I thrived. And now I'm here to help you do the same and better.



Do you remember when Luke Skywalker and his rebels had one shot at destroying the Death Star?

This is exactly like that. With the difference that Product Hunt doesn't do sequels like Star Wars does. You don't get to destroy the Death Star twice like Luke did.

Does this make me your Master Yoda? Yes, exactly what it means, that is.



Now, Product Hunt doesn't do sequels. But it *does* do spin-offs. You can in fact launch a new feature of your product if it's cool enough to be marketed on its own and provides real value to the early adopters. In the end, it all comes down to how you sell it (as always).

A full-blown launch of your product is more complicated. You can't launch your product twice unless its essence is so new and/or improved that it can be considered a new product. Think of it as a reboot of a franchise.

A second shot at destroying the Death Star you might get after all, young Jedi.

TL;DR

- *you only have one shot at launching on Product Hunt (sort of)*
 - *do or do not — there is no try*
 - *I am Yoda*
-

Play #1: Get in the tribe. Act as if you belong 😊

Know your audience.

Before you even think of launching on Product Hunt, you should first experience first-hand what it is all about. What makes these early adopters tick?

Sign up, immerse yourself and play ball. Dive in headfirst. Get to know the ins and outs of the community by becoming part of it.



Let's cover some basics first:

- **The Daily Hunt** 👁️

Product Hunt's frontpage showcases products according to the number of upvotes they got (and more — there's [a secret algorithm](#)). The product that ends on top at the end of the day is the winner. At 12am PST the page refreshes and the hunt starts all over again.

- **Upvotes** 👍

Upvotes are Product Hunt's equivalent of Facebook's likes. If you like a product, you can vote it up and push it up the page. The more votes, the higher on the page it will end up at the end of the day.

- **Hunters** 🕵️

Hunters are members with special rights to hunt products and post them on Product Hunt. Their special powers were given by them by other hunters, making them the chosen ones of the community.

- **Makers** 🧑🔬

These are the members who created the product.

Once you got the basics figured out, have your curiosity take the lead. Lurk around, check out similar products to yours and learn about their launch strategies. Spy on titles, taglines, logos, screenshots, comments and general wording. Steal with your eyes 👁️.

TL;DR

- *immerse yourself in the PH — community*



- *get to know the basics: upvotes, hunters and makers*
 - *lurk around & steal with your eyes*
-

Play #2: Hunt down your Hunter

No Hunter = No Product Hunt Launch. You already got that.

There's hunters and there's hunters. What you want is one of the *uber hunters*. These are the top of the pack. The crème de la crème. The chosen ones among the chosen ones.

Things to take into account to finding the Frodo that will take your One Product To Rule Them All all the way up the Product Hunt mountain:

- Numbers of followers 
- When a Hunter submits a product, all of his/her followers will be notified. The more followers, the more visibility, the more likely you are to get shot to the top of the page.
- History of successful posts 
- So you know he has game.
- Affinity with your type of product 
- So you know he gets why your product is awesome.
- (we're going to assume yours is, in fact, awesome)

Having a good hunter on your side is like being in pole position on the starting grid of a Formula 1 race. Your chances of finishing first are significantly higher .

Nail your pitch 

You choosing a hunter doesn't mean the hunter chooses you. You may be madly in love with your product, your hunter probably isn't (yet). It's up to you to make him/her fall for it. Top hunters get pitched multiple times a day. Don't waste their time. Make sure yours is on point.

Pitching is an art: it takes time to perfect.

Good thing you've been doing it ever since you got started with your idea, right?

Still, I guess it doesn't hurt to refresh your memory with these 6 golden pointers from top hunter [Bram Kanstein](#) .

- First and foremost: show enthusiasm and make your pitch personal!
- Tell about the problem you're solving 
- Be voilà  show your solution
- Show early results if you have them 
- Why are you the man/woman/team that's going to take this to the moon? 



- How can the person you pitch to help you? Asking for specific feedback is also good. It's difficult to help when your question is simply: "what do you think?"

These are from Bram's killer article [5 ways not to pitch your product](#) — a must-read if you're looking to get your pitch right.

Bram is not just any hunter, he is the hunter who launched the [#1 most upvoted product of all time on Product Hunt](#).

This product, [Startup Stash](#) — a carefully curated directory of startup tools and resources — also happened to be his own product.

Bram was #1 on my list to hunt Salesflare and reading through his articles was part of my strategy to get through to him.

Rules like this don't mean you can't get creative with your pitch. My idea to hook him was to pitch Salesflare in the exact ways Bram tells you not to in his article. Something like this:

"Hi Bram,

You'll be amazed by this. We built the Uber of Sales! It's a unique CRM that is going to change the way sales is being done. We've been working our asses off for more than 2 years but now our baby has finally been born. Everyone we showed it to loved it! It's going to be yuge!"

This was just to get his attention.

I believe in standing out.

I also tend to do the opposite of what people tell me to. I would have gone on and pitched Salesflare the right way after.

Thing is I never needed to.

You see, Bram had just pinned this on his Twitter wall:





I guess he was kind of sick of emails like the one I was going to send him.

Tweets are something else. We decided to send him our video.

(This one: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=LD3XkOtCpFk>)

He went for it! 🙌

Remember to show your solution and be *voilà*? 🙌

Well, nothing is more *voilà* than a video.

We had a video in the making for about 2 months and it was one of the crucial factors in deciding when to go full-in on our Product Hunt Launch. Not only does it help you pitch to hunters — it's also kind of a must for your Product Hunt page once you actually get hunted.

TL;DR

- *score yourself a top hunter*
 - *he/she will give you a head-start in your race to the top*
 - *look for (1) numbers of followers (2) history of successful posts (3) affinity with your product*
 - *nail your pitch*
 - *get your product a video*
-

3. Cook up your Product Hunt Starter Pack 🧑🍳

Now that you've found yourself an experienced general, it's time to gear up for battle.

Essentials to prepare:

Name of the product 🌟

Pretty straightforward. But you can still make a difference here. We made it Salesflare CRM to make sure people could easily find us when searching for a CRM on Product Hunt afterwards.

Correct website URL (+App/Play Store URLs) 🔑

Throw them all in there. If you don't have a website yet, you can create a landing page with general information on your product and a download link if possible.

Tagline 📌

Catchy and clear. We went for *Intelligent sales CRM for startups who thrive on technology*. Sales CRM to clearly define our position within the CRM space, *intelligent* as our main differentiator and *startups who thrive on technology* to indicate who we built it for. Resist the urge to be overly creative here, you don't want to confuse people.

Logo 🗨️

Sure, you can just put your logo. But this won't exactly get you points with the Product Hunt cool kids. Make it move. Like Jagger. We had a Salesflare Product Hunt cat pop up in our logo and combined this with some conceptual animations. It doesn't have to be the next Star Wars movie. People are attracted by moving things especially when they're quickly scanning a front page filled with all kinds of stuff.

Maker Product Hunt Profile URLs 🧑🔬

Make sure team members considered to be makers of the product are all on Product Hunt prior to the launch so your Hunter can list everyone as Makers. This is not just to make you look good. Being listed as a Maker will get you commenting rights, crucial for engaging in conversation with the community.

Video/Screenshots 📺

Your chance to be *voilà*. Don't stop at the video (yes, it autoplays) — your screenshots should be equally engaging. We put up animated GIFs showcasing different Salesflare features. You don't have to put GIFs. I've seen great Product Hunt pages with static screenshots. Thing is GIFs provide more value because... well, because they move and people love stuff that moves.

Prepare your intro comment 💬

It's up to you to kick off the conversation on your product once it's live. You don't want to be



putting something together in a rush at the very last minute, so make sure you write something beforehand you can copy-paste when the time is right. Start off with why you built the product and lay out some of its core functionalities. Specify what kind of feedback you're looking for. Mention the special promotion you have in store for the community (more on that later) and don't forget to give your hunter a shoutout for hunting you.

This was ours:



Jeroen Corthout — Co-Founder Salesflare

First of all, thanks @bramk for hunting Salesflare! We're psyched to be here.

My co-founder Lieven and I love to automate our work by building intelligent systems.

We deeply believe in software that works for its user, not the other way around.

About two years ago we had enough of manually inputting data in different CRMs. It is a real pain to keep a CRM up-to-date, even in the more user-friendly sales pipeline tools, meant for startups like us.

One sunny afternoon, we figured the data we were inputting was already available in other systems. We decided to build an intelligent and automated CRM for startups. To free startups of manual data input and have them spend the least time and energy possible on their CRMs. We called it Salesflare.

Salesflare automatically fills out your address book and keeps track of all interactions with the people you're in contact with. It takes data from social media, company databases, phone, email, calendar, email and web tracking... to hand it to you in automated customer timelines. Everything you need to know about your customers right at your fingertips. Easy and effortlessly.

In the past few months we've onboarded happy customers like Udacity, Behave.org, Hungry, Spent, ... and Salesflare is now ready to welcome you all!

Here's our unicorn customer Udacity explaining why they use Salesflare: <https://blog.salesflare.com/why-...>

We have a nice treat as well for the Product Hunt community: 3 users for the price of 1 for the full first year (on annual plan, after your 14-day free trial)! The code is 3FOR1MEOW.

What's more: we help with data imports FOR FREE, and also with setting up integrations with Slack, Trello, MailChimp, ... using Zapier.

Hope we can welcome you on Salesflare, so we can help you boost your sales and productivity!

Our team will be available here all day to answer any questions you may have. We're really looking forward to your feedback!!

👍 38 🗨️ REPLY 🐦 TWEET 🌐 SHARE </>

Tags 🏷️

Make your product easy to find by adding relevant tags. Some examples of tags we chose for Salesflare include tech, sales, customer communication, chrome extension and web. Don't worry if you don't get them right from the start, you can make changes afterwards. Product Hunt closely watches these tags and may remove them if they don't agree. Feel free to chat with them if you think they made a mistake. We had a few tags removed and then put back again after we explained why we thought they were relevant for Salesflare.



Launch date of the hunt

As a rule of thumb, Product Hunt's busiest days of the week range from Tuesday until Thursday (I guess early adopters in California party from Friday till Sunday and then die on Monday — fair enough). Busy means more competition, but busy also means more people to upvote, try your product and leave you with valuable feedback. Ending up on top may be very exciting, quantity of users getting in touch with you is probably more valuable for your business on the long-term.

Tuesday is arguably better than Wednesday because you'll have 24 hours more to be upvoted and make it into Product Hunt's weekly digest. With all this in mind, we chose Tuesday and took about one and a half week to prepare our launch as soon as we got the green light from our hunter. You could easily do with less, but gathering support pre-launch while continuing to attend to every-day business stuff is no walk in the park. You don't want to skip any of your shuteye time prior to your launch either — it'll get kind of crazy once you're live.

Launch time of the hunt

A new hunt is launched every day at 12am PST. People typically say to post immediately after midnight, but this is not the best way to go. Product Hunt's secret algorithm is said to penalize age in ranking products, so you're better off waiting a few hours as the US' awakening comes closer. This is if you're confident your own network can help you get initial traction in the first hours, so you'll be high as soon as New York and then San Francisco crawls out of bed.

For Salesflare we initially proposed to be posted around midnight to our hunter but he said he found posting around 3–4am PST (12–1am local time here in Antwerp) to be the most effective. This gives you enough time to push yourself up in the first hour and be right where you should be as Product Hunt's core members start checking their smartphones hanging over their morning coffees.

Once you're done, send everything over to your hunter in a nice email, well in-time before D-Day.

Use a Google Drive folder to share your screenshots and other media so you can still make last-minute changes if needed.

We sent a Google Calendar Invite to set a date and time to avoid any confusion for everyone involved.

TL;DR

- *prepare essentials for your launch*
- *name — clear & easy searchable*
- *tagline — catch & clear*
- *logo — make it move*



- *video — just have a video*
 - *screenshots — make them stand out (by making them move)*
 - *prepare your intro comment — why, what, thank hunter, promotion*
 - *set a day — (1) somewhere between Tuesday and Thursday (2) take your time to prepare*
 - *set a time — (1) after midnight PST (2) before the US wakes up*
 - *hand everything to your hunter, on a silver platter*
-

4. Gather your fans 🤝

The secret formula to a successful Product Hunt launch is made up of two things:

- a great product (duh)
- initial traction

Both things you can control. If your product is not great, stop reading now and come back once it is. Don't worry too much about some features not being entirely on point yet. Remember, these are early adopters — they're okay with your product still being an infant and will happily help you find and kill early bugs as long as they see value.

You may have the greatest product the world has ever seen— if people don't have it in front of them, they won't upvote it. Don't make yourself any illusions: even early adopters won't scroll endlessly to find your product. It has to be right there as soon as the site or app loads.

Slap 'em in the face with it.

This means you'll need a fair amount of upvotes as soon as Product Hunt rush hour kicks in. Having a top hunter on your side will get you a long way already, but remember that battles are won by soldiers, not by generals.

Now, you cannot just ask all of your friends and family to upvote you. Product Hunt was built to make it easy to discover the world's greatest new products, not to force-feed your own stuff to whoever.

It is precisely this that makes Product Hunt so great at showcasing the best things out there. Not only should you respect that, Product Hunt's algorithm will also increasingly push down your product if too many votes from brand new accounts come rolling in.

What can you do? Here's a few ideas:



1) Find your friends on Product Hunt 🧑🧑

Chances are you already have some friends on Product Hunt. Product Hunt syncs the people you follow on Twitter so your first move should be to check who of them could be willing to show some support and notify them of your upcoming launch.

2) Ask your other friends anyway 🙏

You'd be surprised how many people know about Product Hunt without having an account. Maybe they've been peeking from time to time without getting into upvoting. Or maybe they know about it but didn't take the time to take a proper look yet. Your launch may well be the perfect occasion for these people to sign up.

I know it says friends but what I really mean is network: friends, family, customers, business contacts, your dog,... Anyone you have a direct line with. We went through our contact lists and started asking people we thought of as early adopters if they had a Product Hunt account. If they did, we told them about our launch. If they didn't, we told them about the community and how awesome it is. If it's their jam, they'll make an account and you have them onboard. If it's not, you'll leave them be.

While Product Hunt is not just a marketing channel for you to exploit, you can still tell people about it. In fact, Product Hunt needs this kind of visibility to keep on growing. Many of my friends have been active users since we introduced them to the community. Make sure to do so ahead of your launch and not the day itself.

3) Make a Google Sheet and follow up 📈

Now you'll have tens or even hundreds of people lined up to support your launch and it's your responsibility to make sure they come through. Keep track of the people you contacted so you can effectively follow up on the big day. Include name, channel (Messenger, WhatsApp, Twitter,...) and status (did they vote already?).

4) Look for social gatekeepers

Give special attention to people with a lot of followers and try to get them to share your Product Hunt launch with their network.

5) Chat is king

The magical word at this stage is chatting. Remember you need these people to commit twice: you need them to sign up beforehand and you need them to upvote you on the big day.

This is why a channel like email will be far less effective here: it doesn't allow for a direct, engaging dialogue.

Sure, you can send an email a week beforehand and another one on launch day but you'll have zero control over people making accounts and being active on Product Hunt prior to your launch. This may negatively affect your page ranking. We chose not to take that chance.

You can think of Product Hunt's front page as a Google Search Results page — only the top gets clicked and visibility goes downhill fast as you go down the page. It's like a snowball effect — make sure you have a big ball already once the heavy snow starts falling down. If your product is great, the community will take over and make sure you stay on top.

We did all the chatting manually. That means asking them three-four days up front if they were willing to give us a vote and telling them about Product Hunt in the process. If they said yes, we would add them to the Google Sheet and follow up with them on Launch Day.



TL;DR



- *great product + initial traction = great success on PH*
- *find friends on PH*
- *ask your other friends if they're on PH — if they're not, tell them about it ask if they want to be*
- *create a Google Sheet for follow-up*
- *scrape upvoters of similar products on PH => target*
- *find yourself some influencers*
- *chat with everyone you know to tell them about your PH launch*

5. Butter up the community 🐼

Make the Product Hunters feel special.

Why?



We've been over this.

Because they're *innovators* and you need their help **to cross the chasm**.

Besides, as you are in the early stages of your product, their feedback will be invaluable. The more, the merrier.

It's common courtesy to offer Product Hunt members special deals. If done right, Product Hunt will be a gift that keeps on giving. It's only right you give something back. For Salesflare, we gave the club 3 users for the price of 1 — 3FOR1MEOW.

TL;DR

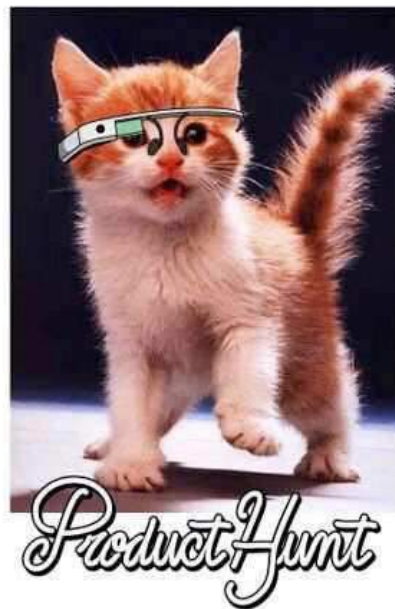
- *make the Product Hunters feel special and loved*
- *by giving them an supercalifragilistic deal*



6. Become a cat person 🐱

In case you haven't noticed: Product Hunt loves cats.

One day Product Hunt fan [Jesse Thomas](#) offered to design a t-shirt. The Glasshole Kitty was one of the ideas he sent in. The Product Hunt team liked it so much they ordered a bunch of t-shirts and stickers and started sending them to early community members. These in turn would share their Kitty gifts on social media, sparking the idea of the Kitty mascot.



While Product Hunt never really changed their logo, the kitty is everywhere. It's big in social media posts and has been adapted to launch several Product Hunt projects like books, podcasts and their Snapchat account.



So if you're looking to get that meowntain of upvotes from the community, you'll better turn into a crazy cat lady for the day.

TL;DR

- *Product Hunt likes cats*
 - *for some reason*
-

7. Dress up your website for the big day 🎀

Your Product Hunt launch is a day of celebration so it's only right your website looks all nice and pretty for the occasion, don't you think?

It's also a great chance to once again highlight that special Product Hunt deal you prepared for your fans. Shine bright like a diamond! 💎

You can use [IntroBar](#) (yes, it's free) to put up a nice-looking welcome bar on top of your website when people click through via your PH-link (this will end in `?ref=product hunt`).

[Here's what Salesflare's website looked like on her big day.](#)

TL;DR

- *make your website shine for its big day*
-

8. Set the internet on fire 🔥

OK.

You're live on Product Hunt. Showtime! 🌟📢

Get the word out. Bring out the big guns. *Release the Kraken!*

The goal is simple: to make sure the whole world knows you're on Product Hunt.

Now remember: Product Hunt frowns upon asking for upvotes. So don't. Instead, say things like 'come say hi' or 'join the conversation'. Just let people know you're on Product Hunt but spare no effort.

There's this rumour that Product Hunt's algorithm penalizes you if you send people directly to your PH — page.



To this day, I have not found compelling evidence of this being true. We were careful about it though, sending people to the search results page for the the query 'Salesflare'.

Next is a list of PH guerrilla tactics even Rambo would be jealous of.

Let's hustle 🦾.

1) Go through your list 📋

Follow up on the people you know have a Product Hunt account following your pre-launch efforts and give them a quick reminder. Make sure you miss no one and be thorough. Just because people say they will take a look, doesn't mean they will. Check if their vote is already there and follow up again if needed. They may have just forgotten — it's your big day, not theirs. Be careful not to spam though. We called it quits after two reminders.

2) Notify your customers with email and/or live chat 🗨️

Your customers already bought/subscribed to your product, so they must kind of like it. Follow up on the ones already on your list following your pre-launch strategy.

The rest you can target with email and livechat on your website (given you have that). We had an [Intercom](#)-message pop up notifying users of our campaign as soon as they signed in to Salesflare.

Again, chatting has an edge over email when it comes to educating your recipient on what Product Hunt is and what they should do if they want to help you out.

3) Flood Twitter 🐦

Most of Product Hunt's core audience is on Twitter so it would be great if you get people to talk about your launch on there.

Go for both quality and quantity. It's a good idea to prepare some tweets the day before so you don't lose time coming up with something funny in the middle of the storm.

Tweet as soon as you're live and keep it up as you reach several milestones (every 100 upvotes for example).



Make your tweets funny and likeable with GIFs and memes so your followers are more likely to share them. Then, keep the conversation going. People will start tweeting and retweeting you.

Help out, stay humble, thank, like and retweet. Repeat.

Thank your hunter, your upvoters and Product Hunt itself. We thanked every upvoter with a personalized tweet in which we tagged Product Hunt to increase our chances of being liked and retweeted.



4) Facebook, LinkedIn, Instagram, Snapchat, Pinterest,...

Besides Twitter, use any channel you have some kind of following to get the word out. Facebook is obvious. We posted the same kind of stuff as we did on Twitter — just a little less because it's somewhat harder to make something go viral there using hashtags and mentions. Also have team members post from personal accounts.

Apply the same strategy to LinkedIn. Although you might want to put up a small blog post there while you're at it — those get great visibility these days. Be sure to have it prepared though.

Instagram, Snapchat and Pinterest can be great too. It all depends on your type of product. Release balloons everywhere, just remember to always adjust your message accordingly.

5) Facebook Groups and Slack Chats 🤗

Where do people on the internet hang out these days? Nowadays, you're probably best off looking at Facebook Groups and Slack Chats.

A lot of geographical regions have their own dedicated Product Hunt community. Just ask for access to as many as possible prior to your launch and keep track of which ones they allow you to. Examples of Groups we posted in include [Product Hunt France](#), [Product Hunt Berlin](#) and [Product Hunt London](#). Make sure to be active before your launch so you're not a total stranger when you post about your launch.

You can also post in other Groups on stuff like startups, entrepreneurship and growth hacking but it's not as easy. Increase your chances by being a valuable member and preferably having a good relation with the group admin. You can try to post about your launch with a post that provides actual value to the community.

For example, we put together a post on some of our pre-launch marketing tactics — then referring to our launch in the first comment. This worked for some groups, not all of them.

Early adopters and entrepreneurs are increasingly finding each other in dedicated Slack Chat communities these days. Same rules: explore beforehand and engage with the community before you ask something from them. You can start looking for relevant Slack communities [here](#) and [here](#).

6) Reddit and Hacker News 🗣️

Reddit and HackerNews can be equally powerful channels to get the word out on your PH launch. But, again, you'll need to prepare this beforehand. Write a post that brings value and isn't too spammy.

It's probably also a good idea to build up some karma on your account beforehand as well. Make sure you have some guys/girls ready to upvote your post so people get to see it. The share your startup thread over at the [/startups subreddit](#) is a great place to start.

7) A yuuuuuuge email campaign 📧

"Stick a fork in email, because it's D-O-N-E."

It's not.



Email is still one of the backbones of the Internet. I'm sure you agree and have a big fat email list all ready to fire the news about Product Hunt launch at. If you don't, start right now.

Your email doesn't have to be too fancy. Just put the word out: explain a little about what Product Hunt is all about and include a call-to-action to join the conversation.

8) Make friends. Help out & create value 🧑🧑

By now it will probably have hit you that a lot of this stuff has to do with network and preparation. Sure, you can try to pull off some last-minute hustle and hope for the best but it won't get you very far if no one knows about you.

The single best piece of advice I can give you is to make friends online.

This is not too different from making friends in real life. Start talking, ask about projects, help out where you can, show support, throw in a joke or two... You know how to be a human being, right?

This will all take quite some time, but if you're real about it, it won't feel like work. Before you know it, you'll have a whole army ready to die for you and your Product Hunt glory.

Time to light sh!t up!

TL;DR

- *make sure the whole world knows you're on PH using guerrilla tactics*
- *follow up on your list*
- *keep chatting*
- *make sure every tweet on Twitter is about your PH launch*
- *repeat for other channels — consider blog post on LinkedIn*



- *make nice in Facebook Groups and Slack Chats*
 - *earn some serious karma on reddit and HackerNews*
 - *a yuuuuuuge email campaign*
 - *make friends — be a human being*
-

9. Fly high on comments and caffeine ✈

Reading this thing all the way down to here may have you believe that Product Hunt is all about upvotes. It's not.

Upvotes are easy. A lot of people on Product Hunt will give you one just because you have a nice logo or because your screenshot moves. Maybe it's because you look pretty in your profile picture. Who knows.

It's all about sparking a conversation about your product and upvotes will make it easier to get that going. These are early adopters — product enthusiasts who will show a genuine interest in why and how you built your product. They have tons of value to give you, make it easy for them to do that. It's up to you to take the lead, help people out and demonstrate your appreciation for constructive criticism.

If handled well, your PH page will become a treasure of ideas and connections. From the second you're live, gear up to quickly answer any question that pops up. Always stay positive, even if people are grilling you for no reason. Thank people for their feedback. Lead by example.

Make sure you have your PH page manned around the clock. Always have a guy around for technical questions. These too will come your way.

Your Product Hunt launch is going to be one of those SLEEP IS FOR THE WEAK kind of days. And after it's going to be one of those SLEEP FOR A WEEK kind of weeks. Which of course you won't do since your traffic, signups and requests will be going through the roof and you won't know where to look first.

We loved it. I'm sure you will too.

TL;DR

- *upvotes are overrated*
- *it's about getting people to talk about your product*
- *your chance to shine*
- *lead the conversation — always stay positive*



- *be sure to have people on the team awake around the clock*
 - *prepare for sleep-deprivation*
-

10. The Aftermath 🌟

If done right, Product Hunt is a gift that keeps on giving.

Done right means finishing in the top 5 of the day. This will have you highlighted in PH's newsletter the next day, which will be sent out to (hundreds of) thousands of people. You will also be picked up and featured on sites like <http://thetopfives.net/> and <http://thenews.im/> as well as various by Twitter accounts. We still had a lot of new upvotes coming in two days after our launch.

A week after, we we're still all over the place following up on effects of our Product Hunt campaign.

- 878 upvotes (940 as 5/05)
- 2nd most upvoted product of the day
- #1 CRM on Product Hunt
- 250+ new trials
- 250+ Twitter mentions
- 1000+ new Twitter followers
- 5000+ website visitors
- Chatting on Intercom has become a full-time job

Effects aren't short-term.

Aside from the daily craze, Product Hunt is quickly gaining popularity as a source for great apps. The site is successfully crowdsourcing a space that is traditionally dominated by directories like Capterra and GetApp for a fee.

It's more than a launch vehicle for some early-morning traction — it's also a directory of great products people trust more than alternatives.

In fact, several startups have seen their Product Hunt feature generating high quality leads long after they were featured. This is why becoming the most upvoted CRM is such a big deal for us.

Salesflare is right there when people search for CRM on Product Hunt. Another strategy we'll be working on is to target resourceful PH collections we feel are close to our space and customers and try to get included.

This comes to show there's more to Product Hunt than just a day of madness. It's a one-time opportunity that, if seized well, will bear fruits far beyond early traction and feedback.

UPDATE 5/5: Two months later, Product Hunt is still one our top 5 channels for inbound leads. Not just that, with conversion rate somewhere around 12%, they also seem to be highly qualified leads.

There's more.

Product Hunt recently launched [Product Hunt Ask](#) - an additional forum where user can ask recommendations for types of products. We're monitoring these questions daily. The guys at Product Hunt announced that Product Hunt Ask will soon be searchable too (it's not at this very moment).

TL;DR

- PH is a gift that keeps on giving — if done right
 - aim for the top 5
 - PH can be a sustainable source of leads
 - Monitor the threads in Product Hunt Ask
-

Your move 🙌

There we go, *young Padawan*.

I have nothing left to teach you. Make me proud.



SOFTWARE HACKING



How to Target Capterra
Reviewers with Cold Emails,
Facebook Ads and LinkedIn
Automation

Gilles De Clerck 299

How to Target Capterra Reviewers with Cold Emails, Facebook Ads and LinkedIn Automation

Credit: [Gilles De Clerck](#), Growth Strategist at Salesflare

If you're involved in SaaS I'm sure you're familiar with the likings of [Capterra](#), [GetApp](#), [G2Crowd](#) and their gazillion cousins.

When I started at Salesflare, I was obsessed with these websites.

Not because they would get us tons of leads. They just don't if you're not willing to open up your wallet big time for a good listing.

No, I used to browse them for hours because of the gazillion reviews people left our competitors. It was a great way to get to know our target audience and their needs. It helped me figure out what kind of value we needed to create to win them over.

Today, I know who our target customers are and I know what kind of value they're looking for. The game has shifted from getting to know them to putting the moves on them.

Which brings us to the next phase: how do you target all those target customers at scale?

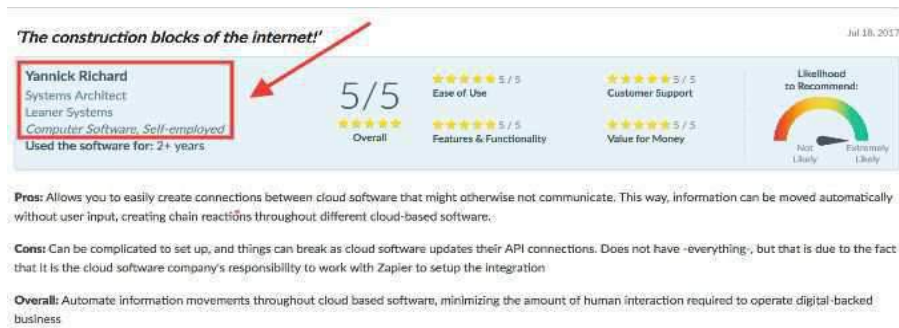
This guide will walk you through the steps needed to get target customers like these in front of your value using cold emails, Facebook Ads and LinkedIn automation.

We'll be taking Capterra as an example but you can make this work for any webpage that provides you with at least the following three elements:

- first name
- last name
- company name

Here's what a typical Capterra review looks like (for workflow automation gem [Zapier](#)) 📌 📄





In addition to the name of the reviewer and the company he/she represents, we'll also have their role and their industry.

Zapier has 130 reviews on Capterra. Of course, there's no way we're going to manually copy and paste all of that data.

Welcome to the Scrapocalypse 🗑️



Process:

- Step 1: Create a scraping recipe with [Recipe Creator](#)
- Step 2: Scrape it. Scrape it real good with [DataMiner](#)
- Step 3: Match Company Names with Domains using [PhantomBuster](#)
- Step 4: Use [FindThatLead](#) to find email addresses for cold emailing
- Step 5: Match personal addresses to make Facebook Audiences with [FindThatLead](#)
- Step 6: Match LinkedIn Profiles with [PhantomBuster](#)
- Step 7: Automate LinkedIn outreach with [Dux-Soup](#)

Targeting possibilities:

- Cold email



- Facebook Ads
- LinkedIn outreach and automation

Tools:

- [DataMiner](#) ft. [Recipe Creator](#)
- [PhantomBuster](#)
- Microsoft Excel and/or Google Sheets
- [FindThatLead](#)
- [Dux-Soup](#)

Step 1: Create a scraping recipe with Recipe Creator

There's tons of scraping tools out there.

To get the data we want, we don't need something fancy schmancy. [DataMiner](#) is a free and easy Chrome extension that does the job.

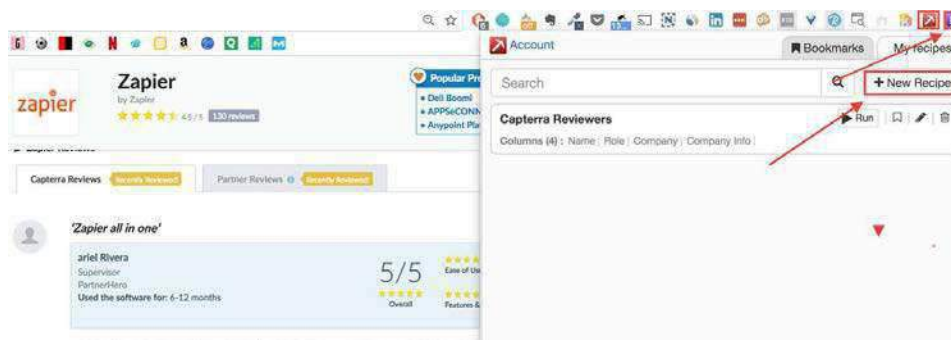
First thing you'll need to do is set up DataMiner to scrape the data you want, creating a recipe for it.

I'd happily share mine in the public DataMiner directory but I'd need to have a paid subscription to do that, which I don't.

Instead, I'll just tell you how to create the recipe yourself, which will also get you acquainted with data scraping logic.

Once you get a hang of this, no data on the web will be safe for you anymore.

First, download [Recipe Creator](#) — another Chrome extension that will work together with DataMiner. Open it up on the page you want to scrape and click 'New Recipe'.



You'll now be taken through a process that'll help you define the data you want to retrieve from the review page.

Check out this 2-minute video for instructions: <https://youtu.be/XZY1KQq62hE>

This recipe will work for every Capterra product page you'd ever want to scrape.

Step 2: Scrape it real good with DataMiner

Time to mine the gold 🏆.

Open the DataMiner Chrome extension and select the recipe you just created with Recipe Creator.

Data Miner - Chrome Extension				
	Name	Role	Company	Industry + Company Size
1				
2	Ariel Rivera	Supervisor	PartnerHero	
3	Steve Prendergast	Owner	Game Changer Media Group, LLC	Marketing and Advertising, 1-10 employees
4	Stephen Vulpitta	Marketing	Think Tank NTG	Computer & Network Security, 11-50 employees
5	Don Tinea	Director of Strategic Partnerships	Checkmate	
6	Yannick Richard	Systems Architect	Leaner Systems	Computer Software, Self-employed
7	Sarah Chamberlin	Founder	Abacus Design	Internet, 1-10 employees
8	Rachel Campbell	Marketing Director	The Grossman Law Firm APC	Legal Services, 1-10 employees
9	Patrick Sylim	University Researcher	University of the Philippines Manila	
10	Anastasia Osbourne	business owner	Dejadrewit	Arts and Crafts, Self-employed
11	Connor Haslam	Marketing Manager	VA Partners	Marketing and Advertising, 1-10 employees
12	JJ Beeler	Health Coach	Benestare Pain Management	Health, Wellness and Fitness, 1-10 employees
13	Antoine Le Mette	Traffic Manager	SchoolMouv	Education Management, 11-50 employees
14	Martin Wong	Marketer	mailfloss	
15	Matthew Nadler	Tutor	Matthew Nadler Tutoring	
16	Ben McClure	Head of Development Technologies	Top Floor	Internet, 11-50 employees
17	Jacob McConaughy	Office Manager	TimeSaver Home Services	Consumer Services, 1-10 employees
18	Janelle Wheale	Owner	Own Your Success Training	Health, Wellness and Fitness, 1-10 employees
19	Paul Pace	Account Executive	AHK Electronic Sheet Metal	Management Consulting, 11-50 employees
20	Peg Perry	CEO	trickswithsticks.ca	Internet, Self-employed
21	Yavor Trampov		PolyTech	
22	Nicholas Scalice	Founder	Earnworthy	Marketing and Advertising, 1-10 employees
23	Nathan West		Digital Vibe	
24	Josh Teslin	Director of Sales & Marketing	Fort Wayne Komets	Entertainment, 1-10 employees
25	Trent M.	Director	Coda metro	Civic & Social Organization

Bam.

Names, roles, company names, industries and company sizes.

Hit 'Download' on the bottom of the DataMiner UI for a .CSV with the results.

Pretty sweet but not quite enough have them fall into your web. Yet.

Step 3: Match Company Names with Domains using [PhantomBuster](#)

*(There is an alternative way to retrieve Domains. This involves getting LinkedURLs from names + company names (with another PhantomBuster script) and then revisiting/scraping those LinkedIn profiles using Dux-Soup. **Head over to Step 5–6 if this sounds more like your jam.**)*

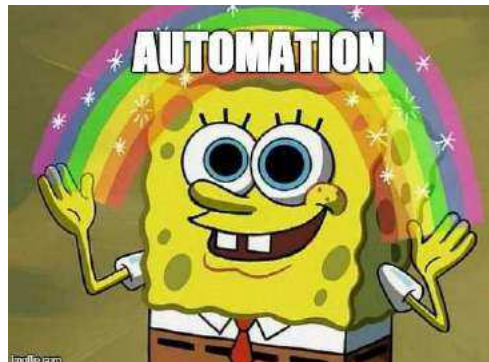
To find email addresses, we need (1) names and (2) domains.

Names we already have.

Domains we can find by running the Company Names through a search engine and getting the first result, which will be the company's website in about 90% of the cases.

No, we're not going to do this manually.

You're a human being. This is robot's work so we'll have a robot do it.



[PhantomBuster](#) is a platform that gives you the power to automate repetitive data scraping tasks like this one.

You just have to tell it what to do.

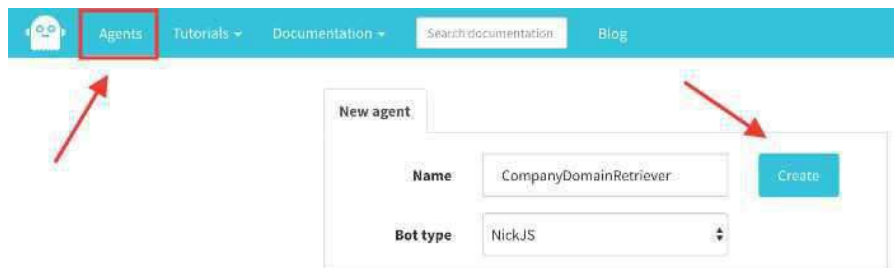
We to set up a bot that automatically runs search queries in Google for each of the company names, then save the first result in a column of a .CSV export file.

That is exactly what this [script](#) does.



You can follow these steps to set up the script in PhantomBuster and run it to retrieve Company Domains from a list of Company Names:

- Head over to [Phantombuster](#) and create a free account.
- Select 'Agents' from the top menu and Create a 'New Agent' from the form on the top.

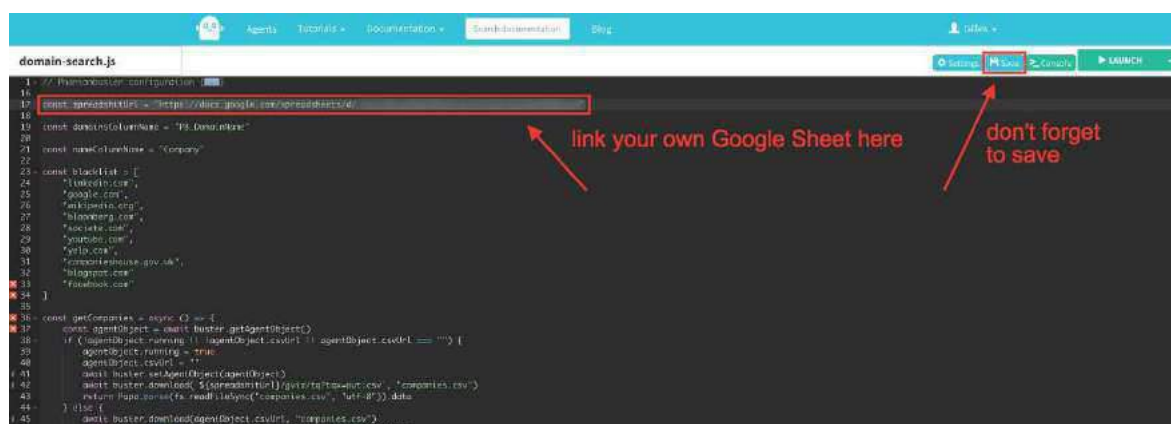


- You'll be taken to a scary-looking code interface. Stay calm, you just need to copy-paste a script into it.
- There may be some pre-filled code into. Empty everything (Select All > Delete/Backspace) and copy-paste the code from this [script](#).
- The script will source Company Names from a Google Sheet. Copy the contents of the .CSV with scraped data you got from DataMiner into a Google Sheet and paste the link into the script as shown in the screenshot. Make sure to delete everything after the first combination of letters/numbers when you paste it in.

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/0B7r3lbqzGX7YUHQ2QWpkOC0zcG8/view?usp=sharing>

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/0B7r3lbqzGX7YUHQ2QWpkOC0zcG8> make sure to remove this part

- the script will source company names from the column with header 'Column'. If you followed the scraping script from Step 1 this should be fine.



- Go into 'Settings' and set a number higher than 0 for 'number of retries'. Google has the tendency to block IPs if a certain number of searches are run from the same IP in quick succession. The script will relaunch and use another IP if this happens.

domain-search / Settings

- Click 'Launch' — you'll get something like this

script may run into errors - mainly because Google may block IPs when scraping automatically. The script will just relaunch where it left off until it has an output for all the inputs.

click here to download the .CSV

this .CSV contains a new column with the Company Domains

- Download the .CSV with the Company Domains - this will be called *output.csv*

These domains enable you to find work email addresses (Step 4 and LinkedIn profiles (Step 6 for the reviewers.

Step 4: Use [FindThatLead](#) to find email addresses for cold emailing

FindThatLead is a badass lead finder tool that will get you email addresses from inputs like names and domains.

From the data we have gathered, there's two things we can do with FindThatLead:

- 'Domain Search' to retrieve emails linked to a Domain
- 'Lead Search' to find specific emails from First Name, Last Name and Domain



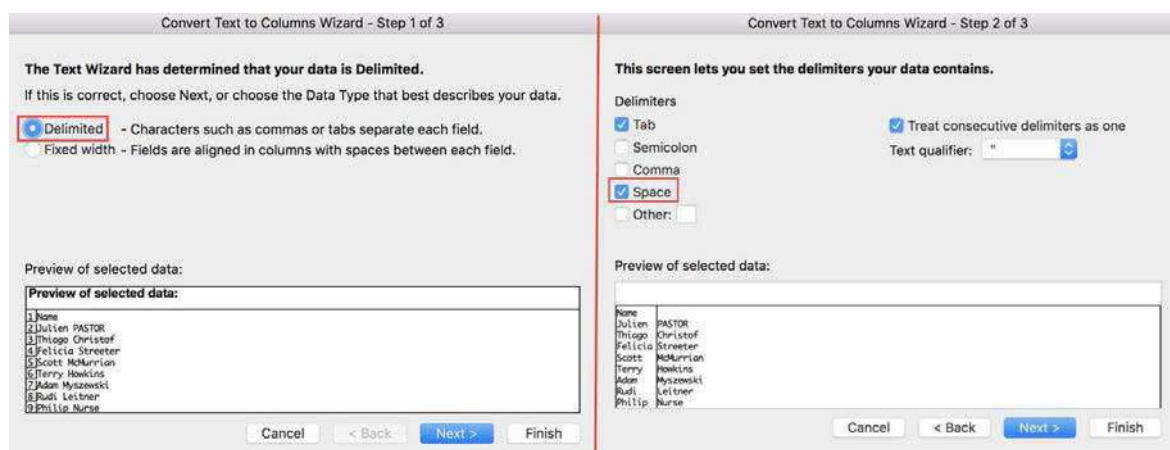
Domain Search

All you need: a .CSV with a 'Domain' column — FindThatLead will get you emails for every domain.

Lead Search

To find the email addresses of specific people at companies, you'll need a .CSV with three columns: First Name, Last Name and Domain.

Since you scraped the names in full, you'll need to split first name and last name. The fastest way to do this in Excel is to select the column containing the name and then using Data > Text to Columns, using 'Space' as delimiter.



A free FindThatLead account will get you 10 credits per day, so you'll need to upgrade to a paid plan.

Here's the thing though: you won't find anything cheaper that is as good.

Step 5: Find LinkedIn Profiles with [PhantomBuster](#)

Having names and domains also allows us to match reviewers with LinkedIn Profile URLs.

Similar to how we matched Domains to Company Names, we'll have PhantomBuster automate scraping Google to retrieve LinkedIn URLs from name + company name.

Yes, you'll need another script.

👉 [This one](#) 👈.

The steps to have PhantomBuster execute it are essentially the same as the ones described in Step 3.

- create a New Agent
- empty the terminal and copy-paste the script
- link a Google Sheet containing names and company names. The script will take names from column A and company names from column C. This is based on the scraping recipe outlined in Step 1
- Run the script hitting 'Launch'
- Download .CSV with results

PhantomBuster will just fill the first empty column in the sheet with results, so you don't need to set something up there.

Running the two scripts to retrieve domain names and LinkedIn profile URLs, you now should be left with this beautiful sheet of data on your competitor's customers.

	Name	Role	Company	Company Info	DomainName	PB_LinkedInUri
1	Thiago	CEO	Calamar	Computer Software, 1-10 e	calamar.com	https://br.linkedin.com/in/thiago
3	Felicia	Owner	Dream4Self Business Servic	Professional Training & Coa	manta.com	https://www.linkedin.com/in/dream
4	Terry	Logistics Sales	Just Rush Express	Transportation/Trucking/R	justrush.com	https://www.linkedin.com/in/terry
5	Adam	National Sales	Houck Transit Advertising	Marketing and Advertising,	houckads.com	https://www.linkedin.com/in/adam
6	Rudi	Chairman	Hypenica	Events Services, 11-50 emp	hypenica.com	https://za.linkedin.com/in/rud
7	Phillip	Business Owne	TUTCH Mobile Spa	Health, Wellness and Fitnes	tutchmobilespabarbados.c	https://www.linkedin.com/in/errol
8	Julien	Head of Sales	ARGOLIGHT	Research, 11-50 employees	argolight.com	https://fr.linkedin.com/in/julien
9	Clint	founding partn	The Writing Company		writingcompany.net	https://www.linkedin.com/in/clint
10	Ricardo	Principal	LunaCap Ventures	Venture Capital & Private E	lunacapventures.com	https://www.linkedin.com/in/ricardo
11	Emily	Project Manage	Post Modern Marketing	Marketing and Advertising,	postmm.com	https://www.linkedin.com/in/emily
12	Eckart	CEO	Uberchord		uberchord.com	https://de.linkedin.com/in/eckartburg
13	Gregory	Account Execut	Advantage Caribbean Instit	Education Management, 1-	advantagecaribbean.com	https://www.linkedin.com/in/gregory
14	Patrick	Sales Operator	testXChange	11-50 employees	testxchange.com	https://de.linkedin.com/in/patrick
15	Mark	VP Sales	Selvera	Computer Software, 11-50	selvera.com	https://www.linkedin.com/in/mark
16	Craig	VP Business De	VCS	Broadcast Media, 1-10 emp	vcscompanies.com	https://www.linkedin.com/in/craig
17	Chris	Nc Chief Commec	Adapto Technologies ApS	Human Resources, 1-10 em	adapto.me	https://dk.linkedin.com/in/chris
18	Alexandre	Business Devel	Abreu Carga	Transportation/Trucking/R	abreucarga.co.ao	https://pt.linkedin.com/in/alexandre
19	Steve	Sales Manager	Ultra Electronics		ultra-electronics.com	https://uk.linkedin.com/in/eadstu
20	Matt	Head of Busine	Tracts	Oil & Energy, 1-10 employe	tracts.co	https://www.linkedin.com/in/mattc
21	Pia	Managing Direc	Advantage Caribbean Instit	Education Management, 1-	advantagecaribbean.com	https://www.linkedin.com/in/pia
22	Andrew	Marketing Dire	Web Sauce Studio	Marketing and Advertising,	websaucestudio.com	https://www.linkedin.com/in/andrew
23	Andres	CEO	estacionLAPAZ	Marketing and Advertising,	estacionlapaz.com	https://bo.linkedin.com/in/andres
24	Jorge	CSO	Imaginamos		imaginamos.com	https://co.linkedin.com/in/jorgequin
25	Daniel	Marketing Asso	ParqEx	Real Estate, 11-50 employe	parqex.com	https://www.linkedin.com/in/daniel
26	Dan	Director of Sale	ParqEx		parqex.com	https://www.linkedin.com/in/dan

Step 6: Unleash the Dux

To make the most out of the found LinkedIn URLs ,we'll be using one of my favorite growth hacking tools: Dux-Soup.

Dux-Soup is a little robot that allows you to auto-visit LinkedIn profiles.

You can use it to auto-visit targeted profiles in LinkedIn or Sales Navigator.

You'll get new connections, introductions and leads without lifting a finger.

There's more.

Dux-Soup will also scrape first names, last names, industries, roles, company size and company domains and whatever else they have filled in on their LinkedIn profiles. Exportable as a .CSV — file.

In fact, instead of retrieving domains with the PhantomBuster script, you could have also first scraped the LinkedIn Profile URLs and then visit those with Dux-Soup to get company domains.

To auto-visit/scrape the LinkedIn profiles of the Capterra reviewers, we'll be using Dux-Soup's 'Revisit Data' feature.



Note: Revisiting is a Pro-feature. It would set you back about \$15 a month.

#1. Download Dux-Soup .CSV template

The idea of Dux-Soup's 'Revisit Data' is to revisit profiles you auto-visited before.

We're going to trick Dux-Soup into thinking it already visited the LinkedIn profiles of the Capterra reviewers before.

All it takes is a .CSV with Dux-Soup export headers and first names + last names filled in.

You can get a template [here](#).

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T
1	id	VisitTime	Profile	Deezee	First Name	Middle Name	Last Name	From	Title	Company	CompanyPro	CompanyWe	Email	Phone	IM	Twitter	Location	Industry	My Tags	My Notes
2			https://br.linkedin.com/		Darth		Vader													
3			https://www.linkedin.co		Jon		Snow													
4			https://www.linkedin.co		Jordan		Belfort													
5			https://www.linkedin.co		Jesus		Christ													
6			https://a.linkedin.com/		Sales		Flare													
7			https://www.linkedin.co		Ilion		Musk													
8			https://li.linkedin.com/s		Nikola		Tesla													
9			https://www.linkedin.co		Barack		Obama													
10			https://www.linkedin.co		Net		Flix													
11			https://www.linkedin.co		Daearys		Targaryen													
12			https://de.linkedin.com/		Balerion		The Dread													
13			https://www.linkedin.co		Jeff		Bexos													
14			https://de.linkedin.com/		Pablo		The Gorilla													
15			https://www.linkedin.co		Rico		Wagner													
16			https://www.linkedin.co		Jerren		Janssen													
17			https://de.linkedin.com/		Jaqen		Hagar													
18			https://at.linkedin.com/		Khal		Drogo													
19			https://uk.linkedin.com/		Kylo		Ren													
20			https://www.linkedin.co		Sip		Weill													
21			https://www.linkedin.co		Dux		Soup													
22			https://www.linkedin.co		Ian		Fleming													
23			https://ro.linkedin.com/		Alan		Turing													
24			https://co.linkedin.com/		Frodo		Baggins													
25			https://www.linkedin.co		Pie		Pie													
26			https://www.linkedin.co		Alexander		The Great													
27			https://www.linkedin.co		Mao		Zedong													
28			https://a.linkedin.com/		Abraham		Lincoln													
29			https://www.linkedin.co		Julius		Caesar													
30			https://a.linkedin.com/		Vasco		Da Gama													
31			https://www.linkedin.co		Nelson		Mandela													
32			https://uk.linkedin.co		Michael		Jordan													
33			not found		Muhammed		All													
34			https://in.linkedin.com/		Curtis		Jackson													
35			https://au.linkedin.com/		Marshall		Mathers													
36			https://fr.linkedin.com/		Freddy		Mercury													

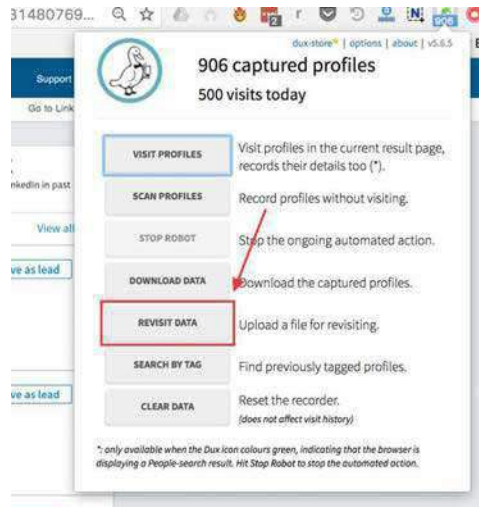
all the other stuff can be empty

LinkedIn URLs
from reviewers

#2. Paste the LinkedIn URLs in the 'Profile' column

Dux-Soup will update the rest of the data once it revisited the LinkedIn Profile URLs in the 'Profile' column'.

#3. 'Revisit' the LinkedIn profiles



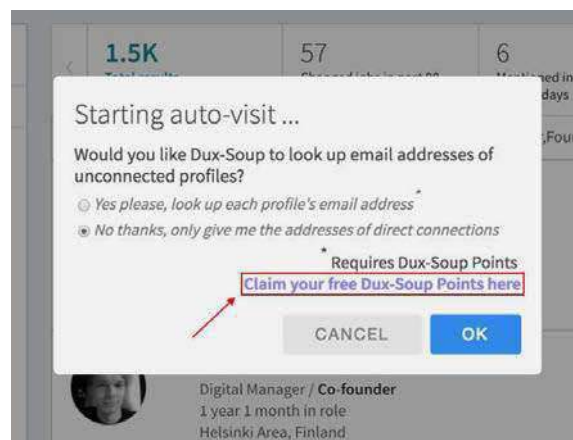
#5. Upload the .CSV with the LinkedIn profiles

#6. Hit 'Visit Profiles' from the Dux-Soup Chrome extension UI

#7. Download results with 'Download Data'

Step 7: Create Facebook Audiences by getting personal email addresses with Dux-Soup's email finder

As soon as you hit that 'Visit Profiles' button, Dux-Soup will ask if you want it to find email addresses too.



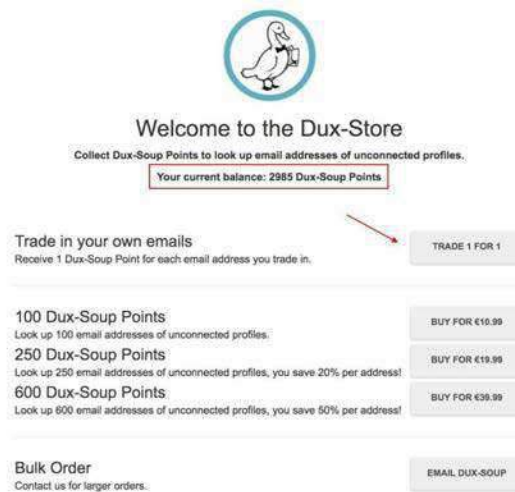
Dux-Soup has a point system where 1 point is good for 1 email address return.

You can either buy these points or trade in the email addresses from your LinkedIn connections.



This is how they source all those emails.

Return rate? About 90% 🌟.



Get this: *a lot* of the email addresses Dux-Soup will return are *personal* Gmail — addresses.

How so?

Simple: back when LinkedIn was taking its first steps, most people signed up with their personal email and never bothered to change their primary email addresses to their work email.

If you're having an *oh oh* — moment now: sorry about that. Now go ahead and change it.



There's good news too.

Personal email addresses are what you need to create Facebook Audiences from these competitor's customers.



Once your Facebook Audience has reached a certain size, you can make a Lookalike Audience out of it.

More of your competitor's customers 😊.

What about other review websites?

You can apply this Play and its steps to any website that gives you at least names and company names.

Keep in mind that you'll need to create different scrape recipes with Recipe Creator. It goes without saying every other website will have its data structured differently than Capterra.

I used Capterra as an example because it's arguably the most important software review website out there and because most products have a ton of reviewers you can all turn into leads.

Second biggest [GetApp](#) is part of the Capterra — ecosystem as of recently and sources reviews from Capterra onto its page. That plus the fact that it leaves out company names for reviewers makes it not worth looking at.

Scraping [G2Crowd](#) is possible (and interesting) but more complicated because the reviewers' credentials are only provided on the reviewer's profile page. This means you'd first have to scrape all profile URLs to then scrape the data you want off each profile URL. This is not possible with DataMiner's free version. If you'd like to get into this, feel free to connect with me on [LinkedIn](#) or [Facebook](#).

A software directory you can pretty easily scrape is [Sifterly](#).

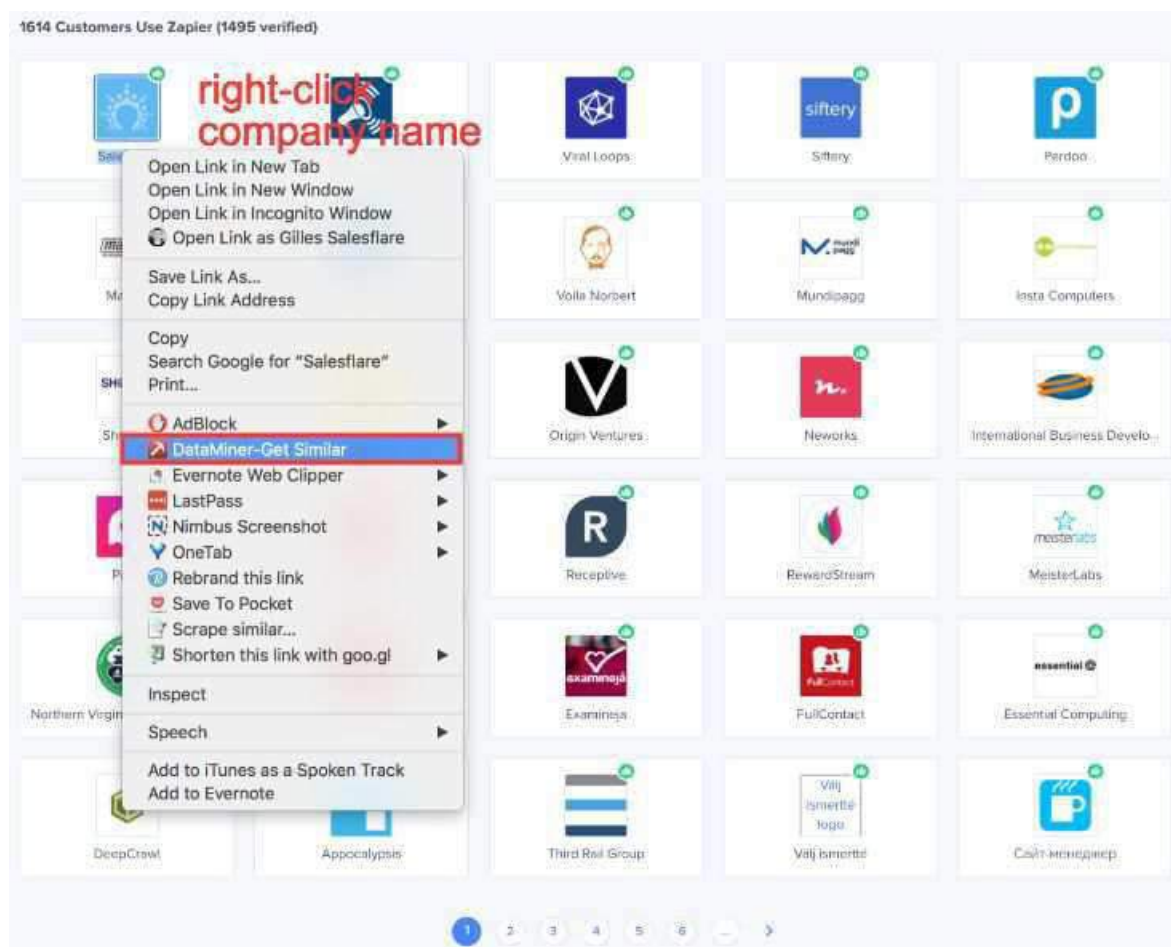
Sifterly lists the companies using a particular software product.

You can scrape these companies pretty easily by using DataMiner's 'GetSimilar' feature on each page.

This will get you all the company names and their Sifterly Profile URLs in two columns.

Repeat on every page.





There's a drawback.

Siftify only allows you to check out 120 companies using a software product. With each page showcasing 30 companies, you'll be prompted to submit a special request to Siftify as soon as you try to access page 5.

You can use the [PhantomBuster](#) script to retrieve Domains for Company Names as shown in Step 3 and then use those Domains to find email addresses using [FindThatLead](#)'s Domain Search feature.



CONTENT HACKING



The 11 P.M. Rule	Josh Fechter	315
How I Created Over 1,200 Pieces of Content in the Last Twelve Months	Josh Fechter	317

The 11 P.M. Rule

Credit: [Josh Fechter](#), Co-Founder of [BAMF.Media](#)

Do you follow the 11 p.m. rule?

If not, keep reading.

Every Monday I send out two newsletters:

1. My latest growth hacks
2. Events coming up

Here's the problem:

Some Mondays I can't find a single second to send out these newsletters until it's almost midnight.

I could wait.

And send these newsletters out the next day.

But I don't do that.

Because if it's okay one time, then it's okay the next time.

And most people aren't consistent.

In fact, the easiest way to be memorable is to show up every day.

How many people do you know never miss a gym session?

You can probably count them on one hand.

This is why even when it's 11 p.m., I'll still send out these emails.

As a result, this happens:

Sloppy grammar? Check.

Lazy subject line? Check.

Bad spacing? Check.

IT DOESN'T MATTER.

CONSISTENCY IS MORE IMPORTANT THAN BEING PERFECT.

Repeat this several times. Seriously.

If you're waiting for perfection, then you've already lost momentum.



Even if it's 11 p.m. and you have one hour left until the next day - just fucken do it.
If you don't, then you're like every inconsistent person who wishes they had more discipline.
I don't care if you have lower open rates.
I don't care if your copy sucks.
I care that you show up when you promise. Otherwise, you're not dependable.
And if I can't trust you, then I pay attention to you.



How I Created Over 1,200 Pieces of Content in the Last Twelve Months

Credit: [JoshFechter](#), Co-Founder of [BAMF.Media](#)

1. Document; don't create

Gary Vaynerchuk says this all the time.

This week I created close to twenty pieces of content from meetings I had.

These pieces of content received over 1,000 engagements in total.

How many of you have business meetings? No excuses not to create content.

2. Eat last

Great content creators don't celebrate after a piece of their content gets lots of engagement. They move on to the next piece.

3. Always be resourceful

I try to walk away from every conversation with a new piece of content I can create. If I don't, then it wasn't a useful conversation.

Note: You are allowed one post on how to avoid useless conversations ;)

4. Test faster

If you don't test, then you have no experiments, experiences, and processes to document.

This requires you to develop a high tolerance to risk. Get used to it.

5. Set the bar high, then reach higher

My most engaged case studies came from taking the most risk. If you set the bar low, you'll always feel good, but have average content.

6. No days off

In the last year, I took one entire day off from creating content.

7. Have a big mouth

I rarely ever "think" about business because I externalize everything through my writing and video.

An hour after a meeting, I'll sit down and write a post like this one reflecting on it. The more time I think; the fewer experiments I create.

8. Your journey gets less engagement than the result



But documenting your journey will 10X the engagement of the result. For example, I tore my hamstring. I might not compete in the world's this year.

Here's the thing: No one cares about my torn hamstring.

But it makes the result better because people can relate to coming back from an injury. It's the hero's story.

9. Have a zero meeting policy

I don't let people set meetings with me.

I set meetings with them because I operate on my time.

10. Don't pick a niche; document your journey

If you document your journey, then the niche should appear naturally. I consult startups. In turn, I have a lot of startup content to document.

11. Never ask for permission

If you receive a "no" or have to wait for a "yes," then you've lost valuable time to document your journey.

12. Don't chase media exposure; build cool shit that gets attention

Media exposure doesn't give you a lot of leverage except another logo to add to your landing page.

Cool products will give you media, customers, and relationships.

13. Don't reply to 90% of asks

Enough said.

14. Don't reply to the 99% of people who want intros

I get many requests every week to hire a head of growth even for companies where I've never used their product.

Relationships are your most valuable asset.

I have to remind them that a recruiting fee for a head of growth ranges from \$15K - \$30k.

15. Have fun; laugh often

The hardest part of creating unique content is avoiding burn out. I've faced this several times in the last year.

What keeps me sane is not taking my work too seriously. I treat every meeting as a fun opportunity to make friends even when there are thousands of dollars on the table. I believe there should never be a reason to stress. Life is short.





TOOLS



80+ Epic Growth Hacking Tools

Josh Fechter

320

Your Epic Tool List

Credit: [Josh Fechter](#), Co-Founder of [BAMF.Media](#)

1. Send many cold emails:

[GMASS](#)

[Mailshake](#)

2. Emails with Sequences

[MixMax](#)

3. Quickly Analyze a Site's Traffic and Referring Traffic (Quick view)

[Alexa Ranking](#)

[Similar Web](#)

4. A great screenshot, GIF tool

[Lightshot](#)

[GIPHY](#)

5. Keeping Password's Secure

[Password Box](#)

6. Identifies whether you're being retargeted and if your retargeting works

[Facebook Pixel Helper](#)

[Tag Assistant](#)

7. Auto-posting to Instagram

[Grum.co](#)

8. Wireframes

[UX Pin](#)

[Balsamiq](#)

9. Email Setup

[ConvertKit](#)

[MailChimp](#)

[Autopilot](#)



10. Chatbot Automation

[Chatfuel](#)

[ManyChat](#)

11. YouTube Analytics

[vidIQ](#)

12. Email Extraction

[Toofr](#), [Email Hunter](#), [Clearbit](#)

13. Extract Audio from Live Video

[Audio Extractor](#)

14. Download Facebook Video

[Download Facebook Video](#)

15. Scrape Emails

[Scrapebox](#), [Webscraper.io](#), [Import.io](#)

16. Reduce image quality without reducing size:

[TinyPNG](#)

17. Recording to Text

[Rev](#)

18. Slack Paid Wall Subscription

[Slack Paid Wall](#)

19. Customer Onboarding/Support

[Drift](#), [Intercom](#)

20. Fear of missing out

[UseFomo](#)

21. Test whether your email will go to spam



[G-Lock Apps](#), [Mail Tester](#)

22. Pluck (finding Emails from Tweets)

[Pluck](#)

23. Use Paperless Post for better onboarding

[Paperless Post](#)

24. Alexa by Category

[Alexa Top Sites](#)

25. Re-sending emails

[Rebump](#)

26. Online Calculators

[Viral Coefficient Calculator](#), [A/B Test Calculator](#)

27. Retargeting Links:

[Clickmeter](#)

28. Extracting emails from Twitter and Instagram users

[Geekmail](#)

29. Extract emails from websites

[Email Grabber](#)

30. Free Logo

[Tailorbrands](#)

31. Online Community Building

[Facebook@Work](#), [Slack](#), Facebook Groups

32. Social discovery for Instagram and Twitter (includes automation and exporting target users)

[Audiense](#)



33. Quickly Analyze a Site's Traffic and Referring Traffic (Overall view):

[Similar Web](#)

34. Automation for Twitter, Instagram, Pinterest

[FollowerLiker](#)

35. Facebook Group Analytics

[Grytics](#)

36. Scaling Facebook Ad Campaigns

[AdEspresso](#)

37. Slack Analytics

[Statsbot](#)

38. CRM for sequences and funnel tracking

[PropellerCRM](#)

39. Referral Marketing Software

[Queue](#)

40. Twitter and Instagram Automation

[Crowdfire](#), [FollowLiker](#)

41. Choose Color Scheme

[Coolors.co](#)

[Color.adobe.com](#)

42. Pick a font for your brand

[Dafont](#)

43. Connecting software tools

[Zapier](#)

44. A/B Testing

[Optimizely](#)

45. Facebook digital courses and Facebook membership communities

[22Social](#)



46. Automated syncing with custom audiences
[driftrock](#)

47. Cleaner copywriting
[Grammarly](#), [Hemingway App](#)

48. Landing Page Setup
[Instapage](#)

49. Gather and automate the reporting of data
[Blockspring](#)

50. Automated reporting
[Google Analytics Spreadsheet Add-on](#)

51. Live Stream
[OBS Software](#), [BlueJeans](#)

52. Survey
[Qualaroo](#), [SurveyMonkey](#), Google Forms

53. Capturing Leads
[Thrive Leads](#)

54. Better presentations
[Amplislide](#)

55. Payment syncing
[Braintree](#)
[Stripe](#)

56. Outsourcing
[Upwork](#)

57. Cleans scraped data
[Friendly CSV](#)

58: SEO optimization and backlinking
[MOZ](#), [Ahrefs](#)



59: Data collection and reporting

[Segment](#)

60: Transactional emails

[Sendgrid](#)

61: Free ribbon to collect emails

[Sumome](#)

62. Heat maps

[Hotjar](#)

63. Organizing Google Spreadsheets (add-ons)

[Hunter.io](#), [Remove Duplicates](#), [Clearbit Sheets](#), [Sort by Color](#), [Split Names](#), [Power Tools](#)

64. Find out what tools different sites are built with

[BuiltWith](#)

65: Gmail inbox testing

[Litmus](#)

66: Finding emails for free

[Lucify](#)

67: Export Facebook Comments

[Crazy Comment Export Tool](#)

68. Auto sending message to people who comment on a fan page post

[Trustmsg](#)

69. SaaS Analytics

[Chartmogul](#)

70: Find your startup lawyer

[LawTrades](#)

71. Pull email addresses from LinkedIn

[Contactout](#)

72. Mouse over any spot on the web and grab the color

[ColorPick EyeDropper](#)



73. LinkedIn automation on steroids

[GPZ LinkedIn](#)
[Linked Helper](#)
[Dux Soup](#)

74. Pull member data from Facebook Groups

[Grouply](#)

75. Invite all friends on Facebook to like your page

[Invite All](#)

76. Referral marketing software for marketers

[Maitre](#)

77. Referrals software for almost every type of company

[Viral Loops](#)

78. Faster A/B Testing

[Effin Amazing A/B Tester Calculator](#)

79. Faster UTM Building

[Effin Amazing UTM Builder](#)

80. The fastest way to create branded links when sharing any URL.

[Rebrandly](#)

81. Remove your News Feed and replace it with an inspirational quote

[News Feed Eradicator](#)

82. See what software companies use on their websites

[Wappanalyzer](#)

83. Allows you to bulk unfollow and block people to clean up your engagement on Twitter

[Tweepi](#)



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empower 1 million founders
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THE END



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